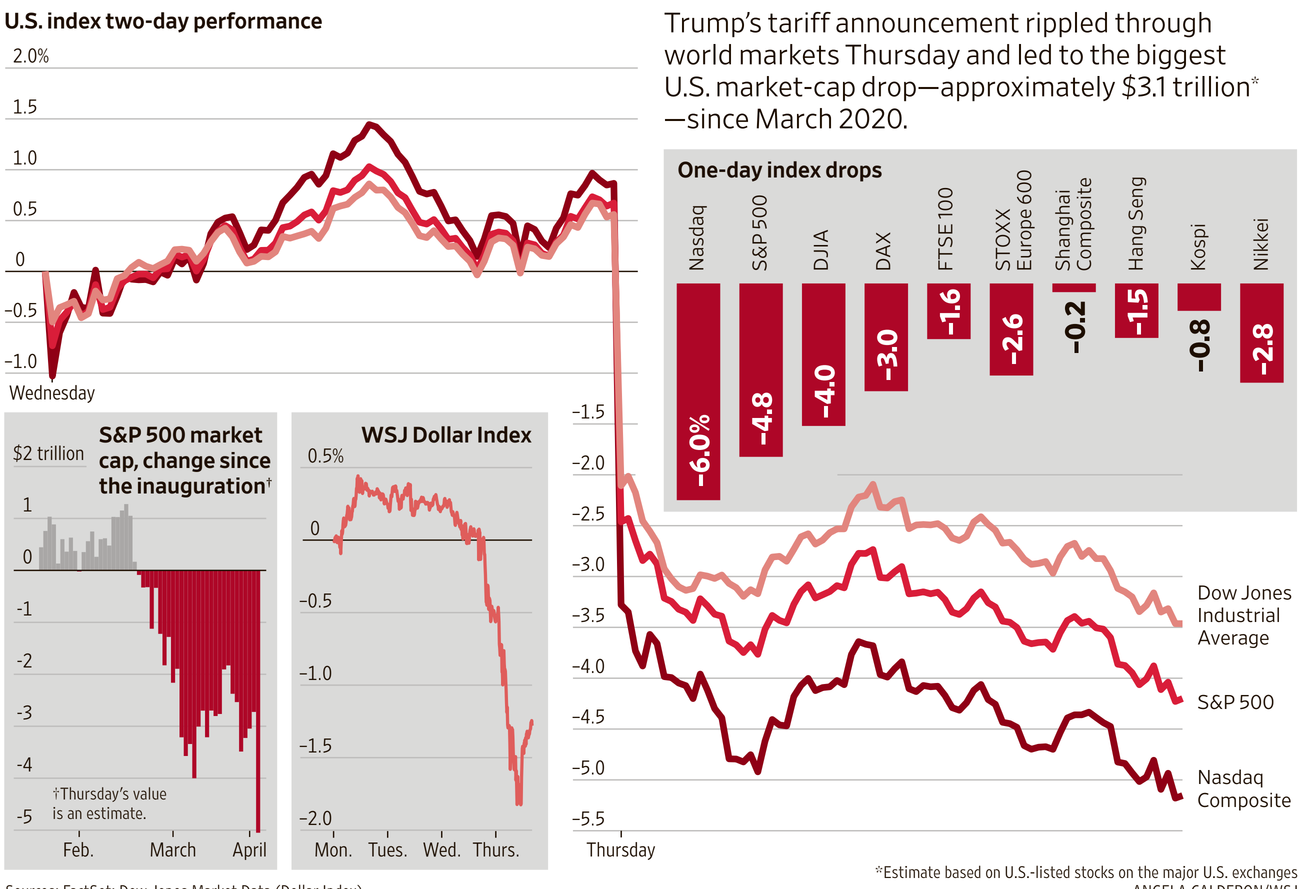
P2JW094000-7-A00100-16DDF61078D

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DOW JONES | News Corp * * * * * * * FRIDAY, APRIL 4, 2025 ~ VOL. CCLXXXV NO. 78 WSJ.com ★★★★ $5.00

DJIA 40545.93 ▼ 1679.39 3.98% NASDAQ 16550.61 ▼ 6.0% STOXX 600 523.12 ▼ 2.6% 10-YR. TREAS. ▲ 1 5/32, yield 4.054% OIL $66.95 ▼ $4.76 GOLD $3,097.00 ▼ $42.90 EURO $1.1055 YEN 146.06

Stocks Suffer Steepest Slide Since 2020



Sources: FactSet; Dow Jones Market Data (Dollar Index)

*Estimate based on U.S.-listed stocks on the major U.S. exchanges
ANGELA CALDERON/WSJ

Dow drops 1,679 points as tariffs are more severe than investors expected

U.S. markets plunged Thursday in their steepest declines since 2020, as investors grappled with the threat that President Trump's new tariff plan will trigger global retaliation and hurt the economy.

By Gregory Zuckerman, Krystal Hur and Gunjan Banerji

Stocks lost about $3.1 trillion in market value Thursday, their largest decline since March 2020.

The Dow industrials dropped 1,679 points, or 4%. The tech-heavy Nasdaq, which powered the market higher for years, was down 6%, pulled lower by big declines in Nvidia, Apple and Amazon.com. The S&P 500, which fell 4.8%, and the other benchmarks, suffered their sharpest declines since the early days of the pandemic.

Asian stocks extended the losses in Friday morning trading. Japan's Nikkei Stock Average finished the morning session down 2.6%, following a 2.8% decline on Thursday. South Korea's Kospi pared earlier losses and was down 0.5%, while markets in Hong Kong and China were closed for a holiday.

Some of the U.S.'s allies came out swinging. President Emmanuel Macron of France said Europe is weighing retaliation against U.S. tech firms, while Prime Minister Mark Carney of Canada said his country will match Trump's auto tariffs with 25% tariffs of its own.

Dozens of household-name stocks posted double-digit declines, including HP, Nike and Target. Stellantis also fell sharply. The Jeep maker said it is temporarily halting production at its auto assembly facto-

Please turn to page A8

Trump's Tariffs Buffet Businesses As CEOs Rush to Deal With Fallout

Business leaders scrambled to assess how President Trump's latest tariffs would affect their companies, with

By Theo Francis, Inti Pacheco and Alistair MacDonald

many top CEOs staying silent as the president's new policies made the cost of doing business in the U.S. much steeper.

Restoration Hardware Chief Executive Gary Friedman was on a call with analysts talking about the furniture retailer's strategy and how the housing market could slow in this economic environment when the tariff news broke. He asked colleagues to get a "live read" of his business to check how the company's stock was doing.

"Oh, really? Oh, s—, OK," Friedman said in the moment. "Everybody can see in our 10-K where we're sourcing from, so it's not a secret."

More than 70% of the furniture company's products come from Asia, its annual report shows, including 35% from Vietnam and 23% from China, where steep new duties were put in place.

The stocks of some big U.S. businesses fell on fears the new trade barriers would swallow their profits. Jeep-maker Stellantis, which owns the Chrysler and Dodge brands, said it would halt production at some Canadian and Mexican plants.

Wall Street bankers and business leaders have spent weeks trying to understand—and shape—Trump's ever-shifting tariff plans. Many also believed—as they were reassured by some in Trump's inner circle—that the potential levies were negotiating tactics the businessman-turned-politician would use to extract concessions from trading partners and adversaries.

Instead, Trump unveiled 10% across-the-board tariffs, and even higher levies on Europe and countries including Japan, South Korea and Vietnam. The new levies will push up the cost of many goods from China—from toothbrushes to televisions—by

Please turn to page A7

President Looks to the Past to Remake the Economy

Trump dreams of new factories and towns revitalized by tariffs, but stocks plunged on fears of hit to growth

By Brian Schwartz and Greg Ip

As investors and consumers fretted in recent weeks about the fallout if President Trump unleashed a massive trade war, Trump himself kept looking to the past.

The rest of the world has been ripping off the U.S. for 40 years, he told advisers who asked him to articulate his vision. It was, he and his advisers would note, an argument he has been making on television since the 1980s. Before his second term ends, he said, he feels he has to right those wrongs.

If people complained about the tariffs, Trump tried to remind the public of his view of how the U.S. once was and could be again: a place with thriving Main Streets and hometowns, where American workers made American products sold to the American public.

Trump leaned into that vision with his market-shaking tariff announcement Wednesday. "Empty, dead sites, factories that are falling down...will be knocked down, and they're going to have brand new factories built in their place," he said, to an audience that included members of the United Auto Workers union. "We're going to be an entirely different country."

The tariffs Trump announced would lift the average duty above the previous peak of 1930. It is by far the most disruptive component of an agenda that may be one of the most disruptive of any new president since the 1930s, one that includes slashing immigration, government spending, taxes and regulations.

Perhaps the most striking aspect of Trump's dramatic move to reposition the American economy is the timing. The economy he inherited was the envy of the world with growth of 2.8%

Please turn to page A8

James Mackintosh: Market carnage could be just a start **A4**

Global economic order gets reshuffled **A4**

Breaking down the trade imbalance in charts **A6**

White House whirlwind that led to all-out tariff strategy **A7**

Heard on the Street: Why Trump's tariffs sank the dollar **B10**

Leader Ousted In South Korea

CHUNG SUNG-JUN/GETTY IMAGES

A ruling by the Constitutional Court of South Korea that removed impeached President Yoon Suk Yeol from office touched off celebrations Friday in Seoul. An election must be held within 60 days. **A9**

North Korean Hackers Steal Billions in Crypto To Keep Regime Afloat

At 11:49 a.m. on July 18, North Korean hackers pounced on a major cryptocurrency exchange handling hundreds of millions of dollars.

By Patricia Kowsmann in Singapore and Timothy W. Martin in Seoul

The hackers slipped into the exchange's virtual vault, took control and then started pilfering cryptocurrency tokens. Within a little more than an hour, the hackers had disappeared—and with them, more than $200 million for the Kim Jong Un regime.

The shocking theft at WazirX, India's largest cryptocurrency exchange, along with several other major recent heists, has made it clear: North Korea is now the world's most dangerous crypto thief.

It has swiped more than $6 billion in cryptocurrency over the past decade—a sum so large that no one else compares.

The country's hackers are patient and brazen, investigators said. To get into companies' computers, they comb through employees' Facebook and Instagram pages and invent stories to trick them into clicking on links with viruses. Some North Korean hackers have even become employees, fooling U.S. companies into hiring them as remote IT workers and gaining access to their networks.

After grabbing their bounty, North Korean hackers are masters at escaping. At WazirX, they used algorithms to spread funds through global crypto networks faster than any human could, making it almost impossible for authorities to catch up. Once the crypto is dispersed, North Korean hackers often lie low until investigators move on, waiting months or years to convert their haul into traditional money.

Please turn to page A9

Raising Chickens Isn't All It's Cracked Up to Be

* * *

Backyard egg-layers can be messy, costly; 'We put the kibosh on it.'

By Te-Ping Chen and Roshan Fernandez

Carol Lewis has no regrets about how she voted on the chicken issue.

As a longtime member of the St. Cloud, Minn., city council, she'd heard all the arguments. At a December meeting, locals argued backyard chickens would offer a cheaper source of eggs. One resident said chickens would simply be "awesome."

Lewis, who left the council this year, was unmoved. "We can't even seem to get people to mow their lawns these days. I don't know how we're going to keep chicken coops clean," she told the crowd before voting "nay" on the measure, which would have allowed backyard chickens at some homes.

Her grandmother, who raised chickens, always told her they were "dirty birds," she

Please turn to page A2

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **U.S. markets plunged** in their steepest declines since 2020, as investors grappled with the threat that Trump's tariffs will invite global retaliation and hurt the economy. The S&P 500, Nasdaq and Dow shed 4.8%, 6% and 4%, respectively, and dozens of household-name stocks fell by double digits. **A1, A4, A6**

◆ **OPEC and its allies** agreed to make a larger oil output increase in May in a move that further weighed on tariff-hit crude prices. **B9**

◆ **The 10 biggest U.S.** consulting firms to the federal government offered to cut billions of dollars from their contracts with agencies. **A2**

◆ **A Guatemalan** conglomerate agreed to acquire SunnyD and other beverage brands in a roughly $1.5 billion deal and said it would seek to expand the products' consumer base. **B1**

◆ **A small shareholder** launched a proxy fight at WeightWatchers' parent company, seeking board seats and hundreds of millions of dollars in cost cuts. **B1**

◆ **Verizon said it would** freeze rates for a broad spectrum of its customers in an effort to retain cellphone users annoyed by years of price increases. **B1**

◆ **Hershey agreed to a** roughly $750 million deal for the popcorn brand LesserEvil, confirming an earlier report from The Wall Street Journal. **B3**

◆ **Puma said** Chief Executive Arne Freundt would leave the company because of differences with the board and named former Adidas executive Arthur Hoeld as his successor. **B3**

World-Wide

◆ **Economists said that** Trump's approach to trade, if not rolled back, could rival President Richard Nixon's 1971 decision to overturn arrangements created by the U.S. and its allies during World War II. **A4**

◆ **The National Security** Agency chief, Gen. Tim Haugh, was fired on the direction of the White House, along with his civilian deputy, Wendy Noble. Several National Security Council staffers were dismissed earlier. **A3**

◆ **South Korea's** Constitutional Court ousted President Yoon Suk Yeol over his short-lived declaration of martial law, clearing the way for a snap vote to elect a new president. **A9**

◆ **The Trump administration** escalated its campaign against American universities by preparing to pull $510 million in federal grants from Brown University. **A3**

◆ **The Office of the** Inspector General at the Pentagon said it began a review into Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth's sharing of military plans ahead of U.S. strikes on Yemen in a Signal chat group. **A3**

◆ **HHS Secretary** Robert F. Kennedy Jr. said he would reinstate some programs and federal workers cut earlier this week as part of his sweeping reorganization of the department. **A3**

◆ **Hungary said it would** withdraw from the International Criminal Court, a declaration that coincided with a visit to Budapest by Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu, the object of an ICC arrest warrant. **A16**

CONTENTS

14535> 0 78908 63141 1

U.S. NEWS

California Backstop Insurer Falls Short

Some homeowners get poor service and inadequate payoffs in the wake of fires

By Jean Eaglesham And Nicole Friedman

LOS ANGELES—Susan Spira called her insurer days after wildfires destroyed her family's home—only to be told her policy had been canceled. The reason: In the chaotic days after the house burned to the ground, her monthly premium hadn't been paid.

"I nearly fell apart," she said. Spira, a real-estate lawyer, fought back and the insurer, California's Fair Plan, agreed her Pacific Palisades house was covered when the infernos sparked.

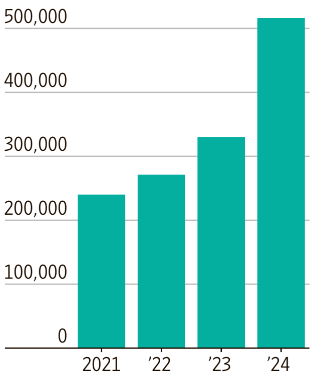
Then an upfront payment of $562,500, half the $1.125 million coverage for her four-bedroom home, was sent to her by check with no tracking. It got lost in the mail.

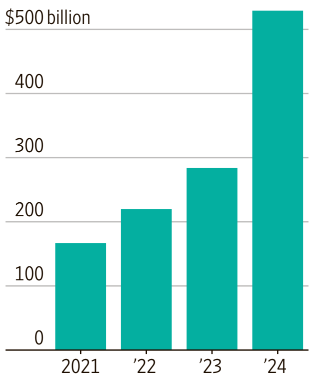
Spira's experience with Fair Plan wasn't unusual, according to homeowners and consumer advocates, who have reported problems including refusals to treat toxins from smoke, delayed payments and dire customer service.

Fair Plan, California's state-chartered insurer of last resort, has taken on an outsize role in the aftermath of the infernos. Originally set up as a backstop for hard-to-insure areas, it became the only option for hundreds of thousands of homeowners.

It more than doubled its number of policyholders—and tripled its exposure to losses—in a little over three years. Fair Plan filled the gap as commercial insurers such as State Farm canceled policies, citing the threat of wildfires and regulated premiums that weren't keeping pace with the risk.

The plan at the end of September insured more than 50,000 homes in ZIP Codes affected by the fires.





Note: Data as of the end of September for all years except 2024, which is for end of December
Source: California Fair Plan Association

'Overstretched'

"Insurers of last resort weren't built to serve this many people," said Amy Bach, executive director of United Policyholders. "The issues we're seeing in California with delays and poor service stem partly from the plan being badly overstretched."

A spokeswoman for the plan said it can't comment on individual claims, but is handling them in accordance with state law and "not experiencing delays in responding to policyholders." Most payments for claims are made electronically and it is rare for checks to go astray, she added.

Most states have an insurer of last resort model like Fair Plan that offers a basic level of coverage for homeowners rejected by private insurers. Many plans are growing rapidly, as insurers pull back from disaster-prone areas.

In most cases, taxpayers aren't directly on the hook. Plans are often state-created, but funded and influenced by the insurance industry.

Insurers, who backstop the plan financially in return for the right to operate in the state, have the majority of seats on the California plan's governing committee, according to plan documents.

Fair Plan's approach is tougher than many other insurers', with claims paid for "permanent physical changes," such as melting or staining only, according to Dylan Schaffer, a lawyer for policyholders suing the insurer.

Eric Bollens's parents' home in the Palisades survived the fires, but testing after the fires revealed high levels of lead, arsenic, chromium and barium. Bollens said Fair Plan told his parents that it wouldn't cover the cost of the testing or professional remediation services.

"You abate lead contamination—you don't clean it with a mop and a vacuum," Bollens said.

A spokeswoman for California Fair Plan said its claims adjusters are expected to abide by state laws. The plan will pay for recommended testing or treatment, if it is warranted, she added.

The state's insurance commissioner said insurers shouldn't deny smoke damage claims without an investigation, or require customers to pay heavily to investigate a claim.

Lost checks

The California plan pays homeowners up to $3 million, which has to cover rebuilding costs, personal possessions and temporary-accommodation costs. Thousands who lost their homes in L.A. lived in high-end neighborhoods, and are now in expensive rentals.

Jewlz Fahn is more than a million dollars worse off because State Farm axed her fire insurance in the fall. Weeks later, her five-bedroom Palisades home burned to the ground. "My family lost everything," Fahn said.

Her $3 million Fair Plan coverage, the maximum allowed, has paid $153,000 for destroyed personal possessions: a fraction of the $1.4 million limit on her old State Farm policy. She has also been paid two-thirds of her living-expenses coverage of $153,000, barely a quarter of the $600,000 State Farm cap.

A State Farm spokesman said the insurer "made the difficult decision to non-renew a small number of…property insurance policies" in response to its Californian subsidiary's financial health.

A $997,500 check sent in February to Fahn by regular mail, with no tracking, went missing. She has since received a replacement check.

Spira, whose $562,000 check went AWOL, got through to a Fair Plan representative—only to be told she was "too upset" to help, and hung up on. It took more than two months from the fires before she received a replacement $562,500 check.

U.S. WATCH

WASHINGTON

Kirkland in Talks With White House

Kirkland & Ellis, the largest U.S. law firm by revenue, is in talks with the White House to avoid an executive order similar to those levied against several of its rivals, according to people familiar with the matter.

The firm, which has some 4,000 lawyers and brought in about $9 billion last year, is one of the White House's next targets for sanctions, some of the people said.

Kirkland—a powerhouse in the worlds of private equity and mergers and acquisitions—has been eager to avoid a conflict with the White House and has hired a lobbyist as part of its efforts, the people said. It isn't clear what objections President Trump and his inner circle have to the firm's activities.

Three targeted firms, Perkins Coie, Jenner & Block and WilmerHale, filed lawsuits challenging the administration's actions.

—Erin Mulvaney

LOS ANGELES

Death Toll After Wildfires Hits 30

Nearly three months after two wildfires destroyed thousands of homes in the Los Angeles area, officials said the death toll from the blazes had reached 30.

The Medical Examiner's Office said human remains were found at a scorched property in Altadena, within the Eaton Fire burn zone, bringing the deaths from that blaze to 18. Twelve people died in the Palisades Fire.

The two blazes ignited during fierce winds on Jan. 7 and destroyed nearly 17,000 structures. The causes of the fires are still under investigation.

—Associated Press

FLORIDA

St. Petersburg to Replace Rays' Roof

The once and possibly future home of the Tampa Bay Rays will get a new roof to replace the one shredded by Hurricane Milton with the goal of having the ballpark ready for the 2026 season.

The St. Petersburg City Council voted 7-1 to approve $22.5 million to begin the repairs at Tropicana Field. The damage forced the Rays to play home games at the spring training home of the Yankees.

—Associated Press

Consulting Firms Offer Cost Cuts to Government

By Chip Cutter

The 10 biggest U.S. consulting firms to the federal government have offered to cut billions of dollars from their contracts with agencies but face pushback from the Trump administration to deliver even deeper savings.

Companies including **Accenture**, **Booz Allen Hamilton**, **Deloitte**, **IBM** and others met the General Services Administration deadline this week to justify their contracts and identify potential cost cuts to existing projects. Trump administration officials are expected to go back to some of the firms for further price concessions or other revisions, people familiar with the review process say.

Some companies missed the mark by submitting too little in savings or by sending voluminous pages of PowerPoint slides explaining their work, the people said, while other firms identified detailed potential cuts. At least one company outlined $12 billion in potential savings to the government, according to a person familiar with the matter.

The chief executive of Booz Allen, which generates nearly all of its $11 billion in annual revenue from contracts tied to the U.S. government, said his firm had proposed more than $1 billion in savings related to its own projects. The firm identified Booz contracts that agencies could review or potentially cancel and proposed dozens of other ideas to streamline the way the government functions.

Booz also suggested the government shift more contracts to performance-based pricing arrangements and earmarked some projects that could be done by the government itself, said Horacio Rozanski, Booz Allen's CEO.

"There is some work that in the spirit of efficiency, the government could choose to insource," Rozanski said.

Leidos, another large contractor, provided the GSA with a "detailed set of options for meeting the administration's goal of making the U.S. government more efficient and cost-effective," a spokesman said. He declined to give a cost estimate of its proposals.

Accenture and IBM didn't comment. Deloitte didn't respond to a request for comment.

The Trump administration this year asked the 10 biggest consulting firms to the government to "defend the spend." It said those firms alone are set to receive more than $65 billion in fees in 2025 and future years.

The push has weighed on the firms' stocks and prompted meetings with Trump officials. Many executives have sought time with Josh Gruenbaum, a former director at private-equity firm **KKR** who was picked by President Trump as the GSA's procurement chief and is now leading the broad review of consulting spending.

The proposals will be reviewed by the federal agencies overseeing the contracts.

"I have no doubt that you'll see some progress made because the companies are going to respond to what the government tells them to do," said Stan Soloway, the former head of the largest trade association of government-service contractors, who is now CEO of consulting firm **Celero Strategies**.

Plenty of firms already are affected by the administration's focus on costs. Accenture CEO Julie Sweet said as the government works to streamline spending "many new procurement actions have slowed, which is negatively impacting our sales and revenue."

◆ **How Booz Allen's CEO navigates budget cuts.... B3**

CORRECTIONS & AMPLIFICATIONS

The 30-year Treasury yield was at 4.551% Wednesday, up from 4.508% on April 2, 2024. In some editions Thursday, a Markets article about municipal-bond funds incorrectly said the 30-year Treasury yield was at 4.14% Wednesday, down from 4.35% in April 2024.

Readers can alert The Wall Street Journal to any errors in news articles by emailing **wsjcontact@wsj.com** or by calling 888-410-2667.

FROM LEFT: KATHY SHEA MORMINO; JILLIAN WILLSEY

Kathy Shea Mormino, left, said she's happy to see the rise of backyard chicken-raising, but urges caution for new owners. Jillian Willsey had to remove her hens, pictured as chicks, under government order earlier this year.

Everyone's Raising Chickens

Continued from Page One

said in an interview. Lewis had other concerns, including bird flu. "I hate to be a Debbie Downer," the 68-year old said. "But until we get that under control, it's just not even worth talking about.“

The measure failed, 5-1. "We put the kibosh on it," she said.

A decade ago, backyard chickens were more a niche for part-time farmers and urban hipsters. But the Covid-19 pandemic—and more recently, a surge in egg prices—has sent Americans flocking for their own poultry.

There were 11 million households with backyard chickens in 2024, up from 5.8 million in 2018, according to the American Pet Products Association. Even U.S. Agriculture Secretary Brooke Rollins recently jumped in, saying she wants to help Americans save money by making it easier to raise their own egg-layers.

Aspiring chicken-fanciers face plenty of hurdles. Local regulations often throw up red tape, or neighbors squawk. The birds can have steep startup costs and require diligent care. And good luck finding a pet sitter.

In Dallas, personal trainer Betina Gozo Shimonek said raising chickens on her half-acre of land is addicting. She started with four chickens last year to feed her family of five and will soon have over three dozen birds. She said her rooster crows at 6 a.m., but the neighbors don't mind, perhaps because she gives them eggs.

On a recent February day, her local farm store was scheduled to receive its first shipment of chicks this year between 10 a.m. and 2 p.m. Shimonek called at 12 p.m., but by then, they'd sold out.

"They were like, 'It's like Black Friday in here whenever the chicks come,'" she said.

On review site Yelp, searches for "live chickens for sale" and "chicken coops" were up 559% and 700% in the year between February 2024 and 2025. Kelly Null, a customer service representative at Cackle Hatchery said people start lining up at 6 a.m. outside their Lebanon, Mo., storefront to buy chicks, three hours before opening.

"Yesterday a woman had a lawn chair and a throw," she said. "Everyone wants baby chicks."

But when it comes to saving money, chickens aren't all they're cracked up to be. Setting up a coop and chicken run, then raising chicks until they're old enough to start laying is expensive. "Your first egg costs you about $1,500," said Ryan Korbar, who runs a farm and teaches poultry-maintenance classes in Rostraver, Pa.

Nervous new chicken parents could shell out up to $2,495 for a "Smart Coop," a poultry condo equipped with automatic doors and cameras that alert owners via an app when predators like raccoons are nearby. They can activate alarms to scare predators.

In Suffield, Conn., Kathy Shea Mormino—who successfully lobbied her town to change its rules to permit backyard chickens over a decade ago—said she's glad to see the hobby taking flight, but advises caution. Unlike pet owners with cats or dogs, finding veterinarians versed in chicken care is hard, she said. Many new poultry enthusiasts also tend to underestimate how much care their birds will require.

"Chickens are not a vending machine that you park in your backyard," said Mormino, who has written guides to raising chickens.

The lure of a more pastoral life, including a brood of hens, encouraged Jillian Willsey to move with her husband and three daughters to central Michigan from a Phoenix suburb three years ago. There were no chickens allowed at her former home, but the family added six birds to their 2-acre Midwest plot.

In February, though, the local government ordered her to remove them, saying they weren't permitted on plots smaller than 5 acres, something she hadn't known. She sent the birds to stay with friends and is petitioning for a rule change.

"I honestly did not think it would take such an emotional toll on me," said Willsey, who said she values knowing where her food comes from.

More states have adopted regulations to make it easier to raise backyard chickens, including Arizona and Missouri. Others are considering the matter.

"Feeding yourself is a basic human right," said Jim DeSana, a Republican state representative in Michigan who has a farm and recently introduced legislation to allow more people to raise backyard chickens.

Debate over such regulations can get heated: in Tigard, Ore., a recent effort to update urban livestock regulations prompted an outpouring of comments on backyard birds. Many residents said they were delighted by the presence of such flocks, while others said they created rat problems and cited public health concerns.

One resident alleged chicken owners were bribing their neighbors with eggs to curry favor. Another circulated photos of dead rats on their property they said had been attracted by chicken feed.

Mayor Heidi Lueb said that the city's regulations, which don't limit the number of chickens locals can raise, also allow people to bring complaints over code violations that would cause noise, odor or pest issues. She said the town tries to strike a balance between unnecessarily restricting residents' freedoms and ensuring that they don't have "full-on farms."

"And no roosters," she said. "That's self-explanatory."

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL

(USPS 664-880)
(Eastern Edition ISSN 0099-9660)
(Central Edition ISSN 1092-0935)
(Western Edition ISSN 0193-2241)

Editorial and publication headquarters: 1211 Avenue of the Americas, New York, N.Y. 10036

Published daily except Sundays and general legal holidays. Periodicals postage paid at New York, N.Y., and other mailing offices.

Postmaster: Send address changes to The Wall Street Journal, 200 Burnett Rd., Chicopee, MA 01020.

Letters to the Editor:
Fax: 212-416-2891; email: wsj.ltrs@wsj.com

Need assistance with your subscription?
By web: customercenter.wsj.com;
By email: support@wsj.com
By phone: 1-800-JOURNAL (1-800-568-7625)

Reprints & licensing:
By email: customreprints@dowjones.com;
By phone: 1-800-843-0008

WSJ back issues and framed pages: wsjshop.com

Our newspapers are 100% sourced from sustainably certified mills.

GOT A TIP FOR US? SUBMIT IT AT WSJ.COM/TIPS

President Steps Up Fight vs. Colleges, Targeting Brown

The Trump administration escalated its campaign against American universities by preparing to pull $510 million in federal grants from Brown University, while also laying out demands Harvard must meet to avoid losing billions in government dollars.

By Douglas Belkin, Natalie Andrews and Liz Essley Whyte

The administration is freezing National Institutes of Health grants to Brown while it investigates the Ivy League school's handling of antisemitism and diversity, equity and inclusion policies, according to two people.

Additionally, new developments emerged regarding Harvard University after the government opened a review of nearly $9 billion in federal grants and contracts earlier this week.

Three members of a newly formed Trump administration task force on antisemitism wrote Harvard President Alan Garber on Thursday, asking for the school to take nine actions that "we regard as necessary for Harvard University's continued financial relationship with the United States government."

National Institutes of Health grants of $510 million are being frozen.

Most of the demands concern how the university operates. The government is asking for a comprehensive mask ban and changes to governance, leadership and admissions as well as an end to DEI programs.

The government is also seeking to reach into the classroom, demanding "necessary changes" be made "to address bias, improve viewpoint diversity, and end ideological capture," which fuel antisemitic harassment, the letter said.

A Harvard spokesperson said Thursday night the school received the letter and the recommended measures from the task force.

On Monday night, Garber said if the federal government removes its funding, it would halt lifesaving research. The money is spread among Harvard and its affiliates, which include Boston-area hospitals. "We fully embrace the important goal of combating antisemitism, one of the most insidious forms of bigotry," he wrote.

Brown, in Providence, R.I., became the fifth Ivy League institution to face a potential loss of federal funding. Brown said the freeze was a rumor they couldn't confirm. "We are closely monitoring notifications related to grants, but have nothing more we can share as of now," said the provost, Frank Doyle.

Trump has vowed to crack down on campuses that his team views as liberal hotbeds that suppress conservative views. Some faculty and critics have described his actions as authoritarian overreach.

The White House push to change higher education started in March with Columbia University, where the government canceled $400 million in grants and contracts over what it said are antisemitism concerns related to the school's handling of the pro-Palestinian protests that disrupted campuses nationwide last year. Columbia agreed to meet a series of demands as a precondition to negotiate for the return of the money. On Friday, Columbia's interim president stepped down after making comments in private meetings with faculty that played down changes the school agreed to with the Trump administration.

On Tuesday, following Harvard, Princeton University said the Trump administration was suspending "several dozen" research grants. Chris Eisgruber, Princeton's president, said in an email to students and staffers that "the full rationale for this action is not yet clear."

In a recent Atlantic magazine essay, Eisgruber described the Trump administration's "attack on Columbia University" as "the greatest threat to American universities since the Red Scare of the 1950s."

A White House official called the Princeton measure a pause in funding pending an investigation into alleged antisemitism. The administration has also paused about $175 million in federal funding to the University of Pennsylvania for allowing a transgender athlete to compete on the women's swimming team.

Schools nationwide have watched Trump's fast-moving attack with alarm; many fear a demand for similar concessions. They have expressed concern that without freedom to follow their intellectual curiosity, the discoveries and innovations that fuel the U.S. economy will decline.

SCOTT EISEN/GETTY IMAGES

The Brown University campus in Providence, R.I.

Tornadoes and Violent Winds Strike Central U.S.

THOMAS WELLS/THE NORTHEAST MISSISSIPPI DAILY JOURNAL/ASSOCIATED PRESS

AFTERMATH: A house was ripped off its foundation and thrown 75 feet away near Walnut, Miss., as powerful storms that struck the central U.S. killed at least seven people in Tennessee, Missouri and Indiana late Wednesday and early Thursday.

Trump Fires NSA Director, Purges Key Security Staff

WASHINGTON—Gen. Tim Haugh, the chief of the National Security Agency, was fired Thursday at the direction of the White House, according to people familiar with the matter.

By Dustin Volz, Alexander Ward and Meridith McGraw

Haugh, who jointly helms U.S. Cyber Command, the military's combatant command for offensive use of cyberattacks, was informed by the White House that his services were no longer required, the people said. His civilian deputy at the NSA, Wendy Noble, was also let go.

The reasons for the dismissals couldn't immediately be determined. They came in the midst of the firings by President Trump of several National Security Council officials following a meeting that the right-wing conspiracy theorist Laura Loomer had with the president in which she alleged that some members of his administration weren't aligned with his priorities.

Haugh had been serving as the chief of the NSA and U.S. Cyber Command for about a year, taking over for Gen. Paul Nakasone.

Sen. Mark Warner, the top Democrat on the Senate Intelligence Committee, confirmed in a statement Haugh's firing.

"General Haugh has served our country in uniform, with honor and distinction, for more than 30 years," Warner said. "At a time when the United States is facing unprecedented cyber threats, as the Salt Typhoon cyberattack from China has so clearly underscored, how does firing him make Americans any safer?" Warner said, referring to the widespread compromise of U.S. telecommunications networks by Beijing-backed hackers.

The White House and NSA declined to comment. The Cipher Brief, a news outlet focused on national security, earlier reported the firings.

At the National Security Council, four aides were fired overnight, people familiar with the matter said. Two other NSC aides were let go on Sunday, others familiar with the matter said. The staffers worked on a series of portfolios, including intelligence, India, congressional affairs and the impact of technology security, the people said.

The exact reasons for the staffers' ouster couldn't immediately be determined.

Two people added that this was just the first round of firings. There will be at least 10 people ousted from the NSC by the end of the second round, the people said.

During a Wednesday meeting in the Oval Office, Loomer told the president that she had concerns about some of his staff, the people said.

Asked about Loomer on Thursday, Trump said, "She makes recommendations...and sometimes I listen to those recommendations."

NSC spokesman Brian Hughes declined to comment.

In a statement, Loomer declined to discuss her meeting with the president. "It was an honor to meet with President Trump and present him with my findings, I will continue working hard to support his agenda, and I will continue reiterating the importance of strong vetting for the sake of protecting the President and our national security," she said.

The firings are the first since members of Trump's cabinet discussed sensitive information about a military operation in Yemen on a nongovernment messaging app, and mistakenly added a journalist. Democrats called for national security adviser Mike Waltz to resign, as he initiated the chat.

Two U.S. officials said there had long been an internal campaign to oust NSC officials deemed not sufficiently loyal to Trump's agenda.

Hegseth's Role in Chat Under Review

By Nancy A. Youssef

The Pentagon's inspector general said Thursday it had launched a review into Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth's sharing of military plans ahead of U.S. strikes on Yemen in a Signal chat group.

The decision by the inspector general to publicly share its move, and that it was focused on the defense chief, was unusual. The Office of the Inspector General is an independent watchdog group within the department.

"The objective of this evaluation is to determine the extent to which the Secretary of Defense and other DoD personnel complied with DoD policies and procedures for the use of a commercial messaging application for official business," the inspector general's office said.

The office launched its review at the request of Sens. Roger Wicker (R., Miss.) and Jack Reed (D., R.I.), the chairman and ranking member, respectively, of the Senate Armed Services Committee, who wrote a letter to the inspector general last week. The White House confirmed that members of its national security team had communicated on Signal, a nongovernmental app, about an upcoming strike in Yemen.

National Security Adviser Mike Waltz added Atlantic editor in chief Jeffery Goldberg, apparently inadvertently, to the text thread about the upcoming strikes, and the magazine subsequently published the chat details after the White House described its contents as unclassified.

Hegseth shared some of the most sensitive information in the chat, including specific times that F-18s, MQ-9 Reaper drones and Tomahawk cruise

SAUL LOEB/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

Defense Secretary Hegseth

missiles would be used in the March 15 attack and mentions intelligence that an unnamed target of the strikes was at a "known location."

Hegseth said afterward that "the messages have no locations, no sources and methods, and no war plans. Foreign partners had already been notified strikes were imminent."

In the two-page memo Thursday, the IG said it "may revise the objective as the evaluation proceeds." The Pentagon declined to comment.

In their letter asking for an investigation, Wicker and Reed asked for an assessment of Defense Department policies on sharing sensitive and classified information on nongovernmental networks and messaging services, and to examine whether any individuals transferred classified information to unclassified systems.

President Trump fired 17 inspector generals across government agencies within days of taking office, including at the Pentagon. The department's acting inspector general, Steven Stebbins, signed the memo announcing the review. While the memo called for the department to provide two points of contact to facilitate the review within five days, it does not provide a timeline for the assessment.

New York Mayor Adams to Start Own Political Party for Re-Election

By James Fanelli and Ginger Adams Otis

New York City Mayor Eric Adams announced plans to start his own political party to run for a second term—an unorthodox strategy that he thinks is his best path to win re-election.

No longer encumbered by his bribery case, the mayor said he plans to focus on a run in the general election in the fall. He would still be a Democrat but campaign on a newly created party line that emphasizes public safety.

"I firmly believe that this city is better served by truly independent leadership, not leaders pulled at by the extremists on the far left or the far right but instead those rooted in the common middle, the place where the vast majority of New Yorkers are firmly planted," Adams said in a video Thursday.

The mayor said he won't run in the Democratic primary in June, claiming that his criminal case had dragged on for months, making it impossible to mount a proper fight in the race. Instead he will pin his hopes on the November election, allowing him a longer runway to mount a campaign.

The mayor had been keeping his campaign plans under seal, holding off on an announcement until after a federal judge on Wednesday dismissed the charges against him.

The Justice Department had asked for the case to be dropped, saying it distracted the mayor from running the city and helping President Trump in his push to crack down on illegal immigration and violent crime.

Adams's campaign decision means that the general election in November could be unusually competitive. Former Gov. Andrew Cuomo, a Democrat, is the current front-runner in the June primary. If he wins, he could square off against Adams in the fall.

Adams spent the past six months fighting for his political life and freedom after federal prosecutors charged him with bribery and campaign-finance violations. While he denied wrongdoing, Adams faced calls for his resignation.

RFK Jr. to Restore Some Programs, Workers

By Kristina Peterson and Liz Essley Whyte

Health and Human Services Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr. said he would reinstate some programs and federal workers cut this week as part of his sweeping reorganization of the department.

"Some programs that were cut, they're being reinstated," Kennedy said on Thursday. "Personnel that should not have been cut were cut. We're reinstating them."

Kennedy last week said 10,000 employees would lose their jobs in a broad reorganization of the health department and the agencies it oversees.

Layoff notices began Monday night and continued through Tuesday morning, with health-department employees scrambling to figure out who had been cut and how to keep government functions going that had been delegated to those workers.

Kennedy said a program at the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention that monitors blood-lead levels for children would be reinstated. He said agency leaders approached the reorganization with a willingness to make dramatic cuts even if they made errors.

"That was always the plan," he said, referring to fixing mistakes and the Department of Government Efficiency's approach to making federal cuts. "Part of the DOGE—we talked about this from the beginning—is we're going to do 80% cuts, but 20% of those are going to have to be reinstalled, because we'll make mistakes."

Entire divisions and offices of the CDC, Food and Drug Administration, National Institutes of Health and other sections of the health department were eliminated on Tuesday, including groups focused on HIV prevention, violence prevention, injury prevention and Freedom of Information requests.

Some key leaders were offered reassignment to remote offices of the Indian Health Service.

Kennedy said last week the cuts would make HHS more efficient and effective. "We are going to do more with less," he said.

Some FDA employees who were let go on Tuesday have been asked to continue to help the agency with certain functions, but it is unclear if their layoffs have been rescinded, people familiar with the matter said.

P2JW094000-5-A00400-16DDF61078D

Global Economic Order Gets Reshuffled

Trump's tariff move risks pushing nations, including the U.S., to the brink of recession

By Nick Timiraos

The U.S. is moving to blow up the global trading order it built, ushering in an uncertain new era.

President Trump's highly anticipated announcement represents a high-stakes gamble to transform a global economic relationship that Trump for decades has said ripped off the U.S.—even as the American economy had emerged from the pandemic as the envy of its rich-world peers.

The president's moves raise the specter of a stagflationary shock that increases prices while putting more economies, including the U.S., at risk of recession.

Trump stunned markets by announcing a suite of tariff hikes on major trading partners, including 20% for the European Union and 34% on China. The tax on imported goods, which also includes at least a 10% across-the-board increase on all countries, will raise overall weighted-average tariffs to 23%—the highest in over 100 years—from 10% before the announcement and 2.5% last year, according to JPMorgan Chase.

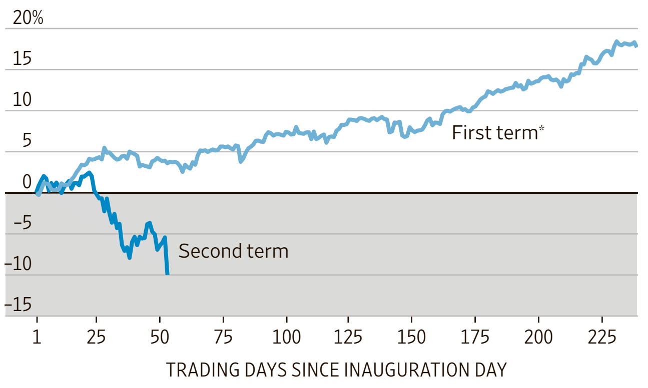
Economists said Trump's policy shift, if it isn't rolled back, could rival President Richard Nixon's 1971 decision to overturn arrangements created by the U.S. and its wartime allies during World War II, when Washington had agreed to exchange dollars for gold at a rate of $35 an ounce.

It would mark "probably the biggest attempt to fundamentally reshape the tax-trade structure in the U.S. since Nixon took us off the gold standard in the early 1970s," said Michael Gapen, chief U.S. economist at Morgan Stanley.

Gapen said his bank had been advising clients that markets were too complacent about the risks of bigger and broader tariffs, but Wednesday's announcement "was more expansive than even we thought."

The president's mercurial and chaotic rollout of his trade plans, which already have included 20% tariffs on China, 25% tariffs on auto imports and 25% tariffs on Canadian and Mexican goods that aren't covered by an existing trade agreement, has chilled business investment and consumer sentiment.

Change in S&P 500 since the inauguration day of Trump's first and second term



*Shows through the end of 2017
Source: FactSet

"They just announced a major tax hike, mostly on the corporate side, but as with most corporate taxes, they will be translated into higher prices to the consumer. And you don't grow an economy with higher taxes," said Steven Blitz, chief U.S. economist at GlobalData TS Lombard.

The tariff increases announced Wednesday are particularly drastic because they don't have exemptions for the two-thirds of imports that normally come in duty-free, such as coffee, tea and bananas, which aren't produced in significant quantities domestically, said Douglas Irwin, a trade economist and historian at Dartmouth College.

They will cover a far wider array of goods than during Trump's 2019 trade war with China. Nike produces half of its shoes in Vietnam, which faces a 46% tariff. A web of consumer-electronics makers across China, Taiwan and South Korea will face tariffs of at least 25%. The tariffs exempt oil, gas and refined products.

The tariff hikes raise the risk of a sharp hit to consumers' inflation-adjusted incomes that could tip the U.S. economy into recession this year, said Diane Swonk, chief economist at KPMG. The suite of tariffs announced amounted to a "worst-case scenario" relative to expectations in the run-up to the announcement, she said.

Moreover, it isn't clear how trading partners will respond, meaning uncertainty could remain elevated for some time to come. "If the goal is to get firms to relocate here, this doesn't accomplish that, because you don't know for sure in three to five years, by the time you build a plant, will the tariffs still be intact," said Swonk.

Tariffs could bring in new revenue but at a potentially steep cost to financial markets. Lofty asset prices over the past two years have reflected investors' bets that the U.S. economy was well positioned relative to its peers, given advances in technology and the prospect for an elusive "soft landing."

Trump inherited an economy with steady growth and a declining rate of inflation but vulnerabilities from a frozen housing sector, cooling labor market and richly valued stock market.

Trump has long regarded trade deficits as a sign of economic weakness. But in the Trump administration's attempts to narrow those deficits, foreign countries could reduce their purchases of U.S. Treasury securities or have less surplus capital to park in American stock, real-estate and private-debt markets.

"The real pain from this event will be the breaking down of the capital flow agreement that we had with the rest of the world," said Blitz. "This idea that you can break trade, and not break the capital flow side, is a fantasy."

If the tariffs remain in place for a prolonged period of time, inflation using the Federal Reserve's preferred gauge could rise from 2.5% in February to 4.4% at the end of this year, according to economists at UBS. They see inflation declining after that, to 3% by the end of 2027.

STREETWISE | By James Mackintosh

Market Carnage Could Be Just a Start

Is "recession" now spelled T-A-R-I-F-F? Markets were gripped by the recession trade after President Trump's tariffs threatened a global trade war. Treasury yields, stock futures and the dollar all plunged.

This isn't mere market hyperbole. Thursday was only the sixth time in history that the S&P 500 had fallen more than 4% while the dollar also fell more than 1%—with investors shocked that the greenback had failed in its usual role as a safe haven.

The market carnage may be just the beginning: If the tariffs, which are in effect the biggest U.S. tax rise since at least the 1950s, cause the economy to shrink, stocks and Treasury yields still have a long way to go down.

As recessions take hold, stocks are hit both by lower earnings and lower valuations. Defensive stocks better able to maintain sales—such as sellers of food and other staples—beat those selling optional purchases, known as cyclicals.

Since the S&P 500 peaked in mid-February, investors have moved fast to dump cyclicals and switch to defensives. My measure of cyclical sectors, which equally weights stocks within each sector, has lagged behind defensives by the most over such a short period since the March 2020 Covid lockdown.

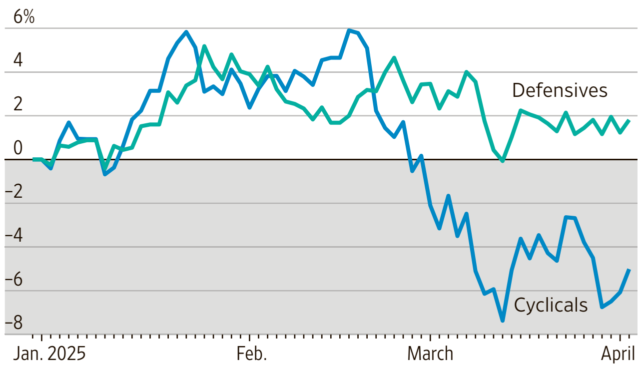
The lowest-rated junk bonds, most likely to default in tough times, have also been hit hard. Their extra yield above Treasurys has risen by more than 2 percentage points. They last had such a big jump over a similarly short period when economists were sure recession was imminent in 2022 (in the end there was no recession).

Yet while the market is moving fast to price in a higher chance of recession, it's far from fully prepared. The S&P 500 is only down 12% from its all-time high and back to where it stood in August. Usually in recessions, stocks eventually fall at least 20% and give up far more than seven months of gains.

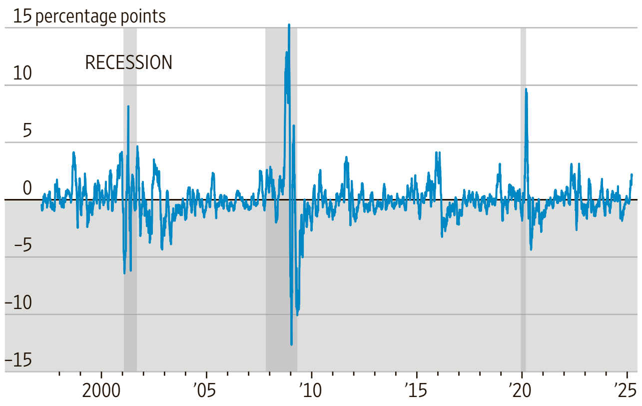
Junk bonds are also far from pricing in recession, which would typically lead to spreads over Treasurys for the weakest bonds at least double the current levels.

Treasury yields haven't actually fallen all that much. The 10-year is off 0.76 percentage point from its high earlier this year. But it has had bigger falls over such a period three times in the past two years. Two of those times, they ended up dropping more than a percentage point. Since recessions commonly cut rates by three points or more, a much bigger fall in yields would be needed if recession became a certainty. Unless, of course, stagflation prevents the Fed from cutting—but that would mean the economy, stocks and corporate bonds would suffer even more.

Price change this year*



Change in CCC-or-lower-rated U.S. bond† spread over Treasurys over 31 days



*Cyclicals are equal-weighted consumer discretionary, information technology, industrials and materials; defensives are utilities, healthcare, consumer staples and communication services. Data through Wednesday †ICE BofA index, data through Wednesday.
Source: LSEG

For now, markets think the Fed will look through the tariffs and cut even as new taxes push up prices. While Chair Jerome Powell is unlikely to repeat his description of the 2022 inflation as "transitory," he could reasonably treat the tariffs as one-offs so long as inflation expectations don't rise too much.

Markets think this is likely: The chance of a rate cut next month priced into futures doubled to 24% after the new tariffs, according to CME FedWatch.

Investors who think the return to tariffs higher than the 1930 Smoot-Hawley rates will hammer the economy into recession should expect much bigger falls in stocks and bond yields as 2025 goes on.

Those who think the rest of the world won't seriously retaliate and that Trump will quickly negotiate the rates away can be happier with the still-high levels of prices. But even they ought to worry about the damaging effects of prolonged uncertainty on the economy.

Some in GOP Fear Effect of Trade Blitz

WASHINGTON—Senate Republicans grew jittery about President Trump's wide-ranging tariffs, with some saying Congress should reassert its powers to run trade policy and others warning that the administration's plans carried deep risks.

By Lindsay Wise, Siobhan Hughes and Richard Rubin

The tariffs, central to Trump's second-term economic agenda, sparked a sell-off on Wall Street amid concerns they would drive up prices and tip the economy into a recession.

Sen. Chuck Grassley (R., Iowa), the only grain farmer in the Senate, joined with Sen. Maria Cantwell (D., Wash.) to introduce a bill Thursday that would allow Congress to remove tariffs put in place by any president.

Grassley's office said the bill was part of his longstanding work on trade policy and not specifically a response to Trump's actions. Several other Republicans including Sens. Lisa Murkowski of Alaska, Thom Tillis of North Carolina and Mike Rounds of South Dakota said they would support the measure or were open to it.

"We have to wait and see" on the new tariffs, Grassley said. "I'm not surprised at the impact today, but we've got to wait a few days and get a longer-term impact."

Late Wednesday, four Senate Republicans helped Democrats pass a measure aiming to reverse a previously announced 25% tariff on Canadian imports, and Democrats said they were planning more such measures to challenge Trump's policies.

None of the proposals are likely to become law, but they served to gauge GOP pushback.

Sen. Mitch McConnell (R., Ky.), who backed the Canada measure, said on X that tariffs were "bad policy, and trade wars with our partners hurt working people most," pointing to the expected impact on farmers, bourbon makers and car manufacturers in his state. He said that "at a time when Americans are tightening their belts, we would do well to avoid policies that heap on the pain."

The other three Republicans to support ending the Canada tariffs were Murkowski, and Sens. Rand Paul of Kentucky and Susan Collins of Maine. Paul has argued that the tariffs amount to a tax, making them a matter for Congress to decide, not the president.

"This isn't about political party," he said. "I voted for and supported President Trump. But I don't support the rule of one person."

Other GOP lawmakers indicated their support for the president's agenda might have a breaking point.

Senate GOP leaders were working to keep Republicans on message, highlighting that Trump's broader goal was to level the playing field, saying unfair trade relationships had cost Americans jobs and sent vital industries overseas.

Senate Majority Whip John Barrasso (R., Wyo.), one of Trump's staunchest Senate GOP allies, told reporters that "long-term, I think this is very important for the country."

Trump Tariff Message to World: Resistance Is Futile, Make a Deal

Leaders from Canada, Europe and China are threatening stiff countermeasures against the U.S. in response to President Trump's surprisingly steep tariffs on nearly all imports. The administration's response is, don't even think about it.

By Kim Mackrael, Vipal Monga and Michael Amon

Trump is trying to short-circuit the trade war's cycle of retaliation by threatening massive new tariffs on any country that responds, and by dangling the prospect of a better deal for those who hold fire and negotiate. The highest tariffs—the so-called reciprocal duties for many countries with goods-trade imbalances with the U.S.—don't go into effect until Wednesday, giving world leaders time to plead their case with a president who considers himself a master dealmaker.

"Every country's called us," Trump said on Thursday. "That's the beauty of what we do. We're in the driver's seat."

Will he make deals to lower tariffs? "It depends," Trump said. "As long as they are giving us something good."

So far, most of the world is holding out hope for a deal. Anthony Albanese, the prime minister of Australia, which has a free-trade agreement with the U.S. but now faces 10% tariffs, said his government would try to negotiate with the U.S. and won't join a "race to the bottom" by retaliating.

Even the two countries that have retaliated—China, which faces tariffs of up to 70% now, and Canada, which went from a no-tariff free-trade agreement to 25% tariffs on many exports—have held back their most potent weapons.

For Canada that's in part because Trump threatened to double tariffs on the country when Ontario's provincial leader began taxing electricity exported to the U.S. at 25%.

Similarly, Trump threatened 200% tariffs on European alcoholic beverages, including Champagne, after the EU said its retaliation against earlier steel and aluminum levies would include a 50% tariff on American whiskey. The EU delayed implementing the first of those duties—which the bloc said would eventually hit up to $28 billion worth of American products—until mid-April in hopes of striking a deal.

Now European and Canadian leaders are walking a tightrope, trying to project strength with countermeasures while still holding out hope for talks with Trump.

EU Trade Commissioner Maroš Šefčovič, who is scheduled to hold a video call with U.S. trade officials on Friday, said he would "work round the clock" in pursuit of a deal with the Trump administration.

France's Emmanuel Macron called on industries to stay united.

Retaliating countries have a dilemma. The U.S. imports more goods from Europe, China and Canada than it exports to them, a fact that has long angered Trump and also limits their ability to respond with tit-for-tat tariffs. They also want to avoid putting levies on products they need and can't easily obtain from other trading partners.

Countries that retaliate against the U.S. risk worsening their own economic problems, said Barry Appleton, an international trade lawyer and co-director of the New York Law School's Center for International Law. "It's like putting your head in a lion's mouth," he said. "Don't do that."

Europe is laying the groundwork for a novel response that could target America where it hurts the most: Its overwhelming superiority in services exports.

Targeting big American tech companies like Alphabet or Meta, or taking other measures to restrict U.S. services, is widely viewed as a last resort for the bloc because doing so could provoke a harsh reaction from the Trump administration and damage the EU's reputation as an open market. There's also a risk it could raise costs for consumers or have unintended consequences for European companies.

"Sometimes it's important to have a gun, and sometimes it's also important to put it on the table, even if you're not using it," said Bernd Lange, who chairs the European Parliament's trade committee.

French President Emmanuel Macron said the EU could activate a new law that allows the bloc to respond to another country's attempt to use economic coercion against it. Options for retaliation under the law are wide ranging and include the ability to restrict services companies' access to the market or curb the enforcement of intellectual property rights, among other measures.

Macron called on industries "to remain united, to be determined" rather than to make one-off deals or announce investments in an attempt to negotiate exemptions with Washington.

TARIFF FALLOUT

How to Visualize The Trade Deficit

President Trump has unveiled the centerpiece of his tariff agenda, saying he will impose sweeping import taxes on goods from all nations. The tariffs are pegged to amounts the president said other countries impose on the U.S.

In many cases, the tariff amounts seem to match a basic formula: the size of a country's goods-trade imbalance with the U.S., divided by how much America imports from that nation.

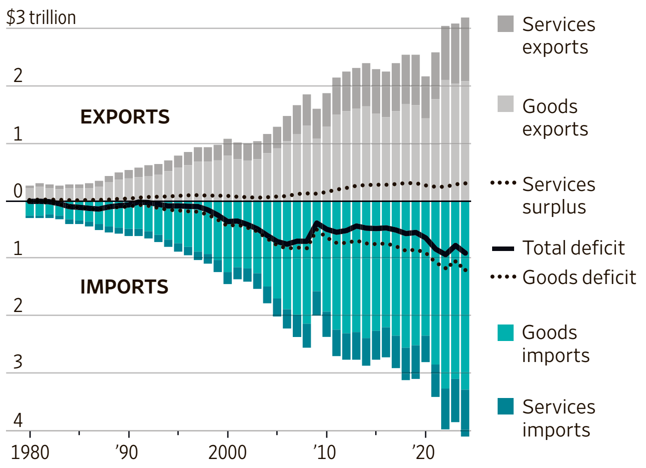
A trade deficit is the difference between the value of the goods and services a country imports and the value of goods and services it exports. A deficit means that a country is importing more than it exports. A surplus means the opposite. Economists sometimes examine the total trade balance—goods and services—and sometimes analyze just goods or services trade. Services include transportation, construction and the provision of accounting or legal support. The White House's tariff analysis appeared to include only goods, not services.

What does the trade balance say about U.S. industrial strengths and weaknesses?

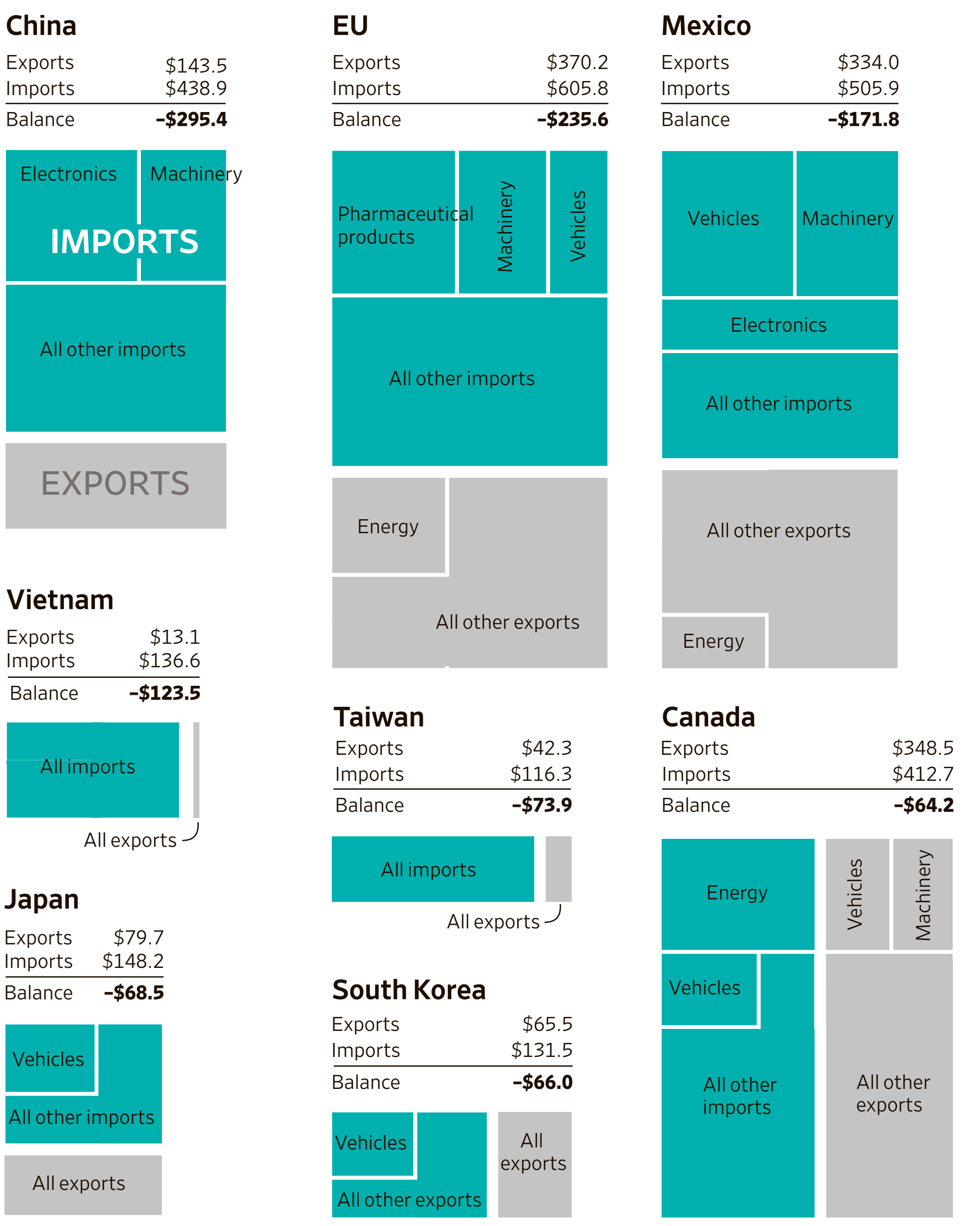
The U.S. excels at exporting services, such as banking, insurance, consulting and legal advice. It is also a major exporter of some goods, including aircraft, soybeans and oil. Over the years it has increasingly turned to other nations for many of the goods it consumes, including electronics, clothing and other items.

—Alana Pipe, Drew An-Pham and Jeanne Whalen

U.S. trade balance



Value of goods in 2024 by trading partner, in billions



Note: Machinery includes nuclear reactors, boilers, mechanical appliances and parts. Vehicles includes vehicle parts. Electronics includes electrical machinery and equipment, sound recorders and reproducers, television image and sound recorders and reproducers, and parts and accessories. Energy includes oil, gas and electrical energy. Balances may not equal differences between exports and imports due to rounding.
Sources: Commerce Department (trade balance); Census Bureau (value of goods in 2024)

Economists Question Math Behind Rate Formulas

By Matt Grossman, Anthony DeBarros and Konrad Putzier

The White House laid out new tariffs on more than 200 countries in two main ways. For more than half, it imposed a reciprocal tariff of 10%. For the rest, it added an additional levy based on a basic formula. The administration determined costs it said countries imposed by taking the amount of a nation's 2024 goods-trade imbalance with the U.S., then dividing that by the value of the goods America imports from that nation.

Several economists said that basing tariffs off of bilateral goods deficits is confusing and illogical.

Learning of the tariff formula "was like watching a movie, and at the end of it, you're like, 'That's it?'" said David Beckworth, a senior research fellow at George Mason University's Mercatus Center.

Beckworth said a more holistic approach would have taken services trade into account, too—like tech and education the U.S. sells to foreigners.

Goods deficits are a normal feature of healthy trade and "do not imply that anything is wrong," said Gian Maria Milesi-Ferretti, a senior fellow at the Brookings Institution.

A poor country that mostly exports coffee to the U.S. might lack the wealth to buy Boeing aircraft or Tesla SUVs. But that is no reason to discourage that country's coffee from reaching American consumers, Milesi-Ferretti said.

WTO Sees Trade Flow Decline This Year

By Paul Hannon

Global trade flows will likely fall this year following President Trump's latest round of tariff increases, while fresh rounds of retaliation would deepen the economic impact, the head of the World Trade Organization said.

Trade in goods rebounded last year after a 2023 decline, and the WTO had expected to see a further pickup this year. But that outlook has changed following the sweeping rise in duties on imports announced by the U.S. on Wednesday.

"While the situation is rapidly evolving, our initial estimates suggest that these measures, coupled with those introduced since the beginning of the year, could lead to an overall contraction of around 1% in global merchandise trade volumes this year," said Ngozi Okonjo-Iweala, the WTO's director general.

In a statement, she added that trade flows would fall further if the U.S. were to respond to any retaliation with further tariff increases.

Trade diversion is a possible source of further escalation.

If businesses in China, for example, find that demand for their products has weakened because of tariffs, they will likely try to find customers elsewhere, and lower their prices to do so.

But that could prompt the European Union and other places to contemplate measures to limit the inflow of Chinese goods, opening up a new front in the trade conflict.

The WTO rarely comments on the actions of one of its members, but said other countries "have reached out to us" for an assessment of the likely impact of the new tariffs.

TARIFF FALLOUT

World Braces For Flood of Chinese Goods

President's tariffs risk domino effect across globe as new markets are sought

By Jason Douglas And Rebecca Feng


Cars for export waited to be loaded onto a ship Thursday at a port in Yantai, in eastern China's Shandong province.

AFP/GETTY IMAGES

President Trump's jumbo tariffs on China threaten to create a new problem for a global economy already stressed over trade: a $400 billion deluge of Chinese goods looking for new markets.

U.S. consumers and businesses learned on Wednesday that, from April 9, Chinese imports will face tariffs of around 70% on average, after Trump walloped China with stiff new duties as part of his trade broadside. The new tariffs will likely push up prices in the U.S. for products ranging from consumer electronics and toys to machinery and essential components for manufacturing.

That towering tariff wall also risks diverting some U.S.-bound Chinese exports into a global market already swimming in China-made goods, worsening a so-called China shock that is facing pushback around the world, economists say. Other major exporters, such as Vietnam, South Korea and Japan, could also see barriers to their exports proliferate as U.S. spending on imports falls and their exports get shunted to new destinations.

Economists say such domino effects underscore how trade wars can quickly escalate, drawing in more countries as retaliatory measures fly and defensive barriers go up.

"The real fireworks are yet to come," said Michael Pettis, a professor of finance at Peking University in Beijing who has written extensively about global trade.

President Trump on Wednesday announced plans to levy tariffs on a range of U.S. trading partners that he accuses of taking advantage of the U.S. by boosting exports while keeping their own barriers to imports high.

China, regarded by many in Trump's orbit as the U.S.'s chief geopolitical foe, was hit especially hard. Chinese imports will be slapped with a 34% duty. That new tariff rate was stacked on top of a 10% tariff levied in February, another 10% added in March and a range of other tariffs imposed during Joe Biden's presidency and Trump's first term in office. Economists say that lifts the average rate on Chinese imports to around 70%.

It will be hard for other countries to absorb Chinese exports that normally went to the huge U.S. market. The U.S. in 2024 imported around $440 billion of goods from China, according to Census Bureau data. China in 2023 was the source of a fifth of iron and steel products imported into the U.S., more than a quarter of its imported electronics, a third of its imported footwear and three-quarters of its imported toys, according to data from the International Trade Centre, an agency of the United Nations and the World Trade Organization. Ninety-one percent of U.S. umbrella imports came from China.

To be sure, U.S. imports from China are unlikely to drop to zero overnight. Consumers might be able to find alternatives to some Chinese-made products, but not others, and manufacturers outsource big chunks of their production to Chinese factories. Even if they manufacture goods at home, they are often bringing in parts and basic materials from China that can be hard to find elsewhere.

Lower U.S. spending on Chinese imports means unsold goods have to go somewhere else. Yet surging Chinese exports are already jacking up tensions between China and the world's big economies, and could rise further if exporters try to unload what had been U.S.-bound shipments to other countries.

Since Trump launched his trade war in 2018, China has been the subject of almost 500 antidumping rulings and investigations, according to Global Trade Alert, a Switzerland-based nonprofit that tracks global trade policy.

Chinese leader Xi Jinping has poured investment into manufacturing to support advanced technology and pump up growth amid an epic property crunch and tepid consumer spending. The result has been a surge in exports, as firms hunt for overseas buyers to soak up goods they can't sell at home. China last year posted a trade surplus of $1 trillion. Countries have moved to shield domestic industries from cut-price Chinese competition in response.

With the U.S. raising tariffs, "there just aren't other big markets that can easily absorb the immense scale of China's manufacturing capacity," said Brad Setser, a senior fellow at the Council on Foreign Relations and a former U.S. Treasury official.

Beijing said on Thursday that it would deploy "resolute" countermeasures against the latest tariffs on Chinese goods, though it didn't say what those were. In response to Trump's earlier tariffs, China retaliated with tariffs of 15% on imports of U.S. chicken, wheat, corn and cotton and 10% duties on soybeans and beef. It also added a string of U.S. companies to export-control and corporate blacklists.

The White House Whirlwind That Led to 'Liberation Day'

WASHINGTON—In the final run-up to President Trump's "Liberation Day" tariff announcement, aides were left with a difficult task.

By Gavin Bade, Josh Dawsey and Meridith McGraw

They were struggling to square the president's seemingly contradictory goals for sweeping new duties. He wanted them to raise significant revenue for the government, as well as provide a durable signal for companies to invest in the U.S., people with knowledge of the discussions said. Those goals would align with a permanent, across-the-board tariff. A universal approach would also help prevent companies from avoiding tariffs by shifting production to other countries—a key issue for Trump's economic team.

But the president also liked the idea of reciprocity, the people said—or charging nations "what they charge us," as Trump has put it publicly. That pointed to individualized tariff rates for nations that could be calibrated according to their tariffs and other economic policies.

A senior administration official described a "ping pong match" between universal tariffs or the reciprocal approach.

On one hand, Trump viewed the idea for a universal tariff as simple and easy to explain, this person said. On the other hand, advisers such as National Economic Council director Kevin Hassett and Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick argued the American public would understand the tit-for-tat principle underlying a reciprocal approach.

In a Monday afternoon meeting with his trade advisers, Trump asked for numbers on every country, a prelude to the chart of tariff rates he displayed in the Rose Garden on Wednesday, the senior administration official said. The figures didn't necessarily match what foreign countries charge against imports from the U.S., The Wall Street Journal has reported.

In the end, they decided to implement both tariff options. On Tuesday afternoon in an Oval Office meeting, Trump wanted to go with the reciprocal approach, the person said, though the plan would also include a universal, 10% tariff for any nation not targeted with higher, reciprocal tariffs. That decision came late in the monthlong lead-up to Trump's self-imposed April 2 deadline, with the U.S. Trade Representative's office as late as Tuesday afternoon still working on alternative, less aggressive plans.

> The result is an approach that has shocked the stock market.

The result is an approach that has shocked the stock market and ignited a scramble for companies and foreign governments ahead of April 9, when the higher, reciprocal tariffs will take effect.

White House economic officials have largely taken the chaos in stride, the senior administration official said, adding that despite the magnitude of the announcement, "we are only down 3%," referring to the stock market.

Trump—who has called himself "a tariff man"—imposed a plan similar to one he promised on the campaign trail. He did so almost entirely based on his own vision for the U.S. economy, upending decades of U.S. trade policy without keeping some of his advisers in the loop and frustrating some Republicans who have backed his America First message.

In the aftermath of the tariff decision, Trump's aides took to TV to defend the president's action, but not always satisfactorily from the White House's perspective, people familiar with the matter said. On Thursday morning, there were discussions to make sure everyone was beating the same drum on TV. On Thursday, officials focused on consolidating his message that the tariffs are here to stay, even as aides close to him said some negotiations with other countries are likely.

"I don't think there's any chance…that President Trump's going to back off his tariffs," Lutnick said on Thursday on CNN. "The world should stop exploiting the United States of America." The administration has said the baseline 10% tariffs aren't up for negotiation, though higher duties could come down.

"He'll be in a negotiation with every country," said Steve Bannon, a former senior White House strategist who remains close with Trump and his aides. "Every day will be like Christmas. At the end of the day, what really excites him is talking about a deal with Canada, having Witkoff update him on Russia—the deals." Steve Witkoff, Trump's special envoy, has been leading negotiations in the Middle East and Ukraine.

Many people urged Trump to take a more modest path. Earlier on Tuesday, and in the days leading up to Trump's Wednesday tariff announcement, the White House fielded calls from industry and labor officials cautioning not to take a maximalist approach. GOP lawmakers and strategists expressed similar concerns about rising prices associated with tariffs.

The announcement was a surprise to many. Prominent business executives weren't invited to the Rose Garden, nor were they given information before the event about what was to come, according to people involved in the White House tariff discussions. One of the few chief executives invited to the event, Zekelman Industries CEO Barry Zekelman, said before boarding a flight to Washington that he still didn't know the details of the announcement he planned to attend.

Inside the White House, many aides were ready to finally move on from the weeks of tariff uncertainty. One senior administration official hoped the White House could just "deal with the bloodbath" on Thursday and move on.

After his announcement, the atmosphere among the trade leaders in Washington was downcast. At a pre-scheduled dinner hosted by the National Foreign Trade Council on Wednesday, pro-trade speakers from both parties railed against the tariffs, with Rep. Ted Lieu (D., Calif.) calling them crazy. "Anyone who suggests a tariff is not a tax needs to go back to school," former U.S. Trade Representative Susan Schwab said.

CEOs Rush To Address Fallout

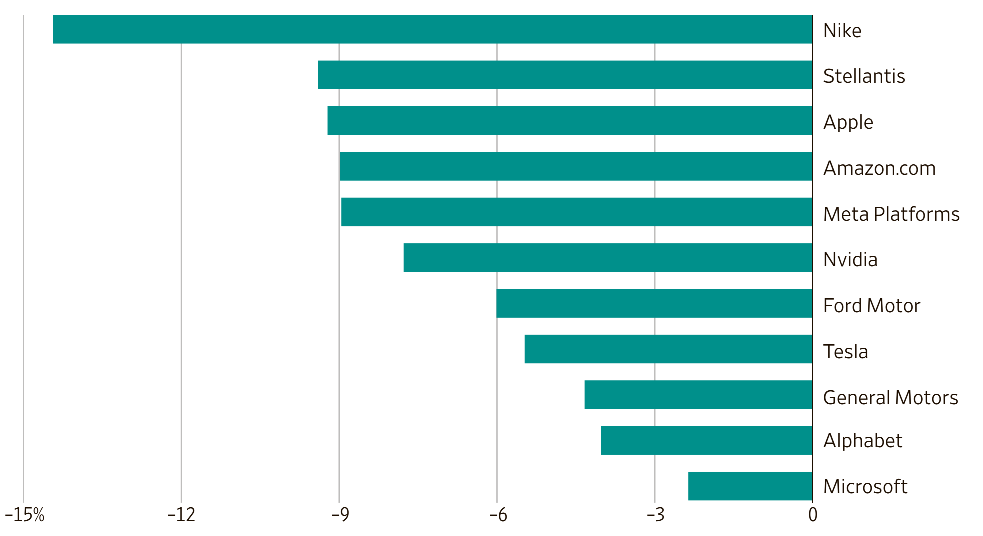
Continued from Page One

more than 50%. The 10% tariffs kick in Saturday, and the higher rates April 9.

Many CEOs of publicly traded companies were silent Thursday. The Business Roundtable, which represents 200 heads of U.S. companies across sectors, said universal tariffs run the risk of harming U.S. manufacturers, families, workers and exporters.

"Damage to the U.S. economy will increase the longer the tariffs are in place," the group said.

Share price change on Thursday, selected companies



Source: FactSet

'Feeling of nausea'

Brian Riley, CEO of Guardian Bikes, was among the guests on Wednesday at the Rose Garden where Trump unveiled his sweeping new plan, one of the few business leaders sitting alongside auto workers and steelworkers. He said he welcomed the tariffs, even though they will squeeze his business.

Guardian moved production of its children's bicycles in 2022 from China to Seymour, Ind. While 90% of the components are imported from China, Riley had already put in place a plan to reduce that number to about 20% by the end of next year.

The tariffs provide incentive for Guardian to expand capacity at its Seymour facility and invest in building out the bicycle supply chain in the U.S. Trump's agenda "is a welcome departure from a trade and economic policy that prioritized offshoring production and cheap consumption," Riley said.

The mood was less joyous at Pulsar Products, a Cleveland supplier of stationery, novelty items and souvenirs. Employees held a "watch party" in the company's boardroom to listen to Trump's announcement.

"As I looked around, I sensed a feeling of nausea," Pulsar CEO Eric Ludwig said. Employees are concerned not just with the impact on Pulsar, but also with what tariffs mean for their own wallets and the American people. "We are thinking our clothes are going to cost more," he said. "Everything is going to jump."

Pulsar has reduced the share of its supply coming from China to 50% from 80% in the past two years by moving some sourcing to Vietnam. One Pulsar employee is currently in Vietnam checking on production for the busy back-to-school season, set to arrive at U.S. retailers in July. Such shipments from Vietnam now face 46% tariffs.

Ludwig said he was hoping for some relief to help small businesses like his through the adjustment period. The new tariffs are the same for big companies and small, "but the impact on smaller companies is bigger," he said.

Complicated plans

Victor Yarbrough, CEO at Brough Brothers Distillery in Louisville, Ky., was left wondering what retaliatory tariffs would bring. He recently invested in an expansion, with a strategy to send his excess spirits overseas. The tariffs complicate those plans.

"We are certain the EU is going to retaliate," he said.

For booze giant Diageo, there was some relief after the White House kept duty-free access to the U.S. for products compliant with the U.S.-Mexico-Canada Agreement. It had feared some of its bestselling brands in the U.S.—like Don Julio tequila from Mexico and Canadian whisky Crown Royal—could be hit by new levies, potentially hurting operating profit by tens of millions of dollars a month.

While Trump wants to encourage foreign manufacturers to beat the tariffs by establishing production in the U.S., many simply can't. Europe's food and drink industry, for example, trades on its regional heritage and ingredients. Scotch and Irish whisky must be made in Scotland and Ireland.

Harry Tayler, co-founder of Scotch brand Wolfburn, watched on YouTube from his vacation in Cape Town as Trump hit British imports with a 10% tariff. He plans for the company and its U.S. distributor to absorb the cost.

"Our profits will end up in the pocket of the U.S. government," he said.

Still, Tayler sees a potential upside. The higher tariffs placed on imports from Ireland and Japan mean that Scotch may become more competitive and eat into the market share of two highly competitive rivals.

Shifting overseas

For Wisconsin-based Husco, which makes engines and parts for automakers and other manufacturers, the problem was the magnitude of the tariffs.

"If there had been a 5% tariff, we could have worked through it—maybe absorbing it, maybe sharing some of it with our suppliers," CEO Austin Ramirez said.

Husco has revenues of about $500 million and three factories in the U.S., as well as plants in India, China and Europe, which mostly produce for those regions.

Instead of boosting U.S. production, the new tariffs are likely to lead Husco to shift some production out of its U.S. factories. The new tariffs mean it will no longer be cost-effective to import components to make products for export.

"It doesn't make any sense to do that, I'm going to have to make those products in another part of the world," Ramirez said.

P2JW094000-6-A00800-1--------XA

TARIFF FALLOUT

Bid to Remake Economy

Continued from Page One

last year, faster than almost every other major developed economy, an unemployment rate of just 4.1% and inflation of 2.8%. Stocks were at record highs.

Wall Street assumed Trump would prioritize growth-friendly tax cuts and deregulation while delaying and diluting tariffs, as he did in his first term.

Instead, Trump decided to administer shock treatment immediately. The economy, he argued, is a sick patient that needs therapy now, regardless of the pain. "THE PATIENT LIVED, AND IS HEALING. THE PROGNOSIS IS THAT THE PATIENT WILL BE FAR STRONGER, BIGGER, BETTER, AND MORE RESILIENT THAN EVER BEFORE," he wrote on social media Thursday.

Trump's aides see the tariff rollout as part of a comprehensive program, along with tighter borders, lower taxes and less regulation, that will result in a more self-sufficient economy, where Americans produce more and import less of what they consume, fewer jobs are filled by immigrants who came illegally, the private sector is freer and the government less burdensome.

In that economy, "We're making a lot more stuff in America, high-tech manufacturing, security goods, autos, a lot more stuff across the industrial spectrum," said Stephen Miran, chairman of Trump's Council of Economic Advisers. Less regulation and taxes will "make it faster and more flexible to make stuff in America." Families and communities left behind by deindustrialization should benefit, Miran added.

Independent economists and even many Republicans think Trump's theory of the economy is wrong and that his trade policies will leave the U.S. poorer and international relations damaged. Some economists warn they could cause a recession.

U.S. markets slid Thursday in their steepest decline since March 2020, as investors worried the new tariff plan will hurt economic growth. Global markets also sank.

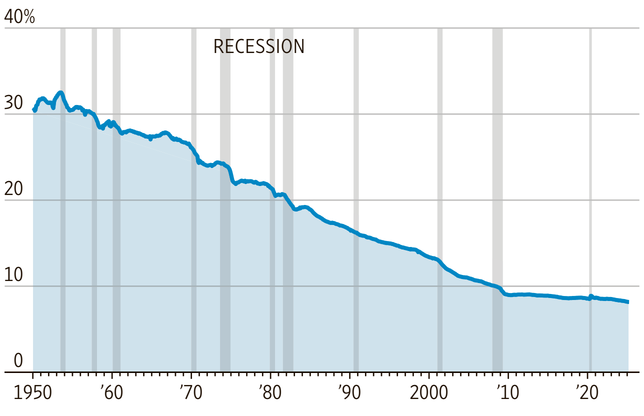
White House spokesman Kush Desai said Trump has made it clear that the U.S.'s decline isn't inevitable, but a choice rooted in bad policies that put it last. "Other peer countries like Germany and Japan have put their citizens first and maintained their manufacturing base and workforce," he said.

Donald Trump in 1987. He has talked about what he considers unfair trade policy since the 1980s. JOE MCNALLY/GETTY IMAGES

On Wednesday, which Trump called "Liberation Day," the president dismissed naysayers, saying: "Every prediction our opponents made about trade for the last 30 years has been proven totally wrong."

Still, he has acknowledged privately and publicly that, in the short run, implementation of his plan is going to be disruptive—higher inflation, at least temporarily, and an elevated risk of recession. "Will there be some pain? Yes, maybe (and maybe not!). But we will make America great again, and it will all be worth the price that must be paid," he said on social media in early February.

U.S. manufacturing workers as a percentage of all nonfarm workers



Source: Labor Department

Real-estate history

At a Republican National Committee fundraising dinner at the Four Seasons in New York on March 31, donors asked Vice President JD Vance how tariffs could impact Republicans in the 2026 congressional midterm elections.

Vance pivoted to Trump's vision for a realignment of global trade to one that better benefits the U.S., said attendees.

He told the crowd that he had met with Ford Motor Executive Chairman Bill Ford, whose family still controls the company, just the previous week, as Trump announced a 25% tariff on imported cars. Ford could suffer from Trump's auto tariffs since the company has supply chains that move through both Canada and Mexico.

Trump is making policy decisions with his gut after meeting with his advisers, Vance told the roughly 20 donors.

A spokesman for Vance didn't respond to a request for comment. A Ford spokeswoman confirmed the meeting.

Trump's obsession with trade and tariffs is heavily influenced by his background in real estate. "From the very first time I met him, on trade, it was as if he was talking about developing properties in New York City," recalled Sam Nunberg, who worked for Trump from 2011 to 2015. "He was extremely well versed, and he followed the nuances and he knew the history of it."

Marc Short, chief of staff to Trump's first vice president, Mike Pence, and now a critic of the tariffs, said, "The way [Trump] would describe it is to say...the American marketplace is the greatest marketplace, and people should be charged to have access to it, like a real-estate fee. And we're suckers not to be charging people not to have access to it."

> **Trump's rhetoric evokes past eras when U.S. manufacturing was at its zenith.**

Trump developed this viewpoint early on as a real-estate developer dealing with deep-pocketed Japanese investors. "Forget about our enemies—the enemies you can't talk to so easily. I'd make our allies pay their fair share," Trump told talk show host Oprah Winfrey in 1988. "We let Japan come in and dump everything into our markets. It's not free trade. If you ever go to Japan right now and try to sell something, forget about it...We make it possible for [Kuwait] to sell their oil. Why aren't they paying us 25% of what they're making?"

The targets of his ire have changed, from Japan, Kuwait and Saudi Arabia to China, Vietnam and Mexico, but his prescription has stayed the same: Make them pay for the privilege of selling to or being defended by the U.S.

His views were honed by listening to protectionist television personalities, including the late Lou Dobbs on CNN and Fox Business, Laura Ingraham on Fox and the late Ed Schultz on MSNBC, according to Nunberg.

Nunberg said Trump would remark on how much cheaper televisions were in the U.S. compared with other countries, a differential he blamed on bad trade deals. He said American workers were being victimized not just by offshoring but by illegal immigrants, citing conversations with union construction workers, Nunberg said.

The central message of his presidential campaigns reflected these ideas—that American workers and families were being unfairly hurt by prior presidents who had allowed imports and immigrants to flood the economy.

Tapping nostalgia

Trump's rhetoric often evokes past eras when American manufacturing was at its zenith.

"As I was driving over, I see these empty old, beautiful steel mills and factories that are empty and falling down," he told an interviewer in Chicago last year. "We're going to bring the companies back."

Princeton historian Julian Zelizer said Trump's vision of the economy is fundamentally a nostalgic one. "It's an older, manufacturing-based, 1950s-'60s auto-producing economy that I think he still envisions is possible, fueled by oil, not fueled by electricity."

Former Republican Speaker of the House of Representatives Newt Gingrich, a supporter of Trump, disagreed. Trump, he said, admires Elon Musk and is enthralled by space travel. But he said Trump has returned the U.S. to its roots when it comes to tariffs and trade.

Trump, he said, is an admirer of President William McKinley, who raised tariffs sharply in the 1890s. Only since Franklin Roosevelt has free trade been "enshrined in modern economic thought," he said.

In his first term, Trump raised tariffs considerably, especially on China. Japan, South Korea, Canada and Mexico all made concessions to secure new trade deals with the U.S.

Yet Trump ended his term with a sense of unfinished business. He has recently told allies at his Mar-a-Lago club in Florida that he felt blocked from larger scale tariffs by people such as National Economic Council director Gary Cohn and Secretary of State Rex Tillerson.

Trump's advisers have often tried to dissuade him of what they said were his misconceptions about trade, such as who pays the cost of the tariff. "That was always a circular conversation," recalled Short. "It would be explained, it's the American importers, and he'd come back...and he'd say those countries need to pay."

Trump's current team includes skeptics on tariffs, but they don't try to talk him out of using them.

On Wednesday, Trump affirmed his commitment to both tariffs and prosperity. But the announcement didn't explain how the first would lead to the second.

Doug Irwin, a trade historian at Dartmouth College, noted that moving automotive supply chains with Canada and Mexico, some of which date to the 1960s, to the U.S. will be a costly, decadeslong project.

"What all economists know about tariffs is they reduce efficiency," he said. "Is it plausible that we could make all parts of all cars and be just as efficient, and offer the same cars at the same prices, than when we take advantage of specialization across borders?"

Even supporters of tariffs say they should be complemented by investment in skills, research and advanced manufacturing, such as the law signed by President Joe Biden that directs $39 billion in subsidies toward chip manufacturing. Trump wants the law repealed, arguing for tariffs on chips instead.

"Tariffs are a very important part of the puzzle, but I think you also need supply side policies for rebuilding in America," said Oren Cass, founder of American Compass, a think tank aligned with Trump's populist agenda that favors more manufacturing at home and less immigration. "The details and subsequent policies are the way to get things done, and they've not done that yet."

Explaining Trump's economic agenda remains a challenge for Republicans who are steeped in the economic orthodoxy that tariffs are a form of taxes and thus bad for growth.

Trump's more mainstream advisers, such as Kevin Hassett, director of the National Economic Council, and Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent, play up the growth potential of his deregulatory and fiscal moves.

While Republicans in Congress have moved toward Trump on tariffs, few have embraced them enthusiastically. Rather than defend the tariffs, most prefer to discuss the parts of Trump's agenda that align with what Republicans have traditionally argued help growth, namely lower regulations, taxes and government spending.

"There's a mosaic," said Tennessee senator Bill Hagerty this week. "Part of it includes tariffs. It also includes taxes...there's also a deregulatory effort that's under way right now."

The hope is that the disruptive effects of tariffs, deportations and spending cuts wear off soon, allowing the positive effects of reshoring, cheaper energy and lower taxes to emerge. The anxiety among business, markets and the public that greeted Trump's "Liberation Day" announcement suggests threading that needle has become more treacherous.

U.S. Stocks Suffer a Steep Slide

Continued from Page One

ries in Mexico and Canada.

The turmoil spread, with oil prices dropping more than 6% and investors selling gold after its sharp run over the past year to fresh records. So far, traders said, selling has been orderly and though the scale of U.S. tariffs came as a shock, few investors are surprised to see stocks pull back following their gains over the past two years.

Trump took the selloff in stride. "I think it's going very well," Trump, a Republican, said in response to a question about his tariffs Thursday afternoon. "The markets are going to boom."

Still, the decline sets up financial markets for one of their most precarious periods in recent years, as the tariffs and the international reaction test that faith of investors used to sticking with stocks.

Across Wall Street, money managers, brokers and bankers were reeling from what many described as an unprecedented shock, fearing it marked an end to the relatively calm post-Covid rally. They might have lived through much bigger market swings, but this one felt incomparable because it was the result of deliberate policy.

"We're in a macro world that I've never seen now," said Stephen Solaka, managing partner at Belmont Capital Group. "We've been used to sort of the, 'buy the dip, things kind of work out,' scenario."

ARNE DEDERT/DPA/ZUMA PRESS

PETER PARKS/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

A trader at the Frankfurt Stock Exchange on Thursday; a board showed stocks on the Hang Seng Index in Hong Kong. Below, traders at the New York Stock Exchange and traders near a screen showing the Korea Composite Stock Price Index in Seoul.

JUSTIN LANE/EPA/SHUTTERSTOCK

AHN YOUNG-JOON/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Solaka, who spoke to many clients, sensed a level of anxiety they haven't felt in years, maybe ever. It is likely they grew accustomed to the market roaring back from every selloff, he said. This time, they aren't interested in looking to add tech stocks at a discount. "We've seen a lot of clients look to derisk," Solaka said, or reduce the risk of their portfolios.

Within about an hour on Wednesday evening, traders increased the probability of a recession this year to 48%, up from 38%, according to Polymarket, a crypto-based prediction market.

Even before Trump's speech ended, Wall Street's investors and intermediaries swung into action. But they struggled for the right words to describe what might come next, or what to do with their money. Some of their notes and commentaries referenced the tariff policies of the 1930s, rarely a welcomed historical comparison for either the markets or the economy.

As the market slide continued, some grew concerned selling would beget more selling. Automated-trading strategies have emerged as a stronger force in the market.

These programs, which depend on preset algorithms and models rather than intuition and instinct, tend to flicker to life just as the market turns more volatile, said Arnab Sen, who helped build some models while working for Barclays and Morgan Stanley. As a result, they can amplify selloffs, he said. "Think of it as a delayed reaction," Sen said. "They are not the spark, but they will exacerbate the chaos if this shock persists."

The ratio of options contracts typically meant to protect against big market declines—versus those meant to place bets that stocks will rise—surged to their highest level since Aug. 5, according to Cboe Global Markets. That day, the Nikkei 225 fell more than 12%, its worst one-day drop since the crash after Black Monday in 1987.

Thursday's market drop might have been, according to DRW Trading Group's Lou Brien, "as swift as I've even seen," but it will take time for investors to digest fully what Trump's tariffs mean. "It is a process, not an event," he said.

For weeks, investors hoped the tariffs unveiled at the president's "Liberation Day" wouldn't be so extensive.

Instead, "It was pretty shocking," said Danny Kirsch, head of options at Piper Sandler. He said his team had one of the busiest nights he can remember, placing bearish trades for clients until 10 p.m. Wednesday. "The bull argument keeps shrinking," Kirsch said.

Rob Citrone, a hedge-fund manager, watched Trump's announcement from his Orlando, Fla., home. Citrone knew more levies on imported goods were coming—the White House had stuck to this message for months—and so he had placed a series of wagers against U.S., European and Chinese stocks, betting they would drop as investors fretted over the consequences for consumers and companies.

But for the first part of Trump's Wednesday speech, the market moved higher. "This rally is crazy," Citrone thought, and added to his bets that stocks would fall.

Then Trump unveiled a plan that went further than most investors thought possible. Trump had just taken on the globe in a trade war. "I should have sold more," he said.

P2JW094000-7-A00900-1--------XA

WORLD NEWS

U.S. 'Going to Remain in NATO,' Rubio Says

Secretary of state offers new military-spending target for members: 5% of GDP

By Laurence Norman And Michael R. Gordon

Secretary of State Marco Rubio said NATO allies should spend up to 5% of their economic output on defense—a goal he said wouldn't need to be met immediately, and would require more U.S. spending, too.

"We do want to leave here with an understanding that we are on a pathway, a realistic pathway, to every single one of the members committing—and fulfilling a promise—to reach up to 5% of spending," Rubio said on his first visit to the alliance's headquarters in Brussels. "That includes the United States, who will have to increase its percentage."

BO AMSTRUP/RITZAU SCANPIX/AGENCE FRANCE-PRESSE/GETTY IMAGES

In Denmark, U.S. Army equipment waits to be loaded onto ships headed to America after drills.

A commitment by countries in the North Atlantic Treaty Organization to spend 5% of gross domestic product on their militaries would provide a huge boost to the alliance's defense, and address Washington's concerns that the Europeans haven't been pulling their weight. If Washington were to approach the 5% target, it would entail a big rise in military spending. Though Rubio signaled increased U.S. military spending, he didn't commit the U.S. to the 5% goal.

NATO diplomats in recent weeks have informally discussed reaching a 5% goal within several years for a limited period, diplomats said.

Rubio said the Trump administration understands that NATO allies can't reach the 5% goal immediately.

"No one expects that you are going to be able to do this in one year or two but the pathway has to be real," he said, speaking alongside NATO Secretary-General Mark Rutte.

NATO's previous target, set in 2014, committed alliance members to spend 2% of GDP on defense by last year. Twenty-three of the alliance's 32 members met that goal, NATO said.

Diplomats say there is already growing consensus among alliance members that they should move toward a target of 3.5% on core military expenditures. Members are informally discussing adding to that military-related infrastructure and other spending.

The U.S. spent 3.4% of its GDP in 2024 on defense. U.S. Defense Department spending and Energy Department expenditures on nuclear weapons totaled more than $880 billion for fiscal 2025.

To reach 5% of GDP, the U.S. would need to spend hundreds of billions of dollars more each year, according to an analysis by the Peterson Institute for International Economics in Washington.

President Trump and Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth have discussed a 5% goal. Rubio reinforced that message in remarks before the meeting of NATO foreign ministers, saying the alliance must build up its "hard power."

"President Trump has made clear he supports NATO. We are going to remain in NATO...But we want NATO to be stronger. We want NATO to be more viable," Rubio said. "And the only way NATO can get stronger and more viable is if our partners—the nation states which comprise this important alliance—have more capability."

Several European countries recently announced new plans to accelerate military spending.

"When you look at the hundreds of billions of euros...rolling in the last couple of months, this is probably the biggest surge in military spending we have seen in Canada and Europe since the Cold War," Rutte said. "But still, we'll need to do more."

South Korea's Impeached President Yoon Is Ousted

SEOUL—South Korea's Constitutional Court ousted President Yoon Suk Yeol over his short-lived declaration of martial law, clearing the way for a snap vote to elect a new president who will contend with deep divisions at home and rising friction with the U.S.

By Timothy W. Martin, Soobin Kim and Dasl Yoon

The Constitutional Court's eight judges voted unanimously in favor of upholding the impeachment of Yoon by the country's legislature. Yoon can't appeal the ruling.

Following the removal of Yoon, South Korea must now hold an election within 60 days—a vote that promises to be especially contentious as the fallout from Yoon's declaration of martial law continues to roil domestic politics.

The dismissal of the 64-year-old conservative closes a tumultuous chapter in South Korean politics. Yoon shocked the nation when he declared martial law on Dec. 3, arguing the country was at risk of falling prey to North Korean "communist forces" and to a constitutional crisis owing to a political impasse in the opposition-controlled legislature. He was forced to withdraw the declaration just hours later.

Yoon and his lawyers had argued that martial law was an act of governance, not an impeachable offense or crime.

PEDRO PARDO/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

People react to the court verdict upholding the impeachment of South Korean President Yoon Suk Yeol on Friday in Seoul.

On Friday, the Constitutional Court rejected those claims as invalid. The challenges faced by Yoon "must be resolved through political, institutional and judicial means—not by mobilizing the military," said Moon Hyung-bae, acting chief of the eight-judge Constitutional Court.

The clear front-runner in the coming election is opposition head Lee Jae-myung of the left-leaning Democratic Party, a popular though divisive politician who survived a brutal knife assault last year. The ruling conservatives remain bitterly divided over Yoon's actions and have yet to agree on a candidate.

"From now on, the real Republic of Korea begins," Lee said, referring to South Korea's official name. "Together with the people, we will restore the collapsed livelihood, peace, economy, and democracy in a spirit of unity."

The stakes are especially high for Seoul. President Trump has taken aim at South Korea's sizable trade surplus with the U.S. Meanwhile, North Korea has kept up its weapons launches and stands ready to carry out a nuclear test on short notice, according to a new assessment by the U.S.'s spy agencies. Trump has repeatedly accused Seoul of failing to pay enough to host American troops stationed in South Korea. Seoul is home to the U.S.'s largest overseas base.

The leadership vacuum has meant that direct talks with Trump to make South Korea's case have remained elusive. The country has cycled through acting presidents since December, with Prime Minister Han Duck-soo regaining the role after judges reversed his own impeachment over certain judicial appointments last week. A Han-Trump call doesn't appear imminent.

South Korea's next leader will be tasked with smoothing relations with Trump, while deciding how to react to China's growing overtures to deepen economic cooperation. During the Biden administration, South Korean firms invested tens of billions of dollars in the U.S., drawn in part by subsidies. But now, those investments could be seen as liabilities, as Trump repudiates Biden-era policies.

At home, the new president could seek to heal divisions opened by the martial-law order. Such uses of emergency powers were common until the 1980s, when sometimes-bloody mass protests ultimately toppled a multidecade run of military rule and brought democracy to the country.

Roughly one in three South Koreans expressed no preference for any candidate, according to a recent Gallup Korea poll, suggesting the race could be unpredictable.

Within days of the martial-law declaration, the National Assembly impeached Yoon, stripping him of his presidential powers. More than a dozen officials involved in the martial-law decision—including Yoon himself—have been indicted on charges of insurrection, among others.

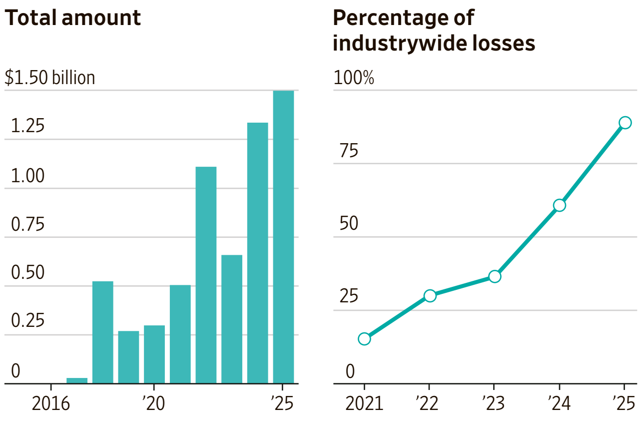
Yoon becomes the second South Korean president to be ousted since the country transitioned to democracy in 1987. The first came in 2017, when former President Park Geun-hye was removed over an influence-peddling scandal.

Pyongyang Hackers Fill Coffers

KCNA/KNS/AGENCE FRANCE-PRESSE/GETTY IMAGES

Crypto hackers have bolstered Kim Jong Un, seen inspecting intelligence-gathering tools.

Cryptocurrency theft by North Korean hackers



Note: 2025 data as of March 26

Source: Chainalysis

Continued from Page One

"North Korean hackers are playing a different game than anyone else," said Nick Carlsen, a former Federal Bureau of Investigation analyst who is now an investigator at TRM Labs, a blockchain-analytics firm.

Pyongyang's crowning achievement came in February with a $1.5 billion raid of Bybit, one of the world's biggest cryptocurrency exchanges, in the largest-ever such heist. That followed several hackings in 2024, when North Korea stole more than $6 out of every $10 lost by the cryptocurrency industry, according to Chainalysis, which tracks crypto theft.

The illicit money helps fund the Kim regime's nuclear program and prop up the country's sanctions-strapped economy.

North Korea's success reflects the major resources dedicated to the task. The regime commands more than 8,000 hackers as though they were in a military unit. State support means its hackers can wait months or years to exploit a single slip in a company's digital security. Pyongyang's desperation for cash, and its lack of concern for diplomatic blowback, have fueled its drive to be better than anyone else.

"The North Koreans are very pragmatic and just want to get things done—that's what makes them special," said Joon Kim, owner of Seoul-based Naru Security, which works with South Korea's intelligence agency and national police on cyber issues.

Pyongyang hasn't commented publicly about the latest crypto hackings. It has denied involvement in other cyber offensives in the past, which U.S. authorities said included the 2014 email hack of Sony Pictures Entertainment, 2016's theft of $81 million from Bangladesh's central bank and the WannaCry ransomware attack in 2017.

U.S. officials and private investigators said North Koreans leave behind digital crumbs making it clear they are the culprits, including familiar malware code and crypto wallets that were reused from prior heists attributed to Pyongyang.

The theft from WazirX, the Indian crypto exchange, showcased many of North Korea's go-to moves.

At the time, company officers were conducting a routine operation: moving $625,000 in crypto from a WazirX cold wallet, a digital vault where exchanges keep their reserves, to a so-called hot wallet, used to fulfill client transactions and withdrawals.

The transfer required three WazirX officials and an external service provider to sign off. Once those approvals were done, North Koreans somehow took control of the cold wallet and drained all the money in it—more than $200 million—and dispersed it without being caught.

With almost half its assets gone, WazirX had to shut its exchange. Only around $3 million of the stolen crypto has been frozen, in this case by Tether, the company that issues a cryptocurrency bearing its own name.

A representative for WazirX said it is trying to maximize recovery for users and reactivate its platform as quickly as possible.

The Wall Street Journal wasn't able to determine how the North Koreans got access to WazirX's cold wallet or modified the necessary approvals to take control.

But it was clear they were highly skilled. The North Koreans used more than 400 transactions to move WazirX crypto tokens to a wallet they controlled, suggesting the use of automation, said Benedict Hamilton, a managing director at Kroll, the firm WazirX hired to help trace the funds and restructure its debt.

Most of the funds have likely been converted to cash, Hamilton said.

North Korea spent decades cultivating its elite hacking capabilities, with the current dictator's late father, Kim Jong Il, once professing, "All wars in future years will be computer wars."

The country's cyber-attacking operation, South Korean officials said, comprises six groups and about a dozen supporting organizations.

Youths who show aptitude for math and science are quickly enlisted for training. Cyber operatives do little other than work on improving their skills, and are subject to physical punishment, said Elma Duval, a co-author of a report by PScore, a Seoul-based advocacy group that interviewed former North Korean IT workers. Still, they live more comfortably than most North Koreans.

The reason for North Korea's focus is obvious: It needs about $6 billion a year to fund its various government activities, South Korea's spy agency has said, including hundreds of millions of dollars estimated to be earmarked for its nuclear program.

International sanctions have limited North Korea's take from its traditional cash cows, including arms sales, coal smuggling and overseas labor. Crypto theft offers a low-risk way for Pyongyang to fill its coffers, said Eric Penton-Voak, who served as coordinator of the U.N. panel overseeing sanctions enforcement of North Korea from 2021 to 2023.

"North Korea has to pay more for everything, so they have to steal more than anyone else," he said. "It's very expensive to be a sanctioned country."

P2JW094000-0-A01000-1--------XA

ARTS IN REVIEW

FILM REVIEW | KYLE SMITH

An Oddball Blockbuster

The Hollywood adaptation of Minecraft retains the game's nutty spirit

"A MINECRAFT MOVIE" was always going to be weird considering the nuttiness of the videogame franchise upon which it is based: blocky pink sheep, skeletons firing flaming arrows, a cube called the Orb. But cheers to Warner Bros. for embracing the weird by choosing director Jared Hess, whose deadpan 2004 debut, "Napoleon Dynamite," was so awkward it was sublime.

Mr. Hess's take on Minecraft is an expensive and expansive blockbuster with the soul of a scrappy no-budget indie. Big, effects-driven features tend to play it safe; this one is adorably unruly, in tune with the intentionally retro look of the game. Those expecting a more conventional multiplex offering along the lines of "Jumanji" might be caught off-guard by what amounts to a $150 million cult item.

The external evidence suggests that Jack Black, sporting a beard with patches of gray, has put fifth grade long behind him. Yet you'd never know it by the way he acts, exhibiting a don't-care-about-being-cool level of enthusiasm that is pure elementary school as Steve, an office drone who sells doorknobs but always yearned for the physicality of life as a miner. Still hanging around mines as an adult, he zips through a mystical portal and into another dimension called the Overworld, where he not only gets to mine but also to craft: He learns to whip up objects such as tools and weapons and building blocks. Soon he has assembled a cabin out of bales of pink wool and has a pet wolf named Dennis.

Alas, in contrast to this creativity-forward dimension, another, more sinister one awaits, and Steve gets drawn into a fight for survival against an array of monsters both wacky and scary. Creative mode vs. survival mode: There are a lot of life metaphors in Minecraft, and I trust many a Ph.D. in cultural studies will produce papers on the matter.

In battling the monsters Steve will shortly be joined by a random assortment of newbies drawn through the portal from an Idaho town built around a potato-chip factory. One of its employees is a young woman, Natalie (Emma Myers of Netflix's "Wednesday"), who is taking care of her little brother, Henry (Sebastian Hansen), after their mom died. They meet a real-estate agent (Danielle Brooks) who doubles as a traveling zookeeper—alpacas poke their heads out of her car—and a former champion gamer, Garrett (Jason Momoa), whose glory days, such as they were, are long past. Mr. Momoa, who after a soggy launch in those regrettable Aquaman epics is becoming a highly amusing ensemble actor, is, like everything else Mr. Hess presents, gratifyingly offbeat in his fringed pink-leather jacket.

Visually speaking, "A Minecraft Movie" is like a hyper-caffeinated trip to a colossal candy store, or maybe just a trip, full stop. Imagine 1970s kiddie-TV producers Sid and Marty Krofft given access to today's digital toybox: The screen teems with bizarre monsters (giant pigs who talk like high-school burnouts, dog-shaped hedges with giraffe necks called "Creepers" that have a tendency to explode) and gonzo weaponry: A "tot launcher" fires little potato puffs, and buckets meant to be used as nunchucks get dubbed "buck-chuckets." As was true of the Lego movies, every set piece has a lovable throwback quality, suggesting early-generation videogame designs with their block-by-block structures.

Not everything about the film works—some gags are thin, and a few of the fight scenes underwhelming—but on occasion Mr. Hess steers things in such an unexpected direction that it's hilarious. One particularly inspired subplot brings in Jennifer Coolidge as the love-starved vice-principal of Henry's school. She collides with one of the placid, monk-like animated Villagers from the Overworld who slips into her dimension, then takes him out on a date. Another appropriately bizarre interlude finds Mr. Black riding the airborne Mr. Momoa into battle like a flying pony. Scoring this scene to the B-52s dork-rock classic, "Private Idaho," is an inspired choice; the whole film is like a B-52s song, full of jerky jubilation and sly mischief, not for a moment hard-edged, mean-spirited, jaded or cynical.

One tiresome habit of the blockbuster factory these days is that it keeps stamping out quippy young wisenheimers who react to everything with hyper-confident sangfroid. But Mr. Hess and his five screenwriters have mined childhood to craft something that's alive with imagination. It's not the most polished movie you'll see this year, but it's as cheerfully mad as a little kid's birthday party. We could use more of that.

Jack Black, Jason Momoa and Sebastian Hansen in 'A Minecraft Movie,' above; Emma Myers, below.

WARNER BROS. PICTURES (2)

TELEVISION REVIEW | JOHN ANDERSON

A Dying Woman's Desires Set Free

Jenny Slate, above left; Michelle Williams and Jay Duplass, above right, in 'Dying for Sex.'

It's very tempting to simply heap roses on "Dying for Sex" through blossomy phrases like "heartbreaking" or "captivating" or "life-affirming," which have lost all meaning, having been overused by critics. They don't do the show justice anyway. The bigger problem with "Dying for Sex" is that while it's revelatory, liberating, emotionally devastating and a very sex-centric story about love and desire, it also needs to be explained.

"Everybody has a bucket list," says palliative-care consultant Sonya (the marvelous Esco Jouley), reassuring the terminally ill Molly Kochan (Michelle Williams). Sure, people do: Disney World. Batmobiles. A weekend at the George V in Paris. What Molly wants, at long last, is a satisfying sexual experience with another person after years of a petrified marriage, a battle with breast cancer, reconstructive surgery and the news, after four years of remission, that the cancer has come back. In her hip. Stage IV. Inoperable. Her guilt-monger husband, Steve (Jay Duplass), stopped sleeping with her after the first diagnosis. Is it significant that the cancer has re-emerged below her waist? There are many ways of interpreting many things in this eight-part series.

> **The return of cancer becomes the catalyst for Molly Kochan to upend her life.**

Developed by Elizabeth Meriwether and Kim Rosenstock, "Dying for Sex" is based on the podcast of the same name by Nikki Boyer (played by a genius Jenny Slate) and the real-life Molly Kochan. It tracks, with much humor, poignancy and abundant frankness, Molly's sexual journey—not reawakening: She knows very well what she wants and has not been getting. The climax of the story? I lost count.

The shadow of death has set her free—likewise, the cancer drugs that are supposed to reduce libido but in Molly have the opposite effect. For all the supposedly erotic content, though, "Dying for Sex" is remarkably free of titillation or prurience. And what the radiant performance by Ms. Williams makes clear—and heartbreaking, and life-affirming—is that Molly just wants to be desired. Steve, whom she dumps immediately upon getting the very bad news, has been attentive, caring, organized and devoted. You hate him. Mr. Duplass, quite good in a heroically thankless role, is playing a guy whose every act of alleged tenderness comes with a surcharge of martyrdom. If you didn't know better, you'd think he was carcinogenic.

Once Molly frees herself from Steve (but not his health care), she still has to contend with her childhood; having been sexually abused at age 7 by the boyfriend of her mother (Sissy Spacek), she is haunted by both the experience and her abuser (in phantom form). This aspect of the Kochan story may have been based in fact (I don't know; I've purposely avoided the podcast), but it seems narratively unnecessary. Why does her journey have to be a reaction to trauma, rather than incipient mortality? It makes her a little less brave as she abandons all bourgeois notions of what constitutes propriety and the series becomes both comic and fiercely emotional in relating the awkward explorations of one woman, and the bond between two. It isn't a competition, but whether one falls in love with Ms. Slate or Ms. Williams—as Nikki assists, and Molly scores—is a toss-up. Why choose? Both give startling, uninhibited and poignant performances (sorry, more adjectives), in a show guaranteed to generate love and disquiet.

"Dying for Sex" will surely upset some with its unfettered biology and acknowledgment of kinks. David Rasche ("Succession"), who plays Molly's oncologist, is simply wonderful and a stand-in for the more prim among us; he is understanding, but squirms. He knows, at the same time, that while the body may be basic, what makes the libido tick is something else—many things, in fact. Molly, in her shall we say open-mindedness, discovers a gift for domination, which she exercises with partners who, for example, dress up like dogs. Or with her gruff, seemingly unapproachable neighbor across the hall (a terrific Rob Delaney), who was just waiting for someone to tap into his submissive inclinations. Their relationship is a beautiful thing, though not as lovely and real as the one between Nikki and Molly. But again, it's not a competition.

Dying for Sex
Friday, FX on Hulu

Mr. Anderson is the Journal's TV critic.

FX (2)

ARTS IN REVIEW

THEATER REVIEW | CHARLES ISHERWOOD

Clooney Comes to Broadway

The movie star plays broadcaster Edward R. Murrow in a stage version of 'Good Night, and Good Luck'

New York

Good night, good luck, and the nearest Starbucks is two blocks south on Broadway.

That is obviously not the salutation the celebrated newsman Edward R. Murrow used to conclude his television programs. Murrow worked in an era when journalists were fueled by cigarettes and Scotch, to begin with. But it might be a useful sendoff for audiences attending "Good Night, and Good Luck," the stylish but stolid stage adaptation—transcription might be a more apt term—of the 2005 movie, with George Clooney making his Broadway debut. A double shot of espresso might not come amiss after watching this slick but unenthralling show.

Mr. Clooney directed the movie and co-wrote it with Grant Heslov. They also wrote the stage version, which presumably is why it closely mirrors the film's structure and content, with a sizable portion of the dialogue lifted verbatim. Fair enough: The Oscar-nominated movie was smart, and written with admirable economy. A running time of roughly 90 minutes is almost unheard-of in film today; it's less so in the theater, and the stage version runs about 100 minutes without an intermission.

But for those who saw the movie—I assume a considerable portion of the audience—the theatrical version offers little that's fresh, or even more fully fleshed out. True, Mr. Clooney has moved into the central role of Murrow, after playing his co-producer Fred Friendly on film. This was no doubt a calculated decision to goose the box office; no one wants to pay Broadway prices to see a big star of his stature in a minor role. (The show already set a Broadway record for a straight play, grossing $3.3 million in one week.)

And Mr. Clooney gives an excellent, self-effacing modest performance. He portrays Murrow, as the excellent David Strathairn did in the movie, with a stark, almost grim sense of seriousness and wary courage as he embarks upon a journalistic crusade to expose the mendacity and sheer cruelty of Sen. Joseph McCarthy, a ringleader of the Red Scare of the 1940s and 1950s.

The talented director, David Cromer, works feverishly to fill the ample Winter Garden Theatre stage with background movement to complement the generally brief scenes in the foreground. But the production never breaks free of the source material to become a captivating or original theatrical event, notwithstanding the obvious parallels to the current political climate.

> The slick drama closely mirrors the structure and content of the film.

As in the movie, McCarthy is seen only in archival video projected on televisions embedded in the proscenium and on screens elsewhere, as are two of the victims of his movement: the Air Force reservist Milo Radulovich, and Annie Lee Moss, a black woman who worked at the Pentagon. And again, jazz standards such as "How High the Moon" and "When I Fall in Love" are used interstitially, here performed live on a raised platform by a small combo, with the terrific Georgia Heers singing.

Murrow's anti-McCarthy commentary is projected on a much larger screen that drops down, with Mr. Clooney effectively evoking Murrow's studied lack of emotional affect, which paradoxically heightens the power of his words.

But while the supporting cast is uniformly fine, few have significant amounts of stage time. As Don Hollenbeck, a colleague accused of being a "pinko" in the Hearst press, Clark Gregg turns in a brief but quietly moving performance. Glenn Fleshler brings wry humor, matched by Murrow's own, to his role as the producer Friendly. Paul Gross has a stately presence as CBS chief William Paley, who stood by Murrow, even knowing it could be both controversial and costly.

But much of the cast, large for a Broadway play at almost two dozen, has little to do except fill the stage with movement as they clack away at typewriters, squabble at conferences or preside over a sound booth. (The atmospheric set design, by Scott Pask, is superlative—virtually a character in its own right.)

The play does add some supplemental commentary and dialogue, and concludes with a video montage including images from television in the post-Murrow era, ending with Elon Musk's infamous Nazi-or-not salute. But while the stage show is, like the movie, admirably free of plain preaching or righteous fictionalized speeches, audiences attending are likely to be coming from two camps: rabid fans of Mr. Clooney who can afford the staggeringly high prices (many tickets sell for $800), or those who share Mr. Clooney's liberal political views and can afford those ticket prices. Or is that just one camp?

In any case, few among them are going to come away enlightened—or even consistently entertained.

EMILIO MADRID

Glenn Fleshler and George Clooney in the play, directed by David Cromer.

Good Night, and Good Luck
Winter Garden Theatre, 1634 Broadway, New York, 212-239-6200, closes June 8

Mr. Isherwood is the Journal's theater critic.

FILM REVIEW | KYLE SMITH

In the Footsteps Of 'Pulp Fiction'

The feature-length anthology "Freaky Tales" is joyfully anchored in a specific time and place: It's 1987 Oakland, Calif., where we're told there's a cosmic green glow that infuses everything with a mystical power. There is indeed a recognizable vibe to the film, but it is derived from a somewhat more mundane force: the oeuvre of Quentin Tarantino.

Ryan Fleck and Anna Boden, who made soulful indies ("Half Nelson," "It's Kind of a Funny Story") before they took a detour into franchise filmmaking with the billion-dollar earner "Captain Marvel," have returned to their roots after a six-year absence from cinemas. They serve as both writers and directors of this "Pulp Fiction"-style four-chapter tale that finally coheres with a thumper of a final act that is awash in righteous gore served up with an arch sensibility.

That conclusion both supplies an alternative fantasy ending to a highly publicized real-life occurrence (à la "Once Upon a Time . . . in Hollywood") and centers on a vengeance-minded figure with an East Asian outlook dispatching baddies with a sword while wearing a snazzy tracksuit like the Bride in "Kill Bill." Mr. Fleck (who grew up in Oakland and neighboring Berkeley) and Ms. Boden might have been credited with some inventiveness if they had dug up a more obscure artist to whom to pay homage, but given Mr. Tarantino's status as perhaps the single most imitated filmmaker of his generation, "Freaky Tales" can hardly avoid being stamped as derivative.

Which is not to say it isn't fun, at least intermittently. Did you know the guy who was in "Splash" used to sell hot dogs at Oakland A's games? Characters keep bringing this up, sometimes referring to the actor in question as the guy from "Bachelor Party" or "The Money Pit." Though these are perhaps not the three projects he is today most proud of, Tom Hanks is ever the good sport, and obligingly appears in the film. He plays Hank, the impressively, and annoyingly, well-informed owner of a video store. From the checkout counter he slings unsolicited film commentary along with VHS rentals (and is hence yet another reminder of Mr. Tarantino, famously a chatty video-store clerk around the same time).

Mr. Hanks joins a sprawling cast of characters who wander in and out of each other's stories in the four chapters, which strike different tones as if alluding to different types of '80s movies. In the first, a multicultural group of youngsters led by Tina (Ji-young Yoo) and Lucid (Jack Champion) who dance at the Berkeley punk club 924 Gilman Street take up arms against a gang of skinhead thugs who have been terrorizing them. In chapter two, a pair of aspiring hip-hop singers, Barbie (Dominique Thorne) and Entice (Normani), are invited to perform at a club where they get into a comical rap battle with an established, real-life master of the form, Too Short (DeMario Symba Driver). The artist, an early avatar of West Coast hip-hop, also narrates the film and has a cameo as a cop; his 1987 track "Freaky Tales" gave the movie its title. In the third section, a disillusioned loan-shark enforcer, Clint (Pedro Pascal), tries to exit the game after losing his pregnant wife. In the climactic fourth act, the corrupt cop (Ben Mendelsohn) for whom Clint works organizes a string of robberies at the homes of Golden State Warriors players while they're participating in a playoff game against the Los Angeles Lakers.

Stretching across all of the segments is much excited discussion of "Psytopics," a New Age psychological inquiry, or self-improvement method, or cult that sounds a bit woo-woo in the California way but turns out to be highly useful in a crisis. One of its practitioners is the movie's hero, real-life basketball star Eric "Sleepy" Floyd (Jay Ellis), who has a record-setting night on the court and (at least in the movie) an even more memorable one away from it.

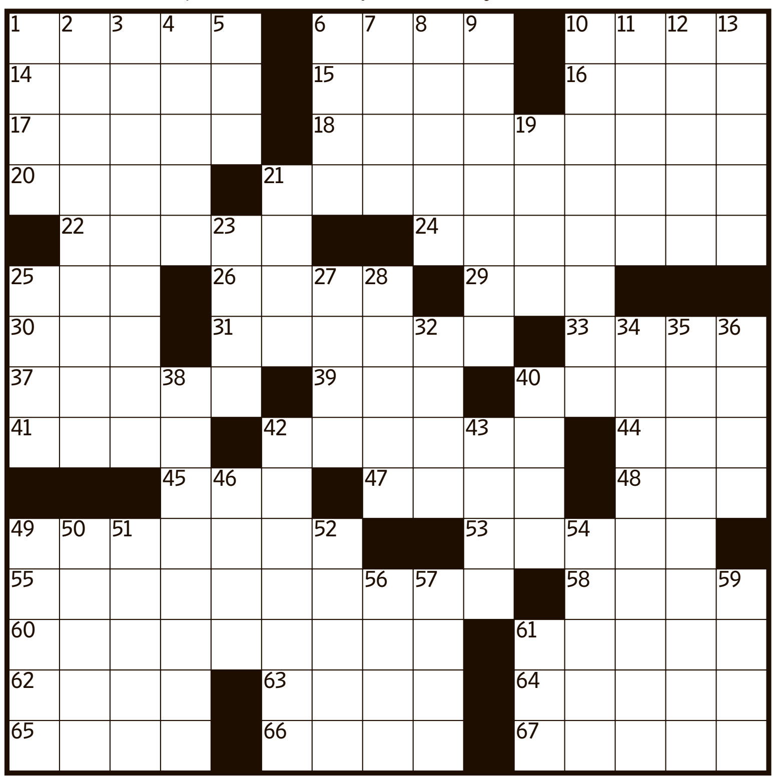
That over-the-top climax, despite its borrowed elements, partially redeems "Freaky Tales," which until then follows a zigzag path that is paved with clichés. Unlike Mr. Tarantino, who has few peers when it comes to dialogue and characterization, Mr. Fleck and Ms. Boden fail to keep the narrative energy consistently high. Still, with its love for trashy genre conventions and its referential humor ("The Shining" and "Scanners" are among the non-Tarantino features that earn an amusing shout-out), "Freaky Tales" contains a bit more mojo than the average indie.

LIONSGATE

Pedro Pascal in 'Freaky Tales.'

The WSJ Daily Crossword | Edited by Mike Shenk

PUZZLE CONTEST



YOU'LL FIGURE IT OUT | By Matt Gaffney

The answer to this week's contest crossword is **an Oscar-winning movie of the 21st century.**

Across

1 Unusual tie
6 Give for free
10 Suffix in company names
14 India's longest-serving prime minister
15 Dangerous rounds
16 "Hard ___!" (sailor's shout)
17 Willie Nelson's "___ a Mistake"
18 Carbon copy
20 Sherbet choice
21 Total chemical potential for electrons
22 Peter of "Casablanca"
24 Stress, in a way
25 Band from Athens
26 Societal woes
29 Prefix with skeleton
30 Special effects letters
31 Calm
33 Hint from an oracle
37 Online shopping victims, often
39 Tiananmen Square figure
40 Genre without live actors
41 "Nolo contendere" is one
42 Canal clogger
44 Karaoke handful
45 Mythical bird
47 Become wearisome
48 Sort
49 Home to seven 14th-century popes
53 "The Power of Positive Thinking" author
55 Hannah Montana portrayer
58 Greek tapas
60 Happy as a clam
61 Dickens character, often
62 Bar bills
63 Finito
64 East Coast train
65 "OK, got it now"
66 Finishes up
67 Ivanišević who won Wimbledon in 2001

Down

1 Indigo-yielding plant
2 Like some questionable actions
3 Teahouse option
4 Choose a dish
5 Third-col. heading
6 Casual place
7 Soccer star Marmoush
8 876 years from now
9 Assumed to be true
10 One of Chad's neighbors
11 2022 Cooperstown inductee Tony
12 Find a new tenant for
13 Key partner
19 Holly's genus
21 Plunged
23 Tears
25 Dudley Do-Right's grp.
27 Monk in the mountains
28 Steep bank
32 "State Fair" setting
34 She directed "On the Basis of Sex" and "Deep Impact"
35 Paul Muni was Oscar-nominated for playing him in 1937
36 Bottle part
38 Monetary generosity
40 Car bar
42 Destruction of habitats
43 Obstacle for Hannibal
46 Finish for syn- or pseud-
49 Expensive violin
50 He beat Connors in the 1977 U.S. Open final
51 "Heavens to Betsy!"
52 Stuff in stockings
54 Florentine friend
56 Tear in two
57 Finds a role for
59 McGregor of "Big Fish"
61 Tail movement

Previous Puzzle's Solution

M	A	I	T	R	E	D		E	M	B	A	S	S	Y
A	R	M	H	O	L	E		P	R	O	N	O	U	N
L	I	I	I	I	I	I	I	I	I	I	I	I	M	O
T	A	N	S			G	N	C		T	S	L	O	T
				G	U	N	K		B	A	E			
S	I	T	S	O	N			C	O	N		B	I	O
P	O	O	O	O	O	O	O	O	O	O	O	O	R	K
A	W	L	S			M	V	P			M	O	A	B
W	A	A	A	A	A	A	A	A	R	R	A	N	T	Y
N	N	W		M	S	N			K	E	R	S	E	E
			L	I	P		W	H	O	A				
B	Y	R	O	N		B	A	Y			O	N	M	E
U	U	U	U	U	U	U	N	D	E	R	W	E	A	R
C	A	S	I	T	A	S		R	A	V	I	O	L	I
K	N	E	S	S	E	T		A	R	S	E	N	I	C

▸ Email your answer—in the subject line—to **crosswordcontest@wsj.com** by 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time Sunday, April 6. A solver selected at random will win a WSJ mug. Last week's winner: Rachel Tan, Rochester Hills, MI. Complete contest rules at **WSJ.com/Puzzles**. (No purchase necessary. Void where prohibited. U.S. residents 18 and over only.)

SPORTS

JASON GAY

The Most Exciting Player In the Final Four

Paige Bueckers came to UConn with heavy expectations. The 23-year-old is making history on and off the court and getting one last shot at the title that's eluded her.

Paige Bueckers has been on a historic tear in the NCAA Tournament.

It's just a quick clip that spun around social media, but it summed up the moment we live in: Paige Bueckers, the UConn women's basketball star, inbound to the Final Four in Tampa, Florida, when she encounters a young fan overcome by emotion.

Bueckers gently puts an arm around the teary child, who's wearing a hoodie with Buecker's name and No. 5. She offers to pose for a photo; A photo is taken. The girl keeps sobbing. She puts her face in her hands. It's the way superfans react to meeting pop idols.

This is where we are now: Paige Bueckers, the best remaining player in the NCAA Women's Tournament, is a bona fide American sports celebrity, as big a name as there is in college basketball, rivaled only by the injured Juju Watkins, and the Duke phenom Cooper Flagg.

If you've been watching hoops this month—men's or women's—you can't miss Bueckers (pronounced "Beckers"). She's the engine of this 35-3 Husky team; she's constantly in commercials (Nike, Gatorade); she's getting flowers from Elle, Andraya and Chiney on the ESPN halftime show (the sharpest halftime show going, FWIW).

She's earning. Bueckers is a vanguard of Generation NIL, with earnings estimated in seven figures.

None of this would mean much if Bueckers wasn't a dynamo on the court. The 23-year-old from Hopkins, Minn., has been on a historic tear, averaging a tournament-leading 29 points per game over Connecticut's four victories, including a 40-point masterpiece in the Sweet 16 versus Oklahoma. It was the most points ever scored in a tournament game by a UConn women's player, a wild mark when you consider how much talent has rumbled through Storrs.

Bueckers is doing this while flirting with "50/40/90"—the heavenly shooting standard of 50% from the field, 40% from 3, and 90% from the free throw line (she's at 88.8%, currently).

Numbers fail to tell the whole story, of course. Bueckers's journey to her last Final Four—she intends to go pro this summer, almost surely as the No. 1 pick in the WNBA—traveled a winding, arduous path.

She's been the highly-recruited phenom from Gopher country who captured national player of the year as a freshman. She's been the hard-luck case derailed by repeated injuries, including a torn ACL which forced her to miss an entire season.

Today Bueckers is a rebuilt, relentless vet guiding the Huskies to the doorstep of a title the legendary program hasn't won since 2016.

Her extended college career raised her profile, but the highlights have come with heartache. Ambitions have been disrupted. As Bueckers recovered from her injuries, Caitlin Clark evolved into the college game's breakthrough sensation. Defending champ South Carolina, also arrived in Tampa, was anointed the next UConn.

The actual UConn remains formidable, led by indefatigable coach Geno Auriemma, in season No. 40. These Huskies are deep. There's freshman sensation Sarah Strong, so good in the regional final over a Watkins-deprived USC; there's Princeton transfer Kaitlyn Chen, pushing the offense with Bueckers; there's graduate senior Azzi Fudd, another comet undone by injury, soaring as a vital contributor.

But in crunch time this is Paige's show.

"I trust her to always do the right thing," Auriemma said of Bueckers following Monday's quarterfinal win. "After she's tried all the [expletive] she wants to do, then she'll finally do the right thing."

The legendary coach smirked as he said this. At 71, Auriemma has mentored more stars, won more games and captured more championships (11) than any women's college basketball coach ever. He's earned the right not to suffer fools, and doesn't. (Geno lighting up the NCAA's daffy two-site regional format was a treat.)

Still, Auriemma knows it's different now. The financial rewards are impressive, but the demands on high-profile talent like Bueckers—he thinks there's never been a UConn player who's faced as much scrutiny. "She's the first one," Auriemma said. "Other [players] were able to navigate it—there was pressure, but not like it is today."

Bueckers is keeping her head down. These Final Four teams are all potent: UCLA, Texas and South Carolina covet the same finish she covets. She spoke of "not getting too caught up in *what if that, what if this,* just staying present, staying in the moment, not worrying about the pressures or the stakes because everybody's dealing with it."

"Everybody's there to win a national title," she said.

And yet why not Paige Bueckers?

It would be a starry ending.

"I'm really going to miss her," Auriemma whispered, adding: "I can't say that out loud."

JENNY KANE/ASSOCIATED PRESS

A Golden Rule Is Being Challenged by Data-Obsessed Coach

By Laine Higgins and Andrew Beaton

FOUR YEARS AGO, a young basketball coach at the University of San Francisco named Todd Golden sat down in front of a computer to deliver a presentation on data.

His 30-minute spiel, entitled "Analytics in Basketball: Winning in the Margins," covered a range of topics that might cause even the biggest basketball nerds to doze off, from formulas for calculating advanced statistics to heat maps showing how shot selection has evolved over time.

But one of the ideas he discussed in detail wasn't just a little wonky. It was a revolutionary notion that challenged one of the core tenets of college basketball orthodoxy.

"What you see a lot of coaches do, and I don't want to call them old school..." Golden said, before launching into his premise.

When a player collects two fouls in the first half, coaches typically send them straight to the bench to avoid a scenario where they pick up a third and are dangerously close to fouling out before halftime.

This seemed like a perfectly logical strategy, Golden explained. Except it was a load of bunk.

Why, he asked, should coaches keep their best players out of the game and limit their playing time over a fear of something that might never happen?

It's that kind of subversive thinking that has taken Golden from Ivy League assistant to head coach at the University of Florida in less than a decade—and which now has the Gators two wins away from a national championship.

The 39-year-old is part of a generation of coaches who aren't just using the data that has flooded sports to inform their coaching styles, but to upend long-held beliefs that fans—and other coaches—don't even think to question.

"We do everything by numbers," said Florida associate head coach Korey McCray. "It's something that is different."

To be sure, Golden isn't the only coach who relies on data. Duke coach Jon Scheyer, the 37-year-old who replaced Mike Krzyzewski on the Blue Devils bench in 2022, has also steered his team to the Final Four thanks to a willingness to let his biggest stars stay on the floor even after collecting two fouls.

The logic behind the strategy is so simple that it seems impossible it was ignored by traditionalists for so long. Reflexively benching a player with two fouls in the first half puts an artificial cap on their time on the floor.

Todd Golden, below, kept Will Richard in an Elite Eight game after the starting guard picked up his second foul.

"A lot of coaches think, 'Oh, I'm gonna save that guy for the second half when the game is on the line,'" Golden said. "What people don't realize is that regardless of whether it's two minutes into the game or the final minute of the game, points are worth the same across all 40 minutes"

And it's not as if coaches get a prize for a player finishing with unused fouls. Someone who picks up two fouls in the first half might not pick up another one the rest of the way. That's why it can be more advantageous to test the limits by letting a star stay on the court rather than simply assuming he'll pick up additional fouls. It's always possible to sit him later, but you can't get back those minutes he spent on the bench.

In every season since Golden first became a head coach in 2020, he has ranked in the Top-40 among college basketball's 360-plus coaches in the percentage of first-half minutes he has played starters with two fouls, according to college basketball statistician Ken Pomeroy. Since Golden became Florida's coach three years ago, the Gators are the only major conference team to have been in the Top-40 each season.

Golden hasn't hesitated to put his theory to the test on the biggest stage. Midway through the first half of Florida's Elite Eight clash against Texas Tech, starting guard Will Richard picked up his second foul. Golden left him in—and was rewarded when Richard wound up with only three fouls in the entire game.

Granted, there are some occasions when sitting a player still makes sense. If he's so scared of picking up a third foul that he eases up on defense, say, sidelining him can be worthwhile.

But one of the reasons Duke has looked so dominant in the NCAA tournament is because of Scheyer's willingness to buck that thinking—even when it comes to the top player in America.

Early in the tournament, Cooper Flagg got into foul trouble against Baylor, but Scheyer let him play the final four minutes of the first half anyway. It paid off spectacularly. Out of nowhere, Duke's lead ballooned from six to 17.

Flagg had seven of those points in a two-minute span—even though he already had two fouls.

GODOFREDO A. VASQUEZ/ASSOCIATED PRESS; THEARON W. HENDERSON/GETTY IMAGES

P2JW094000-0-A01300-1--------XA

OPINION

Time for Congress to Musk-Up

POTOMAC WATCH
By Kimberley A. Strassel

This GOP Congress is effusive in its praise of Elon Musk's effort to cut waste and fraud. What they won't say is that nothing fundamentally changes until their blab becomes a plan—and a work ethic to match that of the billionaire. The news: A handful of Senate Republicans have a plan for that, and the ear of Donald Trump.

The party of "limited government." The party of "fiscal sanity." The party of "we don't have a revenue problem; we have a spending problem." The party that promises to balance the budget, that criticizes Covid blowouts, that revels in creative ways to visualize $36 trillion in national debt.

Words, words, words.

Love or hate Mr. Musk, his examples of government squander and ineptitude are a shocking reminder of how long it's been since anyone bothered to scrutinize the federal jalopy. Those examinations are rightly Congress's job—the power of the purse!—though it traded true oversight for the slogan long ago. Congress only cares about its spending power when someone threatens to block more—not when it comes to scrutinizing what's already on the books.

And love or hate Mr. Musk, his efforts will prove temporary. He can cancel thousands of leases and grants—more, please—perhaps hit his $1 trillion in savings, perhaps make government more efficient. Once. At which point Congress will rubber stamp another omnibus that renews much of it, or roll his "savings" into different spending priorities. Because—this is basic—our Constitution gives Congress the spending power, not well-meaning special advisers to the president.

Enter those GOP senators. They are demanding that, as part of the continuing "reconciliation" effort, the majority engage in a formal process that is the equivalent of the Musk work, with an end goal of returning spending to prepandemic levels. Sen. Ron Johnson, flanked by Senate Budget Committee Republicans, on Wednesday briefed Mr. Trump on that proposal; Mr. Johnson reports the president "embraced a prepandemic spending level and a process to achieve it."

Here's how it'd work: Republicans would set up a review panel—populated by a representative span of GOP House and Senate members and the president's budget team—tasked with reviewing the budget line-by-line. Executive branch officials would appear before the committee to explain each spending item. The panel would come up with its list of cuts or reductions—with a special emphasis on ending wasteful, duplicate or zombie programs, as well as spending that appeared since the pandemic. Republicans would make these cuts in reconciliation bills or votes on rescission packages sent by the president.

Call it the "one big, beautiful budget review panel."

The eye-glazing term for this is "process," but as Mr. Musk's DOGE team is showing, it's the only way to oversee a going concern—line-by-line. Politicians know process matters, too, which is why over the years they've devised the 1974 Budget Act, Simpson-Bowles, the 2011 Budget Control Act. Each had upsides, but none resulted in long-term budget "control."

The process today? Congressional staff hand bosses a little sheet setting out the following cosmic choice: Vote to increase everything by 2% . . . or by 4%! That stumper is happily avoided when Congress instead passes a year-end omnibus that no one has read, that turbocharges all government and that is further slopped with parochial graft. That's the extent of the "work" members put into the awesome "power of the purse." And while many Republicans are currently bragging about their membership in new DOGE "caucuses," these coalitions are mainly riding on Musk coattails.

Republican Senators propose a budget review panel to make DOGE's efforts stick.

The singular merit of the Johnson plan is that it would provide Republicans their best path to achieving what everyone claims to want: a pro-growth tax bill paired with spending sanity. The party keeps groping around for one or two big items it can tackle to realize large savings, which then inspires nervous Republicans to erect fences around priorities. It's causing enough division to put a successful reconciliation in doubt.

A prepandemic spending level—accomplished by considered reductions and rescissions across hundreds of programs—would minimize (if not eliminate) pain, even as it adds up to a substantial number. As Sen. Johnson notes, simply returning to 2019 spending levels—upwardly adjusted for population growth and inflation—would result in a $770 billion spending reduction in fiscal 2025 alone. Compare this to the $1.5 trillion in deficit reduction over 10 years that Republicans are currently fighting about. And "prepandemic spending" is a strong political sell. Other than progressive voters, who thinks world-emergency spending levels ought to be the new normal?

The plan would take political will—the Trump team and GOP leadership would need to commit fully. And there's no guarantee even a budget panel could overcome parochial interests. But this plan would at least require that Congress do the work, and publicly own its spending decisions. And it could cement Mr. Trump's bold DOGE work. Bring on "one big, beautiful, budget committee."

Write to kim@wsj.com.

Jerusalem and Athens Meet in Manhattan

HOUSES OF WORSHIP
By Liel Leibovitz

New York

Is truth truly beauty, and beauty really truth? And is that all ye know on earth, and all ye need to know?

This was under discussion on a January morning on Manhattan's Upper East Side. The moderator was Chana Ruderman, a former university seminar instructor, and the spirited participants, wearing crisp uniforms, were 11- and 12-year-olds, approaching John Keats's immortal lines with the enthusiasm their peers usually reserve for Spider-Man or Juan Soto.

Creative ideas were welcomed but textual proof was demanded to back up each statement. The students dived back into the "Ode on a Grecian Urn," shouting with glee when they discovered lines that supported their theses. As the pace grew quicker, they exhibited something you rarely experience in middle school: joy.

This was simply another morning at Emet, the country's first Jewish classical-education preparatory school, more than halfway through its inaugural year. Walk its halls and you will see portraits of Churchill, Plato and Maimonides, urging students to plant one foot firmly in Western civilization and the other in Jewish tradition. Although it has been operating for only a few months, the school has become a sensation, holding public events with luminaries like writer Douglas Murray. It is attracting applications from hundreds of parents, including some who never thought they would send their child to a Jewish school, let alone one that teaches Latin and requires students to attend recitals at Carnegie Hall to develop an appreciation for Paganini.

Which is all the more remarkable considering the school wasn't supposed to be running yet. Working under the aegis of Tikvah, a Jewish cultural and education organization, Eric Cohen, who leads the group, and Abe Unger, a former college professor and now Emet's head of school, wanted to take their time. The classical-education model, which emphasizes canonical texts and traditions of Western civilization and which is enjoying a resurgence among Christians, is heavy on Greek and Roman culture. How, then, to infuse it with Judaism, a tradition whose values sometimes contradict those of the Hellenized world?

They were grappling with the question when Oct. 7, 2023, happened. Many parents, shocked to see Hamas sympathizers plant themselves on college campuses and in city streets, urged the school to open as soon as possible. More than 500 families expressed interest and, after rigorous aptitude tests, 40 students in the fifth, sixth and ninth grades were chosen. That number is already slated to double next year.

They didn't have to wait long to figure out what kind of environment their school would foster. Each day starts with two student marshals holding two flags, America's and Israel's, while reciting the Pledge of Allegiance. As they file out of assembly, they must pause, look Mr. Unger in the eye and shake his hand. That, he says, is where the educational transformation begins.

"Suddenly, they feel like citizens," he tells me in his office. "Reciting the Pledge and holding the flag and shaking the principal's hand are all civic acts. They are acts of coming together in a kind of small-r republican community."

Observations during a morning at Emet, the first Jewish classical school in America.

If there's one thing that can devastate even the most dedicated community it's the abundance of screens, which is why Emet doesn't permit them. Rather than iPads or Chromebooks, the students carry textbooks, as well as notebooks, index cards, pencils and pens. When they write, it's in cursive, another classical skill prized at Emet.

All this pleases Brigette Roberts, who pulled her 10-year-old daughter from a competitive private school last year to give Emet a shot. The school's emphasis on discipline, she says, has helped her daughter thrive. "I definitely see a change in her. Suddenly, she's asking us to buy a lot of different books she'd like to read—and she's constantly asking us questions about everything from architecture to physics." Ms. Roberts says her daughter is "thinking more, questioning more. It's clear that she loves to learn."

Mr. Unger adds that these tensions—between joy and discipline, Jewish tradition and Western civilization—make Emet's students engage with their work. "We teach them that it's OK to live with contradicting views on any given topic," he says. "That is what's fun. They study these traditions, and then they look at them on their own terms, asking, 'What can I say about that? How can I forward the conversation and the human prospect?' " For Jews living with a rising tide of antisemitism, such agility and resourcefulness are key.

Yet holding conflicting values in conversation doesn't mean accepting that all is true and everything is permitted. "The quest for truth lies at the very heart of Western civilization, and we abandon it at our great peril," Mr. Cohen tells me. "The moral teachings and miraculous survival of the Jews remind the world that the deepest truths endure, that hope is never lost and that the renewal of civilization is always possible." Indeed, in one Jewish prep school in Manhattan, renewal happens every day.

Mr. Leibovitz is editor at large of Tablet magazine and author, most recently, of "How the Talmud Can Change Your Life: Surprisingly Modern Advice From a Very Old Book."

We Won't Sign an 'Implicit Bias' Pledge

By Aida Cerundolo And Jared L. Ross

Our medical careers have an expiration date. In 2029 and 2030, respectively, we will no longer be board-certified in emergency medicine and therefore unable to work in almost all U.S. hospitals. The only way to maintain our certification is to pledge to fight so-called implicit bias, which we refuse to do on medical and moral grounds.

In 2021 the American Board of Emergency Medicine published a Code of Professionalism for all physicians who rely on the organization for certification—nearly every emergency medicine doctor in the country. The code requires us to promise to "mitigate both implicit or explicit biases based on race, gender, age, sexual orientation, disability, national origin, or religion when providing patient care."

We're comfortable signing a pledge to fight bias. Any doctor who refuses to treat a patient or provides a lower quality of care to members of particular identity groups should be barred from the profession.

But implicit bias, unlike explicit bias, can't be measured. Popular tools that claim to identify such bias have been roundly disproven. So have activists' claims that implicit bias leads to health disparities. If implicit bias can't be measured, how can it be shown to hurt some patients over others?

This puts our certifications as physicians at risk.

Our job is to use measurable facts to treat patients and save lives. But extirpating "implicit bias" would require physicians to note patients' skin color, sexual preferences and so on and place them in a hierarchy of grievances during treatment. In other words, physicians would need to engage in bias to end bias—an Orwellian threat to the equal treatment that's supposed to define the medical profession.

This is why we refuse to sign ABEM's pledge. Yet our refusal means that the board won't recertify us.

We hope ABEM changes its ways. So should the American Board of Medical Specialties, which has pushed its member boards, including ABEM, to combat implicit bias. These entities can follow corporate America's example by abandoning diversity, equity and inclusion. But if their policies persist, the Trump administration must intervene.

President Trump should sign an executive order directing federal agencies to condition healthcare funding on common sense. If a hospital wants Medicaid or Medicare reimbursements, for example, it shouldn't be able to require that doctors be certified by boards that promote or require DEI. This would force changes in many medical certifying boards.

The president can also look to withhold federal funding from states such as Maryland, Michigan and Massachusetts that require implicit bias training for medical licensing or renewal. Congress should codify these provisions so a future president can't easily undo them.

We will never sign a code that undermines medical ethics and jeopardizes patient health. We hope ABEM does the right thing, but if it doesn't, the Trump administration can save our medical careers and empower physicians to continue serving all patients equally and with excellence.

Drs. Cerundolo and Ross are emergency medicine physicians and senior fellows at Do No Harm.

BOOKSHELF | By Daniel Gallagher

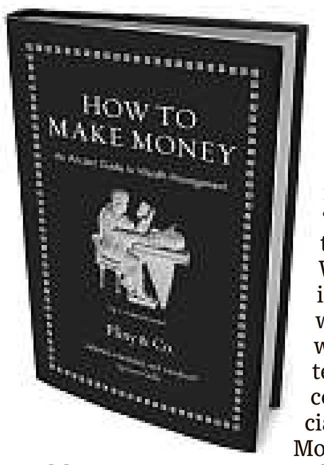
Imperial Investments

How to Make Money

By Luca Grillo
Princeton, 248 pages, $17.95

A world-renowned classicist is alleged to have telephoned his university's human-resources department, desperate to know whether his retirement account was a 401(k) or a 403(b). It was the latter. "Thank God!" the don exclaimed. " '401' is a *terribly* inauspicious number! King Alaric crossed the Alps that year!"

True or not, this episode likely speaks volumes to the average classics professor's knowledge of finance. Indeed, ancient economics hasn't been an area of serious scholarship until recently; not long ago graduate students studying their Loeb Ciceros had little to go on but outdated footnotes indicating the 1930 conversion rate of denarii to pounds sterling. That wasn't too much of a problem, though, since all you needed to know to pass comprehensive exams was that Martial was dirt poor, Crassus filthy rich and Julius Caesar either dirt poor or filthy rich depending on the year.



Today there are plenty of erudite books on economics in the ancient world—the "Cambridge Economic History of the Greco-Roman World" (2007), for example, is a superb resource. What we lacked was a straightforward presentation of primary texts accompanied by limited commentary for the nonspecialist. In "How to Make Money: An Ancient Guide to Wealth Management," Luca Grillo, a professor of classics at the University of Notre Dame, has consulted "Pliny & Co." to create one.

Fans of Wendell Berry and Victor Davis Hanson will be glad to know the book begins where it should, with farming. As the word *pecunia* suggests—"cattle" lead to "money"—agriculture "remained the ideal and the measure of individual success" even after Rome achieved economic superiority in the Mediterranean. Mr. Grillo includes advice from Cato the Elder on how to buy and prepare land, and from the elder Pliny on how to optimize production.

Over time, commerce and banking became lucrative opportunities for social advancement in the ancient world. Roman coins unearthed in China, Ghana, Nigeria and Scandinavia show how far traders were willing to travel to obtain luxury items such as pepper, peacocks and frankincense. Banks sprang up in temples and forums all over the empire to supply capital for these burgeoning businesses. Though Cato inveighed against moneylending, he himself was not immune, even in a "most shameful way, that is, on maritime loans," as Plutarch later tells us. Such loans on sea cargo were risky; as Mr. Grillo explains, shipowners "bore the entire risk of damage or loss of the ship," but if "cargo was lost for unforeseeable causes, such as a shipwreck or piracy," the loss fell to the lender.

Taxation issues are eternal—Mr. Grillo distinguishes between the various types of Roman taxes and examines the "power of the publicani," those professional tax collectors associated in the Gospels with prostitutes and sinners. The author includes a fascinating letter from Cicero to his brother Quintus, governor of the Roman province of Asia, advising him to use his "quasi-divine wisdom" to identify how best to handle complaints from the provincials about the abuses of the publicani while also ensuring that Rome received sufficient revenues.

"I'm not that proud of my philanthropy," the investor Charlie Munger said in a 2020 interview. "I regard it as an absolute minimum duty for somebody who's reasonably successful to be reasonably generous." The Romans could hardly have agreed more; Mr. Grillo includes Suetonius' commemoration of Julius Caesar's lavish public entertainments and Martial's verse on the unsurpassed marvel of the Colosseum, built for public use in the very spot where Nero had constructed a luxurious lake for his personal enjoyment. "Rome," wrote Martial, "is being returned to herself, and under [the emperor Titus'] rule . . . what used to delight a single master now delights all people."

Agriculture remained an ideal measure of wealth in the ancient world even after Rome achieved economic superiority.

Freedom was not among the many ideas Rome bequeathed to America. Human trafficking was rampant. A compendium of Roman law created under the Byzantine emperor Justinian I in the sixth century defined "prostitute" as a woman who "openly practices prostitution not only when she has put herself for sale in a brothel, but also if she regularly does so in a tavern or if she has no regard for her dignity in any other place." Mr. Grillo explains, "the discriminating factor was the absence of free will," available neither to free nor enslaved prostitutes.

Any entrepreneurial venture could lead to financial ruin, far from uncommon in the ancient world. Plutarch chronicles the ascent and decline of Marcus Licinius Crassus, whose very name became synonymous with wealth and greed. Crassus, Mr. Grillo explains, rarely passed up an investment opportunity, including his last: an immense military campaign against the Parthians in Syria that cost his son's life and his own.

Mr. Grillo's thoughtful selections and lucid translations are accompanied by the original Greek and Latin texts as well as his informative commentary. Measuring less than 5 inches by 7 inches and weighing little more than your smartphone, his book is but one of several gems in the Ancient Wisdom for Modern Readers series from Princeton University Press—highly useful to readers looking to brush up their rusty memories or to learn an ancient language for the first time. I never thought I'd be able to combine my career in Latin with my growing interest in finance and investing. Then again, I never thought I'd be interested in the difference between a 401(k) and a 403(b).

Mr. Gallagher is a lecturer in literature and philosophy at Ralston College.

OPINION

REVIEW & OUTLOOK

Trump and His 'Little Disturbance'

> The effective U.S. tariff rate is now higher than after Smoot-Hawley.

President Trump said there would be "a little disturbance" from his tariffs, but how does he define little? The stock market Thursday suffered its worst day since the government shut down the economy in March 2020. Not to worry, the White House says tariffs will eventually be worth the pain. Feeling better?

The S&P 500 fell 4.8% and the Nasdaq 6% in reaction to Mr. Trump's Wednesday tariff announcement of the largest tariff increase in a century. The biggest market casualties were retailers and manufacturers such as Apple (-9.3%), Nike (-14.4%) and Gap (-20.3%). Oil prices, the U.S. dollar and the 10-year Treasury yield also fell, likely signaling slower growth expectations.

* * *

Markets around the world spent Thursday absorbing the historic magnitude of Mr. Trump's tax on commerce. Evercore ISI estimates that Wednesday's news will raise the U.S. effective tariff rate to 24%, and 27% if he goes ahead with the sectoral tariffs he promises on drugs, copper and more. That's higher than after the Smoot-Hawley tariff of 1930.

Worse is the bizarre, slapdash way the White House calculated the tariff rates on individual countries. Everyone will pay 10%. Then the White House appears to have calculated each country's additional tariff rate by dividing its trade deficit with the U.S. by its exports to the U.S. This rate was then cut in half for most countries, which Mr. Trump calls a "discount." The discordant result is that U.S. adversaries like Iran (10%) and Venezuela (15%) will pay lower rates than friends in Europe (20%), Japan (24%) and Taiwan (32%).

The trade deficit is a long-time Trump fixation that he sees as a zero-sum game. Trade-deficit countries must be cheating somehow, but then what about countries like the U.K. and Australia that have a trade deficit with the U.S.? Why hit them with a 10% tariff?

The trade balance reflects many factors, including national comparative advantage. We sell things we are better at—services, high-tech goods—and buy things that can be made more cheaply elsewhere. The U.S. also spends more than it saves, which means it imports capital. This is the flip-side of the trade deficit in national accounts, so shrinking the trade deficit will mean less capital coming in.

Yet Mr. Trump claims his tariffs will unleash a flood of new investment in the U.S. Then why is the dollar falling in value (see nearby), recording its worst single-day loss in two years? Our guess is that investors are losing confidence in U.S. economic decisions.

The President complains about foreign currency manipulation, taxes that suppress consumption and non-tariff barriers. But if he wants other countries to open more to U.S. exports, he could negotiate. The stillborn Trans-Pacific Partnership would have reduced Japan's non-tariff barriers.

The Trump tariffs ironically will punish companies that have moved manufacturing out of China to other countries in Southeast Asia, which his first Administration encouraged them to do. About half of Nike's shoes are now made in Vietnam versus 18% in China.

Mr. Trump hits Vietnam with a 46% tariff, which means Nike will have to rethink where to make low-margin shoes. Mr. Trump seems to think they should be made in America. Mr. Trump's tariffs may have the U.S. investing to create jobs in shoe-making when it should invest in AI. This misallocation of capital will not make the U.S. more competitive against China.

The only silver lining we see is that imports from Canada and Mexico are exempt if they comply with the USMCA. But cars and trucks assembled in the two countries will still be taxed 25% on their non-U.S. components.

* * *

There is also the not-so-small matter of the rule of law. Mr. Trump justifies his tariffs by declaring a national emergency under the 1977 International Emergency Economic Powers Act. No previous President has used that law to impose tariffs. Mr. Trump is stretching his authority much as Joe Biden did with his student-loan forgiveness.

Congress has circumscribed the President's power to impose tariffs, allowing it on imports that threaten national security (Section 232) or in response to "large and serious" balance-of-payments deficits (Section 122), a surge of imports that harms U.S. industry (201), and discriminatory trade practices (301).

None of these trade provisions empowers Mr. Trump to impose tariffs on all imports from all countries based on an arbitrary formula. Section 122 lets a President impose tariffs of up to 15% in response to trade deficits, but Congress must approve them after 150 days. Someone should sue to block his abuse of power.

Mr. Trump's tariffs are the biggest policy shock to the world trading system since Richard Nixon blew up Bretton Woods in 1971. As with that decision, Mr. Trump is acting with little understanding about the damage his tariffs will cause. The "disturbance" might not be as little as he imagines.

Finland Knows Winter Is Coming

> The Finns ramp up defense spending and leave a land-mine pact.

The Trump Administration is shaking up world affairs and thinks Europe should handle its own defense. Finland is answering that call with a re-armament announced this week, but it's a testament to the storm clouds all over the world, which still requires U.S. leadership.

Finland's President Alexander Stubb said Tuesday that the government "has today taken two key decisions, reflecting the changes in our security environment." Finland will spend 3% of its economy on defense by 2029, up from about 2.4% now, according to North Atlantic Treaty Organization data. Helsinki will also "prepare for the withdrawal from the Ottawa Convention," the 1990s treaty aimed at eliminating the use of anti-personnel land mines.

The Finns take their preservation more seriously than the European defense-spending laggards the Trump Administration complains about. That is from long experience of sharing an 800-mile border with Russia.

Adding Helsinki to the NATO alliance was a force multiplier, particularly large Finnish military reserves and expertise in winter warfare. But the Finns aren't betting on peace. They're reading the room of a more aggressive Russia and a less reliable United States, and reorganizing accordingly.

The arms-control lobby is howling about the land mine treaty and the danger to civilians if such weapons return to broad use. But that treaty was a luxury of a stable world after the Cold War ended. The Finns are right to cashier it.

Anti-personnel land mines would be crucial to blunting a Russian invasion, and that's why Poland and the Baltic states also want to leave the convention. The U.S. has wisely declined to sign up for the Ottawa convention in part because land mines are essential to America's defense of South Korea.

But the larger picture is that Europe is becoming less stable precisely as the Trump Administration is threatening to skip town. The Finns get it, as the kids say. America's right move now is to propose its own defense investment that reflects the world's threats and not some fantasy about peace in our time.

What the Trump Dollar Plunge Means

> Are investors losing confidence in U.S. economic policy?

Investors around the world on Thursday passed their verdict on President Trump's monumental tariff push, and it wasn't pretty. Amid the hubbub, the dollar and gold warrant special attention since their moves point to special dangers awaiting Mr. Trump.

The greenback lost value as other currencies surged Thursday. The euro strengthened to about $1.11 per euro from $1.08, and the Japanese yen strengthened to around ¥145 per dollar from ¥149. The British pound also gained. The Journal's dollar index fell 1.8% on top of declines in recent weeks.

This appears to be based on expectations of weaker U.S. economic growth and higher inflation. That impression is buttressed by the gold price, which soared to nearly $3,200 per ounce for a time Thursday after Mr. Trump's announcement. Investors flocked to this traditional hedge against inflation and slowing growth.

Mr. Trump is likely to interpret this greenback slide as good news. He has long believed the dollar is overvalued in a way that hurts American exporters, and alleged "currency manipulation" by other countries was one of the benchmarks he says he applied when setting Wednesday's reciprocal tariff rates. That may mark the end of his intuition on the matter, but economists in his orbit put a finer theoretical point on it: They believe policy distortions in other countries cause this excessive dollar strength. To some of these advisers, a falling dollar will be a sign that the protectionist plan is working to rebalance global trade and capital flows.

But not to all of them. Under another theory, an across-the-board tariff should cause an appreciation of the dollar by narrowing the U.S. trade deficit. That is the view of Stephen Miran, now the chairman of Mr. Trump's Council of Economic Advisers, in a widely circulated paper last autumn.

Under this theory, dollar appreciation is a crucial tool to prevent tariffs from setting off domestic inflation in the U.S. The accompanying depreciation of other currencies such as the euro, yen and yuan, meanwhile, is the mechanism by which those countries are said to "pay for" U.S. tariffs in the form of their own diminished purchasing power.

Which side of this argument is right? You'll have to wait and see, as Mr. Trump likes to say, and a lot is riding on the outcome. Protectionists believe (without convincing evidence) that a weaker dollar boosts the U.S. economy. Households may notice the increased prices for imported goods first—exacerbating the pain from the tariffs. Mr. Trump won't believe it, but a dollar resurgence is the best thing that could happen to him now.

LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

What Is a Woman? Don't Ask the Materialists

Regarding Jerry Coyne's op-ed "Losing My Nonreligion" (March 31): It's remarkable to observe such people as Mr. Coyne, Richard Dawkins and Steven Pinker assert that a term such as "woman" must signify one and only one thing—an adult human female—when they otherwise vigorously deny that there is any objective reality to traditional ontological categories. A "human," for dogmatic materialists such as Mr. Coyne, after all, is nothing but a random configuration of matter, without substance, intentionality, teleology, mind or being beyond the entirely contingent fact that matter happens to have configured itself in a certain way in this moment of evolutionary time.

Under this group's metaphysics, there is no reason that large, immobile gametes determine the category of "woman" to the exclusion of, say, some configuration of brain chemistry that makes some people with small, mobile gametes feel like a "woman" within some social arrangement that presumably entails its own evolutionary trade-offs. Rather than a complete biological and sociobiological picture of the individual and its environment—never mind considering whether there is something to human purpose and identity that transcends mere biology—Mr. Coyne requires allegiance to an arbitrary gamete-only doctrine, insists that he knows his pinched definition is best for society, and demands that people who think differently be branded as science heretics. Fundamentalist, know thyself.

PROF. DAVID W. OPDERBECK
Seton Hall University School of Law
Newark, N.J.

The Auto 'Invasion' Was a Boon to Americans

Your editorial "Trump's Giant New Car Tax" (March 28) correctly points out that imported cars give American car buyers more choices at lower prices, enabling them to buy "more and better cars than they could a few decades ago." This simple yet potent argument could be reinforced by pointing out that one of the reasons that importing cars expands choice, improves quality and reduces prices is the salubrious effect that competition from imports has on domestic manufacturers. The same is true of every other good too.

Those of us of a certain age remember driving the cars that the then Big 3 regurgitated onto the American market in the 1970s and much of the 1980s. With a few exceptions, reliability was lacking, fit and finish was dicey and fuel economy was woeful. When the Japanese began aggressively exporting Toyotas, Hondas, Datsuns and Mitsubishis to our shores, the Big 3 were forced to improve their products to survive. The Japanese thus gave the Big 3 the kick in the keister those bloated, overly contented giants needed to become the vastly more competitive enterprises they are today.

Competition, regardless of where it comes from, benefits all market participants. Protection from competition breeds complacency and lethargy to the detriment of consumers and producers.

MARK M. QUINN
Naperville, Ill.

Direct Care Is Just What the Patient Ordered

Clare Ansberry's column "Turning Points: Trust Is Prescription to Heal a Broken Doctor-Patient Bond" (Personal Journal, March 25) raises an increasingly important problem in medical care. The prime reason trust is in short supply is the lack of time physicians have with each patient. When appointments are limited to 15 minutes, there is only 8 to 12 minutes of "face time." This is perhaps enough for a simple problem, but certainly inadequate for a patient with several chronic illnesses who is taking multiple prescription medications. This certainly isn't enough time for an older individual with hearing, vision, mobility or cognitive issues. It isn't enough time for the person who has anxiety.

The article hints at the resolution, and I'd like to elaborate and advocate for creating more time using direct primary care (DPC). DPC means same- or next-day appointments, visits as long as necessary, direct access to the physician via cellphone, text messages and email. DPC eliminates the insurer or the corporation that forces short visits. The added time leads to a decrease in the use of specialists, tests and imaging. We also see fewer visits to the emergency room and fewer hospital admissions. DPC allows for two-way listening, resulting in less frustration for both the patient and the doctor, and allowing trusting relationships to develop.

STEPHEN C. SCHIMPFF, M.D., MACP
Catonsville, Md.

The Secret Tool China Uses To Silence Its Critics Abroad

Bob Fu writes about how the Chinese Communist Party reaches overseas to repress people who criticize the regime ("When Beijing's Bullies Come to Town," Houses of Worship, March 28). They plant spies, "swat" hotel rooms, kick, punch, throw sand in faces and more.

But the most common tool of repression is less visible. If you say something wrong in New York or London, your relatives could have their doors knocked in Shanghai or Guangzhou. The police will advise your loved ones to muzzle you—for their safety, not merely yours. Chinese living overseas are broadly aware of this looming danger. Even seasoned dissidents sometimes pull punches to protect family. When someone who might misspeak travels abroad, the regime can withhold exit permission from a spouse to assure that the leverage will be available.

For the regime, the virtue of this method is that it is so quiet. A self-muzzled citizen can look from the outside like a content one.

EM. PROF PERRY LINK
Riverside, Calif.

Advice for AP Reporters: Get Back to the Business's Basics

As a journalism student, I was taught to report the "inverted pyramid"—who, what, when, where—and leave ideology and politics to the opinion pages. The Associated Press long ago abandoned these key journalistic principles. The irony of defending a conservative and traditional name, the "Gulf of Mexico," seems to be lost on AP executive editor Julie Pace ("The AP's Freedom of Speech—and Yours," op-ed, March 27).

The AP wants our sympathy in its fight to the death over a silly name change while refusing to acknowledge how bias has come to dominate its reporting in the progressive era. Ms. Pace states that if you "discovered that the AP caved to a different government trying to control its speech, would you ever trust anything the AP reported from that country—or for that matter, from anywhere?" Exhibits A, B and C might be the AP's docile and compliant coverage of the Russian collusion affair, the Hunter Biden laptop story and the Covid origin and subsequent lockdowns. Indeed, there is ample reason for everyone to distrust the AP's reporting on anything from anywhere.

PAUL HRIBERNICK
McMinnville, Ore.

The Academy's Appeasement

Regarding your editorial "Columbia Learns a Hard Lesson" (March 24): In much of the discussion about the administration's investigations into higher education, many have referred to universities as "appeasing" President Trump. That sounds as if they are simply humoring the president. But campus encampments, occupying buildings, threatening and assaulting Jewish students, rallying for terrorists and the like shouldn't be happening at our universities. Shutting that down isn't appeasement; it's the right thing to do.

RON COPE
Chicago

Letters intended for publication should be emailed to wsj.ltrs@wsj.com. Please include your city, state and telephone number. All letters are subject to editing, and unpublished letters cannot be acknowledged.

Pepper ... And Salt

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL

"I'm trying to decide which one is worth 40 minutes on the treadmill."

P2JW094000-0-A01500-1--------XA

OPINION

Say Hello to Your New Colleague, the AI Agent

By Marc Benioff

I've been part of many waves of technology in my 25 years at Salesforce—from cloud computing to mobile, social and the early stages of AI. But nothing compares to the transformation we're seeing now.

While much of the AI conversation is about large language models, the real revolution is happening in AI-driven digital labor: autonomous, intelligent agents. Because such agents act on their own, collaborate and continuously learn and improve, companies of any size can scale beyond human limits.

Today's CEOs are the final generation of executives who will lead exclusively human workforces.

Today's CEOs are the final generation of executives leading exclusively human workforces. Going forward, we'll need to learn how to manage human workers and digital labor to work together to deliver efficiency and productivity. Integrating AI agents into daily operations will become a leadership skill that separates companies that thrive from those that fall behind.

The ascent of the Chinese startup DeepSeek—which unseated ChatGPT as No. 1 on the app store at its launch—underscores this shift. Many assume that winning the AI race depends on having the biggest models or the most computing power. DeepSeek suggests otherwise. We're moving toward a world where AI is everywhere and part of everyday life. The models themselves are becoming commodities. The true value of AI is in the data.

This is happening already. At the consulting giant Accenture, our Agentforce digital labor platform is extending the reach of the firm's 52,000 sales people around the world. For example, a coaching agent empowers sellers by autonomously facilitating role-plays, tailored to each deal, providing personalized feedback afterward. This helps their salespeople improve their pitches, leading to higher win rates. These agents let Accenture's human sellers spend more time building relationships with clients and solving their problems. Heathrow Airport, one of the world's busiest, is using Agentforce to field passenger queries 24/7 about flight status, gate directions and airport services. That frees up Heathrow staff to address travelers' more complex problems.

Our own support platform at Salesforce, serving hundreds of thousands of customers, now includes AI agents working with our 9,000 customer service representatives. In just three months, AI agents resolved 84% of incoming customer queries on their own, with only 2% of requests requiring escalation to humans. This allows us to redeploy as many as 2,000 support roles elsewhere in the company. As measured by a recent Morgan Stanley research report, our customers are already seeing 20% to 50% cost reductions in customer support, driven by savings in head count, office space and overhead.

ALAMY

Unlike stand-alone tools, Agentforce unifies all the relevant data and metadata while integrating into existing workflows. This, along with the ability for humans to build task-specific agents using natural language instructions, ensures that agents adapt to each company's unique challenges.

The macro effect of all this is already visible. Despite shrinking labor pools, productivity—the engine of economic expansion—has grown at or above 2% for five consecutive quarters according to the Bureau of Labor Statistics, exceeding recent historical trends. If AI agents continue to accelerate decision-making, reduce operational friction and free up human workers for higher-value tasks, we're on the verge of what the Journal has called a productivity miracle. Optimistic forecasts predict 2.5% to 3% growth. The efficiencies AI agents deliver will become all the more critical to companies and the macro economy in an era of tariffs.

This extends well beyond companies like mine. AI agents allow small businesses and even sole proprietorships to scale where they couldn't before. With digital labor, small businesses can compete at much lower cost. A small financial advisory firm, for example, might once have needed staff for sales and customer service. Now, AI agents can take on outreach, respond to inquiries and automate back-office processes.

Precina Health, a diabetes-care company, is a prime example. In the U.S. alone, more than $400 million—one in every four healthcare dollars—is spent on diabetes treatment annually. Precina analyzes patient data to create personalized diabetes-management plans, improving care and reducing costs so the company can help more patients.

AI agents can do tasks at an unprecedented scale and speed—reaching long-underserved parts of the world. Education agents can create bespoke learning plans for students. Urban planning agents can analyze traffic, energy and housing data to design smarter cities. Health agents can track disease outbreaks, optimize vaccine distribution and connect patients with care.

When catastrophe strikes, as with the recent Los Angeles fires, communities often are inundated with donated clothes, blankets and supplies. Sadly, as much as 70% of these donations end up in landfills. Now, powered by Agentforce, the nonprofit Good360's Resource-Matching Agent ensures critical resources reach the nonprofits and people that need them most.

While agents offer unmatched opportunities, this transformation will be disruptive. Businesses, through such programs as our free Salesforce Trailhead AI certification, must take the lead in reskilling workers for emerging roles such as AI trainers, agent builders and decision auditors. Trust and safety must be embedded into AI systems, along with strong data protection. Equally important are tools that foster transparency and empower users to make informed choices about what to delegate to AI.

Business is the greatest platform for change. With Agentic AI, we can revolutionize work and create a more prosperous, sustainable world. By focusing on trust, accountability and our common humanity, we can ensure that Agentic AI becomes a force for good.

Mr. Benioff is Chair and CEO of Salesforce.

Living Well Is Europe's Best Revenge for Trump Tariffs

POLITICAL ECONOMICS
By Joseph C. Sternberg

Living well is the best revenge, it's said, and it may be Europe's only good play in the face of President Trump's trade wars.

It's an observation—perhaps a warning—that Brussels should heed amid fevered talk of retaliation for the 20% levy Mr. Trump announced on all European imports on his tariff "liberation day" this week. Even before Mr. Trump's Wednesday speech in the Rose Garden, the Continent's leaders were preparing to fight back. Europe "holds a lot of cards" in a potential trade dispute with Washington, European Commission President Ursula von der Leyen said earlier in the week. The trouble for Ms. von der Leyen and the many other worried political leaders on the Continent is that this isn't necessarily true.

The European Union, which sets collective trade policies for its 27 member countries, has demonstrated in response to previous Trump tariffs that it has the legal and political capacity to impose retaliatory duties on American goods. European tariffs are already due to take effect later this month in response to Mr. Trump's steel and aluminum levies. Expect more of this. There now is also some discussion in European capitals (if not in Brussels itself) about activating a legal tool that punishes "economic coercion" directed at the EU. This would open the door to a range of novel measures including lifting intellectual-property protections for American companies.

Alongside those sticks, Brussels has been readying the carrots. Officials have identified concessions the EU might make to the Trump administration, Bloomberg reported last week. These could include more imports of U.S. liquefied natural gas and defense equipment, an easing of the sorts of food-safety regulations that long have vexed American exporters, and promises of more cross-border investment.

The trouble is that Mr. Trump might not care about any of this. He seems unfazed by any of the negative consequences for the U.S. of his trade wars. He suggested last weekend that he isn't alarmed by the certainty that his auto tariffs will force Americans to pay more for cars, and he appears to believe fervently in tariffs as a good idea in their own right rather than merely as a bargaining tool.

His trade adviser Peter Navarro says it's A-OK that Mr. Trump's tariff policy writ large could cost the U.S. economy a stunning $6 trillion over 10 years. In this context, Europe's retaliatory plans sound like a threat to slap a U.S. economy the Trump administration has already shot.

Policy overhauls to boost domestic prosperity can insulate the Continent from U.S. protectionism.

Mr. Trump's cavalier attitude exacerbates the fundamental problem with any form of trade retaliation: If Mr. Trump's trade barriers endanger European economic growth, then retaliatory tariffs make things worse. The hope of such a strategy is that raising prices for Europeans and deterring business investment on the Continent is worth it because the trading partner eventually comes back to the table. It's not clear if or when Mr. Trump would.

Europe needs a new strategy, and the best plan by far is to live well—i.e., economic growth. If the American export market no longer is as available as it once was, there are enormous opportunities to expand Europe's domestic market. Europeans have become aware in recent years of the shocking gap that has opened between European and U.S. productivity and per-capita incomes—with Europeans some 34% poorer on average than their American peers. This implies there are enormous opportunities for the European economy to jolt itself into greater prosperity.

Ideas for how to do so aren't hard to come by. A case in point is the report prepared last year by former European Central Bank President Mario Draghi on how to revive European competitiveness. Love or hate his ideas (his suggestions for deregulation were more compelling than his ideas for industrial subsidies), a striking conclusion of his report in light of the U.S. trade war is Mr. Draghi's emphasis on domestic economic growth rather than an export-dependent strategy.

The upshot is that while the foreign economic environment—not only the U.S. but also China—has rarely been more hostile to Europe in recent decades, political conditions at home have rarely been more conducive to an economic shakeup. The stale big-state centrism that dominated Europe for decades is giving way to more complex, and far less stable, political realignments that create openings for fresh economic thinking. Voters are growing more aware of the costs of awful policies such as the net-zero climate misadventure. Europeans also appear newly sympathetic to policy trade-offs such as welfare reforms necessary to deliver greater strategic and economic security.

To speculate about this rosy future isn't to predict it will happen. Europe has missed plenty of opportunities for prosperity in the past. Rather, it's to observe that if Europe wants to retaliate against Mr. Trump, growing its own economy is its best and perhaps only option for revenge.

The Incredibly Massive Number of Hackneyed Words Is Surreal

By Joseph Epstein

A hackneyed phrase is one characterized by its unoriginality, overuse and, not least, imprecision. The air seems filled with such phrases just now. Consider how the often-used word "focused" has taken on the adjective "laser," to become the fully hackneyed "laser-focused." Not all hackneyed language comes in full phrases; some single words also qualify. How they catch on remains a bit of a mystery, but catch on they do. "Incredible," you might say.

You might say it, that is, if you have no ear for language and don't mind sounding like everyone else who currently avails himself of this hackneyed word. Incredible, a synonym for unbelievable or surpassing belief, has become the hackneyed word of the day. The word has a hackneyed history. An ad for "the incredible edible egg" ran in the 1970s. The show "That's Incredible!" was on television from 1980-84.

Now the word has flared up again. "Incredible" is much favored by President Trump, who regularly cites people he has hired for doing "an incredible job," often not long before firing them. In the mouths of sports announcers, athletes fairly regularly bring off "incredible" feats. The experience of younger actors working with older ones tends to be "incredible." So many otherwise quite credible experiences are now considered incredible.

The use of "incredible," to put it another way, is massive. A home run in the late innings of a game can also be massive. "Massive" was the Republicans' defeat of the Democrats in the last election. As for the laughter at Sarah Silverman's most recent HBO performance, it, too, was massive. With all these things and more being massive, we no longer have a word meaning large and heavy or solid, to describe mountains or skyscrapers or offensive linemen in the National Football League. When words become hackneyed, as incredible and massive have, they lose their original, useful functions, a loss for the language and another gain for unoriginality.

Surreal, really, when you think about it. Yet if you really thought about it, you would never call anything "surreal." Derrek Lee recently described being elected to the Baseball Hall of Fame as "incredible," adding that the feeling was "surreal." Originally meaning fantastic, "surreal" is now regularly used to mean just about anything out of the ordinary. Your getting a ticket for speeding was surreal. So, too, was the way you first met your wife, and the recent firing of your supervisor at work. Surreal, all of it. As for the surrealism of the artists Miró, Magritte and Dalí, what did those jokers know about the surreal?

Hackneyed words that previously had their day pass, alas not quickly enough, into oblivion. Such seems to be the case with "awesome." I used to lunch weekly at a neighborhood restaurant, where our waiter greeted my friends and me by saying, in response to our entrance, "Awesome." When after having been seated we told him we were ready to order, he said, "Awesome." When he asked if everything was all right, or if one or another of us wanted more coffee, in answer to our response, he replied, "Awesome." Leaving I always thanked him for his good service, to which he replied not "thanks," not even "no problem," but with a final, "Awesome."

Overused, meaningless phrases fall out of fashion. It would be awesome if they did it a little quicker.

The awesome waiter has long since left the restaurant to attend chef school, which I trust he will find awesome. Now, though, I wish that for every one of his awesomes, I had responded with a "Whatever!," another hackneyed word that I hope is on its way out. "Whatever!," always understood with an exclamation mark, was used as a way to end the thread of a conversation, if not the entire conversation. You make an interesting point, and, instead of engaging you on the point, I exclaim "Whatever!," which means, in effect, case closed, I'd rather not talk about it. Damn rude, when you think about it, but then you may not wish to think about it.

Hackneyed words and phrases come and go. Let us hope that the mis- and overused "incredible," "massive" and "surreal" will soon depart everyday language. No doubt newly hackneyed words await in the wings. Oh, well, rack 'em up; or, should I say, hack 'em up?

Mr. Epstein is author, most recently, of "Never Say You've Had a Lucky Life."

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.
PUBLISHED SINCE 1889 BY DOW JONES & COMPANY

Lachlan Murdoch
Executive Chairman, News Corp

Rupert Murdoch
Chairman Emeritus, News Corp

Robert Thomson
Chief Executive Officer, News Corp

Emma Tucker
Editor in Chief

Almar Latour
Chief Executive Officer and Publisher

Liz Harris, *Managing Editor*
Charles Forelle, *Deputy Editor in Chief*

Elena Cherney, *Senior Editor;* **David Crow,** *Executive Editor;* **Chip Cummins,** *Newswires;* **Taneth Evans,** *Digital;* **Alex Martin,** *Print & Writing;* **Michael W. Miller,** *Features & Weekend;* **Bruce Orwall,** *Enterprise;* **Philana Patterson,** *Audio;* **Amanda Wills,** *Video*

Paul A. Gigot
Editor of the Editorial Page
Gerard Baker, *Editor at Large*

EDITORIAL AND CORPORATE HEADQUARTERS:
1211 Avenue of the Americas, New York, N.Y., 10036
Telephone 1-800-DOWJONES

DOW JONES MANAGEMENT:
Mae M. Cheng, *EVP, General Manager, Leadership;* **David Cho,** *Barron's Editor in Chief;* **Jason P. Conti,** *General Counsel, Chief Compliance Officer;* **Dianne DeSevo,** *Chief People Officer;* **Jared DiPalma,** *Chief Financial Officer;* **Artem Fishman,** *Chief Technology Officer;* **David Martin,** *Chief Revenue Officer, Business Intelligence;* **Dan Shar,** *EVP, General Manager, Wealth & Investing;* **Ashok Sinha,** *Chief Communications Officer;* **Josh Stinchcomb,** *EVP & Chief Revenue Officer, WSJ | Barron's Group;* **Sherry Weiss,** *Chief Marketing Officer*

DOW JONES | News Corp

Notable & Quotable: Thomas Sowell on Tariffs

From an episode of "Uncommon Knowledge with Peter Robinson," recorded April 1:

Mr. Robinson: What do you make of the present president of the United States and his tariffs?

Thomas Sowell: It's painful to see a ruinous decision from back in the 1920s being repeated.

Now, insofar as he's using these tariffs to get very strategic things settled, he is satisfied with that. But if you set off a worldwide trade war, that has a devastating history.

Everybody loses because everybody follows suit. And all that happens is that you get a great reduction in international trade.

It's disturbing in another sense. Franklin D. Roosevelt, when he was president in the 1930s, said that you have to try things. And if they don't work, then you admit it, you abandon that, you go on to something else and you try that until you come across something that does work.

That's not a bad approach if you are operating within a known system of rules. But if you are the one who's making the rules, then all the other people have no idea what you're going to do next. And that is a formula for having people hang on to their money until they figure out what you're going to do.

And when a lot of people hang on to their money, you can get results such as you got during the Great Depression of the 1930s. So if this is just a set of short-run ploys for various objectives limited in time, fine, maybe.

But if this is going to be the policy for four long years, that you're going to try this, you're going to try that, you're going to try something else, a lot of people are going to wait.

I think [about] what happened in the stock market recently, when things came down substantially for quite a while. I note that various people are holding on to their money before they do anything, because they don't know where this is going to lead.

Kremlin Envoy Meets With Trump Official

U.S. visit is the first by a senior Moscow official since the Russia-Ukraine war

BY ALAN CULLISON AND MICHAEL R. GORDON

WASHINGTON—A top Kremlin envoy completed two days of talks with President Trump's Russia negotiator at the White House on Thursday, the first high-level bilateral meeting in the U.S. since before the Ukraine invasion in 2022.

Kirill Dmitriev, the Russian envoy, announced his visit on his Telegram channel on Thursday, saying "productive dialogue between Russia and the U.S. isn't optional—it is essential."

His meetings with Trump's envoy, Steve Witkoff, came as the administration's push to halt the Ukraine war had appeared stalled.

Dmitriev has emerged as an informal Russian go-between with Washington in two rounds of peace talks held in Saudi Arabia, as well as a recent prisoner swap with the Kremlin.

He declined on Thursday to discuss specifics of the talks.

But speaking to Russian news services outside the White House he said that he had met with "key leaders" of the Trump administration and that more talks were to come.

"Unlike the Biden administration, they listen to the position of Russia, understand the worries of Russia," he said.

He said that there is "big interest" among U.S. companies to return to Russia, after departing the country en masse in 2022 after Russia's invasion of Ukraine.

The Kremlin has used Dmitriev, who has a background in investment banking, as a channel to promote economic deals with the U.S.

Since talks began in February, he has floated proposals in oil, gas and minerals, appealing to Trump's penchant for economic dealmaking.

MAXIM SHEMETOV/REUTERS

Kirill Dmitriev met with Steve Witkoff at the White House.

Trump is hoping to stop the Ukraine war in part to clear away the major obstacle to a broader rapprochement with the Kremlin. However, Russia has slow-walked Trump's cease-fire drive, playing for time as it presses its gains on the battlefield and pushes for maximum concessions in negotiations.

The Kremlin likely pushed for Dmitriev's visit to Washington because it sensed that Trump's patience with Putin is eroding, and that the failure to achieve a peace settlement could be turning popular U.S. opinion against Moscow, said Thomas Graham, a distinguished scholar at the Council on Foreign Relations.

In an interview with NBC over the weekend, Trump said he was "pissed off" with Putin and was considering sanctions targeting Russian oil exports because he was dissatisfied with the pace of the Ukraine talks.

On Tuesday, 50 Republican and Democratic senators introduced a sanctions package that would target Russian oil, gas, uranium and other products if the Kremlin refuses to engage in good-faith negotiations.

With little support in the House, the measure has scant chance of congressional approval. But it suggests some cracks in Republican support for Trump's conciliatory policy toward Moscow.

In his meeting with Russian-speaking reporters Thursday, Dmitriev played down reports of differences between the Kremlin and Trump administration, and said "there are a lot of rumors and distorted quotes."

Dmitriev said that the Trump administration "is ready to solve issues, they behave very respectfully."

While the White House and Kremlin have touted success in negotiations, military officials say they see little progress on the ground.

A senior NATO official told reporters at the alliance headquarters in Brussels on Thursday that Russia isn't observing a partial cease-fire on strikes on Ukraine's energy infrastructure, and doesn't appear to be planning to suspend its military operations.

The NATO official said Russia had pushed back the Ukrainian forces who last summer had launched an incursion into Russia's Kursk region. He added that Russia will likely eject the remaining Ukrainian troops from that area. Russia has 620,000 troops in the conflict zone, he said.

Russia is also drafting 160,000 conscripts, which is more than last year, indicating that Moscow's military aims haven't changed.

SERGEY SHESTAK/EPA/SHUTTERSTOCK

Ukrainian soldiers hold their position near eastern Ukraine's Donetsk region while battling the Russian military forces.

Russia, Ukraine Use Similar Tactics

BY ISABEL COLES

President Trump's pursuit of breakneck diplomacy to end the war in Ukraine is colliding with Moscow and Kyiv's go-slow approach.

Russia is putting sticks in the wheels of Trump's cease-fire drive, playing for time as it presses its gains on the battlefield and pushes for maximum concessions in negotiations. All the while, Moscow insists it wants peace.

Now, after quickly agreeing to U.S. cease-fire proposals, Ukraine is less eager to sign off on a sweeping economic deal proposed by the White House that would hand over significant control of the country's resource wealth. While publicly committing to a minerals deal, Kyiv is trying to buy time to improve the terms.

Both appear to be banking on Trump running out of patience with the other first.

Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky has shown willingness to accommodate Trump, said former U.S. Ambassador to Ukraine John Herbst, "but he's not about to mortgage his country's future on the issue of the critical minerals plus hydrocarbon resources."

Russian President Vladimir Putin is constructing a Potemkin village for Trump, Herbst said. "Whatever gestures he makes towards Trump—it's all for show."

The diplomatic maneuvering by Russia and Ukraine reflects their attempts to keep Trump on their side without fully acceding to his demands.

Ukraine wants to end the war without capitulating to Russia or surrendering its economic independence to the U.S. Russia aims to dominate Ukraine and prevent its integration with the West—and believes it has the upper hand in the three-year war.

Russian Deputy Foreign Minister Sergei Ryabkov on Tuesday said Moscow couldn't accept the U.S. proposal for resolving the war in its current form, suggesting a settlement is a long way off. He said the U.S. wasn't addressing the war's "root causes," Russian shorthand for attempts to integrate Ukraine with the West and the North Atlantic Treaty Organization's military presence in Eastern Europe.

Russia's military, meanwhile, is attacking at several hot spots along the 800-mile front lines and, according to Ukrainian officials, preparing major spring offensives in the north and south of the country.

Kyiv can only hope that with time, the Trump administration will realize Russia isn't serious about peace and lose patience with Putin, said Daniel Fried, a former U.S. ambassador to Poland and a fellow at the Atlantic Council. "Time could work for Ukraine if Trump continues to want a deal quickly and Putin is the obstacle," he said.

Until then, Kyiv is seeking to avoid angering Trump, while resisting pressure to sign a fresh draft of an economic deal that would see the U.S. draw profits from Ukrainian economic projects across metals, oil, gas and other natural resources, as well as infrastructure projects including ports and pipelines. The scope of the new draft, aimed at recouping billions in aid since the start of the war, has led some analysts to conclude that Trump might be seeking to present a deal that Ukraine can't support to blame Zelensky for its failure.

Despite Ukraine's careful approach, Trump warned Zelensky against backing out of the deal. "If he does that, he's got some problems," he said.

Ukrainian Foreign Minister Andriy Sybiha on Tuesday said Ukraine is committed to reaching an economic deal with the U.S., and is in consultations with Washington to arrive at a "mutually acceptable" text.

Ukrainian negotiators in March agreed to a U.S. proposal for an immediate one-month cease-fire, putting the ball in Putin's court. Last week, Ukraine agreed to a truce in the Black Sea, even though the deal was of little benefit to Kyiv.

Putin, in contrast, has repeatedly stalled. In response to the U.S. plan for a comprehensive truce, Russia said many issues would need to be worked out first. On the Black Sea truce, Russia said it would only abide by the terms after some sanctions were lifted.

Trump has begun to show frustration with the Kremlin's approach.

Hungary Will Leave International Court As Netanyahu Visits

BY MATTHEW DALTON

Hungary said it would withdraw from the International Criminal Court, dealing another blow to an institution grappling with the fallout from its decision to issue an arrest warrant for Israeli Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu.

The move comes as Netanyahu arrived in Hungary on Wednesday for a state visit, the first time the Israeli leader has traveled to Europe since the court issued its warrant for alleged war crimes and crimes against humanity committed during the war in Gaza. The court sent a request Thursday to the Hungarian government to arrest Netanyahu, an ICC official said. But Prime Minister Viktor Orban has for months said Hungary wouldn't comply with the warrant.

"The withdrawal process will begin on Thursday, in line with Hungary's constitutional and international legal obligations," said Zoltan Kovacs, a spokesman for Orban.

"The Court recalls that Hungary remains under a duty to cooperate with the ICC," said ICC spokesman Fadi El Abdallah.

The decision to issue arrest warrants for Netanyahu and former Defense Minister Yoav Gallant has shaken the ICC's support among its member countries and fueled doubts about the court's authority. The ICC is facing Israel's staunch backing from the Trump administration. Some European governments that have long been the ICC's strongest supporters—including France and Italy—have suggested they wouldn't comply with a request to arrest Netanyahu.

Orban has openly defied the court over the Netanyahu warrant, and others in Europe have joined him. In February, Friedrich Merz, Germany's likely next chancellor, invited Netanyahu to visit, saying Germany would find a way around the warrant. "I think it is a completely absurd idea that an Israeli prime minister cannot visit the Federal Republic of Germany," Merz said.

Europe's wavering support comes in addition to sanctions imposed by the Trump administration against Karim Khan, the ICC's chief prosecutor, for seeking the warrants. The U.S. has said it would target other ICC officials that work on the cases against Netanyahu and Gallant. The State Department is preparing a report due this month that will name them.

Hungary's move is the first time a European country has withdrawn from the ICC, a worrisome sign for the court in a region where nearly all nations have signed the Rome Statute, the ICC's founding treaty.

JANOS KUMMER/GETTY IMAGES

Viktor Orban , left, and Benjamin Netanyahu met in Budapest.

WORLD WATCH

IBRAHEEM ABU MUSTAFA/REUTERS

PARAMOTOR PARADE: Powered paragliders at the Lusail Sky Festival in Qatar on Thursday

SYRIA

Israel Launches Air Strikes

Israeli strikes reportedly killed at least nine people in Syria's southwest on Thursday. Syrian state news agency Sana said the dead were civilians, without giving details. Britain-based war monitor The Syrian Observatory for Human Rights said they were armed residents from the Daraa province.

Israeli Foreign Minister Gideon Sa'ar on Thursday accused Turkey of doing its "utmost to have Syria as a Turkish protectorate, it's clear that this is their intention." There was no response from Turkish officials.

Israel has seized parts of southwestern Syria since the fall of former Syrian President Bashar al-Assad.

—Associated Press

UNITED KINGDOM

Princes' Charity Is Subject of Probe

Britain's charity regulator opened an investigation into Sentebale, co-founded by Prince Harry and Prince Seeiso of Lesotho, a week after the princes and the organization's board of trustees resigned amid a dispute with the charity's chairwoman. Chair Sophie Chandauka later accused the prince of bullying to try to force her out.

Sentebale provides support for young people in Botswana and Lesotho.

The Charity Commission on Thursday said its focus will be whether current and former trustees, including the chair, "fulfilled their duties and responsibilities under charity law." Harry and Seeiso were patrons, but not on the board.

—Associated Press

BULGARIA

No-Confidence Vote Falls Well Short

Bulgaria's government on Thursday survived a parliamentary vote of no-confidence brought by the pro-Russia Vazrazhdane party and backed by two small nationalist groups. The motion, which criticized the government's pro-Western stance, support for Ukraine and sanctions on Moscow, fell 150-54 in the 240-seat parliament.

Analysts had predicted the outcome, saying a majority supports the pro-European orientation of Bulgaria, a member of the European Union since 2007.

The center-right GERB party, which leads the governing coalition, condemned the motion as an attempt to derail adoption of the euro next year.

—Associated Press

BUSINESS & FINANCE

 * * * * * *

S&P 5396.52 ▼ 4.84% S&P FIN ▼ 5.01% S&P IT ▼ 6.86% DJ TRANS ▼ 9.15% WSJ $ IDX ▼ 1.29% 2-YR. TREAS. yield 3.724% NIKKEI (Midday) 33818.18 ▼ 2.64% See more at WSJ.com/Markets

WeightWatchers Faces Proxy Fight

Small investor seeks board seats, up to $300 million in further cost cutting

By Ben Glickman

A small shareholder is launching a proxy fight at WeightWatchers' parent company, seeking board seats and hundreds of millions of dollars in cost cuts, people familiar with the matter said.

Premca Capital, an investment fund, has nominated three directors for election to **WW International**'s board, according to the people familiar with the matter.

WW International, formerly known as Weight Watchers International, has navigated a rough period as it attempts to shift more of its business to focus on GLP-1 weight-loss drugs such as Ozempic.

The company has a market capitalization of about $40 million, following a sharp decline in recent years. Its stock is down nearly 70% in the past year.

Premca wants WeightWatchers to slash costs by $200 million to $300 million, on top of the cuts the company has already been making.

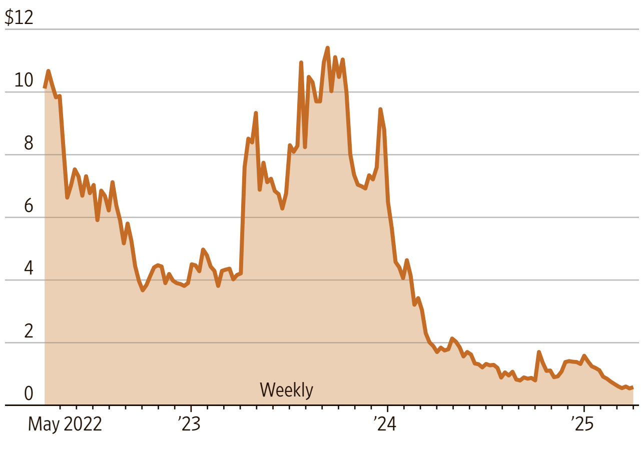
The firm is also pushing for an overhaul of management, a revamp of the WeightWatchers app and adoption of a growth plan, according to the people.

Premca, which has a less than 1% stake in WW International, has been in talks with the company since November, the people said.

WeightWatchers has lost key executives, with its chief executive and chief financial

Please turn to page B2

WW International share price over the past three years



Source: FactSet

SunnyD Is Part of $1.5 Billion Beverage Acquisition

By Jesse Newman And Laura Cooper

A Guatemalan conglomerate is buying SunnyD and other beverage brands in a roughly $1.5 billion deal, aiming to supercharge growth of the bright orange citrus drink.

Castillo Hermanos, a family-owned Guatemalan company, is acquiring the beverage brands from private-equity firm **Brynwood Partners**. Castillo sells food and beverages and operates retail and real estate businesses across Central America.

The deal includes Juicy Juice, Little Hug and other beverages that make up Harvest Hill Beverage Co., which Brynwood formed in 2014. It offers Castillo an opportunity to reach cost-conscious consumers in the U.S. who are turning to value brands to feed their families.

"A lot of people grew up with this brand," said Roberto Lara, Castillo's chief executive. "There is a loyal base, but we have to ensure we listen to those consumers and potential new consumers, as to what they are looking for."

U.S. grocery sales of SunnyD, formerly known as Sunny Delight, in the 52 weeks ended March 16 were up nearly 7% from a year earlier, according to data from market-research firm Circana, provided by Brynwood.

Lara said he would work to expand SunnyD's fan base both in its home market and abroad.

In the U.S., the citrus punch is particularly popular among Hispanic consumers, Lara said, a population whose size and purchasing power are both growing.

SunnyD offers a more affordable option than competitors, Lara said, a competitive edge when U.S. consumers are still reeling from years of inflation.

At a Brooklyn, N.Y., supermarket, bigger brands like PepsiCo's Tropicana and Coca-Cola's Simply can sell for almost $7 a gallon, while a comparable size of SunnyD retails at $3.79.

Introduced in the 1960s, SunnyD had fallen out of favor a decade ago as many Americans were reaching for healthier beverages. While Tropicana and Simply are 100% juice, SunnyD's main drink contains 5% juice. It is sweetened with corn syrup and artificial sweeteners, and made

Please turn to page B2

Verizon Offers a Plan With 3-Year Price Lock

By Drew FitzGerald

Verizon will freeze rates for a swath of its customers in a bid to hold on to cellphone users irked by years of price hikes.

The telecom company said Thursday that subscribers on its myPlan and myHome bundles will automatically gain a price-lock guarantee for three years.

Verizon has spent the past few years boosting its revenue by raising monthly rates and fees.

"This is time for us to start taking share," Verizon consumer chief Sowmyanarayan Sampath said. "The pool of customers who are available for grabs will decline over the next few years as the market matures and saturates, so to grow your base you have to hold on to your base."

The price locks are automatic for all subscribers on Verizon's myPlan or myHome services—both newer plans that offer extras like discounted streaming-media subscriptions—and will automatically renew after three years.

The rate promises don't cover changes in fees, taxes or perks offered by third-party services like **Netflix** and Max.

Sampath said freezing base prices will give customers more peace of mind. About half of Verizon's customer base is on myPlan. The company also will offer free satellite-based text messaging to any myPlan subscriber with a capable device.

Some price locks aren't as ironclad as they used to be. **T-Mobile** recently phased out a rate guarantee it launched in 2022 and introduced new offers, including "5G Internet Price Lock" and "Last Month Price Lock" with more loopholes.

T-Mobile also said some older plans would see their monthly rates increase this week.

The cost of wireless and home internet service has gradually climbed in recent years, a trend some companies attribute to their own rising expenses.

Corporate consolidation, including the 2020 merger of T-Mobile and Sprint, also has left consumers with fewer places to take their business if they don't like their wireless service.

Shares of Verizon added 2% in Thursday's trading.

GABBY JONES/BLOOMBERG NEWS

The cell-service provider has been raising monthly rates.

GEORGE CHINSEE/WWD/PENSKE MEDIA/GETTY IMAGES

Clothes-rental firm CaaStle worked with brands like Ann Taylor and Vince, seen above.

Fallen Fashion Startup Probed for Alleged Fraud

By Chavie Lieber

Christine Hunsicker liked to boast that she could make more money off clothes than anyone, investors recall.

Her startup, CaaStle, provided support for fashion brands looking to rent their clothes to customers. An investor pitch said the company had raised money from Peter Thiel, John Hennessy, Jim Breyer, Bill Ackman, Henry Kravis and Peter Fenton. In 2023 she reported her startup had $521 million in revenue and projected it would hit $1.2 billion in 2025.

Except, as investors learned this weekend, CaaStle wasn't making money.

According to an audit cited by the company's board, CaaStle's net revenue in 2023 was actually $15.7 million, and its losses exceeded $80 million. The company is being investigated by law enforcement for possible fraud, a letter to shareholders said.

In the Saturday letter to shareholders, which was reviewed by The Wall Street Journal, CaaStle's board of directors said Hunsicker had resigned as CEO and stepped down from the board after an internal investigation found evidence of fraud.

The letter said Hunsicker had "provided certain investors with misstated financial statements and falsified audit opinions" and that the company was "facing a severe and immediate liquidity problem."

This article is based on interviews with CaaStle investors and current and former employees. Hunsicker didn't respond to requests for comment.

When it launched in 2018, CaaStle's pitch to brands and investors was "clothing as a service," a play on software as a service, or SaaS. (The company name is a pun on that acronym.) Embracing the spirit of the sharing economy, the company handled the interface of fashion rentals as well as shipping, cleaning and storing clothes. Express, Ann Taylor and Bloomingdale's were among the big brands that became clients and rented their unsold inventory through CaaStle.

On a recording of a 2023 investor call reviewed by The Wall Street Journal, Hunsicker told investors she could "maximize the amount of profit earned on a piece of clothing."

Please turn to page B5

MARK KAUZLARICH/BLOOMBERG NEWS

Founder Christine Hunsicker has resigned as CEO.

INSIDE

RETAILING
Department store Printemps New York is starting out with minimal high tech. **B2**

BUSINESS NEWS
Hershey is acquiring the popcorn brand Lesser Evil for about $750 million. **B3**

'The Pitt' Serves as a Streaming Model for Warner

By Joe Flint

Doctors and nurses in "The Pitt" slip on blood puddles, drill holes in patients on the fly and improvise chest tubes.

Each episode spans one hour of an emergency-room shift that passes in a flash, but lasts an eternity for its characters. In an era when streaming shows give priority to big budgets and short seasons, **Warner Bros. Discovery**'s "The Pitt," which runs on the Max streaming service, has succeeded by doing the opposite.

The hospital drama has one primary set and only one major star on its call sheet—"ER" alum Noah Wyle. It was filmed quickly and its first season has almost as many episodes as a traditional network drama.

The show's ability to deliver prestige drama dressed up as a fast-paced medical show has delighted fans and helped it secure a second season, scheduled for next January.

For Warner, which is grappling with a leaner Hollywood, "The Pitt" is proving that compelling stories can be delivered on a tighter budget.

The show captures a shift at a Pittsburgh hospital, whipping between drug overdoses, a child drowning and gunshot wounds. It is dotted with discussions about nursing shortages and private-equity investment in hospitals.

Wyle oversees the team as Dr. Michael "Robby" Robinavitch, a senior attending ER physician dealing with post-traumatic stress from Covid.

"It's a difficult show to do your laundry to," said executive producer and director John Wells, adding that the intent was to make a show that "people lean forward to watch, rather than lean back."

"The Pitt" made its debut in January and scored a 96% approval rating on Rotten Tomatoes.

Its first season had a 15-episode order, with each episode costing between $5 million and $6 million, people familiar with the matter said.

The new season of HBO's "The Last of Us," meanwhile,

Please turn to page B2

PHILIP CHEUNG FOR WSJ

From left, Noah Wyle, R. Scott Gemmill and John Wells on the set of 'The Pitt.'

INDEX TO BUSINESSES

These indexes cite notable references to most parent companies and businesspeople in today's edition. Articles on regional page inserts aren't cited in these indexes.

INDEX TO PEOPLE

BUSINESS & FINANCE


WARRICK PAGE/HBO/EVERETT COLLECTION

Noah Wyle, left, plays Dr. Michael 'Robby' Robinavitch on the Warner Bros. Discovery streaming emergency-room drama.

'The Pitt' Is a Model For Warner

Continued from page B1

will have seven episodes at a cost of more than $15 million per episode, those and other people familiar with the shows' budgets said.

One of the most-expensive budget items of "The Pitt" is the $4 million-plus emergency-room set occupying two sound stages on the Warner Bros. lot in Burbank, Calif. A typical episode takes about nine days to make.

Meanwhile, **Netflix**'s "Adolescence" spent three weeks filming each of its four episodes.

A typical day in ER

"The Pitt" was a product of Covid. Wyle's fan mail had shifted from kind words about his "ER" character, John Carter, to comments about the trials of doctors and nurses during the pandemic.

Wyle contacted Wells, who had been showrunner and executive producer of "ER," which ended its run in 2009.

"Something is going on in healthcare and it probably should be talked about," Wyle said in an interview, recalling his conversation with Wells.

Wells was wary of yet another medical melodrama.

The two of them, along with former "ER" producer R. Scott Gemmill, decided instead to do a show that would focus on a typical day in an ER.

Gemmill is the creator and showrunner of "The Pitt." Wyle is an executive producer and has written two episodes.

Wyle is a fan of longer seasons and has gotten frustrated when shows he liked watching seemed to be over too soon. He recalled his annoyance after finishing the six-episode second season of Netflix's "The Diplomat."

"I was like, 'That's it?'" Wyle said.

When Wells and Warner Bros. Television Group Chief Executive Channing Dungey started discussing the show in early 2023, they wanted a traditional broadcast model with more episodes and a regular production schedule.

Many popular streaming shows, such as "Severance" and "Stranger Things," can go years between seasons.

Casey Bloys, who heads content for HBO and Max, saw "The Pitt" as an opportunity to bring some stability to the Max lineup with a recurring, longer-running show.

Bloys and Dungey are now talking about other potential series in the vein of "The Pitt," including a police show and a legal drama.

Reality TV

The cast of "The Pitt" prepared by joining a two-week boot camp with doctors and nurses.

There are two ER physicians in the writing room, and as many as 15 actual nurses and physicians on set. The show has been praised by medical professionals for its realism.

"Noah is great at sutures," Gemmill said, "and I'm sure he could intubate if he had to."

The ER set is built in such a way that actors can be filmed at all angles, which means producers and directors wear scrubs during shooting in case they end up on camera.

With every episode covering one hour of the same shift, there aren't major hair or wardrobe changes—except for one medical student whose constant need for new scrubs is a running joke.

Still, that approach to "The Pitt" comes with some complications.

"Nobody could gain a pound, lose a pound, get a tan, get a tattoo. We had to look exactly the same for seven months every single day. The fidelity to continuity was so intense," Wyle said.

New Manhattan Department Store Takes Novel Tack: Almost No Tech

By Isabelle Bousquette


CAITLIN OCHS/REUTERS

The strategy runs counter to the tech-focused experiences retailers have been driving.

The latest shopping experience in lower Manhattan is a 54,000-square-foot temple to Parisian style with a technology outlook that seems almost *fin de siècle*.

Printemps New York, an outpost of the famed French department store, is starting out with minimal screens inside, no shopping app and no e-commerce website. The store is betting on an old-fashioned, face-to-face shopping experience as its killer app for drawing business.

"Originally when we were conceptualizing the whole thing, screens were everywhere," said Mary Jane Puangco, chief experience officer of Printemps America. That changed during the design process. "It didn't feel right...The vibe we want here is a bit more people interacting with people. We didn't want people looking at their screens."

The strategy runs counter to the tech-focused experiences retailers have been driving over the past decade. Retailers have invested in apps that send alerts when shoppers enter stores, scattered QR codes offering more information on products and armed associates with smartphones to order products online when they're not available in person.

Some have gone as far as installing "connected fitting rooms" with features like buttons that shoppers can press to request a different size. Store websites meanwhile have become kitted out with digital shopping assistants and virtual try-on experiences.

The attempt to merge the physical and digital experiences has even spawned a cringey marketing term: phygital.

But so far it hasn't been enough to rescue an industry that has been bleeding market share to lower-priced discount stores over the past couple of decades, said Citi's senior retail analyst, Paul Lejuez. "Mostly what we've seen is closing stores and shrinking the size of the chain," he said.

While the discount stores can offer a treasure-hunt-like experience for in-person visitors, department stores still lack a compelling value proposition to bring people to physical locations, according to Lejuez.

And in fact, a lot of the digitally enabled in-store experiences are simply annoying, said Don Scheibenreif, vice president and distinguished analyst at research firm Gartner. "Retailers are just struggling to find ways to engage customers while they're in the store," Scheibenreif said.

> 'The vibe we want here is a bit more people interacting with people.'

Printemps is focused on creating that in-person value proposition with experiences that include archival fashion exhibits, an on-site spa and champagne tastings.

The store is taking a risk by potentially alienating a group of consumers that might initially want to shop online or look at an app, and are used to that type of experience, Scheibenreif added. "It's definitely a bold move," he said.

But technology is not completely absent from the Printemps experience.

The store currently has four screens, with plans for four more, all designed to help guests find their way around. But they are often tucked away in corners rather than made a main focus.

There is a website, but it is more inspired by the websites of New York's Museum of Modern Art, the Louvre and the Disney theme parks, which entice people to visit in person, than the traditional grid of products seen on a retailer's site, said Alex Levin, founding partner of design and tech studio L+R, which designed the site. And definitely don't expect any AI chatbots.

There are some strong technology foundations behind the scenes, however.

Levin said the website is fully integrated with the in-store screens, meaning that any tweaks made to one will automatically update on the other. Integrations like this are typically a heavy lift, but Levin said it was possible because Printemps New York built all its back-end technology from the ground up rather than using existing digital infrastructure from France. Levin also said he used Apple Vision Pro to determine the dimensions of the in-store screens before construction.

An e-commerce site is slated to launch in the fall, after the store has had enough of a chance to sell consumers on the in-store experience, said Puangco, the Printemps America executive. The company also anticipates releasing an app at some point.

Visitors in the meantime will find that the New York location is designed to mimic a French apartment, with rooms themed to evoke a salon, a boudoir, a playroom and so on. The jewel of the store is the "Red Room," an interior landmark built in 1931 whose walls are lined with over 3 million hand-painted tiles. It now houses Printemps's shoe selection.

Levin said Printemps's choice to let the experience stand on its own without an overwhelming amount of tech will set it apart from other retail competitors. "They would just wrap this entire room with a screen," he said, indicating the Red Room. "It'd be like the Sphere in Vegas."


JON KOPALOFF/GETTY IMAGES FOR WEIGHTWATCHERS GLP-1 HOUSE, LA

The WeightWatchers parent has navigated a rough period as it attempts to shift to a focus on GLP-1 weight-loss drugs.

WW Faces A Proxy Battle

Continued from page B1

officer leaving the company in the past year.

Oprah Winfrey, the longtime face of the company, also stepped down from the board early last year and donated her shares.

Winfrey later said the move was meant to avoid a conflict of interest with a special she was making about weight-loss drugs.

The company held over $1.4 billion in long-term debt as of Dec. 28.

WeightWatchers' lenders in February began restructuring discussions with the company, The Wall Street Journal reported.

WeightWatchers' revenue fell 12% to $785.9 million in 2024, and the company generated an operating loss, largely because of goodwill-impairment charges.

The company is already on pace to cut $100 million in annual costs by the end of this year as part of a broader plan that has included job cuts, it said in February.

Premca was founded by Rajit Marwah, a tech entrepreneur and alum of MySpace and Microsoft.

On Wednesday, WW International shares lost 1% to 54 cents each.

Guatemala Group Buys SunnyD

Continued from page B1

with synthetic dyes.

Sweetened beverages are a frequent target of Health and Human Services Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr., whose "Make America Healthy Again" agenda has set its sights on removing sugary drinks like soda from the nation's food stamp program. Kennedy has said that added sugars such as high-fructose corn syrup are culprits in America's struggle with chronic disease.

Lara said SunnyD would evolve along with consumers, and could potentially use more natural ingredients. He pointed to Spain, where SunnyD products contain fewer artificial dyes and no high-fructose corn syrup.

"I think there are things we should look at," Lara said, adding that Juicy Juice products are 100% juice.

As part of the deal, Centerview Capital is investing and joining with Castillo to help the company grow its U.S. beverage business.

Harvest Hill operates six U.S. manufacturing facilities, and Castillo will absorb all of the company's 1,000 employees, including its leadership team, the Guatemalan company said.

Hershey Strikes $750 Million Deal

Chocolatier to buy LesserEvil popcorn brand to expand its snack offerings

By Lauren Thomas

Hershey agreed to a roughly $750 million deal for the popcorn brand **LesserEvil**, according to people familiar with the matter.

An agreement was announced by the company Thursday, confirming an earlier report from The Wall Street Journal. Hershey didn't disclose the price it agreed to pay.

The deal value could grow over time from $750 million if LesserEvil hits certain milestones in its performance, the people familiar with the matter added.

LesserEvil had recently tapped bankers to pursue a sale of its business, which makes a range of snacks using what it says are better-for-you ingredients.

Among its products are popcorn made with avocado oil, "space balls" that mimic cheese balls and organic onion-flavored corn rings, a play on Funyuns.

LesserEvil is run by Charles Coristine, a former Wall Street executive who bought the company when it was struggling.

Big snack companies have been seeking to buy up popular smaller brands to freshen up their portfolios.

PepsiCo last year agreed to acquire tortilla-chip maker Siete Foods for $1.2 billion. Flowers Foods, the company behind Wonder Bread, in January said it would buy the healthy cracker maker Simple Mills for nearly $800 million.

Hershey's acquisitions in recent years include the sour candy brand Sour Strips and Dot's Pretzels. The Pennsylvania-based company is known for its chocolate offerings, but that has become a liability with record-high cocoa prices.

The LesserEvil deal is a relatively small transaction for Hershey, which has a market value of about $33 billion. Its share price is down 1.5% so far this year after gaining 1.8% Thursday.

RICHARD B. LEVINE/LEVINE ROBERTS/ZUMA PRESS

LesserEvil sells popcorn and other snacks using what it says are better-for-you ingredients.

Government Consultant Navigates Budget Cuts

By Chip Cutter

WASHINGTON—When the Trump administration recently ordered big consulting firms to offer price concessions on the billions of dollars in projects they do for the federal government, **Booz Allen Hamilton** Chief Executive Horacio Rozanski sprang into action.

For Booz Allen, which makes 98% of its roughly $11 billion in annual revenue from government-related work, the assignment was existential. Rozanski and his team pulled in more than 100 employees to develop a response, which included more than $1 billion in potential cost savings.

Rozanski, 57 years old, is a more-than-three-decade Booz Allen veteran who has experienced budget showdowns and new administrations before. But the second Trump term is different.

"Especially with the government, slow means never, and fast means now," Rozanski said. "It's been a jolt to the system. It's been a jolt to the industry."

The jolts are likely to continue. Booz Allen's stock is down about 35% since the inauguration, and the Trump administration is expected to demand deeper cuts from the firms.

In an interview in the capital this week, Rozanski discussed Booz Allen's response, whether staff cuts will follow and why the company is so concentrated in government work. Here are excerpts, condensed and edited:

STEFANI REYNOLDS/BLOOMBERG NEWS

Horacio Rozanski is a Booz Allen veteran of more than three decades.

The Wall Street Journal: The General Services Administration asked companies to explain their work in a way a 15-year-old could understand. What's your answer?

ROZANSKI: We're an advanced technology company. Our work in the federal government spans some of the most critical missions. We're talking about space, the intelligence community and some of the health agencies like the Veterans Affairs administration. Our work, for the most part, is about bringing technology into those missions to make them faster, better and more efficient.

WSJ: The GSA asked firms like yours to say which projects could potentially be canceled. What did you propose?

ROZANSKI: There is some work that, in the spirit of efficiency, the government could choose to in-source or maybe not do because it's not a priority. And we identified contracts where, because we've become more efficient, the same work could be done at a lower cost.

WSJ: Does that mean Booz Allen could lose more than $1 billion in revenue?

ROZANSKI: GSA would need to talk to the partner agencies that actually own the work. But, presumably, an outcome would be that a lot of these dollars don't come to Booz Allen.

WSJ: What are examples of contracts you feel are no longer needed or the government could do itself?

ROZANSKI: We don't have a lot of work that is studies and things like that, but there is some.

There's work where we're supporting, say, a research effort the government may not need us to do, or may not want to continue. There's work that maybe was commissioned three or four years ago that no longer makes sense.

WSJ: Will the price concessions mean layoffs?

ROZANSKI: Time will tell. A lot of technology companies need us and want us to help them scale. So we may have the ability to repurpose and reallocate some of our workforce. Over 70% of our workforce is technologists.

WSJ: Have you met with Elon Musk or President Trump as part of your conversations with the administration?

ROZANSKI: I should not talk about who I have and have not met with, but we're engaging. I will talk to anybody who will talk to me. There's a natural skepticism about this industry: Is it on the side of change, or is it going to resist change? A lot of my argument is Booz Allen is on the side of change.

WSJ: Is Booz too concentrated in government work?

ROZANSKI: About three-quarters of the work we do is national security-oriented. The consequence is that it limits some other things we would want to do, or we could do, serving governments around the world and even serving commercial clients.

WSJ: Are there conversations at the board level to broaden your work?

ROZANSKI: At any time, all options are on the table. We need to find better ways to offer that to a broader set of customers in a way that does not limit our ability to serve the U.S. government the way the government needs to be served.

WSJ: What's the toughest request the administration has made of you so far?

ROZANSKI: The self-examination. It's not easy to take a look at every contract and say: Could this be done by someone else? Could this be done by the government? That's been a challenging, but very valid, request.

WSJ: A year from now—after this cost review—how different will Booz Allen look?

ROZANSKI: I really, sincerely hope DOGE is successful, not just in identifying the inefficiencies, but also in removing barriers to competition and burdens that add unnecessary cost. We really are fast becoming the company that brings dual-use technology to the government. I do believe that there's a path for us to increase the size of the portfolio outside of direct federal government work.

WSJ: One argument is that cuts to the federal workforce will ultimately benefit contractors like Booz Allen. Do you agree?

ROZANSKI: If we're replacing one person for one person, that is not to the benefit of the government.

If we are actually bringing technology in to make people more effective and more efficient, to make things happen faster, to deliver better national security, that is the answer. And in that, Booz Allen has a lot of opportunity.

DANIEL VOGL/DPA/ZUMA PRESS

Arne Freundt has been chief executive of Puma since 2022.

Puma CEO To Depart Following Clash With Its Board

By Adrià Calatayud

Puma said Chief Executive Arne Freundt is leaving due to differing views with the company's supervisory board on strategy execution, and the company named former **Adidas** executive Arthur Hoeld as his successor.

Freundt is leaving the German sporting-goods company on April 11 after 14 years in various positions, including that of CEO since November 2022, Puma said.

He took the helm when his predecessor, Bjorn Gulden, left for Adidas.

The company said at the time of his appointment that his contract ran for four years.

Hoeld, who was responsible for sales on Adidas's executive board until October, will be appointed as new CEO on July 1, Puma said.

The executive change comes as the company is seeking to revive its fortunes while it grapples with the impact of President Trump's tariffs.

Puma is currently evaluating the situation after the latest round of U.S. levies and will react swiftly, a representative for the German sporting-goods company said.

In the interim, Puma's management board will consist of product chief Maria Valdes, financial chief Markus Neubrand and a newly appointed chief commercial officer, Matthias Baeumer, the company said.

Baeumer was most recently vice president of Teamsport, Puma's fastest-growing unit, the company said.

A successor for that position will be named shortly, it added.

Shares of Puma have lost more than half of their value since Freundt became CEO.

In March, Puma issued an outlook for 2025 that came in significantly below market expectations, while it also anticipated weak sales growth and lower earnings this year, partly due to the tense global trade environment.

At the time, UBS analysts said that the company didn't appear to have entered in a turnaround phase, so its results could deteriorate further. They said that the group would require a completely new strategy from management.

Earlier this year, the company unveiled plans to ax around 500 corporate positions worldwide as part of its "nextlevel" efficiency plan, which it announced earlier this year.

Puma is looking to revamp its brand, pushing further into performance products, a category in which it faces fierce competition.

Last summer, the company trimmed its 2024 earnings forecast toward the lower end of its guidance range, partly due to muted consumer sentiment.

In 2024, the group reported a 2.5% increase in full-year sales in reported terms compared with 2023, while operating profit was flat year over year at €622 million, or $675 million, with a margin of 7.1%.

Conagra Brands Profit Sinks

By Dean Seal

Conagra Brands recorded lower earnings and sales in its fiscal third quarter as volumes fell across each of its segments.

The maker of Slim Jims and Healthy Choice frozen meals posted a profit of $145.1 million, or 30 cents a share, for the quarter ended Feb. 23. That is down from $308.6 million, or 64 cents a share, in the same period a year earlier.

Stripping out one-time items, adjusted earnings were 51 cents a share. Analysts polled by FactSet had been expecting 52 cents a share.

Sales fell 6.3% to $2.84 billion, below analyst projections for $2.9 billion, according to FactSet.

The top line was 5.2% lower on an organic basis, driven by lower volumes, prices and an unfavorable change in the mix of products sold.

Revenue also was hurt by foreign-exchange headwinds and impacts from the company's recent divestitures. It sold a majority stake in India's **Agro Tech Foods** in August and said that same month that it would acquire FATTY Smoked Meat Sticks.

Chief Executive Sean Connolly said shipments lagged behind consumption during the quarter.

Conagra faced manufacturing challenges at its primary facility that prepares chicken for frozen meals. It also was hit with a surge of consumption in its frozen-vegetable business that depleted its inventory and led to out-of-stocks.

"We are making solid progress in restoring inventory and improving customer service levels," Connolly said.

DAVID PAUL MORRIS/BLOOMBERG NEWS

The packaged-food maker's sales fell 6.3% in the quarter.

Deloitte Is Laying Off Consultants in the U.S.

By Mark Maurer

Deloitte is cutting U.S. workers in its consulting business after the federal government demanded it find ways to shrink the cost of government projects it is working on.

The Big Four accounting firm didn't specify how many employees would be targeted. "Modest personnel actions" would be taken in the coming weeks based on government clients' evolving needs, the company said.

Deloitte also said voluntary employee turnover had slowed. Since more consultants had stayed in their jobs in recent months, that contributed to the need to reduce its workforce, according to a U.S. spokesman. Overall demand for Deloitte's advisory services remains strong, he added.

Deloitte's U.S. management consulting business was flat last year, growing less than 1% in 2024, compared with 18% the previous year and 25.5% the year before that.

Deloitte's U.S. workforce totaled nearly 173,000 at the end of 2024.

The company is among the largest U.S. consulting firms to the federal government. This week those firms offered to cut billions of dollars from their contracts with agencies in response to a General Services Administration deadline that required them to justify their contracts and propose cuts.

The GSA is already beginning to challenge those submissions, pressing for even deeper cuts, according to people familiar with the review process. Accounting firms have continued to experience slower-than-expected levels of voluntary attrition after aggressively hiring people during the pandemic. Layoffs at several firms have centered on the advisory side, for which revenue growth has generally slowed.

Pinduoduo to Invest Billions to Support Merchants


CFOTO/DDP/ZUMA PRESS

Chinese bargain shopping platform Pinduoduo, owned by PDD Holdings, will invest more than $13 billion over the next three years to support merchants.

Pinduoduo plans to allocate over 100 billion yuan, equivalent to $13.76 billion, in capital, traffic and other resources to strengthen its e-commerce ecosystem and support merchants, the company said.

PDD, which also owns Temu, reported slower profit and revenue growth in the fourth quarter, capping a turbulent year for the e-commerce giant as it faced intense domestic competition, geopolitical tensions abroad and higher U.S. tariffs.

The company in recent months also has faced criticism and pushback from merchants over profit squeezes.

Last year, a group of Chinese merchants supplying Temu stormed a company affiliate's office in Guangzhou, southern China, protesting what they claimed were unfair penalties that left some bankrupt.

Chinese e-commerce companies have been ramping up efforts to support merchants. Tmall, operated by Alibaba Group Holding, said last month that it is committing "unprecedented strategic resources" to support brands in 2025.

—Tracy Qu

Tech CEO: Tariffs Hit Growth Prospects

By Steven Rosenbush

The sweeping tariffs set into motion by President Trump on Wednesday have one software CEO concerned about growth prospects for companies, especially in the second half of the year.

Vineet Jain, co-founder and chief executive of **Egnyte**, which provides a platform that helps businesses manage, secure and govern their cloud content, said he expects the tariffs to depress demand, and that the damage won't be easy to undo.

In February, Egnyte received a majority investment from private-equity firms GI Partners and TA Associates valuing the Mountain View, Calif.-based company at more than $1.5 billion, including cash on the balance sheet, WSJ Pro Venture Capital reported.


NIKKI RITCHER FOR WSJ

Egnyte CEO Vineet Jain expects tariffs' effect will be felt more in the year's second half.

Here are highlights of the conversation with WSJ Pro, which happened on Wednesday as President Trump announced his tariff plan.

The interview has been edited and condensed for length and clarity.

WSJ: How do you expect tariffs to affect your company?

Jain: We hit the quarter handsomely. If we project out to what the second half of the year entails, based on the pipeline and our sales cycle, we know [that in] Q2, we are fine. As it gets further out, it gets fuzzier and I can bet that the impact of what's happening on the macro side will be felt in the second half of the year as a vendor, unless things are magically stabilized, which I don't see a chance in hell of happening right now.

When the year started, I didn't have that sentiment. I thought with the new administration, with more deregulation, with Lina Khan gone at the FTC…that animal spirits will be unleashed, and specifically M&A and IPO activity will increase. Well, that hasn't materialized.

There are a lot of unknowns, and it's the fear of the unknown that causes people not to make decisions, specifically buying decisions. So if I take all of that in, I am making sure we don't get ahead of our skis in terms of hiring or investments. We're still hiring, we should be investing. We just opened an office in Saudi Arabia, but we are applying the brakes to say, "Slow down, make your numbers with efficiency improvement, not additional head count." The second half is a question mark. Absolutely. But we are not changing the operating plan, not yet.

WSJ: There's a theory that the tariffs are mostly a negotiating tactic that will disappear in relatively short order. Do you think that that's a likely scenario?

JAIN: Based on what I can glean from public sources, yes, there is a yo-yo-like effect. You threaten people, then they back off and then you reduce it or sometimes it disappears. But I do think that the damage is being done and some of the damage will be irreversible for a while.

There are long lead times and capital expenditures. I don't know whether any of it gets reversed, but I do think that a complete reversal is out of the question. There's a fundamental intrinsic damage that this is doing because it also raises questions about the reliability of the U.S. as a trading partner. And people will start looking into other markets.

WSJ: Do you think the tariffs as outlined could lead to more growth in the longer run?

JAIN: I am doubtful, since most of the tariffs (not all) will have a direct or indirect inflationary impact on the U.S. economy.

While we are striving to bring a lot of manufacturing back, the fundamental fact is that the labor cost in the U.S. is way higher than say China/Vietnam/Mexico/India etc.

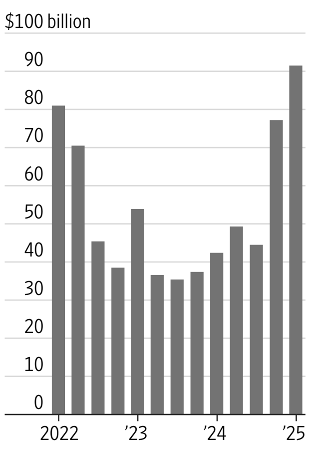
That itself will cause the underlying cost of goods manufactured in the U.S. to be higher, and that cost will get passed to the consumer. Even in highly automated jobs that require less labor, the overall cost of supporting infrastructure is higher in the U.S. A good example would be chip manufacturing in Taiwan vs. the U.S.

Unless we are willing to live with lower wages (which we won't), I don't really see how the tariffs would help drive growth broadly in the long run.

Big AI Deal Lifts U.S. Venture Market In Strong Quarter

By Marc Vartabedian

U.S. venture capital raised by startups, quarterly



Source: PitchBook Data and the National Venture Capital Association

Venture capitalists opened their wallets to start the year, investing more in startups than in any quarter since 2021. But the spending spree was focused on artificial-intelligence companies—particularly ChatGPT maker **OpenAI**.

The massive $40 billion fundraising by OpenAI in the closing days of the first quarter powered much of the overall gain for the U.S. venture market. Excluding the round, the quarter's deal value was roughly on a par with previous periods in the past couple of years.

U.S. venture commitments last quarter jumped 116% to a record $91.5 billion from the same quarter a year ago, according to a report from analytics provider PitchBook Data and the National Venture Capital Association, a trade group. The quarterly figure also eclipsed the $77.2 billion raised by U.S. startups during last year's fourth quarter.

The number of deals, meanwhile, plummeted, dropping by a quarter from the same period a year ago, according to the data.

A dearth of exits has continued to deflate the venture market. Initial public offerings, a primary way venture investors generate outsize returns, have been few.

Investor capital continued to coalesce around AI technology, a trend that's been under way for the last couple of years but which reached a fever pitch last quarter. AI accounted for a record 71% of the capital venture investors committed last quarter, up from 62% in the prior quarter, according to the PitchBook-NVCA report.

"There's a huge amount of money going to a small number of companies," said Kyle Stanford, the lead U.S. venture capital research analyst at PitchBook. "Everyone else is still having a really challenging time."

And the focus on AI is intense.

Aydin Senkut, the founder and managing partner of venture firm **Felicis**, said competitive deals attract up to a dozen term sheets from prospective lead investors. A year ago, those deals might have seen just a handful of term sheets, he said.

"Everyone's trying to get into the same deals," Senkut said, adding that competition for AI startups has driven up deal sizes and valuations.

Felicis, which is based San Francisco and Menlo Park, Calif., made nearly twice as many deals last quarter as in the first quarter of 2024, mostly centered on AI. Driving the AI frenzy, Senkut said, is a belief that enterprise-tech buyers will open their budgets for the new technology, boosting startups' annual recurring revenue, a key business metric investors track.

In January, Felicis co-led a $15 million seed funding round with **Lightspeed Venture Partners** for Fremont, Calif.-based AI data startup Observo AI. In March, Felicis led a $17 million seed round for AI agent startup Browser Use.

Larry P. Naughton, an attorney at the law firm of Mintz Levin Cohn Ferris Glovsky & Popeo, said an expected surge in startup deals under the new U.S. administration hasn't materialized. He worked on nearly 10 deals last quarter, he said, roughly on a par with previous quarters in recent years.

Still, hot companies, particularly in the AI field, are whipping up investor interest, he said.

"I think people want to do deals, but they're nervous," Naughton said. "But when a company checks all the boxes, investors can get pretty aggressive to win the deal."

WPP Buys InfoSum As It Pushes Into AI

By Elena Vardon

WPP said it is buying collaboration platform **InfoSum**, marking the advertising group's latest move in a string of deals to bolster its artificial-intelligence capabilities.

The London-listed ad group said Thursday that InfoSum—which will join its media investment group GroupM—will help it create marketing solutions that are enhanced by AI.

InfoSum's cross-cloud data collaboration technology allows companies to connect data sources without moving or exposing data, it said. Chief Executive Lauren Wetzel will remain in the role, WPP added.

"Directly integrating InfoSum's global data network and technology infrastructure will allow our clients to create even more value from their first-party data and enable us to train client AI models against the most data, from the most places, at unprecedented scale and speed," GroupM's CEO Brian Lesser said.

The company said the deal represents a "major investment" in its artificial-intelligence-driven data but didn't disclose financial details.

WPP recently expanded its partnership with Heineken using an in-house AI platform for shopper-marketing activities and invested in Stability AI to leverage its models across image, video, 3D, and audio to improve marketing and advertising campaigns. WPP CEO Mark Read said that the group is already benefiting from its investments in artificial intelligence.

Davos Founder to Exit After Workplace Probe

By Shalini Ramachandran

World Economic Forum founder Klaus Schwab told the staff and the board of trustees that he will step down as chair in the wake of a board investigation into the Davos organizer's workplace culture.

Schwab, who created the Davos gathering and led the forum for five decades, told trustees this week that he will start the process of stepping down. Last May, Klaus stepped aside as the forum's executive chairman but stayed as nonexecutive chair.

Schwab didn't respond to a request for comment about the decision, which was earlier reported by the Financial Times.


MICHAEL BUHOLZER/EPA/SHUTTERSTOCK

Klaus Schwab led the forum for five decades.

In recent weeks, the forum has been shaking up its leadership after the board received the findings of an investigation into the organization's workplace culture.

The investigation was prompted by a Wall Street Journal article last year that revealed allegations by employees of discrimination against women and Black people at the forum, which is based in Geneva.

The forum disputed the Journal's reporting, and Schwab denied the allegations against him. In a recent memo, Børge Brende, the forum's chief executive officer, said the forum would take steps to address leadership issues identified by the probe and that the investigation didn't substantiate the allegations against its founder.

Why Even U.S.-Made Trucks Aren't Safe From Tariffs


CARLOS OSORIO/ASSOCIATED PRESS

Scan this code to watch a video about how automakers will be affected by Trump's tariffs. No vehicle is built from 100% U.S. parts—not even a U.S.-made pickup. WSJ takes a look inside a Ford F-150 to see.

Fashion Startup Investigated

Continued from page B1

"Nobody makes money in apparel," Hunsicker, 47, told investors on the 2023 call. "We have the solution. We make more money for everybody."

Now investors say they have doubts about whether any of CaaStle's supposed success story was true.

In the letter to shareholders, CaaStle's board said no other management team members had been found to be aware of Hunsicker's alleged misconduct. CaaStle Chief Operating Officer George Goldenberg is now serving as interim CEO. He didn't respond to a request for comment.

Most CaaStle employees are currently on furlough. A spokesperson for the U.S. Securities and Exchange Commission said "the SEC does not comment on the existence or nonexistence of a possible investigation."

"The board is deeply disappointed by the conduct that has led to this moment," a spokesman for CaaStle said in a statement. "Our immediate focus is on addressing the company's challenges, supporting our employees, and preserving the value of our technology and business operations. We regret having to temporarily furlough our employees, but we believe this will best position the company to successfully recover from our current situation."

Several fashion startups have tried to wring profit from the business of renting clothing. **Rent the Runway**, which rents and sells work clothes, evening wear, handbags and jewelry, went public in 2021 with a $1.7 billion valuation. The company has over 132,000 active subscribers. For the 12 months ending Oct. 31, 2024, the company's revenue was $305.5 million. It has yet to reach profitability. Its stock price has plummeted since the IPO.

Nuuly, a rental subscription from the retail chain Urban Outfitters, recently reached profitability, after launching in 2019. The company said it had earned $13 million in 2024 and now has 300,000 subscribers, according to an Urban Outfitters earnings report.

Other fashion-rental startups, including the Rotation, Armarium and Seasons, have closed in recent years, buckling under the business's high costs. Pickle, a newer service, allows customers to borrow directly from each other, lowering the company's overhead.

Hunsicker, a seasoned entrepreneur, was a convincing pitchwoman, investors said. She spent the early 2000s and 2010s working in executive positions at tech startups that were acquired by Yahoo and Facebook.

In 2011, she started a rental company, Gwynnie Bee, which initially focused on renting clothes from plus-size fashion brands. Hunsicker used the technology and logistics of Gwynnie Bee to launch CaaStle, which began offering other brands' rentals in 2018. Gwynnie Bee is owned by CaaStle and still operational, according to a company spokesperson. Hunsicker is no longer involved with the company.

She co-founded CaaStle with Jaswinder Pal Singh, a Princeton University computer science professor. Singh didn't respond to a request for comment. The startup worked with mall brands like Ann Taylor, American Eagle and Express. Ralph Lauren, Vince, Maje and Ba&sh became clients, too. Shoppers would pay subscription fees of $69 to $160 a month to rent their clothes, and CaaStle would share the earnings.

"This is a way to keep up with customers' ever-changing, moving lifestyle," Banana Republic's then-CEO Mark Breitbard told CNN in 2019 about its CaaStle partnership.

A spokesperson for Gap, Banana Republic's parent company, said the Banana Republic CaaStle partnership had ended in 2022.

Banana Republic's partnership with CaaStle ended in 2022, the brand's parent, Gap, said.

GABBY JONES/BLOOMBERG NEWS

CaaStle raised $182 million in funding, according to PitchBook, although some investors believe that number is much higher.

Francis McGill, a partner at Ackman's **Pershing Square Capital Management**, confirmed Ackman made a small investment in the company in 2014 and said Ackman owned less than 1% of CaaStle. Peter Fenton told the Journal he did not invest in CaaStle. A representative for CaaStle declined to comment on Fenton. Henry Kravis declined to comment.

John Hennessy, a computer scientist and chairman of the board of Alphabet, didn't respond to requests for comment. Peter Thiel didn't respond for comment.

Cava Capital, a venture-capital firm in Darien, Conn., invested in CaaStle and hosted some shareholder meetings for the company, moderating its Q&A portion of calls. An investor pitch deck made by Cava Capital and reviewed by the Journal said CaaStle had $60 million in sales in 2019, with over 100,000 customers, and that it expected to hit $275 million in revenue in 2022.

22,000

Rental subscribers that CaaStle had, according to two former employees

CaaStle said it was making money from rental companies it owned, like Gwynnie Bee and Haverdash, and from customers' rental payments.

CaaStle is described by Cava Capital as a "business model [that] is highly profitable and has generated exponential growth."

A year later, CaaStle's revenue had ballooned to $521 million, Hunsicker said on a December 2023 call with investors that was hosted by Cava Capital and its partners Geoff Schneider and Bob Geiman. Calls and emails to Cava Capital went unanswered. Schneider and Geiman didn't respond to requests for comment.

At the end of 2024, Hunsicker told shareholders CaaStle had close to $300 million in cash, according to an investor.

Former and current CaaStle employees said the company often struggled to keep fashion brands on board.

A 2023 company review of CaaStle sent to Cava Capital investors said that the startup was in negotiations "with esteemed retailers such as Nordstrom, Net-a-Porter, Bergdorf's and Neiman Marcus."

CaaStle had about 22,000 rental subscribers over the years, two former employees said. The former employees estimated its annual revenue at around $25 million.

When asked about the company's valuation on the December 2023 call with investors, Hunsicker said, "Take the revenue and multiply it by seven."

Hunsicker last year launched a new startup, P180, which buys and invests in fashion companies, with Brendan Hoffman, a former department store executive. The startup recently bought stakes in the fashion brand Vince and the designer label Altuzarra, and had begun working with the fashion e-commerce site Elyse Walker. A spokeswoman said Elyse Walker was no longer working with P180 or CaaStle.

"I am both shocked and saddened by the recent developments at CaaStle," Hoffman said in a statement. "Christine Hunsicker has stepped down as chairman of P180 which operates as an independent entity." Hoffman said P180 and CaaStle operated separately and that their only overlap was in running Vince's rental service.

Cava Capital's website has removed the names of its employees and advisers, including Hunsicker.

The CaaStle website has removed the names of its brand partners. Its careers page is still live. It lists some of the brand's values, including "do the right thing by people" and "connect the dots differently."

BIGGEST 1,000 STOCKS

How to Read the Stock Tables

The following explanations apply to NYSE, NYSE Arca, NYSE American and Nasdaq Stock Market listed securities. Prices are consolidated from trades reported by various market centers, including securities exchanges, Finra, electronic communications networks and other broker-dealers. The list comprises the 1,000 largest companies based on market capitalization.

Underlined quotations are those stocks with large changes in volume compared with the issue's average trading volume.

Boldfaced quotations highlight those issues whose price changed by 5% or more if their previous closing price was $2 or higher.

Footnotes:
▲-New 52-week high; ▼-New 52-week low; **dd**-Indicates loss in the most recent four quarters.

Stock tables reflect composite regular trading as of 4 p.m. ET and changes in the official closing prices from 4 p.m. ET the previous day.

Thursday, April 3, 2025

Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
A B C			
AECOM	ACM	92.73	-3.11
AES	AES	11.90	-0.58
Aflac	AFL	111.75	-0.52
AGNC Invt	AGNC	9.34	-0.14
Ansys	ANSS	310.45	-10.46
APA	**APA**	**17.74**	**-3.50**
ASE Tech	**ASX**	**8.20**	**-0.83**
▼ **ASML**	**ASML**	**623.22**	**-45.79**
▲ AT&T	T	28.60	0.46
AXIS Capital	AXS	98.96	-2.11
AbbottLabs	ABT	131.63	-0.30
AbbVie	ABBV	201.64	-3.55
Accenture	ACN	301.46	-14.87
Acuity	AYI	257.26	-9.14
▼ Adobe	ADBE	367.25	-18.53
▼ **AdvDrainageSys**	**WMS**	**103.17**	**-6.82**
▼ **AdvMicroDevices**	**AMD**	**93.80**	**-9.16**
Aegon	**AEG**	**6.28**	**-0.40**
AerCap	**AER**	**98.65**	**-5.31**
AffirmA	**AFRM**	**38.91**	**-8.84**
▼ **AgilentTechs**	**A**	**109.67**	**-6.32**
▲ AgnicoEagleMines	AEM	108.49	0.96
AgreeRealty	ADC	76.79	0.30
AirProducts	APD	283.20	-11.76
Airbnb	**ABNB**	**113.97**	**-8.83**
AkamaiTech	AKAM	78.78	-2.85
▲ AlamosGold	AGI	26.87	0.36
▼ **Albemarle**	**ALB**	**66.50**	**-5.75**
▲ Albertsons	ACI	22.91	0.48
Alcoa	**AA**	**27.33**	**-3.51**
Alcon	ALC	89.61	-2.98
▼ **AlexandriaRlEst**	**ARE**	**86.25**	**-6.08**
Alibaba	BABA	129.33	-0.46
▼ **AlignTech**	**ALGN**	**154.24**	**-9.74**
Allegion	ALLE	127.21	-4.94
AlliantEnergy	LNT	64.85	0.36
AllisonTransm	**ALSN**	**90.48**	**-8.43**
Allstate	ALL	205.32	-0.11
AllyFinancial	**ALLY**	**33.00**	**-4.02**
AlnylamPharm	ALNY	262.16	-4.67
Alphabet C	GOOG	152.63	-6.23
Alphabet A	GOOGL	150.72	-6.32
Altria	MO	57.89	0.77
Amazon.com	**AMZN**	**178.41**	**-17.60**
Ambev	ABEV	2.42	0.06
Amcor	AMCR	9.57	-0.23
Amdocs	DOX	88.33	-2.79
AmerSports	**AS**	**24.57**	**-3.79**
Ameren	AEE	101.68	0.84
AmericaMovil	AMX	15.01	0.55
▲ AEP	AEP	109.11	1.36
AmerExpress	**AXP**	**247.82**	**-27.43**
AmericanFin	AFG	130.28	-1.84
AmHomes4Rent	AMH	37.18	-0.66
AIG	AIG	86.20	-1.52
AmerTowerREIT	AMT	228.19	10.29
▲ AmerWaterWorks	AWK	151.96	5.77
Ameriprise	**AMP**	**455.81**	**-38.55**
Ametek	**AME**	**161.49**	**-11.23**
Amgen	AMGN	309.85	4.15
Amphenol	**APH**	**62.66**	**-5.24**
▼ **AnalogDevices**	**ADI**	**180.88**	**-18.71**
AngloGoldAsh	AU	36.97	-0.63
AB InBev	BUD	62.90	0.80
AnnalyCap	NLY	19.63	-0.49
AnteroMidstream	AM	17.97	-0.49
AnteroResources	**AR**	**38.79**	**-3.21**
Aon	AON	394.29	-1.74
APi Group	**APG**	**33.91**	**-2.42**
ApolloGlbMgmt	**APO**	**123.45**	**-18.07**
AppFolio	APPF	224.41	-3.22
Apple	**AAPL**	**203.19**	**-20.70**
AppliedIndlTechs	**AIT**	**216.67**	**-19.65**
▼ **ApplMaterials**	**AMAT**	**135.51**	**-12.24**
AppLovin	**APP**	**261.98**	**-28.41**
Aptargroup	ATR	148.67	-1.86
Aptiv	**APTV**	**55.39**	**-5.39**
Aramark	ARMK	34.01	-1.14
ArcelorMittal	**MT**	**26.95**	**-2.12**
ArchCapital	ACGL	96.28	-0.54
ADM	ADM	47.57	-0.40
AresMgmt	**ARES**	**130.59**	**-23.91**
argenx	ARGX	590.06	6.44
AristaNetworks	**ANET**	**71.27**	**-8.89**
Arm	**ARM**	**97.72**	**-10.42**
AscendisPharma	ASND	150.09	-2.06
Assurant	AIZ	203.42	-7.35
AsteraLabs	**ALAB**	**55.68**	**-8.40**
AstraZeneca	AZN	73.92	1.70
Atlassian	**TEAM**	**198.35**	**-25.61**
▲ AtmosEnergy	ATO	155.29	0.08
AuroraInnov	**AUR**	**6.28**	**-0.89**
Autodesk	ADSK	257.15	-10.78
ADP	ADP	305.39	-1.84
▲ AutoZone	AZO	3826.15	16.89
Avalonbay	AVB	205.86	-9.75
Avantor	AVTR	15.67	-0.62
AveryDennison	AVY	176.34	-4.24
AxonEnterprise	AXON	539.69	-18.73
BCE	BCE	22.66	0.84
▼ BHP Group	BHP	46.48	-1.40
▲ BJ'sWholesale	BJ	118.49	3.52
BP	**BP**	**31.34**	**-2.47**
BWX Tech	**BWXT**	**95.42**	**-6.48**
BXP	**BXP**	**62.60**	**-5.22**
Baidu	BIDU	89.80	-2.13
BakerHughes	**BKR**	**40.86**	**-4.06**
Ball	BALL	50.50	-1.81
BBVA	BBVA	13.66	-0.18
BancoBradesco	BBDO	2.09	0.05
BancodeChile	BCH	27.21	0.45
BancSanBrasil	BSBR	4.90	0.10
BcoSantChile	BSAC	23.12	-0.17
BancoSantander	SAN	6.57	-0.28
BanColombia	CIB	42.23	0.17
BankofAmerica	**BAC**	**37.22**	**-4.63**
BankMontreal	BMO	96.05	-1.49
BankNY Mellon	**BK**	**79.91**	**-4.31**
BankNovaScotia	BNS	48.37	0.85
Barclays	**BCS**	**14.31**	**-1.43**
BarrickGold	GOLD	19.38	-0.03
BaxterIntl	**BAX**	**31.35**	**-2.30**
BeaconRoofing	BECN	123.64	-0.16
BectonDicknsn	BDX	221.59	-4.83
BeiGene	ONC	264.32	-10.46
BellRing	BRBR	73.79	-3.09
BentleySystems	BSY	40.22	-0.91
Berkley	WRB	70.29	0.54
BerkHathwy B	BRK.B	530.16	-7.56
BerkHathwy A	BRK.A	794514	-12170
BerryGlobal	BERY	68.81	-1.74
▼ **BestBuy**	**BBY**	**62.22**	**-13.51**
Bilibili	BILI	19.13	-0.20
▼ **Bio-Techne**	**TECH**	**54.86**	**-3.52**
Biogen	BIIB	130.71	-0.61
BioMarinPharm	BMRN	67.48	-0.84
BioNTech	BNTX	92.01	-1.31
Birkenstock	**BIRK**	**44.63**	**-2.57**
BlackRock	**BLK**	**887.65**	**-74.19**
Blackstone	**BX**	**133.10**	**-14.56**
Block	**XYZ**	**53.97**	**-3.89**
BlueOwlCapital	**OWL**	**17.91**	**-3.25**
Boeing	**BA**	**150.91**	**-17.65**
Booking	**BKNG**	**4450.53**	**-238.77**
BoozAllen	BAH	111.74	-1.09
BostonSci	BSX	98.50	-1.55
BristolMyers	BMY	57.82	-1.78
BritishAmTob	BTI	41.92	1.67
BrixmorProp	**BRX**	**24.97**	**-1.74**
Broadcom	**AVGO**	**154.01**	**-18.08**
BroadridgeFinl	BR	239.91	-6.34
BrookfieldAsset	**BAM**	**47.06**	**-3.75**
Brookfield	**BN**	**50.35**	**-4.03**
BrookfieldInfr	BIP	29.64	-0.65
BrookfieldRenew	BEPC	28.28	-0.19
BrookWealth	**BNT**	**50.41**	**-3.81**
Brown&Brown	BRO	124.43	0.20
Brown-Forman B	BF.B	32.91	-1.60
Brown-Forman A	BF.A	32.41	-1.49
▼ **BuildersFirst**	**BLDR**	**119.82**	**-11.30**
BungeGlobal	BG	78.20	0.19
BurlingtonStrs	**BURL**	**235.66**	**-19.43**
CACI Intl	CACI	392.06	0.80
CAVA	**CAVA**	**84.18**	**-6.17**
CBRE Group	**CBRE**	**123.84**	**-9.45**
▼ **CDW**	**CDW**	**151.57**	**-12.90**
CF Industries	CF	79.86	0.03
CGI A	GIB	100.34	-1.76
CH Robinson	**CHRW**	**94.77**	**-8.05**
▲ CME Group	CME	268.36	5.82
▲ CMS Energy	CMS	75.51	0.85
CNA Fin	CNA	50.73	-0.08
CNH Indl	**CNH**	**11.27**	**-1.07**
CRH	CRH	86.35	-4.28
▼ **CSX**	**CSX**	**27.99**	**-1.75**
CVS Health	CVS	67.51	-0.56
CadenceDesign	**CDNS**	**248.91**	**-16.03**
CAE	CAE	23.56	-1.11
CamdenProperty	CPT	118.89	-3.91
Cameco	CCJ	40.91	-1.56
Campbell's	CPB	39.82	0.82
CIBC	CM	58.94	1.05
CanNtlRlwy	CNI	98.21	-2.03
CanadianNatRscs	**CNQ**	**29.86**	**-1.58**
CdnPacKC	CP	70.48	-1.98
CapitalOne	**COF**	**164.04**	**-18.14**
▲ CardinalHealth	CAH	137.09	-1.58
Carlisle	**CSL**	**327.10**	**-21.13**
Carlyle	**CG**	**38.71**	**-7.60**
CarMax	**KMX**	**76.46**	**-6.31**
Carnival	**CCL**	**17.28**	**-2.74**
Carnival	**CUK**	**15.63**	**-2.38**
CarpenterTech	**CRS**	**166.54**	**-20.81**
CarrierGlobal	**CARR**	**60.72**	**-4.32**
Carvana	**CVNA**	**181.79**	**-44.53**
▲ CaseysGenStores	CASY	449.17	5.29
▼ **Caterpillar**	**CAT**	**305.76**	**-28.90**
Celestica	**CLS**	**69.19**	**-13.16**
CelsiusHldg	CELH	36.00	-0.75
Cemex	CX	5.56	-0.13
▲ Cencora	COR	289.36	9.85
CenovusEnergy	**CVE**	**12.89**	**-1.15**
Centene	**CNC**	**64.29**	**3.56**
▲ CenterPointEner	CNP	37.36	0.43
CentraisElBras	EBR	7.33	0.21
CharterComms	CHTR	368.40	-10.87
CheckPoint	CHKP	224.02	-3.99
Chemed	CHE	619.21	4.53
CheniereEnergy	**LNG**	**220.07**	**-14.55**
CheniereEnerPtrs	**CQP**	**64.23**	**-3.76**
Chevron	**CVX**	**156.12**	**-10.35**
Chewy	CHWY	33.67	-0.33
Chipotle	CMG	50.08	-1.94
▲ Chubb	CB	302.46	0.92
ChunghwaTel	CHT	39.68	0.41
Church&Dwight	CHD	110.76	2.44
ChurchillDowns	CHDN	109.02	-2.77
Ciena	**CIEN**	**56.19**	**-8.84**
Cigna	CI	338.45	6.53
CincinnatiFinl	CINF	144.70	-2.89
Cintas	CTAS	204.85	-3.82
CiscoSystems	**CSCO**	**57.31**	**-4.10**
Citigroup	**C**	**63.05**	**-8.71**
CitizensFin	**CFG**	**36.22**	**-5.44**
CleanHarbors	CLH	198.51	-7.42
Clorox	CLX	148.69	1.07
Cloudflare	**NET**	**107.39**	**-12.16**
▲ Coca-Cola	KO	73.18	1.85
CocaColaCon	COKE	1390.94	-8.19
▲ CocaColaEuropac	CCEP	89.82	2.41
CognizantTech	CTSH	73.27	-3.46
Coherent	**COHR**	**53.91**	**-13.63**
CoinbaseGlbl	**COIN**	**170.76**	**-12.19**
ColgatePalm	CL	96.00	2.45
Comcast A	CMCSA	35.72	-0.89
Comerica	**CMA**	**53.27**	**-5.97**
ComfortSystems	**FIX**	**311.37**	**-30.91**
CommerceBcshrs	**CBSH**	**57.64**	**-4.66**
▲ SABESP	SBS	18.69	0.77
ConagraBrands	CAG	26.78	0.40
Confluent	**CFLT**	**21.20**	**-2.91**
ConocoPhillips	**COP**	**95.25**	**-10.85**
▲ ConEd	ED	112.72	3.14
ConstBrands A	STZ	181.49	-1.24
ConstellationEner	**CEG**	**190.24**	**-24.22**
Cooper	COO	78.17	-3.06
Copart	CPRT	56.64	-0.83
CorceptTherap	**CORT**	**79.37**	**-4.44**
Core&Main	**CNM**	**47.19**	**-3.77**
CorebridgeFin	**CRBG**	**28.63**	**-3.27**
CoreWeave	**CRWV**	**53.80**	**-7.56**
Corning	**GLW**	**42.29**	**-4.25**
Corpay	**CPAY**	**317.63**	**-40.89**
Corteva	CTVA	61.30	-2.70
CoStar	CSGP	76.35	-3.57
Costco	COST	967.08	2.00
CoterraEnergy	**CTRA**	**27.36**	**-1.63**
Coupang	CPNG	21.46	-1.03
Crane	**CR**	**145.87**	**-11.71**
Credicorp	BAP	189.23	-4.37
CrowdStrike	**CRWD**	**347.39**	**-24.10**
CrownCastle	CCI	107.06	3.25
Crown Holdings	CCK	88.72	-1.50
CubeSmart	CUBE	41.09	-0.90
Cullen/Frost	**CFR**	**111.71**	**-13.05**
Cummins	**CMI**	**295.35**	**-24.64**
Curtiss-Wright	**CW**	**302.91**	**-22.86**
CyberArkSoftware	**CYBR**	**327.96**	**-17.73**
D E F			
▲ DTE Energy	DTE	139.49	1.49
DT Midstream	DTM	94.61	-4.89
Danaher	DHR	197.90	-7.26
Darden	DRI	200.68	-8.89
▼ **Datadog**	**DDOG**	**94.47**	**-7.24**
DaVita	DVA	153.73	-0.56
Dayforce	**DAY**	**56.26**	**-3.04**
▼ **DeckersOutdoor**	**DECK**	**100.88**	**-17.10**
Deere	DE	447.45	-23.45
▼ **DellTechC**	**DELL**	**77.23**	**-18.10**
DeltaAir	**DAL**	**38.71**	**-4.66**
DescartesSystems	DSGX	100.67	-3.34
DeutscheBank	**DB**	**22.88**	**-1.46**
DevonEnergy	**DVN**	**33.16**	**-4.76**
▼ **DexCom**	**DXCM**	**61.80**	**-6.34**
Diageo	DEO	108.01	1.53
DiamondbkEner	**FANG**	**141.28**	**-20.21**
▼ **Dick's**	**DKS**	**184.97**	**-26.35**
DigitalRealty	**DLR**	**141.09**	**-7.59**
DiscoverFinSvcs	**DFS**	**161.26**	**-14.68**
Disney	**DIS**	**88.84**	**-9.04**
DocuSign	**DOCU**	**77.37**	**-6.03**
DolbyLab	DLB	77.64	-3.57
DollarGeneral	DG	94.41	4.21
DollarTree	**DLTR**	**67.22**	**-10.35**
DominionEner	D	56.25	0.02
Domino's	DPZ	463.78	-4.57

Continued on Page B8

New Highs and Lows

The following explanations apply to the New York Stock Exchange, NYSE Arca, NYSE American and Nasdaq Stock Market stocks that hit a new 52-week intraday high or low in the latest session. **% CHG**-Daily percentage change from the previous trading session.

Thursday, April 3, 2025

Stock	Sym	52-Wk Hi/Lo	% Chg
Highs			
AI Transportation	AITR	11.00	...
AT&T	T	29.03	1.6
AgnicoEagleMines	AEM	111.04	0.9
AimfinityUn	AIMBU	16.00	1.7
AlamosGold	AGI	27.32	1.4
Albertsons	ACI	23.20	2.1
AlignmentHlthcr	ALHC	18.97	3.7
AEP	AEP	110.46	1.3
AmerHlthcrREIT	AHR	31.61	-1.3
AmerWaterWorks	AWK	154.06	3.9
AnbioBiotechnology	NNNN	7.82	3.9
AscentagePharma	AAPG	24.02	0.3
AtlanticusNts26	ATLCL	24.56	...
AtmosEnergy	ATO	157.62	0.1
AutoZone	AZO	3916.81	0.4
Avista	AVA	43.09	-0.1
BJ'sWholesale	BJ	118.99	3.1
BaselMedical	BMGL	5.48	2.3
CME Group	CME	271.22	2.2
CMS Energy	CMS	76.45	1.1
CantorEqPtrsI	CEPO	10.34	0.6
CardinalHealth	CAH	139.50	-1.1
CaseysGenStores	CASY	458.92	1.2
Cencora	COR	291.83	3.5
CenterPointEner	CNP	37.70	1.2
ChengheAcqnIIA	CHEB	10.36	0.7
Chubb	CB	306.91	0.3
ClearwayEnergyC	CWEN	31.09	0.6
ClearwayEnergyA	CWEN.A	29.23	0.2
Coca-Cola	KO	73.95	2.6
CocaColaEuropac	CCEP	91.29	2.8
SABESP	SBS	18.95	4.3
CerveceriasUnid	CCU	15.67	2.9
ConEd	ED	113.45	2.9
CrescentCapBDC5%	FCRX	24.99	0.6
DRDGOLD	DRD	15.92	-0.1
DTE Energy	DTE	140.39	1.1
DukeEnergy	DUK	124.67	3.0
EPWK	EPWK	5.40	2.5
Enbridge	ENB	46.12	0.4
Evergy	EVRG	70.30	-0.3
Exelon	EXC	47.60	2.7
Fortis	FTS	48.07	2.5
Franco-Nevada	FNV	161.36	1.1
FreseniusMedCare	FMS	25.96	3.8
Gallagher	AJG	350.70	0.1
HennessyCapVI	HCVIU	17.48	25.2
HennessyCapVI	HCVI	13.79	7.6
IDACORP	IDA	120.84	0.5
Junee	JUNE	12.50	2.2
Kroger	KR	70.95	5.2
LaunchOneAcqnA	LPAA	10.26	-0.1
LianheSowell	LHSW	8.18	7.3
M3-BrigadeAcqnVWt	MBAVW	0.30	...
Marsh&McLen	MMC	246.53	0.6
McKesson	MCK	725.00	3.4
MonsterBev	MNST	60.34	0.5
NorthWesternEner	NWE	59.52	-1.4
OGE Energy	OGE	46.91	-0.8
O'ReillyAuto	ORLY	1458.37	1.8
OldPointFinl	OPOF	37.32	23.1
OrientalCulture	OCG	3.58	-7.1
OrlaMining	ORLA	9.65	-0.9
OsiskoGold	OR	21.42	-0.2
PPL	PPL	36.64	0.3
Palomar	PLMR	143.77	1.0
PhilipMorris	PM	163.08	3.8
PinnacleWest	PNW	96.50	-0.2
QuartzseaAcqn	QSEAU	10.12	...
RadiusRecycling	RDUS	29.20	...
RepublicSvcs	RSG	249.73	1.5
Rollins	ROL	56.26	2.1
RomanDBDR II	DRDB	10.06	0.3
RomanDBDRII Wt	DRDBW	0.39	23.3
RoyalGold	RGLD	169.00	1.6
RyanSpecialty	RYAN	77.16	1.2
SIMAcqnIWt	SIMAW	0.17	44.2
SafeBulkersPfdC	SBpC	26.50	-0.7
SilaRealty	SILA	27.42	-0.8
SmartStop	SMA	33.40	1.1
SolenoTherap	SLNO	74.00	-2.0
Spire	SR	79.81	0.3
TakedaPharm	TAK	15.37	1.4
Tradeweb	TW	152.65	0.4
Ventas	VTR	71.36	0.3
VeriSign	VRSN	258.67	...
VeriskAnalytics	VRSK	306.68	1.8
WEC Energy	WEC	111.00	-0.3
WasteConnections	WCN	201.66	1.7
WasteMgt	WM	239.32	1.0
WheatonPrecMtls	WPM	80.43	1.1
Lows			
AAR	AIR	53.15	-7.0
ACCO Brands	ACCO	3.99	-6.1
ADC Therap	ADCT	1.22	-7.5
AGCO	AGCO	81.98	-11.2
AGNC InvPfdC	AGNCN	25.01	-0.7
AIM Immuno	AIM	0.11	-2.7
AIX	AIFU	0.17	-7.6
AlxOncology	ALXO	0.53	-10.5
AMC Networks	AMCX	6.21	-10.1
AMN Healthcare	AMN	21.30	-6.7
AMTD Digital	HKD	2.01	-5.0
A-MarkPrecMet	AMRK	22.10	-8.2
ASGN	ASGN	60.61	-3.6
ASML	ASML	622.82	-6.8
AT&T PfdA	TpA	20.01	-0.5
Abercrombie&Fitch	ANF	68.47	-15.7
Abits	ABTS	2.05	-15.4
Abpro	ABP	0.36	-12.0
Absci	ABSI	2.23	-9.9
AcaciaResearch	ACTG	3.04	-9.3
AcademySports	ASO	38.88	-17.7
AchieveLifeSci	ACHV	2.34	-5.1
AcrivonTherap	ACRV	1.53	-5.7
AcumenPharm	ABOS	0.98	-8.5
AcurxPharm	ACXP	0.32	-8.1
AdicetBio	ACET	0.67	-7.3
Adient	ADNT	11.69	-6.6
Adobe	ADBE	366.29	-4.8
AdvDrainageSys	WMS	101.59	-6.2
AdvEnergyInds	AEIS	83.16	-13.1
AdvMicroDevices	AMD	93.64	-8.9
AdvanSix	ASIX	20.73	-7.9
AdvantageSolns	ADV	1.30	-9.7
AehrTestSys	AEHR	6.84	-12.7
Aemetis	AMTX	1.47	-7.3
AeriesTechWt	AERTW	0.01	-15.3
AffiliatedMgrDeb	MGR	20.83	-1.5
AffiliatedNts60	MGRB	17.00	-1.1
AffiliatedNts64	MGRE	23.70	-0.7
Affimed	AFMD	0.63	-11.2
AgEagleAerial	UAVS	1.11	-9.0
AgilentTechs	A	109.57	-5.4
Agilysys	AGYS	69.53	-4.4
AirSculptTech	AIRS	1.84	-6.0
Akoya	AKYA	1.22	-10.3
AlbanyIntl	AIN	64.63	-8.1
Albemarle	ALB	66.15	-8.0
AlbemarlePfdA	ALBpA	33.83	-5.8
AldeyraTherap	ALDX	1.14	-73.3
Alector	ALEC	1.09	-7.6
AlerusFinancial	ALRS	17.16	-6.8
AlexandriaRlEst	ARE	86.00	-6.6
AlgomaSteel	ASTL	5.06	-9.2
Alight	ALIT	5.27	-10.4
AlignTech	ALGN	150.80	-5.9
AligosTherap	ALGS	6.42	-14.5
AllstatePfdI	ALLpI	19.01	-1.6
AllstatePfdH	ALLpH	20.52	-1.4
AllstatePfdJ	ALLpJ	26.00	-0.2
AlphaMetal	AMR	114.50	-7.2
AltaEquipment	ALTG	4.01	-16.8
Altimmune	ALT	4.43	-6.7
AltoIngred	ALTO	1.01	-8.0
AltoNeurosci	ANRO	1.85	-9.8
AmbacFin	AMBC	7.75	-5.2
AmerantBncp	AMTB	18.32	-12.2
AmericanAssets	AAT	19.27	-5.0
AmericanAxle	AXL	3.55	-9.6
AmerEagle	AEO	10.19	-17.5
AmFinDeb2059	AFGB	21.50	-1.2
AmerFinDeb2059	AFGC	19.04	-1.9
AmericanRscs	AREC	0.41	-6.3
AmerVanguard	AVD	3.94	-4.7
AmericanWoodmark	AMWD	53.99	-8.4
AmericoldRealty	COLD	20.07	-5.0
AmicusTherap	FOLD	7.72	0.1
AmkorTech	AMKR	15.84	-14.9
AmplifyEnergy	AMPY	3.25	-11.9
AmtechSystems	ASYS	4.55	-3.7
AnalogDevices	ADI	180.40	-9.4
Angi	ANGI	12.53	-6.4
AnikaTherap	ANIK	14.51	-2.4
AnnovisBio	ANVS	1.40	-11.3
AntelopeEnterprise	AEHL	0.05	-7.9
ApogeeEnt	APOG	44.77	-5.3
ApolloGlbNts53	APOS	25.49	-1.1
AppleHospREIT	APLE	11.59	-9.3
ApplMaterials	AMAT	135.40	-8.3
AppliedTherap	APLT	0.40	-7.0
ApreaTherap	APRE	1.74	-3.7
ArbeRobotics	ARBE	0.97	-4.7
ArcBest	ARCB	63.51	-11.8
ArchCapitalPfdF	ACGLO	20.34	-1.2
ArchCapitalPfdG	ACGLN	17.08	-1.2
ArcturusTherap	ARCT	9.18	-7.0
ArcusBiosci	RCUS	7.14	-9.1
AresCommRealEst	ACRE	4.24	-4.5
AresMgmtPfdB	ARESpB	42.83	-12.4
Arhaus	ARHS	7.02	-20.0
ArloTech	ARLO	8.34	-11.6
ArmadaHoffler	AHH	6.81	-6.0
ArmataPharm	ARMP	1.15	1.5
ArmourResREIT	ARR	16.25	-2.0
Arq	ARQ	3.89	-6.9
ArrayTech	ARRY	4.35	-10.3
ArrowElec	ARW	95.95	-8.6
ArrowheadPharm	ARWR	11.60	-5.0
ArteloBiosci	ARTL	0.85	-3.0
ArtisanPtrsAsset	APAM	36.40	-8.0
ArtivaBiotherap	ARTV	2.50	-11.2
Arvinas	ARVN	6.75	-3.9
Ashland	ASH	52.98	-8.3
AspenAerogels	ASPN	5.46	-12.5
AspenInsPfd	AHLpF	24.41	-2.0
AspenInsPfd	AHLpD	18.60	-1.9
Assertio	ASRT	0.65	1.5
AstriaTherap	ATXS	5.05	-6.7
AthenePfdB	ATHpB	19.26	-1.3
AthenePfdD	ATHpD	16.69	-1.3
AthiraPharma	ATHA	0.25	-7.5
Atkore	ATKR	54.90	-10.6
AtlUnionBkshs	AUB	27.26	-11.0
AtlasEnergy	AESI	15.71	-14.1
AtlasClear	ATCH	0.49	-1.8
AtossaTherap	ATOS	0.63	-6.6
AuraBiosciences	AURA	5.51	-3.9
Autoliv	ALV	84.61	-6.2
AvadelPharm	AVDL	7.07	-3.5
AvanosMedical	AVNS	13.82	-3.4
Avient	AVNT	32.47	-14.2
AvitaMedical	RCEL	7.44	-3.8
Avnet	AVT	44.29	-8.2
AxcelisTechs	ACLS	44.79	-12.1
AytuBioPharma	AYTU	1.07	-7.0
Azenta	AZTA	31.09	-11.6
BHP Group	BHP	46.10	-2.9
BILL	BILL	40.86	-8.8
BitMining	BTCM	1.58	-8.7
Babcock&Wilcox	BW	0.40	-17.7
BabcockWilcoxPfdA	BWpA	6.54	-6.6
Backblaze	BLZE	4.54	-5.8
BaiyaIntl	BIYA	3.10	-28.9
Bandwidth	BAND	12.26	-6.7
BankofAmPfd1	BMLpG	21.65	-1.5
BankofAmPfdLL	BACpN	20.81	-1.2
BkofAmericaPfdNN	BACpO	18.10	-0.9
BankofAmPfdPP	BACpP	17.22	-1.0
BankofAmPfdSS	BACpS	19.77	-0.7
BankofAmPfdQQ	BACpQ	17.70	-0.8
BNYM Pfd K	BKpK	[illegible]	[illegible]
Bausch+Lomb	BLCO	[illegible]	[illegible]
BeamGlobal	BEEM	[illegible]	[illegible]
BeamTherap	BEAM	[illegible]	[illegible]
BeasleyBroadcast	BBGI	[illegible]	[illegible]
BeazerHomes	BZH	[illegible]	[illegible]
BelFuse A	BELFA	[illegible]	[illegible]
[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]	[illegible]
BestBuy	BBY	[illegible]	[illegible]
DrugsMadeInAmRt	DMAAR	0.09	-11.0
DuPont	DD	67.21	-9.9
ECDAutoDesign	ECDA	0.54	-7.7
EDAP TMS	EDAP	1.71	2.1
elfBeauty	ELF	54.38	-19.0
EPAM Systems	EPAM	152.71	-8.0
ESSTech	GWH	2.40	-6.2
E2open	ETWO	1.86	-7.7
EastmanChem	EMN	79.82	-9.4
IngramMicro	INGM	16.85	-7.5
Innospec	IOSP	88.25	-7.5
InnovAge	INNV	2.77	-6.1
InnovativeEyewr	LUCY	2.27	-10.2
InnovizTechWt	INVZW	0.04	-11.4
Innventure	INV	3.91	-29.4
InozymePharma	INZY	0.82	-5.5
InpointCmclREPfdA	ICRpA	16.52	-7.5
InsightEnt	NSIT	130.00	-7.2
NaviosMaritime	NMM	35.00	-12.0
NavitasSemi	NVTS	1.60	-16.0
NektarTherap	NKTR	0.58	-8.9
NeoGenomics	NEO	8.69	-7.4
NeOncTech	NTHI	6.10	36.9
NerdWallet	NRDS	8.52	-9.5
NetApp	NTAP	81.56	-9.8
NeumoraTherap	NMRA	0.84	-9.7
Neuraxis	NRXS	1.79	-9.3
QuiptHomeMed	QIPT	2.15	-2.2
QuoinPharm	QNRX	0.21	-11.1
RBB Bancorp	RBB	15.44	-6.5
RH	RH	138.40	-40.1
RLJLodgingPfdA	RLJpA	24.06	0.3
RLJ Lodging	RLJ	6.99	-10.7
RMR Group	RMR	15.89	-1.4
RPC	RES	4.89	-14.0
RXO	RXO	15.67	-19.3
TROOPS	TROO	0.71	-14.8
T.RowePrice	TROW	85.74	-8.2
Taitron	TAIT	2.26	-3.0
TandemDiabetes	TNDM	17.28	-6.5
Tantech	TANH	1.81	-4.0
Taoping	TAOP	0.23	-7.8
Target	TGT	93.00	-10.9
TechTarget	TTGT	9.36	-25.0
TeckResourcesB	TECK	33.82	-9.4

Dividend Changes

Company	Symbol	Yld %	Amount New/Old	Frq	Payable / Record
Increased					
Bank OZK	OZK	4.3	.43 / .42	Q	Apr21 / Apr14
UMH Properties	UMH	4.8	.225 / .215	Q	Jun16 / May15
Stocks					
Amarin ADR	AMRN		1:20		/Apr11
Antelope Enterprise	AEHL		1:40		/Apr04
C3is	CISS		1:6		/Apr04
Future FinTech Group	FTFT		1:10		/Apr04
HCW Biologics	HCWB		1:40		/Apr14
Highest Performances ADR	HPH		1:20		/Apr08
Kazia Therapeutics ADR	KZIA		1:5		/Apr17
SOBR Safe	SOBR		1:10		/Apr04
Foreign					
Argo Group 6.5% Nts 2042	ARGD	7.8	.40625	Q	Jun16 / Jun01
Cent Ele Brasil pfd. ADR	EBR.B	7.9	.0195	A	May20 / Apr30
Costamare	CMRE	4.8	.115	Q	May06 / Apr17
Costamare Pfd. B	CMREpB	7.5	.47656	Q	Apr15 / Apr14
Costamare Pfd. C	CMREpC	8.1	.53125	Q	Apr15 / Apr14
Costamare Pfd. E	CMREpE	8.3	.54688	Q	Apr15 / Apr14
Diana Ship 8.875 Pfd B	DSXpB	8.5	.5547	Q	Apr15 / Apr14
Grupo Aval Acciones ADR	AVAL	3.4	.01109	M	Apr17 / Apr11
Maiden Hldgs Nts 2043	MHNC	11.7	.48438	Q	Jun02 / May15
Safe Bulkers 8% Pfd. C	SBpC	7.9	.50	Q	Apr30 / Apr17
Safe Bulkers Pfd. D	SBpD	7.8	.50	Q	Apr30 / Apr17

Note: Dividend yields as of 3:30 p.m. ET

Sources: FactSet; Dow Jones Market Data

KEY: A: annual; M: monthly; Q: quarterly; r: revised; SA: semiannual; S2:1: stock split and ratio; SO: spin-off.

MARKETS DIGEST

EQUITIES

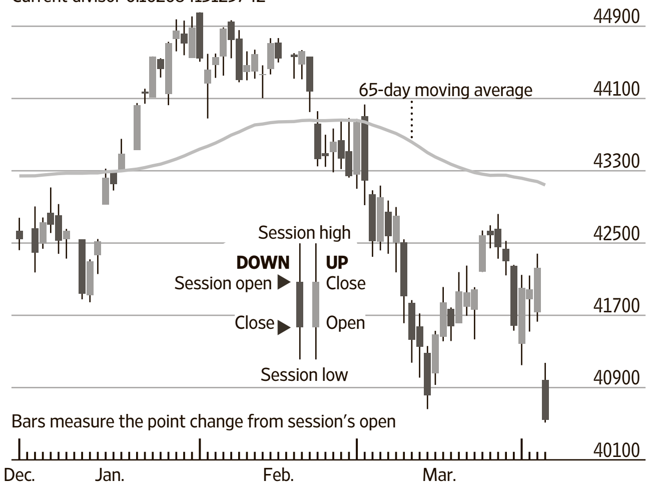
Dow Jones Industrial Average

40545.93 ▼1679.39, or 3.98%

High, low, open and close for each trading day of the past three months.

	Last	Year ago
Trailing P/E ratio	24.31	26.78
P/E estimate *	19.69	19.16
Dividend yield	1.75	2.17
All-time high	45014.04, 12/04/24	

Current divisor 0.16268413125742

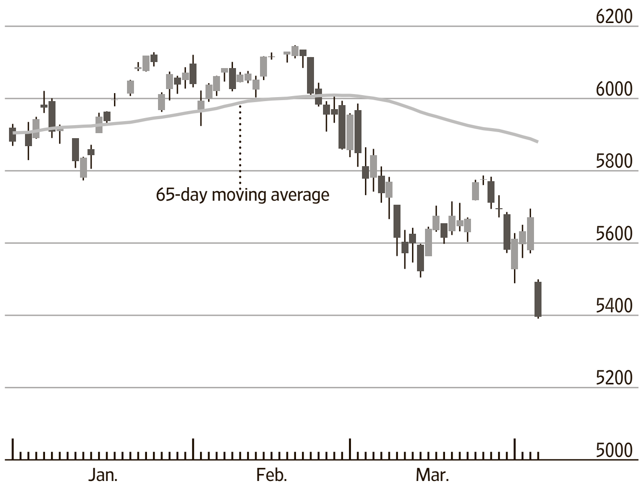


S&P 500 Index

5396.52 ▼274.45, or 4.84%

High, low, open and close for each trading day of the past three months.

	Last	Year ago
Trailing P/E ratio *	23.15	24.36
P/E estimate *	21.10	21.58
Dividend yield *	1.34	1.40
All-time high	6144.15, 02/19/25	

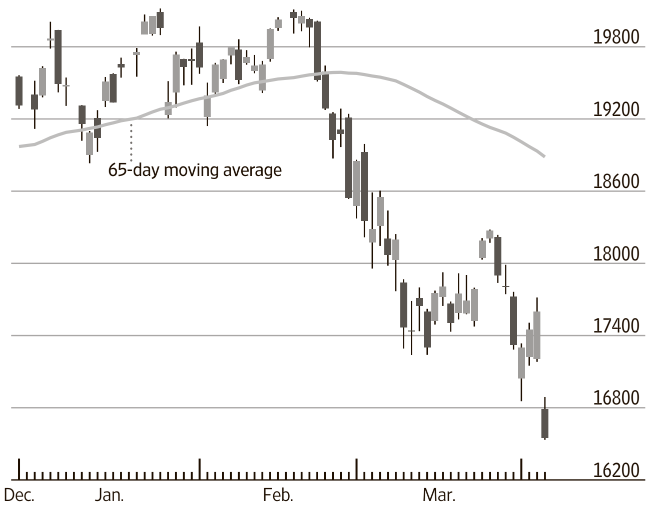


Nasdaq Composite Index

16550.61 ▼ 1050.44, or 5.97%

High, low, open and close for each trading day of the past three months.

	Last	Year ago
Trailing P/E ratio *†	29.27	31.15
P/E estimate *†	25.25	27.98
Dividend yield *†	0.78	0.81
All-time high:	20173.89, 12/16/24	



*Weekly P/E data based on as-reported earnings from Birinyi Associates Inc.; †Based on Nasdaq-100 Index

Major U.S. Stock-Market Indexes

	Latest High	Latest Low	Latest Close	Net chg	% chg	52-Week High	52-Week Low	52-Week % chg	% chg YTD	% chg 3-yr. ann.
Dow Jones										
Industrial Average	41173.62	40513.11	**40545.93**	-1679.39	**-3.98**	45014.04	37735.11	**5.0**	-4.7	**5.2**
Transportation Avg	14574.06	13574.38	**13621.34**	-1371.64	**-9.15**	17754.38	13621.34	**-13.8**	-14.3	**-4.2**
Utility Average	1041.67	1024.83	**1026.49**	-3.75	**-0.36**	1079.88	835.53	**17.8**	4.5	**-1.0**
Total Stock Market	54264.75	53131.05	**53180.45**	-2859.52	**-5.10**	61024.05	49376.46	**3.7**	-8.9	**4.9**
Barron's 400	1173.69	1138.82	**1139.44**	-72.41	**-5.98**	1356.99	1092.05	**0.1**	-9.0	**3.8**
Nasdaq Stock Market										
Nasdaq Composite	16889.34	16533.04	**16550.61**	-1050.44	**-5.97**	20173.89	15282.01	**3.1**	-14.3	**5.1**
Nasdaq-100	18902.07	18502.97	**18521.48**	-1060.30	**-5.41**	22175.60	17037.65	**3.6**	-11.9	**7.6**
S&P										
500 Index	5499.53	5390.83	**5396.52**	-274.45	**-4.84**	6144.15	4967.23	**4.8**	-8.2	**5.9**
MidCap 400	2907.89	2781.41	**2783.05**	-198.63	**-6.66**	3390.26	2783.05	**-6.1**	-10.8	**0.9**
SmallCap 600	1260.26	1206.14	**1206.84**	-92.72	**-7.13**	1544.66	1206.84	**-7.4**	-14.3	**-3.2**
Other Indexes										
Russell 2000	1981.67	1909.70	**1910.55**	-134.82	**-6.59**	2442.03	1910.55	**-7.0**	-14.3	**-3.0**
NYSE Composite	19532.74	18758.31	**18767.19**	-765.56	**-3.92**	20272.04	17388.09	**4.4**	-1.7	**3.8**
Value Line	577.90	541.15	**541.20**	-36.70	**-6.35**	656.04	541.20	**-9.7**	-11.4	**-5.4**
NYSE Arca Biotech	5753.36	5602.28	**5609.48**	-143.88	**-2.50**	6318.63	4861.76	**8.9**	-2.4	**2.3**
NYSE Arca Pharma	977.46	953.69	**954.21**	-7.37	**-0.77**	1140.17	912.71	**-4.2**	2.1	**4.3**
KBW Bank	120.27	111.50	**111.63**	-12.20	**-9.86**	140.59	96.78	**10.0**	-12.4	**-3.1**
PHLX§ Gold/Silver	178.35	171.44	**174.86**	-3.06	**-1.72**	178.66	131.01	**31.8**	27.5	**2.3**
PHLX§ Oil Service	63.97	59.80	**59.90**	-7.91	**-11.67**	95.07	59.90	**-36.4**	-17.5	**-9.8**
PHLX§ Semiconductor	4131.82	3889.62	**3893.69**	-427.06	**-9.88**	5904.54	3893.69	**-18.1**	-21.8	**5.0**
Cboe Volatility	30.02	24.93	**30.02**	8.51	39.56	38.57	11.86	**83.6**	73.0	**15.2**

§Nasdaq PHLX

Sources: FactSet; Dow Jones Market Data

Late Trading

Most-active and biggest movers among NYSE, NYSE Arca, NYSE Amer. and Nasdaq issues from 4 p.m. to 6 p.m. ET as reported by electronic trading services, securities dealers and regional exchanges. Minimum share price of $2 and minimum after-hours volume of 50,000 shares.

Most-active issues in late trading

Company	Symbol	Volume (000)	After Hours Last	Net chg	% chg	High	Low
SPDR S&P 500 ETF Trust	SPY	13,734.0	536.55	-0.15	**-0.03**	561.10	519.87
NVIDIA	NVDA	7,494.1	102.63	0.83	**0.82**	106.36	97.21
Direxion Dly SCOND 3 BL	SOXL	7,422.5	11.70	0.29	**2.54**	11.70	11.26
SPDR Ptf Interm Corp Bd	SPIB	5,581.5	33.29	0.01	**0.03**	33.32	32.88
Intel	INTC	5,109.3	22.55	0.12	**0.53**	22.60	22.30
Pfizer	PFE	4,359.1	24.30	0.01	**0.04**	24.62	24.24
ProShares UltraPro QQQ	TQQQ	4,070.7	50.13	-0.17	**-0.34**	50.45	49.64
iShares Russell 2000 ETF	IWM	3,536.9	189.55	-0.10	**-0.05**	191.45	188.89

Percentage gainers...

Company	Symbol	Volume (000)	Last	Net chg	% chg	High	Low
Vishay Intertechnology	VSH	124.8	13.16	0.71	**5.70**	13.16	12.45
Cencora	COR	121.4	303.82	14.46	**5.00**	303.82	285.07
Adaptive Biotechnologies	ADPT	505.0	7.78	0.37	**4.99**	7.78	7.04
Vizsla Silver	VZLA	69.1	2.24	0.09	**4.19**	2.24	2.15
Leggett & Platt	LEG	75.3	7.74	0.31	**4.17**	7.74	7.38

...And losers

Company	Symbol	Volume (000)	Last	Net chg	% chg	High	Low
MDU Resources Group	MDU	61.8	15.87	-0.92	**-5.48**	16.79	15.87
HDFC Bank ADR	HDB	1,189.7	63.65	-3.32	**-4.95**	66.96	63.65
Royalty Pharma	RPRX	84.2	30.55	-1.24	**-3.90**	31.99	30.55
Barclays ADR	BCS	73.2	13.79	-0.52	**-3.63**	14.55	13.70
Apellis Pharmaceuticals	APLS	475.7	21.80	-0.72	**-3.20**	22.52	21.80

Trading Diary

Volume, Advancers, Decliners

	NYSE	NYSE Amer.
Total volume*	1,523,548,306	15,110,869
Adv. volume*	180,754,268	2,334,435
Decl. volume*	1,338,872,383	11,295,962
Issues traded	2,838	298
Advances	362	63
Declines	2,446	225
Unchanged	30	10
New highs	53	2
New lows	547	1
Closing Arms†	1.09	1.50
Block trades*	6,970	167

	Nasdaq	NYSE Arca
Total volume*	9,461,339,421	571,783,791
Adv. volume*	2,725,141,097	114,872,155
Decl. volume*	6,718,555,302	456,698,718
Issues traded	4,555	2,205
Advances	743	456
Declines	3,738	1,743
Unchanged	74	6
New highs	54	33
New lows	856	377
Closing Arms†	0.49	0.85
Block trades*	61,276	1,988

* Primary market NYSE, NYSE American NYSE Arca only.
†(TRIN) A comparison of the number of advancing and declining issues with the volume of shares rising and falling. An Arms of less than 1 indicates buying demand; above 1 indicates selling pressure.

International Stock Indexes

Region/Country	Index	Close	Latest Net chg	Latest % chg	YTD % chg
World	**MSCI ACWI**	**807.64**	–28.47	**–3.40**	–4.0
	MSCI ACWI ex-USA	**341.99**	–2.28	**–0.66**	4.9
	MSCI World	**3532.64**	–135.89	**–3.70**	–4.7
	MSCI Emerging Markets	**1102.78**	–8.90	**–0.80**	2.5
Americas	**MSCI AC Americas**	**2037.06**	–101.11	**–4.73**	–7.9
Canada	**S&P/TSX Comp**	**24335.77**	–971.41	**–3.84**	–1.6
Latin Amer.	**MSCI EM Latin America**	**2128.34**	30.18	**1.44**	14.9
Brazil	**Bovespa**	**131140.65**	–49.69	**–0.04**	9.0
Chile	**S&P IPSA**	**4101.35**	10.90	**0.27**	13.5
Mexico	**S&P/BMV IPC**	**54089.28**	288.35	**0.54**	9.2
EMEA	**STOXX Europe 600**	**523.12**	–13.80	**–2.57**	3.1
Eurozone	**Euro STOXX**	**531.76**	–16.00	**–2.92**	5.3
Belgium	**Bel-20**	**4294.73**	–49.44	**–1.14**	0.7
Denmark	**OMX Copenhagen 20**	**1713.23**	–40.48	**–2.31**	–18.5
France	**CAC 40**	**7598.98**	–259.85	**–3.31**	3.0
Germany	**DAX**	**21717.39**	–673.45	**–3.01**	9.1
Israel	**Tel Aviv**	**2448.47**	–15.22	**–0.62**	2.2
Italy	**FTSE MIB**	**37070.83**	–1383.37	**–3.60**	8.4
Netherlands	**AEX**	**877.42**	–24.10	**–2.67**	–0.1
Norway	**Oslo Bors All-Share**	**1691.93**	–40.11	**–2.32**	2.9
South Africa	**FTSE/JSE All-Share**	**86082.52**	–3023.22	**–3.39**	2.4
Spain	**IBEX 35**	**13191.20**	–159.00	**–1.19**	13.8
Sweden	**OMX Stockholm**	**913.14**	–32.34	**–3.42**	–4.3
Switzerland	**Swiss Market**	**12279.48**	–308.83	**–2.45**	5.8
Turkey	**BIST 100**	**9484.26**	–39.05	**–0.41**	–3.5
U.K.	**FTSE 100**	**8474.74**	–133.74	**–1.55**	3.7
U.K.	**FTSE 250**	**19210.51**	–439.12	**–2.23**	–6.8
Asia-Pacific	**MSCI AC Asia Pacific**	**182.30**	–1.19	**–0.65**	0.4
Australia	**S&P/ASX 200**	**7859.70**	–74.85	**–0.94**	–3.7
China	**Shanghai Composite**	**3342.01**	–8.12	**–0.24**	–0.3
Hong Kong	**Hang Seng**	**22849.81**	–352.72	**–1.52**	13.9
India	**BSE Sensex**	**76295.36**	–322.08	**–0.42**	–2.4
Japan	**NIKKEI 225**	**34735.93**	–989.94	**–2.77**	–12.9
Singapore	**Straits Times**	**3942.23**	–11.98	**–0.30**	4.1
South Korea	**KOSPI**	**2486.70**	–19.16	**–0.76**	3.6
Taiwan	**TAIEX**	**21298.22**	...	**Closed**	–7.5
Thailand	**SET**	**1161.81**	–10.88	**–0.93**	–17.0

Sources: FactSet; Dow Jones Market Data

Percentage Gainers...

Company	Symbol	Latest Session Close	Net chg	% chg	52-Week High	Low	% chg
iCoreConnect	ICCT	4.23	2.16	**104.35**	35.80	0.24	**-81.3**
Alaunos Therapeutics	TCRT	4.22	1.42	**50.71**	18.20	1.31	**-76.3**
Tivic Health Systems	TIVC	4.87	1.62	**49.85**	31.45	2.43	**-75.6**
NeOnc Technologies Hldgs	NTHI	9.58	2.58	**36.86**	25.00	6.10	**...**
Local Bounti	LOCL	2.82	0.72	**34.29**	3.33	1.18	**-0.7**
MicroSect Big Oil -3X Inv	NRGD	30.69	7.17	**30.46**	33.66	23.33	**...**
Direxion Dly Semi 3 Bear	SOXS	36.81	8.45	**29.80**	46.84	16.35	**4.6**
Creative Global Tech	CGTL	5.38	1.23	**29.64**	10.59	2.80	**...**
MicroSec Big Bk -3X Inv	BNKD	42.92	9.39	**27.99**	42.92	25.07	**...**
Direxion Hi Beta Bear 3X	HIBS	29.95	6.41	**27.23**	32.18	14.71	**22.4**
MicroSectors En 3X Inv	WTID	19.13	4.07	**27.07**	24.01	12.48	**47.5**
MicroSectors Trav -3x Lv	FLYD	24.96	5.29	**26.88**	42.88	12.14	**-3.0**
MAX Airlines -3X Invr	JETD	20.08	4.21	**26.52**	27.74	10.05	**-10.7**
MicroOil & Gas -3x Inv	OILD	15.56	2.99	**23.79**	20.85	12.19	**19.9**
Old Point Financial	OPOF	36.82	6.91	**23.10**	37.32	13.49	**128.8**

Percentage Losers

Company	Symbol	Latest Session Close	Net chg	% chg	52-Week High	Low	% chg
Aldeyra Therapeutics	ALDX	1.42	-3.91	**-73.33**	7.20	1.14	**-69.7**
RH	RH	149.39	-99.96	**-40.09**	457.26	138.40	**-47.2**
GrShr 2x Long DELL Daily	DLLL	10.48	-6.45	**-38.10**	29.01	10.30	**...**
RxSight	RXST	16.21	-9.91	**-37.94**	66.54	14.37	**-68.8**
American Rebel Holdings	AREB	3.96	-2.33	**-37.04**	231.75	1.10	**-93.8**
GrShr 2x Long MU Daily	MULL	9.00	-4.30	**-32.33**	25.50	9.00	**...**
Direxion Dly MU Bull 2X	MUU	10.09	-4.79	**-32.19**	31.04	10.04	**...**
Direxion Rg Banks Bl 3X	DPST	60.86	-27.38	**-31.03**	174.22	56.46	**-12.8**
MicroSect Big Oil 3X Lvgd	NRGU	17.27	-7.53	**-30.35**	26.12	17.27	**...**
Direxion Dly SCOND 3 BL	SOXL	11.41	-4.85	**-29.83**	70.08	11.40	**-73.1**
Innventure	INV	3.97	-1.65	**-29.36**	18.75	3.91	**-63.7**
Baiya International Group	BIYA	3.69	-1.50	**-28.90**	8.00	3.10	**...**
VF Corp	VFC	11.68	-4.71	**-28.74**	29.02	11.00	**-15.5**
Top Win International	TOPW	2.76	-1.07	**-27.94**	13.20	1.80	**...**
Forward Air	FWRD	14.95	-5.79	**-27.92**	40.92	11.21	**-46.6**

Most Active Stocks

Company	Symbol	Volume (000)	% chg from 65-day avg	Latest Session Close	% chg	52-Week High	Low
Damon	DMN	**747,650**	1222.9	0.02	**9.42**	4.95	0.01
NVIDIA	NVDA	**335,417**	22.3	101.80	**-7.81**	153.13	75.61
Direxion Dly SCOND 3 BL	SOXL	**295,336**	227.6	11.41	**-29.83**	70.08	11.40
Intel	INTC	**241,344**	150.2	22.43	**2.05**	40.78	18.51
Direxion TSLA Bull 2X	TSLL	**236,344**	96.1	10.03	**-11.00**	41.50	4.94
Ford Motor	F	**219,721**	121.5	9.54	**-6.01**	14.85	9.06
Lucid Group	LCID	**212,001**	129.1	2.32	**-3.33**	4.43	1.93
Protagenic Therapeutics	PTIX	**177,825**	7763.6	0.42	**84.14**	1.87	0.18
iCoreConnect	ICCT	**175,838**	1555.3	4.23	**104.35**	35.80	0.24
LogicMark	LGMK	**157,443**	1032.8	0.02	**-15.96**	25.38	0.02

* Volumes of 100,000 shares or more are rounded to the nearest thousand

Volume Movers

Ranked by change from 65-day average*

Company	Symbol	Volume (000)	% chg from 65-day avg	Latest Session Close	% chg	52-Week High	Low
Old Point Financial	OPOF	471	**6449**	36.82	**23.10**	37.32	13.49
Innov Intl Dev Pwr Apr	IAPR	1,318	**5546**	27.20	**-1.38**	28.66	26.21
Matthews Asia Innovators	MINV	355	**4894**	27.37	**-3.27**	30.25	24.19
Chenghe Acqn II Cl A	CHEB	1,428	**3706**	10.35	**0.68**	10.36	9.96
Aldeyra Therapeutics	ALDX	21,984	**3450**	1.42	**-73.33**	7.20	1.14
Tremblant Global ETF	TOGA	263	**3354**	27.85	**-5.82**	33.10	24.58
Global X India Active ETF	NDIA	177	**2941**	27.89	**-1.04**	33.82	25.69
AllianzIM US LC Bf20 Aug	AUGW	2,166	**2839**	28.32	**-2.50**	29.96	26.60
Matthews China Active	MCH	383	**2724**	23.92	**-1.99**	29.38	18.00
Invsc MSCI North AmClimt	KLMN	10,137	**2109**	22.09	**-4.97**	25.27	22.09

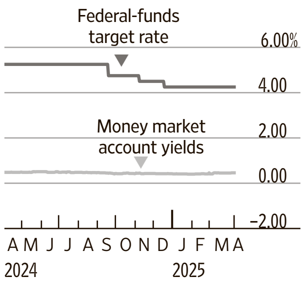
* Common stocks priced at $2 a share or more with an average volume over 65 trading days of at least 5,000 shares †Has traded fewer than 65 days

CREDIT MARKETS

Consumer Rates and Returns to Investor

U.S. consumer rates

A consumer rate against its benchmark over the past year



Selected rates

Money Market/Savings Accts

Bankrate.com avg†:	**0.46%**
America First FCU	**4.20%**
Riverdale, UT	801-627-0900
Quontic Bank	**4.25%**
Astoria, NY	800-908-6600
VirtualBank	**4.25%**
Miami, FL	877-998-2265
CFG Community Bank	**4.32%**
Baltimore, MD	888-205-8388
Vio Bank	**4.41%**
Oklahoma City, OK	888-999-9170

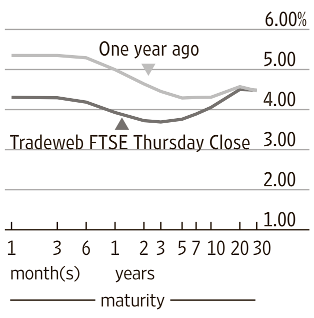
Interest rate	Yield/Rate (%) Last	Week ago	52-Week Range (%) Low	High	3-yr chg (pct pts)
Federal-funds rate target	**4.25-4.50**	4.25-4.50	4.25	5.50	**4.00**
Prime rate*	**7.50**	7.50	7.50	8.50	**4.00**
SOFR	**4.37**	4.35	4.27	5.40	**4.07**
Money market, annual yield	**0.46**	0.45	0.40	0.51	**0.39**
Five-year CD, annual yield	**1.69**	1.68	1.62	1.69	**1.14**
30-year mortgage, fixed†	**6.77**	6.73	6.69	7.72	**1.82**
15-year mortgage, fixed†	**6.11**	6.11	6.02	7.11	**1.99**
Jumbo mortgages, $726,200-plus†	**6.83**	6.83	6.76	7.79	**1.84**
Five-year adj mortgage (ARM)†	**6.19**	6.23	5.88	6.78	**2.91**
New-car loan, 48-month	**7.52**	7.52	7.18	7.94	**3.70**

Bankrate.com rates based on survey of over 1,500 online banks. *Base rate posted by 70% of the nation's largest banks.† Excludes closing costs.

Sources: FactSet; Dow Jones Market Data; Bankrate.com

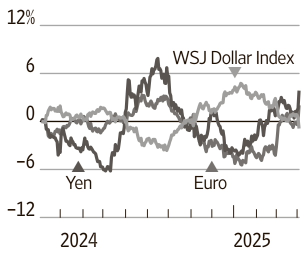
Treasury yield curve

Yield to maturity of current bills, notes and bonds



Forex Race

Yen, euro vs. dollar; dollar vs. major U.S. trading partners



Sources: Tradeweb FTSE U.S. Treasury Close; Tullett Prebon; Dow Jones Market Data

Corporate Borrowing Rates and Yields

Bond total return index	Close	Yield (%) Last	Week ago	52-Week High	52-Week Low	Total Return (%) 52-wk	3-yr
U.S. Treasury, Bloomberg	2277.480	**3.940**	4.230	4.880	3.630	**6.272**	0.332
U.S. Treasury Long, Bloomberg	3231.450	**4.520**	4.760	5.050	3.990	**5.263**	–6.864
Aggregate, Bloomberg	2167.490	**4.450**	4.710	5.310	4.100	**6.534**	0.868
Fixed-Rate MBS, Bloomberg	2149.650	**4.770**	5.040	5.570	4.340	**7.162**	0.986
High Yield 100, ICE BofA	3827.269	**7.100**	6.831	7.871	6.208	**7.035**	4.887
Muni Master, ICE BofA	597.075	**3.481**	3.714	3.760	3.074	**2.752**	1.703
EMBI Global, J.P. Morgan	919.957	**7.464**	7.481	8.073	7.084	**7.151**	3.397

Sources: J.P. Morgan; Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices; ICE Data Services

CURRENCIES & COMMODITIES

Currencies

U.S.-dollar foreign-exchange rates in late New York trading

Country/currency	Thurs in US$	Thurs per US$	US$ vs, YTD chg (%)
Americas			
Argentina peso	.0009	1074.3945	4.2
Brazil real	.1776	5.6298	-9.0
Canada dollar	.7094	1.4097	-2.0
Chile peso	.001053	949.56	-4.5
Colombia peso	.000240	4158.01	-5.6
Ecuador US dollar	1	1	unch
Mexico peso	.0501	19.9407	-4.3
Uruguay peso	.02364	42.3050	-3.2
Asia-Pacific			
Australia dollar	.6328	1.5803	-2.2
China yuan	.1373	7.2816	-0.2
Hong Kong dollar	.1286	7.7784	0.1
India rupee	.01173	85.282	-0.3
Indonesia rupiah	.0000597	16745	2.9
Japan yen	.006847	146.06	-7.1
Kazakhstan tenge	.001993	501.80	-4.4
Macau pataca	.1248	8.0150	0.1
Malaysia ringgit	.2251	4.4420	-0.7
New Zealand dollar	.5794	1.7259	-3.5
Pakistan rupee	.00356	280.600	0.8
Philippines peso	.0175	56.991	-1.9
Singapore dollar	.7500	1.3333	-2.3
South Korea won	.0006889	1451.67	-1.8
Sri Lanka rupee	.0033677	296.94	1.3
Taiwan dollar	.03026	33.050	0.8
Thailand baht	.02925	34.190	-0.4
Vietnam dong	.00003875	25805	1.3
Europe			
Czech Rep. koruna	.04407	22.691	-6.8
Denmark krone	.1481	6.7515	-6.3
Euro area euro	1.1055	.9046	-6.3
Hungary forint	.002742	364.71	-8.2
Iceland krona	.007648	130.75	-5.9
Norway krone	.0969	10.3225	-9.3
Poland zloty	.2616	3.8232	-7.5
Sweden krona	.1023	9.7704	-11.7
Switzerland franc	1.1639	.8592	-5.3
Turkey lira	.0264	37.9403	7.3
Ukraine hryvnia	.0242	41.3500	-1.7
UK pound	1.3101	.7633	-4.5
Middle East/Africa			
Bahrain dinar	2.6528	.3770	-0.04
Egypt pound	.0198	50.5857	-0.5
Israel shekel	.2703	3.7001	1.7
Kuwait dinar	3.2504	.3077	-0.2
Oman sul rial	2.5976	.3850	-0.01
Qatar rial	.2747	3.641	-0.1
Saudi Arabia riyal	.2665	3.7518	-0.1
South Africa rand	.0534	18.7270	-0.8

	Close	Net Chg	% Chg	YTD % Chg
WSJ Dollar Index	98.02	−1.28	−1.29	**−4.61**

Sources: Tullett Prebon, Dow Jones Market Data

Commodities

	Close	Thursday Net chg	% Chg	52-Week High	Low	% Chg	YTD % chg
DJ Commodity	**1056.38**	-32.30	**-2.97**	1095.84	942.52	**4.07**	3.33
FTSE/CC CRB Index	**303.55**	-10.01	**-3.19**	316.63	265.48	**2.43**	2.30
Crude oil, $ per barrel	**66.95**	-4.76	**-6.64**	86.91	65.75	**-22.68**	-6.65
Natural gas, $/MMBtu	**4.138**	0.083	**2.05**	4.491	1.614	**133.26**	13.90
Gold, $ per troy oz.	**3097.00**	-42.90	**-1.37**	3139.90	2288.80	**35.31**	17.79

COMMODITIES

wsj.com/market-data/commodities

Futures Contracts

Metal & Petroleum Futures

	Open	High	Contract hi lo	Low	Settle	Chg	Open interest
Copper-High (CMX)-25,000 lbs.; $ per lb.							
April	4.8750	4.9245		4.7940	**4.8110**	−0.2125	4,420
May	5.0000	5.0000		4.8080	**4.8285**	−0.2120	113,024
Gold (CMX)-100 troy oz.; $ per troy oz.							
April	3150.00	3166.90		3052.00	**3097.00**	−42.90	10,117
May	3145.00	3176.00	▲	3059.60	**3107.40**	−44.20	3,949
June	3196.60	3196.60		3073.50	**3121.70**	−44.50	401,718
July	3188.50	3205.40	▲	3092.00	**3134.80**	−44.30	204
Aug	3208.00	3219.10		3099.10	**3147.80**	−44.50	46,374
Sept	3183.80	3183.80	▲	3183.80	**3160.50**	−44.70	28
Palladium (NYM) - 50 troy oz.; $ per troy oz.							
April	965.00	970.00	▲	965.00	**919.10**	−55.40	7
June	988.50	989.00		925.50	**930.80**	−54.50	19,636
Platinum (NYM)-50 troy oz.; $ per troy oz.							
April	975.30	975.60		936.00	**942.50**	−35.40	2,023
July	1007.00	1007.10		950.30	**956.60**	−38.60	72,236
Silver (CMX)-5,000 troy oz.; $ per troy oz.							
April	34.135	34.135	▲	31.625	**31.844**	−2.655	1,364
May	34.950	34.950		31.730	**31.970**	−2.680	120,134
Crude Oil, Light Sweet (NYM)-1,000 bbls.; $ per bbl.							
May	70.38	70.41		65.98	**66.95**	−4.76	297,842
June	69.80	69.93		65.60	**66.47**	−4.76	238,515
July	69.42	69.42		65.11	**65.92**	−4.69	138,288
Sept	68.30	68.30		64.12	**64.86**	−4.45	122,197
Dec	66.84	66.85		63.05	**63.71**	−4.04	180,712
Dec'26	64.39	64.40		61.74	**62.34**	−2.86	112,384
NY Harbor ULSD (NYM)-42,000 gal.; $ per gal.							
May	2.2795	2.2800		2.1595	**2.1889**	−.1331	103,515
June	2.2474	2.2622		2.1326	**2.1587**	−.1342	73,123
Gasoline-NY RBOB (NYM)-42,000 gal.; $ per gal.							
May	2.3025	2.3025		2.1397	**2.1643**	−.1667	126,223
June	2.2800	2.2800		2.1323	**2.1566**	−.1586	92,199
Natural Gas (NYM)-10,000 MMBtu.; $ per MMBtu.							
May	4.011	4.203		3.968	**4.138**	.083	280,665
June	4.150	4.325		4.108	**4.257**	.067	111,237
July	4.369	4.516		4.322	**4.452**	.054	125,984
Sept	4.376	4.521		4.348	**4.461**	.041	125,604
Oct	4.422	4.565		4.395	**4.506**	.042	137,975
Jan'26	5.366	5.501		5.345	**5.443**	.031	132,873

Agriculture Futures

	Open	High	Contract hi lo	Low	Settle	Chg	Open interest
Corn (CBT)-5,000 bu.; cents per bu.							
May	450.00	462.25		447.50	**457.50**	−.25	601,505
July	460.00	469.50		455.25	**465.50**	.25	569,169
Oats (CBT)-5,000 bu.; cents per bu.							
May	360.50	362.00		349.75	**352.00**	−14.00	1,836
July	356.00	363.00		350.00	**356.50**	−6.50	842
Soybeans (CBT)-5,000 bu.; cents per bu.							
May	1011.00	1020.25		1005.25	**1011.50**	−18.00	331,666
July	1027.75	1035.25		1020.50	**1026.25**	−18.75	246,849
Soybean Meal (CBT)-100 tons; $ per ton.							
May	287.30	291.40	▼	283.50	**288.00**	.80	227,702
July	294.50	298.60	▼	291.60	**295.40**	.80	179,736
Soybean Oil (CBT)-60,000 lbs.; cents per lb.							
May	47.25	48.04		46.16	**47.06**	−1.44	200,541
July	47.85	48.53		46.71	**47.58**	−1.38	171,473
Rough Rice (CBT)-2,000 cwt.; $ per cwt.							
May	13.20	13.25		13.00	**13.08**	−.15	10,732
July	13.46	13.51	▼	13.25	**13.30**	−.17	1,537
Wheat (CBT)-5,000 bu.; cents per bu.							
May	526.75	542.00		525.25	**536.00**	−3.25	221,267
July	541.00	555.75		539.00	**550.00**	−2.75	138,165
Wheat (KC)-5,000 bu.; cents per bu.							
May	558.00	572.25		554.75	**569.00**	.50	117,646
July	568.75	583.50		567.00	**580.75**	1.00	82,300
Cattle-Feeder (CME)-50,000 lbs.; cents per lb.							
April	286.175	287.050		284.625	**285.400**	−3.475	6,858
May	284.100	286.050		282.275	**283.125**	−4.800	32,039
Cattle-Live (CME)-40,000 lbs.; cents per lb.							
April	207.525	209.550		207.050	**208.050**	−2.325	47,762
June	204.400	206.300		203.700	**204.700**	−2.700	163,018
Hogs-Lean (CME)-40,000 lbs.; cents per lb.							
April	86.850	88.150		86.550	**87.375**	−.075	26,799
June	95.100	97.550		94.975	**95.550**	−.975	92,506
Lumber (CME)-27,500 bd. ft., $ per 1,000 bd. ft.							
May	630.00	630.00		603.50	**606.00**	−56.00	5,381
July	655.00	655.00		629.00	**630.00**	−51.50	1,808
Milk (CME)-200,000 lbs., cents per lb.							
April	17.05	17.08		16.96	**16.98**	−.15	4,502
May	17.15	17.24	▼	16.83	**16.84**	−.42	6,338
Cocoa (ICE-US)-10 metric tons; $ per ton.							
May	8,884	9,492		8,884	**9,291**	323	37,016
July	8,952	9,459		8,879	**9,285**	264	30,763
Coffee (ICE-US)-37,500 lbs.; cents per lb.							
May	386.40	391.00		376.90	**385.25**	−3.60	59,521
July	383.15	387.00		373.40	**381.75**	−3.65	52,903
Sugar-World (ICE-US)-112,000 lbs.; cents per lb.							
May	19.34	19.54		18.95	**19.11**	−.48	263,537
July	19.15	19.34		18.80	**18.97**	−.42	227,397
Sugar-Domestic (ICE-US)-112,000 lbs.; cents per lb.							
May	38.01	38.01		38.01	**38.01**	...	593
Sept	38.00	38.00		38.00	**38.00**	...	1,034
Cotton (ICE-US)-50,000 lbs.; cents per lb.							
May	64.80	66.19		64.80	**64.80**	−3.00	111,790
July	67.03	67.21		65.71	**65.71**	−3.00	84,242
Orange Juice (ICE-US)-15,000 lbs.; cents per lb.							
May	240.55	245.45		234.60	**234.60**	−15.00	5,712
July	237.60	242.50		231.95	**231.95**	−15.00	2,032

Interest Rate Futures

	Open	High	Contract hi lo	Low	Settle	Chg	Open interest
Ultra Treasury Bonds (CBT) - $100,000; pts 32nds of 100%							
June	124-300	126-190		124-180	**124-260**	1-10.0	1,822,152
Sept	124-280	125-250		123-240	**124-140**	1-06.0	1
Treasury Bonds (CBT)-$100,000; pts 32nds of 100%							
June	119-050	120-050		119-030	**119-130**	1-13.0	1,838,388
Sept	119-000	119-280		118-050	**119-030**	1-12.0	3,309
Treasury Notes (CBT)-$100,000; pts 32nds of 100%							
June	112-060	113-020		112-055	**112-205**	1-04.5	4,922,495
Sept	112-090	113-050		112-090	**112-255**	1-06.0	3,308
5 Yr. Treasury Notes (CBT)-$100,000; pts 32nds of 100%							
June	108-235	109-127		108-230	**109-040**	27.5	6,556,075
Sept	109-075	109-142		108-172	**109-062**	28.0	41
2 Yr. Treasury Notes (CBT)-$200,000; pts 32nds of 100%							
June	103-240	104-010		103-240	**103-303**	11.2	3,931,635
Sept	104-015	104-079		103-294	**104-053**	12.2	633
30 Day Federal Funds (CBT)-$5,000,000; 100 - daily avg.							
April	95.6725	95.6825	▼	95.6700	**95.6775**	.0075	570,493
May	95.7150	95.7500		95.7100	**95.7300**	.0300	628,609
Three-Month SOFR (CME)-$1,000,000; 100 - daily avg.							
Jan	95.6425	95.6450	▼	95.6425	**95.6450**		12,008
June	95.9150	96.0050		95.9100	**95.9700**	.0750	1,283,489

Currency Futures

	Open	High	Contract hi lo	Low	Settle	Chg	Open interest
Japanese Yen (CME)-¥12,500,000; $ per 100¥							
April	.6718	.6889	▲	.6718	**.6837**	.0157	767
June	.6780	.6944	▲	.6776	**.6886**	.0159	307,568
Canadian Dollar (CME)-CAD 100,000; $ per CAD							
April	.7000	.7130	▲	.6992	**.7105**	.0120	722
June	.7048	.7157	▲	.7010	**.7128**	.0120	276,218
British Pound (CME)-£62,500; $ per £							
April	1.3003	1.3198	▲	1.2978	**1.3094**	.0114	496
June	1.3008	1.3208	▲	1.2973	**1.3094**	.0114	191,208
Swiss Franc (CME)-CHF 125,000; $ per CHF							
June	1.1435	1.1800	▲	1.1432	**1.1712**	.0279	89,525
Sept	1.1630	1.1919	▲	1.1552	**1.1832**	.0281	85
Australian Dollar (CME)-AUD 100,000; $ per AUD							
April	.6240	.6384		.6228	**.6338**	.0044	497
June	.6271	.6394		.6230	**.6341**	.0043	179,838
Mexican Peso (CME)-MXN 500,000; $ per MXN							
April	.05002	.05028	▲	.04922	**.05013**	.00126	164
June	.04913	.04993	▲	.04868	**.04970**	.00124	140,341
Euro (CME)-€125,000; $ per €							
April	1.0824	1.1139	▲	1.0809	**1.1043**	.0181	4,555
June	1.0876	1.1193	▲	1.0848	**1.1082**	.0182	657,651

Index Futures

	Open	High	Contract hi lo	Low	Settle	Chg	Open interest
Mini DJ Industrial Average (CBT)-$5 x index							
June	41870	41870	▼	40655	**40776**	−1716	74,623
Sept	42022	42194	▼	40949	**41062**	−1734	336
Mini S&P 500 (CME)-$50 x index							
June	5550.50	5564.75	▼	5415.25	**5432.75**	−279.50	2,102,311
Sept	5599.50	5609.50	▼	5459.25	**5476.50**	−284.00	8,416
Mini S&P Midcap 400 (CME)-$100 x index							
June	2883.40	3000.00	▼	2789.20	**2799.50**	−203.70	40,991
Sept	...	2932.40	▼	2819.80	**2821.80**	−202.10	n.a.
Mini Nasdaq 100 (CME)-$20 x index							
June	19020.00	19177.00	▼	18614.00	**18675.50**	−1082.50	245,628
Sept	19217.75	19357.75	▼	18794.50	**18853.50**	−1096.75	733
Mini Russell 2000 (CME)-$50 x index							
June	1967.00	1984.60	▼	1917.50	**1923.80**	−135.30	403,837
Sept	1981.70	1998.70	▼	1931.30	**1937.40**	−137.00	194
Dec	2112.10	2015.00	▼	1964.40	**1954.20**	−137.80	108
Mini Russell 1000 (CME)-$50 x index							
June	3021.20	3060.60	▼	2965.80	**2966.80**	−161.10	5,825
U.S. Dollar Index (ICE-US)-$1,000 x index							
June	102.88	103.08	▼	100.98	**101.80**	−1.70	28,452
Sept	102.56	102.56	▼	100.66	**101.46**	−1.67	414

Source: FactSet

Bonds | wsj.com/market-data/bonds/benchmarks

Tracking Bond Benchmarks

Return on investment and spreads over Treasurys and/or yields paid to investors compared with 52-week highs and lows for different types of bonds

Total return close	YTD total return (%)	Index	Yield (%) Latest	Low	High
Broad Market Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices					
2167.49	3.6	U.S. Aggregate	4.450	4.100	5.310
U.S. Corporate Indexes Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices					
3282.43	2.8	U.S. Corporate	5.060	4.640	5.750
3213.49	2.8	Intermediate	4.760	4.400	5.670
4256.97	2.9	Long term	5.680	5.070	6.010
623.33	3.0	Double-A-rated	4.710	4.260	5.330
893.97	2.7	Triple-B-rated	5.270	4.850	5.950
High Yield Bonds ICE BofA					
569.80	0.2	High Yield Constrained	8.003	6.975	8.322
571.69	-3.1	Triple-C-rated	13.688	11.050	13.872
3827.27	1.0	High Yield 100	7.100	6.208	7.871
499.42	0.5	Global High Yield Constrained	7.606	6.808	8.112
376.99	0.3	Europe High Yield Constrained	5.949	5.219	6.710
U.S Agency Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices					
1892.34	2.7	U.S Agency	4.170	3.960	5.190
1676.54	2.5	10-20 years	4.110	3.920	5.190
3585.28	4.8	20-plus years	4.780	4.240	5.300
2888.36	3.1	Yankee	4.740	4.380	5.580
Mortgage-Backed Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices					
2149.65	4.0	Mortgage-Backed	4.770	4.340	5.570
2117.23	4.0	Ginnie Mae (GNMA)	4.770	4.460	5.580
1268.26	4.0	Fannie mae (FNMA)	4.770	4.310	5.580
1955.03	4.0	Freddie Mac (FHLMC)	4.630	4.150	5.510
597.08	0.4	Muni Master	3.481	3.074	3.760
421.71	0.7	7-12 year	3.305	2.858	3.557
480.06	-0.2	12-22 year	4.012	3.469	4.236
457.33	-0.2	22-plus year	4.460	3.959	4.663
Global Government J.P. Morgan†					
553.93	1.7	Global Government	3.440	3.010	3.740
847.01	2.3	Canada	2.940	2.820	3.870
360.44	-0.6	EMU§	3.197	2.726	3.403
654.24	-0.2	France	3.330	2.900	3.530
464.73	-1.2	Germany	2.640	2.080	2.860
266.38	-1.4	Japan	1.730	1.160	1.910
505.88	-1.5	Netherlands	2.860	2.290	3.060
795.84	1.7	U.K.	4.720	4.030	5.070
919.96	2.5	Emerging Markets **	7.464	7.084	8.073

*Constrained indexes limit individual issuer concentrations to 2%; the High Yield 100 are the 100 largest bonds † In local currency § Euro-zone bonds

** EMBI Global Index

Sources: ICE Data Services; Bloomberg Fixed Income Indices; J.P.Morgan

Global Government Bonds: Mapping Yields

Yields and spreads over or under U.S. Treasurys on benchmark two-year and 10-year government bonds in selected other countries; arrows indicate whether the yield rose(▲) or fell (▼) in the latest session

Coupon (%)	Country/ Maturity, in years	Yield (%) Latest(●)	Previous	Month ago	Year ago	Spread Under/Over U.S. Treasurys, in basis points Latest	Prev	Year ago
3.875	**U.S.** 2	3.724 ▼	3.905	3.981	4.679			
4.625	10	4.054 ▼	4.196	4.178	4.354			
4.750	**Australia** 2	3.543 ▼	3.706	3.771	3.874	-19.0	-15.7	-80.7
3.500	10	4.239 ▼	4.390	4.340	4.139	18.1	26.3	-21.6
0.000	**France** 2	2.078 ▼	2.192	2.182	2.883	-165.5	-167.1	-179.8
3.200	10	3.371 ▼	3.435	3.175	2.918	-68.8	-69.3	-143.8
2.200	**Germany** 2	1.951 ▼	2.046	2.079	2.859	-178.2	-181.7	-182.2
2.500	10	2.655 ▼	2.722	2.493	2.400	-140.1	-140.5	-195.5
2.550	**Italy** 2	2.205 ▼	2.276	2.333	3.465	-152.9	-158.7	-121.6
3.650	10	3.774 ▼	3.821	3.603	3.826	-28.4	-30.6	-52.9
0.900	**Japan** 2	0.747 ▼	0.839	0.832	0.187	-298.6	-302.5	-449.4
1.200	10	1.351 ▼	1.479	1.410	0.767	-270.7	-264.8	-358.8
2.500	**Spain** 2	2.100 ▼	2.187	2.271	3.047	-163.3	-167.6	-163.4
3.150	10	3.295 ▼	3.345	3.114	3.275	-76.3	-78.2	-108.1
4.125	**U.K.** 2	4.020 ▼	4.166	4.192	4.222	28.7	30.3	-45.9
4.250	10	4.531 ▼	4.647	4.512	4.061	47.3	52.0	-29.4

Source: Tullett Prebon, Tradeweb FTSE U.S. Treasury Close

Corporate Debt

Prices of firms' bonds reflect factors including investors' economic, sectoral and company-specific expectations

Investment-grade spreads that widened the most...

Issuer	Symbol	Coupon (%)	Yield (%)	Maturity	Spread*, in basis points Current	One-day change	Last week
Sumitomo Mitsui Financial	...	5.632	5.21	Jan. 15, '35	116	17	101
Wells Fargo	WFC	3.900	5.65	May 1, '45	114	17	103
Barclays	...	5.250	5.64	Aug. 17, '45	113	16	108
Goldman Sachs	GS	6.750	5.82	Oct. 1, '37	177	16	152
BNP Paribas	...	4.400	4.69	Aug. 14, '28	102	15	n.a.
Citigroup	C	5.875	5.64	Jan. 30, '42	114	15	n.a.
General Motors	GM	5.000	5.91	April 1, '35	185	15	160
American Honda Finance	...	4.850	4.87	Oct. 23, '31	111	15	92

High-yield issues with the biggest price increases...

Issuer	Symbol	Coupon (%)	Yield (%)	Maturity	Bond Price as % of face value Current	One-day change	Last week
HAT Holdings I	...	3.750	6.02	Sept. 15, '30	89.569	0.77	n.a.
Occidental Petroleum	OXY	6.450	5.99	Sept. 15, '36	103.789	0.21	n.a.

...And with the biggest price decreases

Issuer	Symbol	Coupon (%)	Yield (%)	Maturity	Current	One-day change	Last week
Transocean	RIG	6.800	11.26	March 15, '38	70.000	−6.81	78.030
Bausch Health	...	11.000	13.88	Sept. 30, '28	92.250	−3.65	97.000
Hughes Satellite Systems	...	6.625	26.37	Aug. 1, '26	79.000	−2.44	83.270
Genworth Financial	GNW	6.500	7.21	June 15, '34	95.250	−2.25	97.537
Bath & Body Works	BBWI	6.750	6.89	July 1, '36	98.875	−1.21	100.447
Bombardier	...	7.450	7.07	May 1, '34	102.500	−1.15	104.856
Verde Purchaser	...	10.500	8.82	Nov. 30, '30	105.135	−0.99	106.439
Teva Pharmaceutical Finance	...	6.150	6.18	Feb. 1, '36	99.729	−0.88	100.710

*Estimated spread over 2-year, 3-year, 5-year, 10-year or 30-year hot-run Treasury; 100 basis points=one percentage pt.; change in spread shown is for Z-spread.
Note: Data are for the most active issue of bonds with maturities of two years or more

Source: MarketAxess

Cash Prices | wsj.com/market-data/commodities

Thursday, April 3, 2025

These prices reflect buying and selling of a variety of actual or "physical" commodities in the marketplace—separate from the futures price on an exchange, which reflects what the commodity might be worth in future months.

	Thursday
Energy	
Coal,C.Aplc.,12500Btu,1.2SO2-r,w	78.000
Coal,PwdrRvrBsn,8800Btu,0.8SO2-r,w	14.200
Metals	
Gold, per troy oz	
Engelhard industrial	3085.00
Handy & Harman base	3118.10
Handy & Harman fabricated	3461.09
LBMA Gold Price AM	*3127.05
LBMA Gold Price PM	*3119.75
Krugerrand,wholesale-e	3249.08
Maple Leaf-e	3326.81
American Eagle-e	3326.81
Mexican peso-e	4011.14
Austria crown-e	3050.61
Austria phil-e	3264.63
Silver, troy oz.	
Engelhard industrial	32.3000
Handy & Harman base	31.9450
Handy & Harman fabricated	39.9310
LBMA spot price	*£26.1800
(U.S.$ equivalent)	*33.8700
Coins,wholesale $1,000 face-a	24157
Other metals	
LBMA Platinum Price PM	*980.0
LBMA Palladium Price PM	*984.0
Platinum,Engelhard industrial	965.0
Palladium,Engelhard industrial	957.0
Aluminum, LME, $ per metric ton	*2480.0
Copper,Comex spot	4.8110
Iron Ore, 62% Fe CFR China-s	*103.9
Steel, HRC USA, FOB Midwest Mill-s	*940.0
Battery/EV metals	
BMI Lithium Carbonate, EXW China, =99.5%-v,w	10250
BMI Lithium Hydroxide, EXW China, =56.5% -v,w	9500
BMI Cobalt sulphate, EXW China, >20.5% -v,w	6693
BMI Nickel Sulphate, EXW China, >22%-v,k	3809
BMI Flake Graphite, FOB China, -100 Mesh, 94-95% -v,m	435
Fibers and Textiles	
Burlap,10-oz,40-inch NY yd-n,w	0.8750
Cotton,1 1/16 std lw-mdMphs-u	0.6222
Cotlook 'A' Index-t	*80.10
Hides,hvy native steers piece fob-u	n.a.
Wool,64s,staple,Terr del-u,w	n.a.
Grains and Feeds	
Bran,wheat middlings, KC-u,w	88
Corn,No. 2 yellow,Cent IL-bp,u	4.3100
Corn gluten feed,Midwest-u,w	116.1
Corn gluten meal,Midwest-u,w	437.3
Cottonseed meal-u,w	n.a.
Hominy feed,Cent IL-u,w	115
Meat-bonemeal,50% pro Mnpls-u,w	275
Oats,No.2 milling,Mnpls-u	4.0700
Rice, Long Grain Milled, No. 2 AR-u,w	34.88
Sorghum,(Milo) No.2 Gulf-u	n.a.
SoybeanMeal,Cent IL,rail,ton48%-u,w	298.50
Soybeans,No.1 yllw IL-bp,u	9.9100
Wheat,Spring14%-pro Mnpls-u	7.6125
Wheat,No.2 soft red,St.Louis-u	5.2700
Wheat - Hard - KC (USDA) $ per bu-u	n.a.
Wheat,No.1soft white,Portld,OR-u	6.2000
Food	
Beef,carcass equiv. index	
choice 1-3,600-900 lbs.-u	323.26
select 1-3,600-900 lbs.-u	304.41
Broilers, National comp wtd. avg.-u,w	1.3481
Butter,AA Chicago-d	2.3300
Cheddar cheese,bbl,Chicago-d	166.00
Cheddar cheese,blk,Chicago-d	163.00
Milk,Nonfat dry,Chicago lb.-d	116.75
Coffee,Brazilian,Comp-y	3.8538
Coffee,Colombian, NY-y	3.9920
Eggs,large white,Chicago-u,w	3.7450
Flour,hard winter KC-p	15.80
Hams,17-20 lbs,Mid-US fob-u	0.95
Hogs,Iowa-So. Minnesota-u	86.41
Pork bellies,12-14 lb MidUS-u	1.6189
Pork loins,13-19 lb MidUS-u	0.9699
Steers,Tex.-Okla. Choice-u	210.00
Steers,feeder,Okla. City-u,w	352.00
Fats and Oils	
Degummed corn oil, crude wtd. avg.-u,w	n.a.
Grease,choice white,Chicago-h	0.4800
Lard,Chicago-u	n.a.
Soybean oil,crude;Centl IL-u,w	0.4416
Tallow,bleach;Chicago-h	0.5175
Tallow,edible,Chicago-u	n.a.

KEY TO CODES: A=ask; B=bid; BP=country elevator bids to producers; C=corrected; D=CME; E=Manfra,Tordella & Brookes; H=American Commodities Brokerage Co; K=bi-weekly; M=monthly; N=nominal; n.a.=not quoted or not available; P=Sosland Publishing; R=SNL Energy; S=Platts-TSI; T=Cotlook Limited; U=USDA; V=Benchmark Mineral Intelligence; W=weekly; Y=International Coffee Organization; Z=not quoted. *Data as of 4/2

Source: Dow Jones Market Data

Exchange-Traded Portfolios | wsj.com/market-data/mutualfunds-etfs

Largest 100 exchange-traded funds. Preliminary close data as of 4:30 p.m. ET

Thursday, April 3, 2025

ETF	Symbol	Closing Price	Chg (%)	YTD (%)
CommSvsSPDR	XLC	92.53	-4.46	-4.4
CnsmrDiscSel	XLY	191.03	-6.04	-14.9
DimenUSCoreEq2	DFAC	31.55	-5.51	-8.8
EnSelSectorSPDR	XLE	86.74	-7.85	1.3
FinSelSectorSPDR	XLF	47.69	-4.92	-1.3
HealthCrSelSect	XLV	143.13	-0.81	4.0
IndSelSectorSPDR	XLI	125.85	-5.41	-4.5
InvscNasd100	QQQM	185.63	-5.29	-11.8
InvscQQQI	QQQ	450.66	-5.35	-11.8
InvscS&P500EW	RSP	166.53	-4.76	-5.0
iShBitcoin	IBIT	46.57	-5.75	-12.2
iShBrdUSDHYCpBd	USHY	36.29	-1.22	-1.4
iShCoreDivGrowth	DGRO	59.70	-3.69	-2.7
iShCoreMSCIEAFE	IEFA	74.40	-2.12	5.9
iShCoreMSCIEM	IEMG	53.16	-2.05	1.8
iShCoreMSCITotInt	IXUS	68.77	-2.09	4.0
iShCoreS&P500	IVV	540.07	-4.78	-8.3
iShCoreS&P MC	IJH	55.59	-6.73	-10.8
iShCoreS&P SC	IJR	98.90	-7.01	-14.2
iShCoreS&PTotUS	ITOT	117.10	-5.06	-9.0
iShCoreS&PUSGrw	IUSG	122.24	-5.66	-12.3
iShCoreS&PUSVal	IUSV	88.77	-4.24	-4.1
iShCoreTotUSDBd	IUSB	46.21	0.41	2.2
iShCoreUSAggBd	AGG	99.37	0.53	2.5
iShEdgeMSCIMinUSA	USMV	92.68	-1.17	4.4
iShEdgeMSCIUSAQual	QUAL	164.61	-4.44	-7.6
iShGoldTr	IAU	58.60	-0.59	18.4
iShiBoxx$IGCpBd	LQD	108.90	-0.01	1.9
iShMBS	MBB	94.22	0.67	2.8
iShMSCI EAFE	EFA	80.32	-2.10	6.2
iShMSCIEAFEValue	EFV	57.98	-1.85	10.5
iShNatlMuniBd	MUB	105.80	0.49	-0.7
iSh1-5YIGCpBd	IGSB	52.38	0.34	1.3
iSh1-3YTreaBd	SHY	82.73	0.38	0.9
iShRussMC	IWR	81.68	-5.52	-7.6
iShRuss1000	IWB	294.93	-4.94	-8.5
iShRuss1000Grw	IWF	346.45	-5.56	-13.7
iShRuss1000Val	IWD	181.40	-4.09	-2.0
iShRuss2000	IWM	189.65	-6.42	-14.2
iShS&P500Grw	IVW	89.13	-5.49	-12.2
iShS&P500Value	IVE	183.31	-4.17	-4.0
iShSelectDiv	DVY	129.05	-4.31	-1.7
iSh7-10YTreaBd	IEF	96.29	1.03	4.2
iShShortTreaBd	SHV	110.12	0.01	0.0
iSh20+YTreaBd	TLT	91.85	0.46	5.2
iShUSTreasuryBd	GOVT	23.12	0.74	0.6
iSh0-3MTreaBd	SGOV	100.38	0.02	0.1
JPMNasdEqPrem	JEPQ	49.35	-4.89	-12.5
JanusHendersonAAA	JAAA	50.27	-0.51	-0.9
JPM EqPrem	JEPI	55.21	-3.14	-4.0
JPM UltShIncm	JPST	50.51	0.12	0.3
PacerUSCashCows	COWZ	51.85	-5.56	-8.2
ProShUltPrQQQ	TQQQ	50.30	-16.07	-36.4
SPDRBbg1-3MTB	BIL	91.45	0.01	0.0
SPDR DJIA Tr	DIA	405.22	-3.98	-4.8
SPDR Gold	GLD	286.42	-0.60	18.3
SPDRPtfDevxUS	SPDW	35.83	-2.21	5.0
SPDRS&P500Value	SPYV	49.14	-4.17	-3.9
SPDRPtfS&P500	SPLG	63.24	-4.74	-8.3
SPDRS&P500Growth	SPYG	77.19	-5.43	-12.2
SPDR S&P 500	SPY	536.70	-4.93	-8.4
SchwabIntEquity	SCHF	19.48	-2.21	5.3
SchwabUS BrdMkt	SCHB	20.69	-4.92	-8.9
SchwabUS Div	SCHD	26.73	-4.09	-2.2
SchwabUS LC	SCHX	21.21	-4.97	-8.5
SchwabUS LC Grw	SCHG	24.04	-5.58	-13.7
SPDR S&PMdCpTr	MDY	508.50	-6.67	-10.7
SPDR S&P Div	SDY	132.60	-2.56	0.4
TechSelectSector	XLK	195.23	-6.82	-16.0
VangdSC Val	VBR	177.00	-6.67	-10.7
VangdExtMkt	VXF	163.98	-6.99	-13.7
VangdDivApp	VIG	187.76	-3.61	-4.1
VangdFTSEAWxUS	VEU	59.76	-2.02	4.1
VangdFTSEDevMk	VEA	50.08	-2.09	4.7
VangdFTSE EM	VWO	44.63	-1.80	1.3
VangdFTSE Europe	VGK	69.61	-1.43	9.7
VangdGrowth	VUG	355.58	-5.75	-13.4
VangdHiDiv	VYM	124.11	-4.11	-2.7
VangdInfoTech	VGT	511.50	-7.24	-17.7
VangdIntermBd	BIV	77.05	0.71	3.1
VangdIntrCorpBd	VCIT	82.01	0.34	2.2
VangdIntermTrea	VGIT	59.81	0.91	3.1
VangdLC	VV	247.48	-4.69	-8.2
VangdMegaGrwth	MGK	295.56	-5.85	-13.9
VangdMC	VO	249.18	-4.86	-5.7
VangdMBS	VMBS	46.52	0.69	2.6
VangdRealEst	VNQ	88.02	-3.41	-1.2
VangdRuss1000Grw	VONG	89.07	-5.67	-13.8
VangdS&P500ETF	VOO	494.16	-4.77	-8.3
VangdST Bond	BSV	78.44	0.49	1.5
VangdSTCpBd	VCSH	78.96	0.29	1.2
VangdShortTrea	VGSH	58.71	0.39	0.9
VangdSC	VB	210.85	-6.72	-12.2
VangdTaxExemptBd	VTEB	49.80	0.52	-0.7
VangdTotalBd	BND	73.76	0.52	2.6
VangdTotIntlBd	BNDX	49.00	0.37	-0.1
VangdTotIntlStk	VXUS	61.19	-2.00	3.8
VangdTotalStk	VTI	263.96	-5.03	-8.9
VangdTotWrldStk	VT	112.40	-3.95	-4.3
VangdValue	VTV	166.84	-3.72	-1.5

Borrowing Benchmarks | wsj.com/market-data/bonds/benchmarks

Money Rates

April 3, 2025

Key annual interest rates paid to borrow or lend money in U.S. and international markets. Rates below are a guide to general levels but don't always represent actual transactions.

Inflation

	Feb. index level	Chg From (%) Jan. '25	Feb. '24
U.S. consumer price index			
All items	319.082	0.44	2.8
Core	325.252	0.44	3.1

International rates

	Latest	Week ago	52-Week High	Low
Prime rates				
U.S.	7.50	7.50	8.50	7.50
Canada	4.95	4.95	7.20	4.95
Japan	1.875	1.875	1.875	1.475
Policy Rates				
Euro zone	2.65	2.65	4.50	2.65
Switzerland	0.75	0.75	2.00	0.75
Britain	4.50	4.50	5.25	4.50
Australia	4.10	4.10	4.35	4.10
Overnight repurchase				
U.S.	4.42	4.39	5.45	4.00

U.S. government rates

	Latest	Week ago	52-Week High	Low
Discount	4.50	4.50	5.50	4.50
Federal funds				
Effective rate	4.3300	4.3300	5.3400	4.3300
High	4.5500	4.5500	5.6500	4.3700
Low	4.3200	4.3200	5.3300	4.3000
Bid	4.3200	4.3200	5.3300	4.3200
Offer	4.3300	4.3300	5.3600	4.3300
Treasury bill auction				
4 weeks	4.240	4.220	5.285	4.215
13 weeks	4.205	4.190	5.255	4.190
26 weeks	4.070	4.085	5.170	4.070

Other short-term rates

	Latest	Week ago	52-Week high	low
Call money	6.25	6.25	7.25	6.25
Commercial paper (AA financial)				
90 days	4.30	n.a.	5.37	4.26
Secured Overnight Financing Rate	4.37	4.35	5.40	4.27

	Latest	Value Traded	52-Week High	Low
DTCC GCF Repo Index				
Treasury	4.414	69.926	5.471	4.286
MBS	4.445	65.190	5.526	4.294

Weekly survey

	Latest	Week ago	Year ago
Freddie Mac			
30-year fixed	6.64	6.65	6.82
15-year fixed	5.82	5.89	6.06

Notes on data:

U.S. prime rate is the base rate on corporate loans posted by at least 70% of the 10 largest U.S. banks, and is effective December 19, 2024. **Other prime rates** aren't directly comparable; lending practices vary widely by location; **Discount rate** is effective December 19, 2024. **Secured Overnight Financing Rate** is as of April 2, 2025. **DTCC GCF Repo Index** is Depository Trust & Clearing Corp.'s weighted average for overnight trades in applicable CUSIPs. Value traded is in billions of U.S. dollars. **Federal-funds rates** are Tullett Prebon rates as of 5:30 p.m. ET.

Sources: Federal Reserve; Bureau of Labor Statistics; DTCC; FactSet; Tullett Prebon Information, Ltd.

Biggest 1,000 Stocks | WSJ.com/stocks

Continued From Page B6

Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
▼ Donaldson	DCI	63.73	-4.57
DoorDash	DASH	173.99	-15.26
▼ Dover	DOV	162.73	-16.29
▼ Dow	DOW	31.46	-3.43
Doximity	DOCS	54.58	-3.37
DrReddy'sLab	RDY	13.24	0.01
DraftKings	DKNG	32.40	-2.03
Dropbox	DBX	26.83	-0.64
▲ DukeEnergy	DUK	124.05	3.66
Duolingo	DUOL	313.90	-23.66
▼ DuPont	DD	67.78	-7.47
DutchBros	BROS	56.90	-5.75
Dynatrace	DT	45.66	-2.71
EMCOR	EME	354.54	-30.41
ENI	E	30.07	-1.07
EOG Rscs	EOG	119.89	-10.08
▼ EPAM Systems	EPAM	155.55	-13.51
EQT	EQT	52.09	-2.53
EagleMaterials	EXP	228.65	-6.55
EastWestBncp	EWBC	77.92	-12.83
EastGroup	EGP	165.80	-9.85
▼ EastmanChem	EMN	79.98	-8.31
Eaton	ETN	260.85	-22.99
eBay	EBAY	66.36	-1.06
Ecolab	ECL	250.24	-3.42
Ecopetrol	EC	9.55	-0.56
EdisonIntl	EIX	58.38	-1.54
EdwardsLife	EW	72.98	0.93
Elastic	ESTC	82.21	-9.18
ElbitSystems	ESLT	390.16	1.93
ElectronicArts	EA	144.85	-0.02
ElevanceHealth	ELV	452.69	23.36
Embraer	ERJ	45.17	-0.66
EmersonElec	EMR	101.89	-9.65
▲ Enbridge	ENB	45.34	0.20
EncompassHealth	EHC	101.87	-0.21
EnergyTransfer	ET	17.73	-1.20
EnphaseEnergy	ENPH	58.77	-3.75
▼ Entegris	ENTG	71.94	-13.88
Entergy	ETR	85.06	-1.55
EnterpriseProd	EPD	33.47	-0.58
Equifax	EFX	231.80	-15.77
Equinix	EQIX	801.44	-30.11
Equinor	EQNR	25.49	-1.28
Equitable	EQH	50.21	-4.72
EquityLife	ELS	68.02	1.36
EquityResdntl	EQR	68.55	-3.08
ErieIndemnity	ERIE	421.56	6.00
EssentialUtil	WTRG	40.64	1.25
EssexProp	ESS	294.35	-12.85
▼ EsteeLauder	EL	58.19	-10.57
EvercoreA	EVR	177.60	-32.52
Everest	EG	361.76	-3.58
▲ Evergy	EVRG	69.21	-0.22
EversourceEner	ES	61.92	-0.71
ExactSciences	EXAS	44.28	-0.28
Exelixis	EXEL	36.68	-0.36
▲ Exelon	EXC	47.23	1.26
ExlService	EXLS	46.08	-2.08
ExpandEnergy	EXE	110.55	-3.32
Expedia	EXPE	152.37	-15.48
▼ ExpeditorsIntl	EXPD	110.66	-11.23
ExtraSpaceSt	EXR	144.16	-3.31
ExxonMobil	XOM	112.43	-6.24
F5	FFIV	250.98	-21.75
FTAI Aviation	FTAI	104.34	-11.60
FactSet	FDS	437.15	-14.57
FairIsaac	FICO	1801.05	-88.84
Fastenal	FAST	78.01	...
▼ FederalRealty	FRT	92.68	-6.40
▼ FedEx	FDX	215.86	-29.31
FergusonEnts	FERG	158.41	-6.40
Ferrari	RACE	431.23	-7.31
Ferrovial	FER	45.84	-0.46
FidNatlFinl	FNF	64.23	-2.36
FidNatlInfo	FIS	74.51	-1.23
FifthThirdBncp	FITB	35.47	-4.15
FirstCitizBcshA	FCNCA	1632.06	-227.52
FirstHorizon	FHN	17.21	-2.44
FirstSolar	FSLR	136.23	6.41
FirstEnergy	FE	41.05	0.47
FirstService	FSV	167.01	-4.48
Fiserv	FI	216.90	-9.25
Flex	FLEX	29.32	-4.75
▼ Floor&Decor	FND	70.27	-11.80
FlutterEnt	FLUT	217.62	-11.83
FomentoEconMex	FMX	101.46	1.53
FordMotor	F	9.54	-0.61
Fortinet	FTNT	89.44	-8.64
▲ Fortis	FTS	47.32	1.16
Fortive	FTV	67.62	-6.67
FoxA	FOXA	51.83	-5.21
FoxB	FOX	47.90	-5.10
▲ Franco-Nevada	FNV	158.72	1.71
▼ FranklinRscs	BEN	17.95	-1.48
FreedomHolding	FRHC	127.61	-9.95
▼ FreeportMcM	FCX	33.51	-4.69
▲ FreseniusMedCare	FMS	25.66	0.93
FrontierComms	FYBR	35.94	-0.11
FullTruck	YMM	12.53	-0.48
G H I			
GE Aerospace	GE	187.63	-12.14
▼ GE HealthCare	GEHC	72.00	-7.36

Continued on Page B9

MARKETS

OPEC+ Plans Bigger Hike To Crude Output in May

Increase is part of plan to unwind its production cuts; crude prices slide

By Giulia Petroni

The Organization of the Petroleum Exporting Countries and its allies agreed to make a larger oil output increase in May, in an unexpected move that further dragged on tariff-hit crude prices.

After a meeting held online on Thursday, eight OPEC+ countries said they will increase output by 411,000 barrels a day next month—the equivalent of three monthly increments—citing "healthy market fundamentals" and a "positive market outlook."

MOHAMMED ATY/REUTERS

Brent crude slumped 6.4% to $70.14 a barrel on Thursday.

Brent crude slumped 6.4% to $70.14 a barrel on Thursday, while West Texas Intermediate declined 6.6% to $66.95 a barrel.

Losses also were fueled by widespread fears that President Trump's latest tariff blitz could damp global economic growth and demand for oil.

OPEC+'s May increase is part of a broader plan to gradually unwind production curbs totaling 2.2 million barrels a day starting this month. The eight producers—Saudi Arabia, Russia, Iraq, the United Arab Emirates, Kuwait, Kazakhstan, Algeria, and Oman—made voluntary cuts in two months of 2023, April and November.

OPEC+ members reiterated that the gradual increases might be paused or reversed subject to evolving market conditions. They also confirmed their intention to fully compensate for any volume produced above quotas since January 2024 and to submit updated compensation plans by April 15.

RenWave Kore Raises Nearly $1.3 Billion For Its First-Time Private-Equity Fund

By Rod James

RenWave Kore, a private-equity firm founded by an alumnus of activist investor Elliott Investment Management, has wrapped up fundraising on one of the largest first-time private-equity funds in recent years.

The Greenwich, Conn.-based investment firm collected $1.26 billion of commitments for Ren Fund I with backing from investors including Liberty Mutual Insurance and the University of Chicago endowment, according to an extract of a letter to the fund's investors seen by The Wall Street Journal.

The $1.26 billion total makes Ren Fund I the largest first-time fund with a mandate to do secondary deals and among the 50 largest first-time private-equity funds yet raised, according to PitchBook Data. It is also the largest first-time fund raised since at least June 2023, illustrative of the hard time many new managers have had attracting investor backing.

Cody Kittle founded RenWave in 2023 after 9½ years with Elliott. The firm primarily backs so-called continuation-fund deals centered on businesses in complex situations, which include those wrestling with a market downturn, heavy debt or a complicated financial structure.

Private-equity firms form continuation funds to acquire assets backed by their older investment funds, giving them more time and money to manage those assets.

In RenWave's pitch to investors, it argued that complex deals are being ignored by buyers who have a plentiful supply of strong-performing companies to get behind, a banker familiar with the firm said.

RenWave can also do deals outside the secondary market. Ren Fund I has made six investments so far, one of which saw it acquire around $5 million of publicly listed stock at a roughly 70% discount to its trading price, the letter said.

More than 80% of the firm's investments by value have been in energy and energy-related infrastructure, according to the letter. RenWave said it expects this number to come down.

The firm got a boost last year when Sequoia Heritage, which invests the wealth of certain partners and founders of venture-capital giant Sequoia Capital, committed upward of $200 million to Ren Fund I.

RenWave is one of several recent entrants hoping to profit from an area of private equity that saw record activity in 2024. Many of these, such as Accel-KKR, Leonard Green & Partners and TPG, come from buyout-investing backgrounds.

At RenWave, Kittle works alongside partner Harry Fackelmayer, who was formerly with consumer-focused buyout shop L Catterton.

STOCK SPOTLIGHT

Amazon
The tech giant is particularly vulnerable to tariffs, but there's a possible silver lining: President Trump eliminated a tax policy that allowed Temu and Shein, Amazon's newest rivals, to send packages valued at under $800 to the country without duty or customs screening. Amazon shares fell 9%.

Restoration Hardware
Shares skidded 40%. The furniture company said in its annual report that 72% of its products were sourced from Asia in 2024, including 35% from Vietnam and 23% from China.

Apple, Nvidia, Meta Platforms and Broadcom
Some of the world's biggest companies lost billions of dollars in value Thursday, with Trump's aggressive tariffs ripping through the stock market. Apple lost 9.3%, Nvidia declined 7.8%, Meta dropped 9% and Broadcom decreased 10.5%.

Nike
Shares took a big hit Thursday morning following President Trump's tariff announcement. They closed down 14%, erasing more than $12 billion in market value.

Adidas and Puma
Shares of Nike's biggest rivals also fell on the news, with Adidas dropping 12% and Puma losing 11% in German trading. Sporting-goods retailers Foot Locker and Dick's Sporting Goods lost 15% and 12%, respectively.

Gap, Macy's and Target
Shares of all three retailers nosedived on news of President Trump's latest round of tariffs. The new tariffs heavily penalize goods imported from Asia, where many retailers manufacture and source their products. Gap was among the U.S. retailers that fared the worst, with shares falling 20%. Macy's lost 13% and Target declined 11%.

Hershey
The company agreed to a roughly $750 million deal for the popcorn brand LesserEvil, according to people familiar with the matter. Shares of Hershey rose 1.8%.

Conagra Brands
The maker of Slim Jims and Healthy Choice frozen meals recorded lower earnings and sales in its fiscal third quarter as volume fell across each of its segments. Shares gained 1.5%.

WW International
Premca Capital, an investment fund, has nominated three directors for election to the board of the WeightWatchers parent company, according to people familiar with the matter. Shares of WW slipped 1%.

FRIDAY'S EVENTS:

◆ Jobs report: The nonfarm payrolls report is due at 8:30 a.m. The U.S. likely added 140,000 jobs last month, economists polled by The Wall Street Journal predict.

◆ Fed speakers: Chair Jerome Powell will speak on the economic outlook at 11:25 a.m. Fed governors Michael Barr and Christopher Waller are also expected to speak.

AUCTION RESULTS

Here are the results of Thursday's Treasury auctions. All bids are awarded at a single price at the market-clearing yield. Rates are determined by the difference between that price and the face value.

FOUR-WEEK BILLS

Applications	$251,714,770,600
Accepted bids	$80,275,055,600
" noncompetitively	$6,453,985,700
" foreign noncompetitively	$0
Auction price (rate)	99.670222 (4.240%)
Coupon equivalent	4.313%
Bids at clearing yield accepted	4.75%
Cusip number	912797PC5

The bills, dated April 8, 2025, mature on May 6, 2025.

EIGHT-WEEK BILLS

Applications	$215,375,122,600
Accepted bids	$75,257,875,100
" noncompetitively	$1,472,427,300
" foreign noncompetitively	$100,000,000
Auction price (rate)	99.340444 (4.240%)
Coupon equivalent	4.327%
Bids at clearing yield accepted	28.39%
Cusip number	912797PL5

The bills, dated April 8, 2025, mature on June 3, 2025.

Biggest 1,000 Stocks | WSJ.com/stocks

Continued From Page B8

Stock	Sym	Close	Net Chg
GE Vernova	GEV	297.66	-33.14
GFLEnvironmental	GFL	48.13	-0.25
GSK	GSK	39.01	1.37
Gallagher	AJG	344.40	0.33
GameStop	GME	21.10	-1.59
Gaming&Leisure	GLPI	49.42	-1.14
Gap	GAP	17.84	-4.54
Garmin	GRMN	185.34	-32.73
Gartner	IT	404.95	-19.42
GenDigital	GEN	26.00	-1.01
GeneralDynamics	GD	269.62	-6.42
GeneralMills	GIS	60.97	1.78
GeneralMotors	GM	45.90	-2.08
Genmab	GMAB	19.24	0.42
Genpact	G	48.91	-1.62
GenuineParts	GPC	118.68	-1.39
GileadSciences	GILD	112.39	0.50
GitLab	GTLB	42.53	-5.80
GlobalPayments	GPN	92.98	-6.62
GlobalFoundries	GFS	34.37	-2.81
GlobeLife	GL	127.51	-5.31
GlobusMedical	GMED	72.02	-3.48
GoDaddy	GDDY	177.67	-2.83
GoldFields	GFI	22.65	-0.08
GoldmanSachs	GS	511.23	-51.87
Grab	GRAB	4.26	-0.35
Graco	GGG	80.22	-4.42
Grainger	GWW	973.41	-31.51
GraphicPkg	GPK	26.15	-0.15
GpoAeroportuar	PAC	192.02	2.31
GpoAeroportSur	ASR	285.69	2.11
GpoFinGalicia	GGAL	53.62	-1.57
Guidewire	GWRE	184.17	-8.28
HCA Healthcare	HCA	349.14	2.11
HDFC Bank	HDB	66.96	0.85
HP	HPQ	23.78	-4.10
HSBC	HSBC	53.50	-4.47
H World	HTHT	37.14	-0.15
Haleon	HLN	10.45	0.29
Halliburton	HAL	22.39	-3.31
HalozymeTherap	HALO	61.92	-1.10
HamiltonLane	HLNE	140.89	-14.59
HarmonyGold	HMY	14.65	-0.47
HartfordIns	HIG	123.44	-1.42
Hasbro	HAS	54.99	-7.70
HealthEquity	HQY	82.97	-5.77
HealthpeakProp	DOC	19.46	-0.60
HeicoA	HEI.A	203.85	-8.85
Heico	HEI	259.19	-10.91
HenrySchein	HSIC	66.59	-2.66
Hershey	HSY	166.83	2.88
Hess	HES	148.38	-11.64
HessMidstream	HESM	41.12	-1.77
HewlettPackard	HPE	13.68	-2.44
Hilton	HLT	217.38	-14.00
Hologic	HOLX	61.69	1.13
HomeDepot	HD	355.91	-14.98
HondaMotor	HMC	26.34	-0.97
Honeywell	HON	206.68	-9.31
HormelFoods	HRL	31.44	0.82
DR Horton	DHI	122.31	-5.66
HostHotels	HST	13.30	-1.35
HoulihanLokey	HLI	153.31	-12.58
HowmetAerospace	HWM	125.00	-8.90
Hubbell	HUBB	321.35	-20.27
HubSpot	HUBS	527.79	-65.20
Humana	HUM	265.48	-0.32
JBHunt	JBHT	136.23	-16.55
HuntingtonBcshs	HBAN	13.46	-1.75
HuntingIngalls	HII	199.22	-5.71
HyattHotels	H	115.24	-9.52
ICICI Bank	IBN	31.26	-0.18
IdexxLab	IDXX	410.76	-15.49
ING Groep	ING	19.00	-0.77
IQVIA	IQV	167.69	-6.68
ITT	ITT	119.56	-13.88
IcahnEnterprises	IEP	8.97	-0.16
Icon	ICLR	163.60	-5.10
IDEX	IEX	168.68	-14.62
IllinoisToolWks	ITW	239.44	-12.99
Illumina	ILMN	76.42	-5.46
ImperialOil	IMO	68.59	-4.94
Incyte	INCY	62.46	0.13
Infosys	INFY	17.35	-1.04
IngersollRand	IR	73.52	-8.18
Ingredion	INGR	136.41	1.09
Insmed	INSM	73.33	-0.11
Insulet	PODD	256.80	-12.33
Intel	INTC	22.43	0.45
InteractiveBrkrs	IBKR	159.48	-14.83
ICE	ICE	167.56	-2.88
InterContHtls	IHG	105.55	-5.81
IBM	IBM	243.49	-6.49
IntlFlavors	IFF	76.45	-2.17
IntlPaper	IP	49.18	-5.28
Interpublic	IPG	24.58	-1.46
Intuit	INTU	598.53	-22.38
IntuitiveSurgical	ISRG	494.61	-12.44
InvitatHomes	INVH	33.99	-0.64
IronMountain	IRM	83.10	-5.00
ItauUnibanco	ITUB	5.69	0.16
J K L			
JD.com	JD	39.90	-1.19
JPMorganChase	JPM	228.69	-17.13
Jabil	JBL	123.49	-15.26
JackHenry	JKHY	184.60	0.49
JacobsSolns	J	118.48	-6.04
JamesHardie	JHX	22.97	-0.76
JazzPharm	JAZZ	120.82	-5.62
JefferiesFinl	JEF	47.95	-7.19
J&J	JNJ	159.82	4.46
JohnsonControls	JCI	77.23	-5.63
JonesLang	JLL	232.00	-18.86
JuniperNetworks	JNPR	35.24	-0.83
KB Financial	KB	52.31	-3.49
KE Holdings	BEKE	20.98	0.55
KKR	KKR	102.55	-18.35
KLA	KLAC	620.82	-65.37
KT	KT	17.87	0.56
Kanzhun	BZ	18.87	-0.13
Kaspi.kz	KSPI	90.43	-4.11
Kellanova	K	82.55	0.10
Kenvue	KVUE	23.62	-0.25
KeurigDrPepper	KDP	35.63	0.49
KeyCorp	KEY	14.12	-1.95
KeysightTech	KEYS	135.73	-15.98
KimberlyClark	KMB	145.22	2.32
KimcoRealty	KIM	20.07	-1.38
KinderMorgan	KMI	27.72	-1.20
Kinetik	KNTK	49.15	-4.68
KinrossGold	KGC	12.69	-0.16
KinsaleCapital	KNSL	498.60	7.10
Klaviyo	KVYO	27.88	-3.49
Philips	PHG	23.86	-0.98
KoreaElecPwr	KEP	7.38	0.07
KraftHeinz	KHC	30.81	0.68
Kroger	KR	70.74	3.47
Kyndryl	KD	31.00	-2.09
LatamAirlines	LTM	30.90	-0.30
LKQ	LKQ	42.18	-1.20
LPL Financial	LPLA	312.75	-25.65
L3HarrisTech	LHX	209.94	-1.96
Labcorp	LH	233.46	-2.91
LamResearch	LRCX	65.22	-8.56
LamarAdv	LAMR	109.45	-6.49
LambWeston	LW	59.57	5.42
LasVegasSands	LVS	36.41	-2.63
Leidos	LDOS	139.49	-3.45
Lennar B	LEN.B	102.40	-7.26
Lennar A	LEN	108.40	-7.26
LennoxIntl	LII	546.82	-27.71
LeonardoDRS	DRS	32.71	-1.20
LiAuto	LI	24.77	-0.75
LibertyBroadbandC	LBRDK	84.52	-3.05
LibertyBroadbandA	LBRDA	83.56	-3.24
LibertyLiveC	LLYVK	66.56	-4.98
LibertyLiveA	LLYVA	65.49	-4.90
LibertyFormOne C	FWONK	86.71	-3.34
LibertyFormOne A	FWONA	78.03	-3.81
Light&Wonder	LNW	84.00	-7.95
EliLilly	LLY	789.09	-29.13
LincolnElectric	LECO	179.43	-15.35
Linde	LIN	467.22	-2.52
Lineage	LINE	56.41	-2.12
LithiaMotors	LAD	282.32	-23.80
LiveNationEnt	LYV	126.06	-8.59
LloydsBanking	LYG	3.67	-0.17
LockheedMartin	LMT	454.78	1.91
Loews	L	91.11	-0.92
LogitechIntl	LOGI	71.41	-14.26
Lowe's	LOW	222.52	-12.76
lululemon	LULU	255.65	-27.10
LyondellBasell	LYB	63.11	-7.54
M N			
Macom Tech	MTSI	92.17	-11.61
M&T Bank	MTB	163.36	-16.35
MGM Resorts	MGM	27.90	-2.85
MPLX	MPLX	52.17	-1.72
MSCI	MSCI	544.18	-31.78
MagnaIntl	MGA	33.13	-1.44
MakeMyTrip	MMYT	96.07	-5.32
ManhattanAssoc	MANH	161.76	-17.13
ManulifeFinl	MFC	30.63	-1.72
Maplebear	CART	40.02	-0.48
MarathonPetrol	MPC	128.59	-19.31
Markel	MKL	1827.46	-51.48
MarketAxess	MKTX	216.15	5.32
Marriott	MAR	224.62	-17.94
Marsh&McLen	MMC	244.27	1.45
MartinMarietta	MLM	484.97	-7.50
MarvellTech	MRVL	55.64	-7.59
Masco	MAS	64.15	-6.91
Masimo	MASI	152.37	-19.11
MasTec	MTZ	112.00	-10.76
Mastercard	MA	530.55	-16.83
MatchGroup	MTCH	30.18	-1.10
McCormickVtg	MKC.V	80.34	-0.54
McCormick	MKC	80.84	-0.45
McDonald's	MCD	318.27	6.69
McKesson	MCK	716.93	23.40
Medpace	MEDP	304.11	-7.12
Medtronic	MDT	87.89	-0.97
MercadoLibre	MELI	1945.55	11.52
Merck	MRK	86.39	-0.21
MetaPlatforms	META	531.62	-52.31
MetLife	MET	75.91	-6.58
Mettler-Toledo	MTD	1095.24	-77.26
MicrochipTech	MCHP	40.71	-8.22
MicronTech	MU	74.34	-14.26
Microsoft	MSFT	373.11	-9.03
MicroStrategy	MSTR	282.28	-30.26
MidAmApt	MAA	163.64	-4.36
Middleby	MIDD	142.17	-12.59
MitsubishiUFJ	MUFG	12.10	-1.12
MizuhoFin	MFG	4.96	-0.48
Mobileye	MBLY	14.26	-0.71
Moderna	MRNA	25.73	-1.99
MolinaHealthcare	MOH	353.24	24.75
MolsonCoorsB	TAP	62.46	0.51
monday.com	MNDY	233.63	-32.97
Mondelez	MDLZ	67.90	1.77
MongoDB	MDB	163.34	-16.85
MonolithicPower	MPWR	498.68	-91.97
MonsterBev	MNST	59.65	0.29
Moody's	MCO	442.39	-28.50
MorganStanley	MS	107.93	-11.34
Morningstar	MORN	290.88	-11.00
Mosaic	MOS	25.96	-0.51
MotorolaSol	MSI	435.50	-1.49
MrCooper	COOP	133.10	-0.46
MuellerIndustries	MLI	74.08	-5.31
MurphyUSA	MUSA	482.55	2.20
NICE	NICE	150.34	-7.36
NIO	NIO	3.74	-0.06
NNN REIT	NNN	41.89	-0.52
NRG Energy	NRG	92.77	-10.11
NVR	NVR	7109.99	-192.08
NXP Semicon	NXPI	171.88	-21.79
Nasdaq	NDAQ	73.79	-4.51
Natera	NTRA	138.71	-4.49
NationalGrid	NGG	69.39	3.61
NatWest	NWG	11.85	-0.32
NetApp	NTAP	81.61	-8.88
NetEase	NTES	104.94	-1.46
Netflix	NFLX	917.05	-18.47
Neurocrine	NBIX	102.88	-5.43
NewOrientalEduc	EDU	47.79	-0.80
NYTimes A	NYT	48.75	-0.85
Newmont	NEM	48.33	-0.40
NewsCorp B	NWS	29.43	-1.12
NewsCorp A	NWSA	26.07	-0.99
NextEraEnergy	NEE	72.14	1.66
Nike	NKE	55.58	-9.38
NiSource	NI	39.75	-0.89
Nokia	NOK	4.98	-0.37
Nomura	NMR	5.63	-0.54
Nordson	NDSN	186.39	-16.96
NorfolkSouthern	NSC	220.74	-17.83
NorthernTrust	NTRS	90.58	-8.15
NorthropGrum	NOC	515.17	2.99
NorwegCruise	NCLH	16.31	-3.19
Novartis	NVS	112.26	1.49
NovoNordisk	NVO	67.10	-1.14
NuHoldings	NU	10.27	-0.32
Nucor	NUE	109.79	-13.24
Nutanix	NTNX	64.78	-6.59
Nutrien	NTR	50.71	0.76
nVentElectric	NVT	48.32	-6.61
NVIDIA	NVDA	101.80	-8.62
O P Q			
OGE Energy	OGE	46.00	-0.38
ONEOK	OKE	92.70	-7.67
ON Semi	ON	35.56	-5.20
O'ReillyAuto	ORLY	1441.89	24.88
OccidentalPetrol	OXY	43.90	-5.43
Okta	OKTA	100.27	-5.11
OldDomFreight	ODFL	155.75	-14.35
OldRepublic	ORI	39.36	-0.43
OmegaHealthcare	OHI	38.65	0.77
Omnicom	OMC	75.38	-4.04
OnHolding	ONON	37.65	-7.27
Oracle	ORCL	137.23	-8.63
Orix	IX	20.32	-0.66
OtisWorldwide	OTIS	104.30	0.36
Ovintiv	OVV	39.05	-5.09
OwensCorning	OC	137.26	-9.93
PDD	PDD	113.67	-5.40
PG&E	PCG	17.25	-0.18
PNC Finl	PNC	161.29	-15.72
POSCO	PKX	45.14	-1.61
PPG Ind	PPG	103.99	-6.12
PPL	PPL	36.23	0.10
PTC	PTC	149.53	-7.63
Paccar	PCAR	92.36	-6.73
PackagingCpAm	PKG	189.16	-12.20
PalantirTech	PLTR	83.60	-3.85
PaloAltoNtwks	PANW	165.17	-8.01
PanAmerSilver	PAAS	24.42	-1.55
ParamountB	PARA	11.48	-0.42
ParamountA	PARAA	22.50	-0.06
ParkerHannifin	PH	556.70	-72.28
Paychex	PAYX	153.53	-1.41
PaycomSoftware	PAYC	213.43	-5.05
Paylocity	PCTY	182.76	-7.55
PayPal	PYPL	61.71	-5.44
Pearson	PSO	16.02	-0.05
PembinaPipeline	PBA	40.40	-0.48
PenskeAuto	PAG	141.12	-8.38
Pentair	PNR	81.54	-7.55
Penumbra	PEN	273.24	-4.11
PepsiCo	PEP	151.37	2.25
PerformanceFood	PFGC	76.05	-4.89
PermianRscs	PR	12.26	-1.92
PetroleoBrasil	PBR	14.01	-0.38
PetroleoBrasilA	PBR.A	12.75	-0.34
Pfizer	PFE	24.29	-0.41
PhilipMorris	PM	162.07	5.90
Phillips66	PSX	107.18	-16.88
Pilgrim'sPride	PPC	51.06	2.06
PinnacleFinPtrs	PNFP	91.83	-15.04
PinnacleWest	PNW	95.21	-0.22
Pinterest	PINS	27.51	-3.87
PlainsAllAmPipe	PAA	19.24	-1.04
PlainsGP	PAGP	20.65	-0.96
PlanetFitness	PLNT	97.42	-1.35
Pool	POOL	313.85	-11.81
Primerica	PRI	275.44	-15.18
PrimoBrands	PRMB	35.63	0.88
PrincipalFinl	PFG	79.32	-6.87
ProcoreTech	PCOR	62.06	-6.91
Procter&Gamble	PG	172.39	2.89
Progressive	PGR	287.00	5.87
Prologis	PLD	101.59	-10.75
PrudentialFinl	PRU	104.79	-7.92
Prudential	PUK	20.92	-0.92
PSEG	PEG	81.55	-2.24
PublicStorage	PSA	294.74	-2.19
PulteGroup	PHM	97.75	-6.58
PureStorage	PSTG	40.85	-5.16
Qiagen	QGEN	40.37	0.35
Qualcomm	QCOM	139.42	-14.66
QuantaServices	PWR	252.04	-12.45
QuestDiag	DGX	170.63	2.67
R S			
RBC Bearings	RBC	317.19	-19.80
RB Global	RBA	98.04	-2.90
RELX	RELX	51.44	0.46
RPM	RPM	112.59	-4.99
RTX	RTX	130.23	-2.92
RalphLauren	RL	197.89	-38.46
RangeResources	RRC	38.07	-2.54
RaymondJames	RJF	130.28	-11.61
RealtyIncome	O	57.06	-0.06
Reddit	RDDT	96.90	-12.60
RegalRexnord	RRX	102.71	-18.80
RegencyCtrs	REG	72.09	-2.65
RegenPharm	REGN	610.64	-14.96
RegionsFinl	RF	19.61	-2.41
ReinsGrp	RGA	187.11	-12.85
Reliance	RS	275.32	-18.58
RenaissanceRe	RNR	245.35	-3.80
RentokilInit	RTO	22.79	-0.37
RepublicSvcs	RSG	248.44	3.62
ResMed	RMD	213.35	-9.65
RestaurantBrands	QSR	67.82	0.93
Revvity	RVTY	100.75	-5.97
RexfordIndlRealty	REXR	35.87	-3.54
RioTinto	RIO	58.43	-1.47
Rivian	RIVN	11.53	-0.96
Robinhood	HOOD	38.26	-4.42
Roblox	RBLX	58.22	-3.39
RocketCos.	RKT	13.85	-0.01
RocketLab	RKLB	17.89	-1.45
Rockwell	ROK	239.16	-21.70
RogersComm B	RCI	26.07	0.78
Roku	ROKU	60.26	-11.16
Rollins	ROL	55.90	1.17
RoperTech	ROP	579.70	-10.66
RossStores	ROST	131.21	-1.16
RoyalBkCanada	RY	115.11	0.39
RoyalCaribbean	RCL	188.65	-23.40
RoyalGold	RGLD	167.27	2.71
RoyaltyPharma	RPRX	31.79	0.51
Rubrik	RBRK	57.45	-4.98
RyanSpecialty	RYAN	75.93	0.87
Ryanair	RYAAY	41.93	-1.08
SAP	SAP	264.34	-7.08
S&P Global	SPGI	489.38	-24.60
SBA Comm	SBAC	230.87	11.53
SEI Investments	SEIC	73.49	-4.10
SK Telecom	SKM	21.62	0.32
SS&C Tech	SSNC	79.98	-3.44
Saia	SAIA	319.97	-50.85
SailPoint	SAIL	17.55	-1.40
Salesforce	CRM	255.23	-16.31
Samsara	IOT	34.11	-3.89
Sanofi	SNY	54.62	0.67
Schlumberger	SLB	39.21	-2.98
SchwabC	SCHW	74.87	-3.72
Sea	SE	120.05	-14.53
Seagate	STX	71.53	-13.99
Sempra	SRE	70.73	-2.11
ServiceIntl	SCI	81.38	-0.18
ServiceNow	NOW	774.07	-49.96
ServiceTitan	TTAN	89.90	-8.23
SharkNinja	SN	69.49	-18.94
Shell	SHEL	69.77	-2.95
SherwinWilliams	SHW	340.65	-13.01
ShinhanFin	SHG	31.97	-1.30
Shopify	SHOP	82.29	-18.36
SimonProperty	SPG	153.18	-17.23
SkechersUSA	SKX	48.96	-10.07
Skyworks	SWKS	56.76	-8.04
SmithAO	AOS	63.66	-2.46
Smith&Nephew	SNN	27.94	-0.19
SmithfieldFds	SFD	20.87	0.08
Smucker	SJM	118.32	-0.13
SmurfitWestrock	SW	42.71	-4.35
Snap	SNAP	8.02	-0.86
Snap-On	SNA	327.45	-14.75
Snowflake	SNOW	139.90	-14.01
SOQUIMICH	SQM	39.41	-0.36
SoFiTech	SOFI	10.64	-1.67
Solventum	SOLV	70.19	-6.43
Somnigroup	SGI	58.24	-4.24
Sony	SONY	23.38	-1.46
SouthState	SSB	84.63	-10.04
Southern	SO	92.56	1.26
SoCopper	SCCO	86.73	-7.63
SouthwestAir	LUV	28.86	-3.00
Spotify	SPOT	558.42	-6.99
SproutsFarmers	SFM	153.28	-5.06
StandardAero	SARO	25.60	-1.59
StanleyB&D	SWK	64.66	-12.32
Stantec	STN	84.71	-0.55
Starbucks	SBUX	88.26	-11.15
StateStreet	STT	82.83	-6.76
SteelDynamics	STLD	116.06	-11.30
Stellantis	STLA	10.21	-1.06
Steris	STE	221.41	-6.16
StifelFinancial	SF	86.01	-10.49
STMicroelec	STM	19.53	-2.38
Stryker	SYK	368.15	-9.31
SumitomoMits	SMFG	13.56	-1.46
SummitTherap	SMMT	18.91	-1.55
SunComms	SUI	130.07	1.14
SunLifeFinancial	SLF	58.25	-0.52
SuncorEnergy	SU	36.78	-2.35
Sunoco	SUN	57.00	-2.13
SuperMicroComp	SMCI	32.32	-2.77
Suzano	SUZ	9.10	-0.23
Symbotic	SYM	18.24	-3.79
SynchronyFinl	SYF	46.56	-8.49
Synopsys	SNPS	417.76	-20.79
Sysco	SYY	75.41	0.11
T U V			
TAL Education	TAL	13.51	-0.20
TC Energy	TRP	48.72	...
TD Synnex	SNX	99.48	-7.27
TE Connectivity	TEL	129.98	-12.31
Telus	TU	14.54	0.55
TIM	TIMB	16.51	0.55
TJX	TJX	125.43	0.50
TKO	TKO	150.44	-8.14
T-MobileUS	TMUS	267.89	3.33
TPG	TPG	42.33	-7.29
T.RowePrice	TROW	86.22	-7.68
TaiwanSemi	TSM	157.38	-13.01
Take-TwoSftwr	TTWO	208.93	-2.17
TakedaPharm	TAK	15.19	0.21
TalenEnergy	TLN	184.41	-30.32
Tapestry	TPR	65.09	-9.65
TargaResources	TRGP	180.72	-25.00
Target	TGT	94.28	-11.49
TechnipFMC	FTI	29.49	-3.13
TeckResourcesB	TECK	34.08	-3.52
TeledyneTech	TDY	471.60	-28.08
Ericsson	ERIC	7.48	-0.31
TelefonicaBras	VIV	9.30	0.31
Telefonica	TEF	4.91	0.24
TelekmIndonesia	TLK	14.77	-0.04
TempusAI	TEM	46.17	-3.72
Tenaris	TS	35.90	-3.33
TencentMusic	TME	14.32	0.03
TenetHealthcare	THC	132.86	-4.32
Teradyne	TER	75.09	-8.53
Tesla	TSLA	267.28	-15.48
TetraTech	TTEK	30.01	-0.81
TevaPharm	TEVA	14.85	-0.44
TexasInstruments	TXN	164.20	-13.99
TexasPacLand	TPL	1220.98	-170.45
TexasRoadhouse	TXRH	167.05	-5.17
Textron	TXT	66.87	-5.61
ThermoFisher	TMO	470.03	-19.03
ThomsonReuters	TRI	175.91	0.38
3M	MMM	139.74	-8.02
Toast	TOST	32.66	-3.02
TollBros	TOL	98.39	-8.52
TopBuild	BLD	284.22	-28.77
TorontoDomBk	TD	58.66	-1.25
TotalEnergies	TTE	62.09	-2.31
ToyotaMotor	TM	168.07	-9.24
TractorSupply	TSCO	55.77	0.15
TradeDesk	TTD	49.08	-7.22
Tradeweb	TW	149.02	0.53
TraneTech	TT	331.04	-16.90
TransDigm	TDG	1363.42	-36.15
TransUnion	TRU	75.38	-10.35
Travelers	TRV	263.10	-1.39
Trimble	TRMB	60.28	-6.23
Trip.com	TCOM	61.20	-2.38
TruistFinl	TFC	37.04	-4.52
Twilio	TWLO	89.53	-10.83
TylerTech	TYL	569.68	-12.13
TysonFoods	TSN	63.56	0.81
UBS Group	UBS	28.22	-2.23
UDR	UDR	43.70	-1.66
U-Haul	UHAL	64.52	-3.36
U-Haul N	UHAL/B	57.69	-3.25
UL Solutions	ULS	57.38	0.27
US Foods	USFD	65.02	-2.06
UWM	UWMC	5.56	-0.23
Uber	UBER	69.85	-4.65
Ubiquiti	UI	289.77	-35.13
UltaBeauty	ULTA	367.76	-14.75
Unilever	UL	62.55	2.69
UnionPacific	UNP	223.97	-14.49
UnitedAirlines	UAL	60.23	-11.14
UnitedMicro	UMC	6.44	-0.28
UPS B	UPS	100.12	-10.08
UnitedRentals	URI	591.17	-55.00
US Bancorp	USB	38.79	-4.22
US Steel	X	38.95	-3.45
UnitedTherap	UTHR	307.36	-4.90
UnitedHealth	UNH	540.44	17.24
UnitySoftware	U	18.19	-2.72
UniversalHealthB	UHS	188.73	-0.05
UnumGroup	UNM	79.24	-3.67
VICI Prop	VICI	31.66	-0.53
Vale	VALE	9.73	-0.36
ValeroEnergy	VLO	114.29	-19.33
VeevaSystems	VEEV	221.49	-5.05
Ventas	VTR	69.60	0.21
VentureGlobal	VG	8.98	-0.98
Veralto	VLTO	93.90	-4.78
VeriSign	VRSN	255.43	-0.07
VeriskAnalytics	VRSK	305.09	5.38
Verizon	VZ	45.62	0.88
VertexPharm	VRTX	484.01	0.52
Vertiv	VRT	67.47	-9.64
Viatris	VTRS	8.16	-0.50
Viking	VIK	38.34	-3.63
ViperEnergy	VNOM	41.56	-4.38
Vipshop	VIPS	14.83	-0.51
Visa	V	339.39	-6.94
Vistra	VST	108.21	-18.98
Vodafone	VOD	9.37	0.25
VornadoRealty	VNO	33.92	-4.20
VulcanMatls	VMC	237.18	-2.92
W X Y Z			
WEC Energy	WEC	108.53	-0.31
W.P.Carey	WPC	61.38	-1.30
WPP	WPP	36.69	-0.84
Wabtec	WAB	173.58	-12.33
WalgreensBoots	WBA	11.06	-0.12
Walmart	WMT	87.26	-2.50
WarnerBrosA	WBD	9.16	-1.40
WarnerMusic	WMG	30.93	-0.21
WasteConnections	WCN	199.95	3.33
WasteMgt	WM	236.83	2.27
Waters	WAT	345.12	-17.52
Watsco	WSO	492.52	-28.14
WebsterFin	WBS	43.95	-7.54
WellsFargo	WFC	65.67	-6.59
Welltower	WELL	152.43	-0.65
WescoIntl	WCC	143.72	-18.67
WestPharmSvcs	WST	219.97	-1.53
WestAllianceBcp	WAL	65.27	-12.37
WesternDigital	WDC	34.15	-7.63
WesternMidstrm	WES	40.20	-1.41
Westlake	WLK	94.24	-7.77
Weyerhaeuser	WY	27.43	-2.05
WheatonPrecMtls	WPM	78.50	0.84
Williams	WMB	59.03	-2.57
Williams-Sonoma	WSM	138.86	-26.15
WillisTowers	WTW	332.41	-5.02
Wipro	WIT	2.92	-0.17
Wix.com	WIX	155.94	-9.93
WoodsideEnergy	WDS	13.62	-0.92
Woodward	WWD	174.90	-15.24
WooriFinl	WF	33.27	-0.84
Workday	WDAY	228.33	-7.06
WynnResorts	WYNN	72.88	-8.66
XPO	XPO	96.01	-15.30
XcelEnergy	XEL	72.14	1.24
XChangeTEC.INC	XHG	0.74	-0.01
XPeng	XPEV	21.12	...
Xylem	XYL	110.99	-8.06
YPF	YPF	33.55	-1.95
Yum!Brands	YUM	161.45	3.22
YumChina	YUMC	52.63	-0.65
ZTO Express	ZTO	19.11	-0.37
ZebraTech	ZBRA	238.50	-49.07
Zillow C	Z	68.51	-2.78
Zillow A	ZG	66.86	-2.89
ZimmerBiomet	ZBH	112.66	0.16
Zoetis	ZTS	159.61	-3.89
ZoomComms	ZM	73.25	-1.79
Zscaler	ZS	192.21	-14.83

Mutual Funds

Data provided by LSEG

Top 250 mutual-funds listings for Nasdaq-published share classes by net assets.

e-Ex-distribution. **f**-Previous day's quotation. **g**-Footnotes x and s apply. **j**-Footnotes e and s apply. **k**-Recalculated by LSEG, using updated data. **p**-Distribution costs apply, 12b-1. **r**-Redemption charge may apply. **s**-Stock split or dividend. **t**-Footnotes p and r apply. **v**-Footnotes x and e apply. **x**-Ex-dividend. **z**-Footnote x, e and s apply. **NA**-Not available due to incomplete price, performance or cost data. **NE**-Not released by LSEG; data under review. **NN**-Fund not tracked. **NS**-Fund didn't exist at start of period.

Thursday, April 3, 2025

Fund	NAV	Net Chg	YTD %Ret
AB Funds			
MuniIncmShares	11.22	+0.08	1.6
AB Funds - ADV			
LgCpGrAdv	96.91	-4.76	-11.4
American Century Inv			
Ultra	NA	...	NA
American Funds Cl A			
AmcpA	38.44	-2.06	-10.0
AMutlA	54.73	-1.83	-0.4
BalA	33.49	-0.88	-2.2
BondA	11.42	+0.07	3.6
CapIBA	71.08	-1.20	3.7
CapWGrA	61.69	-2.23	-2.6
EupacA	54.08	-1.56	0.7
FdInvA	75.27	-3.67	-6.5
GwthA	66.88	-3.99	-10.2
HI TrA	9.63	-0.12	0.2
ICAA	53.77	-2.56	-6.5
IncoA	25.01	-0.51	3.1
N PerA	59.16	-2.45	-4.7
NEcoA	55.37	-3.03	-9.4
NwWrldA	77.05	-1.86	...
SmCpA	61.06	-2.91	-9.4
TxExA	12.38	+0.06	0.7
WshA	59.64	-2.28	-2.8
Artisan Funds			
IntlVal Inst	48.96	-0.70	4.3
Baird Funds			
AggBdInst	9.90	+0.05	3.6
CorBdInst	10.24	+0.05	3.3
ShtTBdInst	9.54	+0.03	1.9
BlackRock Funds			
HiYBlk	6.98	-0.08	0.1
HiYldBd Inst	6.98	-0.08	...
BlackRock Funds III			
iShS&P500IdxK	631.52	-32.08	-7.9
BlackRock Funds Inst			
StratIncOpptyIns	9.55	+0.02	2.1
TotRet	9.93	+0.04	3.3
Calamos Funds			
MktNeutI	NA	...	NA
CausewayInst			
CausewayInst	19.99	-0.53	7.7
Columbia Class I			
DivIncom I	32.64	-1.14	-0.7
Dimensional Fds			
EmMktCorEq	23.22	-0.49	-0.1
IntlCoreEq	16.24	-0.31	5.5
IntSmCo	20.14	-0.34	3.9
IntSmVa	23.75	-0.49	8.4
LgCo	35.78	-1.81	-8.0
US CoreEq1	39.59	-2.23	-8.2
US CoreEq2	35.26	-2.05	-8.3
US Small	42.67	-3.17	-12.5
US SmCpVal	41.46	-3.68	-14.2
US TgdVal	29.89	-2.47	-12.6
USLgVa	48.01	-2.39	-2.1
Dodge & Cox			
Balanced	103.32	-2.06	3.2
Income	12.71	+0.07	3.8
Intl Stk	53.87	-1.12	8.0
Stock	252.46	-11.61	-0.3
DoubleLine Funds			
TotRetBdI	8.91	+0.06	NA
Edgewood Growth Instituti			
EdgewoodGrInst	39.44	-2.00	-11.0
Federated Hermes Int			
TtlRtnBdI	9.56	+0.06	3.4
Fidelity			
500IdxInstPrem	187.98	-9.55	-7.9
Contrafund K6	28.49	-1.59	-8.2
ExtMktIdxInstPre	78.74	-5.91	-13.4
FidSer5	7.79	+0.05	5.7
FidSerInt	8.67	+0.04	-0.1
FidSerToMarket	17.54	-0.94	-8.6
FIDZroLgCpIx	19.20	-0.99	-8.2
GlexUSIdxInstPre	15.11	-0.32	4.8
GrowthCompanyK6	25.28	-1.80	-16.9
IntlIdxInstPrem	50.60	-1.02	6.4
LgCpGwId InstPre	33.85	-2.03	-13.6
LgCpVlIdxIstPrem	17.85	-0.78	-1.6
MidCpInxInstPrem	31.34	-1.81	-7.2
SAIUSLgCpIndxFd	21.39	-1.09	-8.0
SeriesBondFd	9.09	+0.04	3.5
SeriesOverseas	14.17	-0.33	5.4
SerLTTreBdIdx	5.59	+0.04	6.3
SmCpIdxInstPrem	23.80	-1.68	-14.0
TMktIdxInstPrem	147.35	-7.91	-8.6
TotalMarketIndex	18.62	-1.00	-8.6
TtlIntIdxInstPr	14.00	-0.28	4.2
USBdIdxInstPrem	10.48	+0.05	3.5
Fidelity Freedom			
Freedom2030 K	17.50	-0.39	-0.3
Idx2030InsPre	20.07	-0.42	-0.5
Idx2035InsPre	23.05	-0.57	-1.2
Idx2040InsPre	24.09	-0.76	-2.2
Idx2045InsPre	25.23	-0.89	-2.7
Idx2050InsPre	25.28	-0.89	-2.7
Fidelity Invest			
Balanc	28.13	-0.86	-4.8
BluCh	187.02	-14.65	-17.7
BluChpGr K6	30.52	-2.31	-17.1
Contra	19.24	-1.06	-7.8
ContraK	19.31	-1.06	-7.8
CpInc	9.77	-0.21	-2.7
GroCo	33.55	-2.33	-16.8
InvGrBd	10.14	+0.05	3.7
LowP	38.79	-1.94	-4.8
Magin	13.52	-0.67	-8.8
NASDAQ	210.12	-13.33	-14.2
OTC	18.19	-1.13	-15.3
Puritn	23.31	-0.80	-6.2
SAIUSMinVolIndFd	21.62	-0.39	0.8
SAIUSQtyIdx	19.99	-0.85	-6.1
SrsBlChGroRetail	16.33	-1.25	-17.7
SrsEmrgMkt	18.79	-0.41	2.6
SrsGlobal	14.86	-0.30	4.8
SrsGroCoRetail	19.98	-1.39	-16.6
SrsIntlGrw	17.55	-0.48	0.7
SrsIntlVal	13.29	-0.35	11.5
TotalBond	9.61	+0.03	3.3
Fidelity SAI			
FidSaiInfltnFnd	10.30	+0.07	4.8
TotalBd	9.11	+0.04	3.4
Fidelity Selects			
Semiconductors r	25.03	-3.01	-25.2
Tech	29.69	-2.58	-19.5
Fidelity Strategic A			
StratAdEmrMrt	NA	...	NA
First Eagle Funds			
GlbA	70.49	-1.45	5.2
Franklin A1			
IncomeA1	NA	...	NA
FrankTemp/Frank Adv			
IncomeAdv	2.31	-0.04	NA
FrankTemp/Franklin A			
DynaTech A	146.49	-9.73	-16.1
Growth A	121.46	-5.88	-9.0
RisDv A	85.31	-3.05	-4.2
Guggenheim Funds Tru			
TotRtnBdFdClInst	24.00	+0.10	3.6
Harbor Funds			
CapApInst	NA	...	NA
JHF III DispVal			
DispValMCI	NA	...	NA
John Hancock			
BondR6	13.62	+0.05	3.3
JPMorgan I Class			
CoreBond	10.39	+0.07	3.9
EqInc	23.55	-1.05	-1.2
LgCpGwth	70.93	-3.72	-11.0
JPMorgan R Class			
CoreBond	10.40	+0.06	3.8
CorePlusBd	7.29	+0.04	3.6
Lord Abbett I			
ShtDurInc p	3.88	+0.01	1.8
Metropolitan West			
TotRetBdI	NA	...	NA
MFS Funds			
IIE	35.62	-0.65	5.3
MFS Funds Class I			
GrowthI	176.38	-10.46	-12.5
ValueI	48.96	-1.69	0.8
Natixis Funds			
InvGradeBdY	9.88	+0.02	2.8
LSGrowthY	25.71	-1.51	-13.0
Northern Funds			
StkIdx	54.70	-2.77	-8.0
Old Westbury Fds			
LrgCpStr	NA	...	NA
Parnassus Fds			
ParnEqFd	56.47	-2.18	-5.2
PGIM Funds Cl Z			
TotalReturnBond	NA	...	NA
PIMCO Fds Instl			
TotRt	NA	...	NA
PIMCO Funds A			
IncomeFd	NA	...	NA
PIMCO Funds I2			
Income	NA	...	NA
PIMCO Funds Instl			
IncomeFd	NA	...	NA
Price Funds			
BlChip	162.22	-9.93	-12.9
DivGro	76.21	-2.70	-0.6
Growth	91.44	-5.37	-13.3
LgCapGow I	72.69	-4.23	-11.6
MidCap	89.05	-4.76	-10.7
Putnam Funds Class A			
PutLargCap p	33.89	-1.46	-1.4
Putnam Funds Class Y			
PutLargCap	33.90	-1.45	-1.3
Schwab Funds			
1000 Inv r	115.44	-6.10	-8.3
S&P Sel	83.10	-4.22	-7.9
TSM Sel r	90.54	-4.86	-8.6
Strategic Adviser			
StratAdCorInFnd	NA	...	NA
StratAdFidCoreS	9.22	+0.04	3.6
StratAdFidEmr	12.35	-0.27	1.9
StratAdFidUS	15.94	-0.83	-8.1
StratAdIntlFnd	NA	...	NA
StratAdMunBond	NA	...	NA
StratAdvFidIntl	12.53	-0.27	6.0
TIAA/CREF Funds			
BdIdxInst	9.73	+0.05	3.5
EqIdxInst	NA	...	NA
IntlEqIdxInst	23.38	-0.49	6.3
LrgCpGrIdxInst	NA	...	NA
VANGUARD ADMIRAL			
500Adml	NA	...	NA
BalAdml	NA	...	NA
CAITAdml	NA	...	NA
CapOpAdml r	NA	...	NA
DivAppIdxAdm	NA	...	NA
EMAdmr	37.01	-0.71	0.7
EqIncAdml	NA	...	NA
ExplrAdml	NA	...	NA
ExtndAdml	124.41	-9.34	-13.4
GroIncAdml	NA	...	NA
GrwthAdml	NA	...	NA
HlthCareAdml r	NA	...	NA
HYCorAdml r	NA	...	NA
InfProAd	23.52	+0.15	4.7
InfTechIdx	NA	...	NA
IntlGrAdml	NA	...	NA
ITBondAdml	NA	...	NA
ITIGradeAdml	NA	...	NA
LarCapAd	NA	...	NA
MidCpAdml	308.60	-16.03	-5.2
MuHYAdml	NA	...	NA
MuIntAdml	NA	...	NA
MuLTAdml	NA	...	NA
MuLtdAdml	NA	...	NA
MuShtAdml	NA	...	NA
PrmcpAdml r	NA	...	NA
RealEstatAdml	124.85	-4.29	-0.1
SmCapAdml	101.10	-7.25	-11.9
SmGthAdml	84.40	-6.02	-14.1
STBondAdml	NA	...	NA
STIGradeAdml	NA	...	NA
STIPSIxAdm	NA	...	NA
TotBdAdml	9.72	+0.05	NA
TotIntBdIdxAdm	NA	...	NA
TotIntlAdmIdx r	32.86	-0.68	NA
TotStAdml	NA	...	NA
TxMCapAdml	277.12	-14.29	NA
TxMIn r	NA	...	NA
USGroAdml	NA	...	NA
ValAdml	NA	...	NA
WdsrllAdml	NA	...	NA
WellsIAdml	NA	...	NA
WelltnAdml	NA	...	NA
WndsrAdml	NA	...	NA
VANGUARD FDS			
DivdGro	NA	...	NA
IntlVal	38.38	-1.05	2.2
LifeGro	NA	...	NA
LifeMod	NA	...	NA
PrmcpCor	NA	...	NA
STAR	NA	...	NA
TgtRe2020	NA	...	NA
TgtRe2025	NA	...	NA
TgtRe2030	NA	...	NA
TgtRe2035	NA	...	NA
TgtRe2040	NA	...	NA
TgtRe2045	NA	...	NA
TgtRe2050	NA	...	NA
TgtRe2060	NA	...	NA
TgtRet2055	NA	...	NA
TgtRetInc	NA	...	NA
Welltn	NA	...	NA
WndsrII	NA	...	NA
VANGUARD INDEX FDS			
ExtndIstPl	306.98	-23.06	-13.4
IdxIntl	19.64	-0.41	NA
MdCpGrAdml	101.37	-5.97	-7.1
MdCpVlAdml	80.20	-3.75	-3.7
SmValAdml	76.04	-5.48	-10.1
TotBd2	9.60	+0.06	3.6
TotIntlInstIdx r	131.39	-2.73	4.0
TotItlInstPlId r	131.42	-2.73	NA
TotSt	NA	...	NA
VANGUARD INSTL FDS			
BalInst	NA	...	NA
DevMktsIndInst	NA	...	NA
DevMktsInxInst	NA	...	NA
ExtndInst	124.40	-9.34	-13.4
FTScinst	NA	...	NA
GrwthInst	NA	...	NA
InstIdx	NA	...	NA
InstPlus	NA	...	NA
InstTStPlus	NA	...	NA
MidCpInst	68.17	-3.54	-5.2
MidCpIstPl	336.21	-17.46	-5.2
SmCapInst	101.10	-7.24	-11.8
SmCapIstPl	291.80	-20.91	-11.8
STIGradeInst	NA	...	NA
STIPSIxins	NA	...	NA
TotBdInst	9.72	+0.05	NA
TotBdInst2	9.60	+0.06	3.6
TotBdInstPl	NA	...	NA
TotIntBdIdxInst	NA	...	NA
TotStInst	NA	...	NA
ValueInst	NA	...	NA
WCM Focus Funds			
WCMFocIntlGrwIns	22.52	-0.68	3.5

HEARD ON THE STREET

FINANCIAL ANALYSIS & COMMENTARY

Why Trump's Tariffs Sank the Dollar

Worries that long-term U.S. growth will fade could matter more for the currency than the mechanical impact of levies

While President Trump has always claimed to want a weaker dollar, the consensus among investors was that his policies would strengthen it. Turns out he was right, but perhaps in the worst way.

On Thursday, stocks tumbled in the U.S., Europe and Asia following Trump's unveiling of a raft of punishing "Liberation Day" tariffs.

What was more unexpected is that the U.S. dollar tumbled against most major currencies. The WSJ Dollar Index, an indicator based on a basket of currencies, has now lost 5.9% this year and is below where it was on Nov. 5, before its postelection rally.

This is making Wall Street analysts look pretty bad: Most were telling investors, even up to the very moment that tariffs were announced Wednesday, that protectionist policies would push up the currency. The idea was that fewer purchases of overseas goods would narrow the trade deficit and mechanically reduce U.S. demand for foreign exchange. Also, U.S. growth is outpacing the eurozone's, which has historically been dollar-positive.

5.9%
The WSJ Dollar Index has fallen this much in the year to date to below its Nov. 5 level

Instead, speculators have swung to betting heavily against the greenback, Commodity Futures Trading Commission derivatives data shows.

The sudden unwind can't truly be about tariffs increasing the risk of recession. The dollar usually strengthens during busts as well as booms because investors seek refuge in it—creating the famous "dollar smile."

Why did the market get it wrong? Perhaps the greenback is at such expensive inflation-adjusted levels that it was primed to fall. Or, as some investors argue, U.S. economic aggression against allies is eroding the dollar's "global reserve" status.

The latter would be a win for the administration. In 2024, Trump's chief economic adviser, Stephen Miran, stressed the need to tackle the trade deficit by penalizing foreign central banks and treasurers for parking assets in the U.S. This is in line with the view that haven demand overvalues the dollar and places an "exorbitant burden" upon the American economy.

It lacks empirical support, though, since higher official foreign purchases tend to coincide with a weaker dollar. Global dollar reserves have flatlined since 2018 as the dollar rose 16%, per International Monetary Fund figures.

A better answer, which is less flattering for Trump, is that faith in the U.S.'s long-term economic potential is fading.

Currency traders can be short-term chasers of bond-yield differentials. Over five-year periods, however, the difference in return on equity between U.S. and European stocks has shown a 70% correlation to dollar-euro moves since 2001.

This suggests a good chunk of dollar strength is due to investments that track relative growth in economic productivity—largely driven by Silicon Valley raking in huge profits and turning the U.S. into a massive exporter of technology goods and, especially, services.

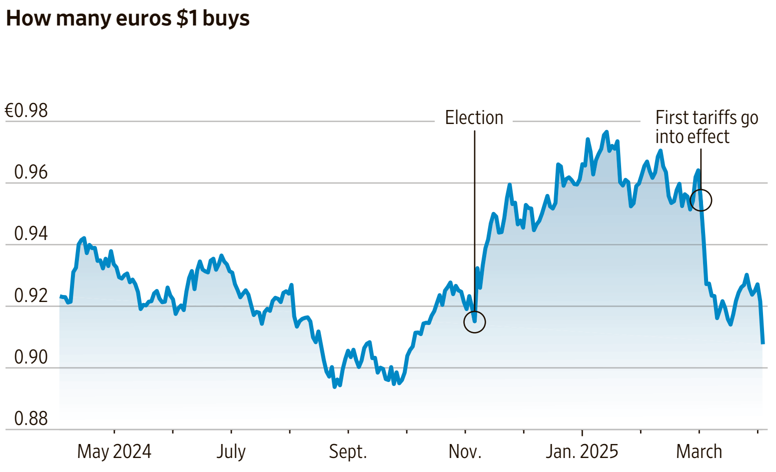
Markets might now be anticipating another structural shift. A rearmament push is fueling hopes of an economic revival in Europe, just as the U.S. growth story becomes tainted by protectionism and Chinese artificial-intelligence challengers.

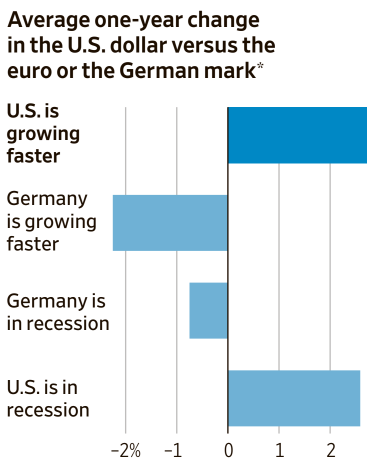
Of course, China's rise itself underscores that the textbook case for free trade is flawed, and that the U.S. government should arguably also try to promote key industries.

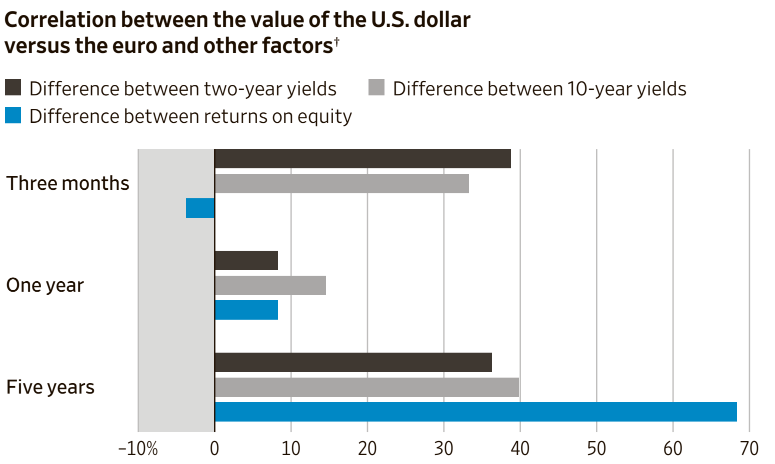
Offshoring to cut costs has often harmed workers, created fragile supply chains and made firms less eager to innovate. Troubled industrial giants such as chip maker **Intel** and aerospace giant **Boeing** can attest to that.

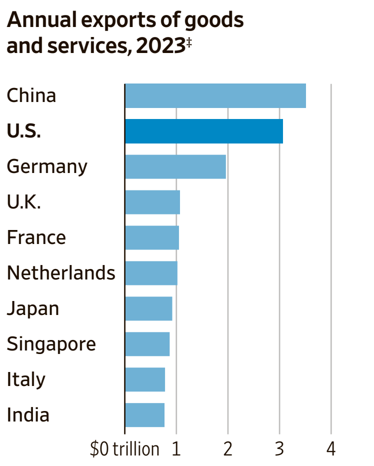
The problem is that Trump's tariffs have been sudden and erratic. Wednesday's list of reciprocal tariffs on each trading partner are a case in point, since they aren't based on any calculation that makes economic sense. Such policies are probably denting corporate investment rather than inducing companies to relocate production through a targeted and phased-in approach. More than Asia's development miracles, these policies resemble Latin America's flawed experiments with "import substitution."

Yes, there could be benefits to









*Data since 1991. The first two bars exclude recessionary periods. †Data between 2001 and 2025. Bond yields compare U.S. with Germany. ROE compares U.S. and European stocks. ‡In current U.S. dollars
Sources: Tullett Prebon (euros, exchange rate); Federal Reserve (GDP); FactSet (correlation); World Bank (annual exports)

JUAN IGNACIO RONCORONI/EPA/SHUTTERSTOCK

Most Wall Street analysts had been telling investors, even up until tariffs were announced Wednesday, that protectionist policies would push the dollar up.

General Motors and **Ford Motor** reshoring assembly jobs from Mexico.

But doing the same with all auto parts—including low-value components such as textiles and wiring harnesses—would just make the U.S. car industry very inefficient.

This comes atop likely retaliation by other countries and the 100% tariffs on Chinese electric vehicles inherited from the Biden era.

U.S. carmakers excel in the truck and SUV segments, where American consumers are particularly discerning. But they struggle to produce cars under $25,000, even before tariffs. **Tesla**, too, is a luxury brand.

If the U.S. market becomes isolated, foreign firms such as **Toyota** and **Hyundai**, which dominate budget models, may innovate less in their U.S. plants than abroad.

This is what happened to Brazil and Argentina, because their attempts to build a homegrown auto industry shielded companies from outside competition between the 1950s and 1980s. And it stands in contrast to how Japan, South Korea and China created world-class automakers by combining protectionism with the discipline of foreign markets.

Focusing too much on trade deficits overlooks the fact that the competitiveness and profitability of American tradable products have played a key role in determining the dollar's value. Right now, they are coming into question.

—Jon Sindreu

Exempt or Not, the Chip Industry Won't Escape Levies

It sounded like a welcome reprieve. But Donald Trump's exemption of semiconductors from his reciprocal tariffs offers little comfort for an industry whose products live inside an ever-expanding set of consumer goods.

It might not even last long. Speaking on Air Force One Thursday Trump said action on chips could be coming soon.

For now at least, the U.S.'s direct chip imports, which totaled around $82 billion last year, are exempt.

Yet most chip imports are indirect. Chips typically are made overseas, packaged there and inserted into electronics shipped across the globe—including to the U.S., where they will be subject to tariffs as high as 49%.

Even many U.S.-made chips are sent to Taiwan, China or Southeast Asia for final assembly before being re-exported to end customers.

That indirectness makes sizing up the impact to the semiconductor industry difficult. One thing is for sure: The hit will be substantial.

The U.S. imported some $521 billion of machinery, $478 billion of electronics and $386 billion of vehicles last year, according to a Bernstein Research analysis. Those things tend to contain a lot of chips, and chip sales fall if people respond to higher prices by buying fewer of them. That will eventually translate into lower revenue and growth rates for chip makers, potentially crimping profits and stock-market valuations.

"Overall we don't see much in the way of positive feelings here for the semi group (or frankly for anything else)," Bernstein analyst Stacy Rasgon said in a note.

No wonder the biggest chip stocks tumbled Thursday; the PHLX Semiconductor Sector index declined nearly 10%. Big chip buyers fell, too: **Apple** slid 9% and PC manufacturer **Dell Technologies** plunged 19%.

It is hard to find bright spots in tariffs' impact on the chip sector.

It is hard to find bright spots. The tariffs give chip makers no additional incentive to grow manufacturing in the U.S. Their products are generally exported into the Asian supply chain anyway before they come back inside tariffed goods.

Companies that already have large U.S. footprints, like **Texas Instruments** and **Analog Devices**, don't get a leg up on foreign competitors because those rivals receive the semiconductor tariff exemption.

Both of their stocks were down sharply Thursday.

A wave of order cancellations through the supply chain is likely on tap as chip makers and their customers anticipate flagging consumer demand caused by higher prices, Wolfe Research analyst Chris Caso said in a note. This would be similar to what happened during Covid lockdowns in 2020.

Consumer electronics will likely be hit hardest, but the tariffs also will increase the cost of highly demanded artificial-intelligence servers proffered by **Nvidia**, he said. This likely calls into question second-quarter earnings guidance across the industry.

"We think there is simply nowhere to hide from these effects," Caso said. Nvidia was down more than 7.8% Thursday.

Chip companies have yet to issue profit warnings, reflecting the as-yet-uncertain extent of the impact. To damp it, the industry may try to negotiate with the Trump administration to reduce tariffs where they hurt most, or to exempt more electronics and other goods that chips go into.

In a best-case scenario, the Trump administration responds by backing off many of the most-damaging tariffs, making Thursday's declines a buying opportunity. Given Trump's penchant for doubling down instead of backing down, the opposite scenario—even more tariffs—seems more likely.

—Asa Fitch

New U.S. Duties Bruise Luxury Brands

Luxury brands were immediate losers from President Trump's tariff onslaught.

Capri, which owns Michael Kors, slid 24% and **Ralph Lauren** declined 16%. Both labels have outsourced manufacturing to Asian countries including Vietnam and China, so now face sky-high tariff bills.

Swiss watches and charm bracelets fell, too. Switzerland faces a 31% tariff on exports to the U.S., higher than the 20% rate on European Union goods like French Champagne and Italian handbags.

This hit the shares of **Richemont**, the maker of Swiss watch brands Vacheron Constantin and Piaget, as well as Omega's owner **Swatch**.

Danish charm-bracelet maker **Pandora** fell nearly 11%. President Trump imposed a 36% tariff rate on Thailand, where the company does its manufacturing. This is far worse than the 10% levy management was bracing for.

Analysts at UBS think prices of luxury goods will go up 6% on average in the U.S. to offset tariffs. This will be most manageable for ultraexpensive brands like Brunello Cucinelli and Hermès that cater to superrich customers, but trickier for others.

The wider worry is that a trade war tips other countries into a slump.

A 54% tariff rate on China—a critical market for luxury brands—could make Chinese consumers hesitant to spend on designer baubles. Together, American and Chinese shoppers drive more than half of global luxury sales.

This explains the sharp drop at **Burberry**, which was otherwise spared by the U.K.'s relatively lenient 10% tariff rate. That is irrelevant if consumers around the world are in no mood to splash out on $2,000 trench coats.

—Carol Ryan

'Liberation Day' Leaves Apple With Only Tough Choices

Apple's costs are about to go way up thanks to tariffs. The biggest question facing the world's most valuable company now is whether to make customers pay for it—or investors.

It is a question with no easy answers—as evidenced by Apple's share-price wipeout Thursday. At one point the loss was equal to about $275 billion in market cap. Apple was the worst hit among megacap tech stocks in the tariff-sparked selloff, given that it is the only one in the group that depends on hardware not made in the U.S. for the majority of its revenue.

If Apple doesn't win any exemptions this time, the company will be faced with the choice of eating the higher costs or passing them along to its customers. Both have risks.

Apple commands some of the highest profit margins among tech hardware makers, giving it more room to absorb higher costs. But those margins are key to the company's appeal to investors. Raising prices could also prove tougher at a time when customers already aren't snapping up the latest iPhones.

Tariffs will take a bite out of Apple, one way or another.

—Dan Gallagher

$25 Million
An oceanfront estate in New Hampshire lists. **M9**

MANSION

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

$13 Million
Scarlett Johansson and Colin Jost buy on Park Avenue. **M4**

FROM TOP: TAYLOR GLENN FOR WSJ; LATHAM JENKINS/LIVE WATER JACKSON HOLE; ROB KAROSIS (NEW HAMPSHIRE)

Jackson Hole, a 60-mile long valley between the Teton and Gros Ventre mountains, is luring wealthy homebuyers. Downtown Jackson is known for its popular restaurants, shops and bars.

Jackson Hole, Now With Aspen Prices

During Covid, wealthy out-of-state buyers bought homes in the Wyoming enclave, drawn by its wide-open spaces and tax benefits. Now that the pandemic is over, they aren't going anywhere, and home prices keep climbing.

By E.B. Solomont

Growing up, Susan Been traveled every summer by RV from North Carolina to Wyoming's Jackson Hole, a 60-mile long valley between the Teton and Gros Ventre mountains. So in 2020, the Atlanta resident jumped at the chance to buy a newly built, roughly 4,400-square-foot vacation home in downtown Jackson.

At the time, homes of that size were trading for around $4 million, a number that has since jumped to about $8 million, thanks to a Covid-era price surge that hasn't let up. In fact, about six months after buying it, Been got an offer she couldn't refuse. She sold the house, but immediately regretted it and in 2023 bought a roughly 3,000-square-

Please turn to page M10

A 233-acre ranch in Jackson Hole went into contract within a week of going on the market.

HOMEOWNEROUS | KRIS FRIESWICK

The Megarich and America's Climate Disaster Zones

Wealthy buyers aren't just purchasing property in areas prone to extreme weather—they're also paying record prices to do so

A home in Palm Beach Gardens. Fla, was damaged by a tornado spawned by Hurricane Milton in Oct. 2024. It made landfall as a Cat. 3 storm.

IT IS NO surprise to anyone that the weather is making huge swaths of the U.S. increasingly inhospitable. Even places that were long considered safe zones, such as Vermont, which saw catastrophic flooding from Hurricane Beryl in 2024, are seeing more frequent and more ferocious natural disasters such as fires, floods, hurricanes, heat waves, droughts and landslides.

Homeowners in these areas are wrestling with what to do; stay and learn to live with this Sword of Damocles and its commensurate inconveniences, damage and skyrocketing home-insurance costs; or move somewhere that doesn't threaten destruction on

Please turn to page M6

MARIA ALEJANDRA CARDONA/REUTERS; EAGLEVIEW

William Lauder is in contract to sell a double waterfront lot for around $200 million. If it closes near that price, it will set a Palm Beach record.

Developer to Buy The Malibu Home Abandoned by Kanye

UPDATE

Less than a week after going on the market, the Malibu, Calif., bunker abandoned by Kanye West is in contract for more than $30 million.

The buyer is an investor group led by Andrew Mazzella, a Montana-based luxury-home developer. Mazzella said he plans to finish restoring the Tadao Ando-designed home to its original condition, then put it back on the market for $55 to $65 million.

The seller is Belwood Investments, a crowdfunding company owned by Steven "Bo" Belmont. Belwood paid $21 million last year for the hulking concrete property, which had been gutted and then abandoned by West. Belmont, who put the beachfront house on the market for $39 million, said the contract price is between $30 million and $34 million. He declined to give the exact price, but said it would represent a roughly 20% return for his investors in five months. Mazzella confirmed the range provided by Belmont.

IN CONTRACT
MORE THAN
$30
MILLION
4,000 sq. ft.,
4 bedrooms

Mazzella, who grew up in Alaska, is a 38-year-old former commercial fisherman turned developer. For years he has wanted to get his foot in the door in the Los Angeles spec home market, he said.

"California and L.A., specifically Malibu, is the highest level there is and I've always wanted to get to the highest level," Mazzella said. "This is me kicking down the door." He is raising money from third-party investors to fund the purchase, he said, and hopes buying the Ando property will announce his presence in the L.A. market "with a bang."

The roughly 4,000-square-foot, four-bedroom house was designed by Ando, an in-vogue Japanese architect, more than a decade ago for financier Richard Sachs. West, who now goes by Ye, paid $57.3 million for the home in 2021, then gutted it. He listed the property in 2023 amid a public firestorm over his erratic behavior and antisemitic comments.

After buying the property, Belmont started a roughly $8.5 million project to restore the house to its original condition. Work started in January, but he hoped to find a buyer before completion.

"The faster I get it off my plate, that's great," Belmont said. "If I take it much further, I'd have to boost up the price considerably."

A longtime fan of Ando's work, Mazzella has had his eye on the home for months, he said, and flew into Los Angeles to see it in March.

A luxury car collector with a self-described "big personality," Mazzella said he is planning to relocate to Malibu for much of the year to complete the project.

"I might have a few more tattoos than a lot of the people there, but other than that I'll probably fit in exactly right," he said.

—Katherine Clarke

Claire Danes Sells West Village Townhouse

A New York City townhouse has sold for $9.9 million—just over the asking price of $9.75 million when it hit the market in August, according to the listing agent.

The actress Claire Danes and her husband, British actor Hugh Dancy, paid $6.876 million for the West Village home in 2012, property records show. Danes, best known for her role in "Homeland," has also starred in "Fleishman is in Trouble." She is working on a new HBO drama, "The Applebaum Curse" with the creator of the 1990s show "My So-Called Life," in which she had a breakout role. Dancy is best known for appearing in 2001's "Black Hawk Down" and the TV series "Hannibal."

SOLD
$9.9
MILLION
3,900 sq. ft.,
4 bedrooms

Representatives for Danes and Dancy didn't respond to requests for comment.

The buyer couldn't be determined.

Overall, Manhattan's luxury market has perked up since last year. The number of luxury sales rose 3.7% during the fourth quarter from the same period of the previous year, according to appraisal firm Miller Samuel. Sales of downtown townhouses jumped 13.5% during that period, according to real-estate brokerage Compass.

Tamer Howard of the Corcoran Group represented Danes and Dancy. Colleague Marie-Claire Gladstone represented the buyer.

—E.B. Solomont

FROM TOP: ADAM AMENGUAL FOR WSJ; ALEJANDRO LEON/DD REPS; EVAN AGOSTINI/INVISION/AP (DANES AND DANCY)

RICH ZIPS | A LOOK AT SOME OF THE MOST EXCLUSIVE ZIP CODES IN THE COUNTRY

Gladwyne, PA 19035

By Jessica Flint

Just west of Philadelphia is the Main Line, a roughly 15-mile-long stretch of suburbs where, around the turn of the 20th century, wealthy Philadelphians built estates near the Pennsylvania Railroad as its Main Line rail line expanded outside the city. Today, this region still exudes affluence, as evidenced by Gladwyne, a roughly 5-square-mile community with historic mansions on large acreage. With a median home-listing price of $3.7 million in February, Gladwyne's 19035 ZIP Code has Pennsylvania's priciest residential real estate as ranked by median listing price, according to Realtor.com. (News Corp, owner of The Wall Street Journal, also operates Realtor.com.) As one of the first Main Line communities outside the city, Gladwyne's desirability is buoyed by its easy access to good schools, other Main Line points of interest, such as shopping, and to trains, including those to New York and Washington, D.C.

$3.7 MILLION
Median list price (up 21% year-over-year)

136
Median days on market

$479
Median price per square foot

12
Active listings (up 50% year-over-year)

Source: Realtor.com (February 2025)

Gladwyne affords large lots and privacy with quick access to Philadelphia.

NOTABLE STOPS AND SHOPS

Homeroom
Chef Henry Morgan opened this neighborhood cafe in 2022. Its small boutique, Shoproom, stocks minimalist design objects.

The interior design is simple, but the food is artfully plated.

Cleopetras of the Main Line
This all-breed dog grooming salon offers custom shampoo and conditioning baths followed by blow-drying done by hand. Other services on offer are nail trimming and ear cleaning. It's a no-crate environment; pets can free roam.

4,000
Gladwyne's approximate population

Gladwyne Free Library
Founded in 1931, this library is in a stone building built in 1921. It houses a Pennsylvania Collection, which has 1,400 books dedicated to local and state history.

The Union League Guard House
This restaurant dates back to 1790. In 2017, it was purchased by the Union League of Philadelphia, a private club founded in 1862. It now serves as a members-only dining room.

MEMBERSHIP TO HAVE

Gladwyne's Philadelphia Country Club was founded in 1890. It has 27 holes of golf, a pool, racket sports, skeet shooting, bowling and children's programming.

ADVICE FOR THE BUYER

"Gladwyne used to be thought of as old Main Line mansions and estates, and it still is that, but there is more architectural diversity now," says Lisa Yakulis, a real-estate agent with Kurfiss Sotheby's International Realty. New builds over the last 30 to 40 years have created different ages and styles of homes. Additionally, since the pandemic, the Main Line has seen an influx of out-of-state buyers. "You can get more for your money than you can in the metro areas of cities outside of the state," says Yakulis, who notes that some homeowners commute into New York and D.C.

LISTINGS

$8.9 million
8 bedrooms, 12 bathrooms
On a 6.81-acre lot, this 16,410-square-foot house was built in 1920. The primary suite has his-and hers-baths. The grounds include a golf green with three tee boxes. Agent: Robin Gordon, Berkshire Hathaway HomeServices.

$7.95 million
5 bedrooms, 7 bathrooms
This 15,769-square-foot house was built in 2024. It's on a 1.74-acre lot. The foyer has an interior pool within a two-story atrium. Views are of the Philadelphia Country Club's golf course. Agent: Lavinia Smerconish, Compass.

$3.495 million
7 bedrooms, 7 bathrooms
Built in 1885, this house is 9,175 square feet on a 1.33-acre lot. Historic craftsmanship is apparent throughout. The living room's original paneling was sourced from an 18th-century German castle. Agent: Lavinia Smerconish, Compass.

CLOCKWISE FROM BOTTOM LEFT: WILL FIGG FOR WSJ (2); HERB ENGELSBERG; CREATIVE OUTFIT; THOMAS DONKIN; VERONICA GRECH (MAP)

PRIVATE PROPERTIES

Scarlett Johansson And Colin Jost Buy On Park Avenue

Celebrity power couple Scarlett Johansson and Colin Jost have purchased a prewar penthouse co-op on Manhattan's Park Avenue for $13 million, less than half its original asking price, according to people familiar with the deal.

Sellers Craig and Deborah Cogut, shown at right, had owned the unit since 2006, when they bought it for $13 million, property records show. They first listed the unit for $27.5 million in 2018. After bouncing on and off the market and several price cuts, it was most recently asking $13 million, according to listings website StreetEasy.

SOLD
$13 MILLION
6,000 sq. ft., 6 bedrooms

Johansson is perhaps best known as the star of Marvel's "Avengers" franchise, as well as films like "Her" and "Lost in Translation." Jost is a long-running cast member on "Saturday Night Live." The two were married in 2020.

Craig is the chief executive of Pegasus Capital Advisors, a private equity impact-investment firm based in Connecticut. The Coguts

didn't respond to a request for comment.

The triplex has five terraces and eight balconies, according to the listing. The living room has a wood-burning fireplace and six sets of french doors opening to Juliet balconies. An oak-paneled library overlooks Midtown and Central Park.

The Rosario Candela-designed building was built in the 1930s. Located in Carnegie Hill, it is about 2.5 miles from the "Saturday Night Live" studio.

The unit is just the latest Park Avenue co-op to sell at a steep discount. Prewar co-ops in Manhattan's prime locations were once the pinnacle of New York luxury. In recent years however, their values have lagged far behind condominiums.

Listing agents Lauren Muss and Sabrina Saltiel of Douglas Elliman declined to comment.

—*Katherine Clarke*

FROM TOP: SCOTT GARFITT/INVISION/AP; EAGLEVIEW; PAUL BRUINOODGE/PATRICK MCMULLAN/GETTY IMAGES

HW/ REALTRENDS VERIFIED

Advertisement

The Full Picture of Real Estate Performance

Each year, **RealTrends Verified** recognizes the top-performing residential real estate brokerages, teams and agents across the country — verifying transaction sides and closed sales volume.

2024 was a year of disruption for the housing market. Inventory remained low — though gradually increased — and persistently high mortgage rates continued to suppress buyer activity. According to **Altos Research**, as of December 16, 2024, there were 682,000 single-family homes on the market across the country, nearly 27% more than the previous year.

Fast forward to today: there are approximately 676,000 unsold single-family homes on the market, reflecting a seasonal decline but still maintaining a 31% increase compared to the same period last year. **HousingWire** projects that inventory will continue to rise in 2025, potentially increasing by 15% and nudging the market toward a healthier balance.

Adding to the complexity, the National Association of Realtors' commission lawsuit settlement reshaped the industry's compensation landscape, prompting brokerages and agents to re-evaluate business models and client engagement strategies in real time.

Amid shifting conditions, the brokers in the **2025 RealTrends Verified Broker Rankings** still found ways to grow — gaining market share, attracting talent, and refining their value propositions to stay competitive. Standouts included **Compass, Anywhere Advisors, eXp Realty,** and **HomeServices of America**, all leading in sales volume. But one firm surged ahead — **The Real Brokerage**, which grew its volume by $28 billion, jumping from 10th place in 2024 to 5th place this year. Another notable mention: **LPT Realty**, which moved from No. 28 by transaction sides last year to No. 10 this year, due to its flexible compensation structure.

As brokerages adapt to shifting market dynamics and new MLS policies, RealTrends Verified data highlights the firms gaining market share and attracting top talent.

Coming in June: RealTrends Verified Agent and Team Rankings, with RealTrends Verified City Rankings coming this fall. Stay tuned for a glimpse into the agents and teams powering the housing market forward.

Clayton Collins
Publisher, RealTrends
CEO, HousingWire

1,295 Verified Real Estate Brokerages

RealTrends Verified has been tracking and analyzing performance data for 36 years. Verified firms must have $350 million in volume or 500 transaction sides in 2024.

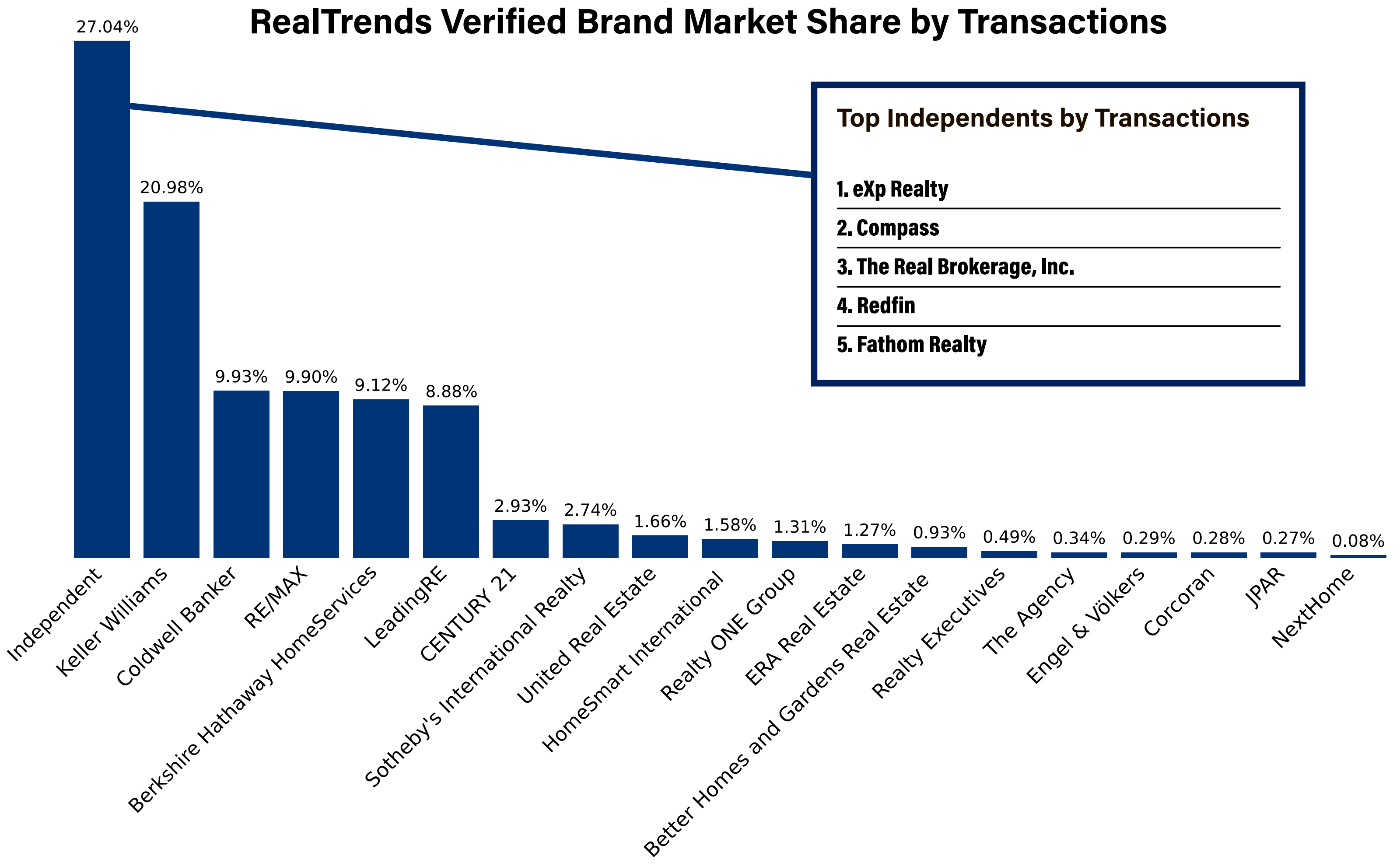
$2.11 trillion in Transaction Volume

Verified brokerages closed over $2.11 trillion in volume in 2024 reflecting a 3.8% increase from 2023, attributed to a steady and increased sales price per transaction.

Consolidation is in Play

Verified brokerages closed 3.86 million transactions, a 3.9% decrease in total sides. The total number of qualifying brokerages declined by 6.9%. Consolidation is in play as market share accrues to fewer players.

RealTrends Verified Brand Market Share by Transactions



Top 15 Brokerages by Transactions

1. eXp Realty	350,119
2. Anywhere Advisors	246,728
3. Compass	228,785
4. HomeServices of America	224,485
5. Hanna Holdings	92,154
6. The Real Brokerage, Inc.	90,298
7. Redfin	46,421
8. United Real Estate	46,025
9. Fathom Realty	36,800
10. LPT Realty	36,369
11. HomeSmart	35,616
12. Keller Williams Realty, GO Network Offices	23,636
13. Side	23,553
14. Douglas Elliman	21,779
15. RE/MAX Gold, representing Gold Nation	21,165

Top 15 Brokerages by Volume

1. Compass	$231,040,313,779
2. Anywhere Advisors	$183,807,260,000
3. eXp Realty	$152,664,657,617
4. HomeServices of America	$136,640,884,770
5. The Real Brokerage, Inc.	$42,443,273,416
6. Douglas Elliman	$36,392,103,498
7. Hanna Holdings	$33,741,323,852
8. Redfin	$29,482,707,101
9. Side	$23,866,284,438
10. United Real Estate	$20,450,671,409
11. HomeSmart	$18,173,968,748
12. William Raveis	$16,678,542,792
13. The Agency	$13,939,162,010
14. LPT Realty	$13,860,450,386
15. RE/MAX Gold, representing Gold Nation	$13,184,066,305

Top Brands by Transactions

1. Keller Williams	810,808
2. Coldwell Banker	383,916
3. RE/MAX	382,576
4. Berkshire Hathaway HomeServices	352,364
5. LeadingRE	250,852

Top Brands by Volume

1. Keller Williams	$356,848,450,099
2. Coldwell Banker	$214,895,284,126
3. Berkshire Hathaway HomeServices	$192,319,983,749
4. LeadingRE	$180,514,783,438
5. RE/MAX	$158,275,132,177

Explore the full report

@RealTrendsInc

RealTrends.com

POWERED BY HOUSINGWIRE

Extreme Real Estate

Continued from page M1

the regular—an expensive, gut-wrenching option, especially for longtime and multigenerational homeowners and lower- or fixed-income residents.

Then there are the megarich, who don't have to wrestle with any of these bad options. Instead, they are moving in droves to risky places and setting home-price records when they get there.

In Palm Beach, Fla., William Lauder, chair of the board of directors of the Estée Lauder Companies, went under contract in February to sell a vacant, oceanfront double lot for close to $200 million. If it closes near that amount, it would set a Palm Beach record. Meanwhile, recently updated FEMA flood maps of Palm Beach County just added thousands of parcels to its high-risk flood zones.

In Miami, sea level is predicted to rise up to 17 inches by 2040 compared with 2000 levels, according to the Southeast Florida Regional Climate Change Compact. In February, a home on the city's Star Island sold for $120 million, a record for Miami-Dade County.

In Charleston, S.C., an unidentified buyer paid a city record of $18.25 million for a historic waterfront home on the Battery in February. In Charleston Harbor, there were 52 major flood events recorded between 1922 and 2023; 38 of them have occurred since 2015, according to data compiled by the National Weather

This home in Charleston, S.C., just sold for $18.5 million. It set a record for the city, and is located in one of the most flood-prone neighborhoods in Charleston, the Battery.

Record heat and record prices are happening in Arizona.

CLOCKWISE FROM TOP LEFT: RICHARD ELLIS/ZUMA PRESS; NICK CANN; JUSTIN SULLIVAN/GETTY IMAGES

Service Weather Forecast Office in Charleston.

Paradise Valley, Ariz., the tony enclave near Phoenix, saw a record-breaking $33.5 million home sale in January. In 2024, the Phoenix area saw a record-breaking 113 consecutive days over 100 degrees, according to data compiled by the NWS Weather Forecast Office in Phoenix.

Why are the megarich streaming into these high climate-risk areas and paying record prices? They want to and they can.

"There are rational reasons why they are moving to those locations," says Milton Pedraza, CEO of the Luxury Institute, a research and consulting firm in Boca Raton, Fla., and New York City. "The love of the ocean, the love of the people who are there, the restaurants, the culture. Also, where are my people? Where's my tribe going?"

Oceanfronts, mountainsides, sweeping desert vistas—these areas have long been the locales of choice for the wealthy and they are not going to let climate risk harsh their vibe. Plus, these locations confer status, especially for people who are new to vast wealth, says Clay Cockrell, a licensed clinical social worker who has many wealthy clients. "There is 'I have always strived for this, I'm going to have it, damn it, whether it floods or not.'"

As the wealthy look to tribe-up, a lack of ultra-high-end inventory means they are also bidding up home values to new records. But why move to a place where your "highest-price-ever-paid" estate could get wiped off the planet by the next big one? Madeline Levine, a psychologist in San Francisco, says that when she asked that question of a fabulously wealthy client of hers, he thought the question was hilarious, then he said "Why not? We can take a hit."

The megarich are moving in droves to risky places and setting home-price records when they get there.

Blame "relative wealth." One of the Malibu, Calif., homes owned by Larry Ellison, co-founder of Oracle, burned down in the fires in January. Zillow had previously valued it at about $21.5 million. That is about 0.01% of his net worth of approximately $216 billion. Ellison didn't respond to a request for comment.

For the lower-tier wealthy who would lose a much larger percentage of their net worth if their multimillion-dollar home burned to ashes, some delusion is required to move to high-risk areas, says Brad Klontz, a financial planner and psychologist in Boulder, Colo.

"These people look around and say 'this looks like a dangerous place,'" says Klontz. "But everyone seems to be calm and smiling and happy and you think 'yeah, I guess we're safe. What are the odds it will happen here?'"

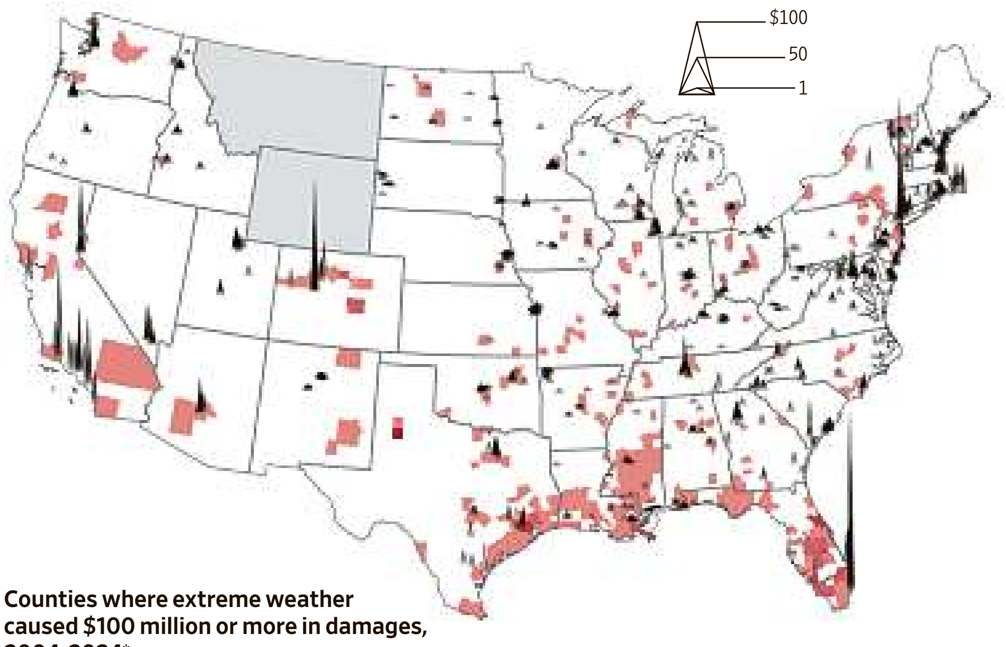
When delusion meets nature's sledgehammer, the wealthy can afford to build houses that are more likely to survive. Cat-5 rated construction techniques, fireproof materials, private firefighting brigades, flood barriers, and homes raised above storm-surge levels are all ways that money buys protection from nature that most normies can't afford.

In Malibu, however, the recent fires, which devastated not just homes but the infrastructure that makes a place a community, may have marked the beginning of the end of its time as an enclave for the super wealthy. "I think we're at an inflection point," says Pedraza. He says that his contacts and clients among the Malibu moneyed are, increasingly, over it, no matter how much money they have. "It is just too fast and too furious."

Where Home Sale Records and Climate Disasters Meet

Some of the priciest real estate sold last year was in areas where extreme weather hit hardest.

Thirty most expensive home sales in each state in 2024



*Inflation-adjusted to 2024 dollars.
Notes: No sale data for Montana and Wyoming.
Sources: National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration (weather disasters); Redfin (home sales)

CARL CHURCHILL/WSJ

EAGLEVIEW; STUART PALLEY FOR WSJ

Larry Ellison lost a tiny fraction of his net worth when this home (second from left), one of several he owns in Malibu, was destroyed in the January fires. The home was worth an estimated $21.5 million prior to the fire.

IN THE TRENCHES | AMY GAMERMAN

When a Home Comes With Its Very Own Squatter

Q Have you ever encountered a squatter in a multimillion-dollar listing?

ABIGAIL PALANCA
licensed real-estate salesperson and head of the Abby Palanca Team at Serhant in Brooklyn, N.Y.

It was a beautiful home, over 4,000 square feet, with a lot of restored details. We listed it at $4 million. The sellers had moved out, and we staged the home. When it's staged and nobody's living there, everything's in perfect order every time you go back. But we were noticing that every time we went to show it, there was something slightly out of place. Like the pillows on the sofa always had to be adjusted.

Because it wasn't always the same person on our team hosting the open house, it took us a little bit of time to put these clues together. One day, someone said that they had noticed a paw print on one of our show sheets. Someone else said, "Actually, when I went there, the cookie jar was knocked over." We started to pay closer attention.

Then an agent went down to the basement to shut off the lights after a showing. She was wearing white pants, and she noticed stains, like, jumping stains, all over her pants. They were fleas. Two days later, someone else on the team was down in the basement and felt little bites on her feet—fleas. That's when she noticed that by the dryer, there's a vent cover that's been knocked off. Something had made its way inside, where it was nice and warm.

We call an exterminator, who verifies that we have fleas—and we have a raccoon. We held off on showing the house for two weeks, to make sure that people wouldn't be bringing fleas home.

It took a while to catch the raccoon. Let me tell you, this guy was clever. I like to joke that he was such a fan of our staging that he kept coming back—even though there were no real cookies in the cookie jar. We never saw him, but his paw prints were everywhere, and the paw print was sizable. Our biggest fear was that we were going to walk in one day, and he was going to jump out at us. But we got lucky; he must have left the house sometime before we sealed the vent.

The house sold—slightly below asking, but we were very happy. And the sellers were happy they weren't living there.

JESSICA PETERS
broker-associate at Douglas Elliman Real Estate, Brooklyn, N.Y.

It was an estate sale in Williamsburg—a house on a big 50-by-100-foot property that had been in one family. The grandmother had died and made the grandkids the executors of the estate. Every developer wanted this piece of land. I represented the buyer, and we were in contract so fast, for $3.725 million.

That was the easy part.

The grandkids' uncle was living in a shed at the back of the property. He had agreed to move out, but he was irritated about how things had transpired.

A few days before the close, this guy decided that he was no longer happy with what everybody had agreed to. He wanted more money. The grandkids were like, "No, that's absolutely ludicrous." So everybody lawyered up.

The uncle—let's call him Squatter—decided he didn't want anybody on the property. He threatened my clients when they went there, like, "If you step onto my property again, I will shoot you." He had a gun. He had a guard dog who lived in the shed with him.

We tried to get him evicted, but this was during Covid. I don't think we saw a judge for two years. Then, after we finally got him evicted, he moved into the main house; it wasn't considered the same property as the shed, which is so crazy. His counsel made us aware of that. We had to go back to court for a new eviction order.

We were about to get a court date to see the judge, when my client called me and said, "You're never going to believe this."

Squatter had burned down the house. It was an accident. The house was burned so badly that the Fire Department deemed the property uninhabitable. A great stroke of luck, because the Fire Marshall kicked Squatter out.

It's a vacant lot now. My clients are building a luxury boutique condo, with parking. I almost want to buy a unit there.

—Edited from interviews

DAVE URBAN (2)

Rocker Rod Stewart's Former Mansion In Los Angeles Sells

A Los Angeles compound that includes the musician Rod Stewart's former home has sold to two separate buyers for a total of $86 million.

The sellers are Bradley Bell, executive producer and head writer of the long-running daytime soap opera "The Bold and the Beautiful," and his wife, former U.S. Ambassador to Hungary Colleen Bell. They bought the house from Stewart for $6.25 million in 1992.

SOLD

$86 MILLION

6 acres, 17,000-sq.-ft. main house, cabin

The roughly 6-acre compound is being divided into two sections and sold separately. The bigger of the two parcels—a roughly 4-acre lot that includes the main house—was sold to producer David Zander for about $57 million.

The remaining parcel, with a circa-1911 cabin on it, has been sold to Nick Kaiser, co-founder of the private-equity firm Marlin Equity Partners for about $29 million.

Zander previously bought, renovated and sold Lasata, the circa-1917 Hamptons estate where Jacqueline Kennedy Onassis spent childhood summers.

Neither Zander or Kaiser responded to a request for comment.

Designed in 1925 by Montecito architect George Washington Smith, one of the masters of the Spanish Colonial Revival style in Southern California, the property's main Spanish Colonial-style home has six bedrooms.

The Bells spent two years renovating and restoring the house. Stewart, who bought the house in the 1970s, had added Art Nouveau-style features, including a disco room. The Bells removed those elements and restored as many original details as possible.

In 2004, the Bells bought the longtime home of the actor Gregory Peck for $19.5 million, razing the Peck home and merging the properties into one roughly 6-acre compound.

The Bells weren't planning to sell, but were approached several times by Zander's agent, Ben Bacal of Revel Real Estate.

Bacal represented the Bells and Kaiser. Drew Fenton of Carolwood Estates represented Zander.

—Katherine Clarke

From left: The Bells, Rod Stewart, and Gregory and Veronique Peck

CLOCKWISE FROM TOP LEFT: REVEL REAL ESTATE; RODIN ECKENROTH/GETTY IMAGES; MATT LUCAR/INVISION/AP; LISA ROSE/ZUMA PRESS; ROB KAROSIS

Coastal New Hampshire Home Could Tie State Record

The first time Michael Kane and Jamee Field Kane laid eyes on their 1930s home in coastal New Hampshire, they fell for its historic charm and ocean views. But behind the stately brick facade, the mansion was little more than a shell.

A prior owner had gutted the Colonial Revival-style house, ripping off the back wall. "They essentially stripped the house. The only thing that they didn't pull out was the main staircase," said Michael, who grew up in New Hampshire and is CEO of the Portsmouth-based real-estate development and investment firm The Kane Company.

Seeing the property's potential, the Kanes paid $3 million for the property in 2010 and embarked on a multiyear, multimillion-dollar renovation inspired by the original architecture. Now planning to move to Florida, they are listing the house, historically known as Balmoral, for $25 million. If it sells for that much, it would tie a state record set in 2022 by a home in nearby Rye.

FOR SALE

$25 MILLION

8,900 square feet, 5 bedrooms, ocean views, wine cellar, gym

Perched above a rocky beach, Balmoral sits on roughly 3 acres in the small town of North Hampton.

In renovating the house, the Kanes used old photos of Balmoral's interior to help guide their design, including custom moldings made to match the originals. The Kanes are selling because they are building a home in Jupiter Island, Fla., and plan to move there, though Michael will keep his business in New Hampshire.

—E.B. Solomont

Make Your Next Move Exceptional

DouglasElliman

2560 Del Lago Drive | Fort Lauderdale, Florida
$34,950,000 | 6 BR, 7 BA, 2 HALF BA | **Web# F10483159**
Julie Jones: O 954.328.3665

100 S Pointe Drive, 3203 | Miami Beach, Florida
$18,900,000 | 3 BR, 4 BA | **Web# A11714963**
Marion Ott: O 305.695.6300

249 W Alexander Palm Road | Boca Raton, Florida
$18,888,000 | 6 BR, 8 BA, 2 HALF BA | **Web# RX-10982874**
Senada Adžem: O 561.322.8208

7621 S Flagler Drive | West Palm Beach, Florida
$16,000,000 | Approx. 1.84 Acres | **Web# 25-179**
Burt Minkoff: O 561.655.8600

230 Argyle Road | West Palm Beach, Florida
$11,995,000 | 7 BR, 8 BA | **Web# 24-1894**
Burt Minkoff: O 561.655.8600

178 Skimhampton Road | East Hampton, New York
$10,995,000 | 7 BR, 7 BA, 3 HALF BA | **Web# H386929**
Justin Agnello: O 631.267.7334 | Erica Grossman: O 631.204.2723

46 Club Lane | Remsenburg, New York
$9,995,000 | 6 BR, 8 BA, 3 HALF BA | **Web# H382031**
Enzo Morabito: O 631.725.7542

16486/488 Captiva Drive | Captiva, Florida
$9,500,000 | 8 BR, 9.5 BA | **Web# 225008480**
Brittany Skotak: O 239.799.5300

320 Central Park West, B18FL | Upper West Side, New York City
$8,900,000 | 4 BR, 4.5 BA | **Web# 23242279**
Susan Sterk Kirch: O 212.727.6113

16475 Captiva Drive | Captiva, Florida
$8,500,000 | 3 BR, 3.5 BA | **Web# 225008413**
Brittany Skotak: O 239.799.5300

10 Jay Street, 4 | TriBeCa, New York City
$8,200,000 | 5 BR, 3.5 BA | **Web# 23367862**
Andrea Anzaldo: O 212.319.2316

333 East 51st Street | Turtle Bay, New York City
$5,950,000 | 4 BR, 2 BA, 2 HALF BA | **Web# 23260916**
Faith Fisher Einhorn: O 212.418.2045

346 West 87th Street | Upper West Side, New York City
$4,500,000 | 10 Units, Multi-Family Residence | **Web# 23353124**
Lydia Sussek: O 212.350.2224

150 Bradley Place, 606 | Palm Beach, Florida
$4,295,000 | 2 BR, 2 BA | **Web# RX-11054967**
Catherine Applegate: O 561.655.8600

50 Old Neck Road | Center Moriches, New York
$3,795,000 | 5 BR, 4.5 BA | **Web# 819482**
Filomena Volpe: O 631.585.8500 | Priscilla Holloway: O 631.468.4899

162 Cherry Street | Katonah, New York
$3,495,000 | 5 BR, 5.5 BA | **Web# 836260**
Margaret Harrington: O 914.232.3700

1 Home Place, B | Downtown Greenwich, Connecticut
$3,295,000 | 4 BR, 4.5 BA | **Web# 122140**
Ira Tamigian: O 203.622.4900 | Steven Magnuson: O 203.622.4900

910 Fifth Avenue, 3A | Lenox Hill, New York City
$2,550,000 | 2 BR, 2.5 BA | **Web# 23369345**
Emily Margolin: O 212.335.2066

2105 Del Monte Drive | Houston, Texas
$2,500,000 | 4 BR, 3.5 BA | **Web# 97456904**
Jeanine Kaminski-Ditzel: O 281.652.5588

2772 SW 32 Court | Miami, Florida
$2,375,000 | 5 BR, 5.5 BA | **Web# A11755865**
Joe Azar: O 305.240.1202

elliman.com

elliman.com

Jackson Prices Climb

Continued from page M1

foot home down the street built by the same developer.

"Do I think Jackson Hole is a great investment? Absolutely. But I didn't think about it like that," said Been, who is in her 50s. She was more focused on being able to walk from her house to her favorite downtown shops, restaurants and bars. She declined to say how much she paid for her homes, and Wyoming is a nondisclosure state where sales prices aren't publicly recorded.

For years, Jackson Hole's natural beauty, bustling downtown and laid-back lifestyle have attracted the likes of Harrison Ford and Sandra Bullock. During Covid, well-heeled buyers arrived in droves, drawn by the wide-open spaces and Wyoming's lack of state income tax, corporate income tax or estate tax. The deluge of buyers quickly absorbed available properties, driving up home values. It also attracted developers eager to build and sell more homes at higher prices.

AARON KRAFT

Source: Prugh real estate

CAMILLE BRESSANGE/WSJ

While the pace of sales has since tapered off, prices remain as high as they have ever been, particularly at the top of the market. Last year, the median home sale price in Jackson Hole was $3.4 million, doubling from $1.7 million in 2019, according to the Jackson Hole Report. In 2024, there were 31 homes listed for $10 million or more, roughly double the amount listed prepandemic.

Generally speaking, homes that sold for $8 million to $10 million before Covid are now fetching $15 million, said real-estate agent Carlos Ordoñez of Hall and Hall. "The Covid bump was real," he said, adding: "A lot of people would be surprised to learn what $10 million doesn't get you in Jackson compared to before Covid."

Settled by homesteaders in the 1800s, Jackson Hole became a summer destination for wealthy East Coast residents arriving by train around the early 1900s. Many of the area's most majestic properties were developed in the middle of the 20th century. "We are now starting to see these turn over," real-estate agent Latham Jenkins of Live Water Properties said. "They can command just astounding prices."

Camp Teton, a 55-acre Jackson Hole estate, sold in 2021 after being listed for $65 million. The 127-acre Bugling Elk estate, listed for $55 million, sold in 2022. The 5,000-acre Diamond G Ranch—about 82 miles east of Jackson Hole near the town of Dubois—traded after being listed for $71 million.

Scarcity is a key price driver, according to Devon Viehman, a real-estate agent and member of the Jackson Town Council. Some 97% of land in Teton County is held in conservation, leaving limited space for development. Meanwhile, buyers who relocated to Jackson during Covid are hanging on to the properties they bought. "We all thought as brokers, well as soon as the pandemic is over they'll list and sell," said Tom Evans of Sotheby's International Realty. "Well, that hasn't been the case. It's not this mass exodus like it was this mass purchase."

Oncologist Dr. Raymond Wadlow, who lives in Virginia with his wife, Jessica Wadlow, has vacationed in Jackson Hole for years. So in 2020, the couple and Raymond's brother seized the opportunity to buy a vacant lot just outside downtown Jackson, where they built a family vacation home.

The Wadlows paid $1 million for 3.5 acres in the Owl Creek subdivision and spent the next three years building a roughly 6,000-square-foot house with four bedrooms and views of the Tetons. "We got in right before it got nuts," said Jessica, a consultant. They have been told that their house could now fetch up to $12 million. "We could flip it and make money, but that wasn't really our purpose," she said. "It's a family house."

Adding to the inventory crunch, wealthy purchasers have continued snatching up properties, even as higher interest rates slowed other market segments. "I've got a Rolodex of buyers that I haven't been able to find product for," Evans said.

Several spec builders have rushed to fill the void. Jackson Home Co., an offshoot of New York's Brooklyn Home Co., has built 20 homes in downtown Jackson since 2019, said co-founder Bill Caleo. The company started buying property in Jackson around 2017 after noticing older homes downtown being snapped up and renovated. The company is currently working on a roughly 10,200-square-foot house in the Bar BC Ranch subdivision priced at $50 million.

Some brokers said Jackson's recent price appreciation reminds them of Aspen, Colo., another mountain enclave where luxury values skyrocketed over the past few years. But Jackson lacks the flashiness and celebrity culture of Aspen. Wyoming's status as a

▲ Squeezed by property taxes, Slade Ross's family is selling a 159-acre tract of land that his great-great-grandparents homesteaded.

nondisclosure state is also a draw for wealthy residents who prefer anonymity. "You don't know who you're sitting next to at the bar, and we like that," said Jackson Hole real-estate agent Jill Sassi of Sotheby's International Realty, who helped the Wadlows buy their lot.

The market's lack of transparency does make it difficult to ascertain Jackson Hole sale prices, however. Sassi said she generally estimates that a home's sale price is roughly 3% to 5% below the asking price.

Locals say the fabric of the community is changing as original homesteads change hands. Slade Ross, the 52-year-old owner of a carwash and oil-change business in Jackson, is selling a portion of the Jackson Hole land his great-great-grandparents homesteaded more than a century ago. Locals like him are feeling squeezed by rising property taxes, he said, adding: "It's going to force us out at some point."

The influx of wealth has created tension between the haves and have-nots in town, said Viehman. "You have people that have lived here forever" in small, older houses, she said. "Then one of these large homes goes up and all of a sudden, a mountain view they used to love, they don't have anymore."

To better understand Jackson Hole's skyrocketing prices, The Wall Street Journal took a close look at five recent listings and sales.

1. Jackson Hole Ranch

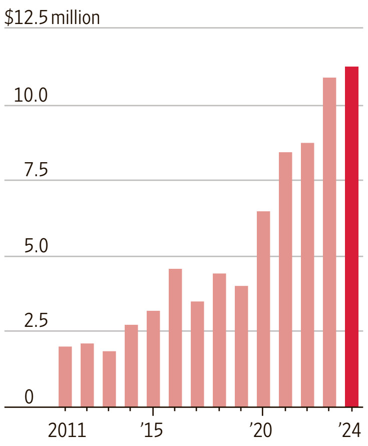
Sold in 2022
Asking price: $35 million
Acres: 233
Buyer: Unknown
Seller: The Givens family
The specs: Five-bedroom main house, guesthouse, ¾-mile stretch of Snake River
What it says about the market: The Givenses bought the first roughly 3 acres for about $172,000 in 1986. When they put the ranch on the market in 2022, it went into contract within a week, said Jenkins, who had the listing.

2. Red Hills Ranch

Listed in August 2024
Asking price: $65 million
Acres: 190
Seller: Estate of Sen. Herb Kohl of Wisconsin, an heir to the Kohl's department-store chain, who died in 2023. He bought the land in the 1970s.
The specs: Main house, guest cabins, a lodge, bunkhouse, tack barn
What it says about the market: Properties like Red Hills Ranch command very high prices because they rarely become available. "The reality is, to find another property like that, within striking distance of Jackson, you don't have another one," said Matt MacMillan of Live Water Properties, who is not involved with the listing.

Raising the Bar in Jackson Hole

The **entry price** for the area's luxury market has jumped significantly in recent years, and saw its biggest increase during the pandemic.



Source: Jackson Hole Report

3. Ross Plateau

Listed in January 2023
Asking price: $25.5 million
Acres: 159
Seller: Ross family
The specs: Undeveloped land surrounded by the Bridger-Teton National Forest; four developable parcels.
What it says about the market: Ross's great-great grandfather was a cattle rancher and the family still uses it as a hay field. But the family has stopped ranching, said Ross, who lives on another family-owned property nearby, where his parents and siblings all have family homes. "It's too expensive for a rancher to live here," he said. "We're not a rich family." While it has been "heart wrenching" to think about selling, "we feel like we're at a point where we have to." While the family believes the property could accommodate 27 homes, "our hope is that one single person buys it to keep it intact," Ross said. They have gotten several offers, but "haven't found the right fit yet," said MacMillan, the listing agent.

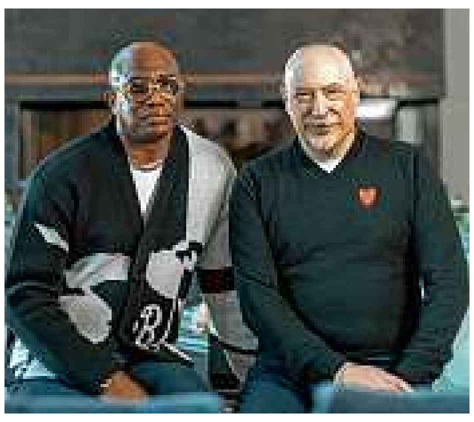
4. Riva Ridge compound

Listed in July 2024
Asking price: $40 million
Acres: 41
Seller: John and Susan Campbell
The specs: Main house, detached primary suite and three guesthouses; structures are named Wynken, Blynken and Nod in a nod to the lullaby.
What it says about the market: The $40 million pricetag is "new territory" for the Jackson market, said Rebekkah Kelley of Budge Kelley Realty Group.

5. Mirror Pond

Listed in March 2025
Asking price: $31.75 million
Acres: 2.43
Seller: Fernando Guerrero and Jill Jachera
The specs: 7,000-square-foot house with five bedrooms
What it says about the market: Located in the private golf community 3 Creek Ranch, Mirror Pond is one of several newly built homes in the area asking more than $20 million.

CLOCKWISE FROM TOP LEFT: LATHAM JENKINS/LIVE WATER JACKSON HOLE; TAYLOR GLENN FOR WSJ; TYCEN BIRCH (2)



Benjamin King, left, and Alan King didn't want to live in a gallery-like white box.

BALANCE SHEET

A Penthouse Fit for Their Art Collection

A $620,000 renovation gave these Raleigh, N.C., homeowners space for their paintings, pottery and textiles—without feeling like a museum

By Sarah Paynter

Curating a 120-piece art collection was easy. Displaying it at home? That was the hard part.

Color and architectural ornamentation in a home can compete with paintings, photographs, sculptures, textiles and pottery. But Alan King and his husband, Benjamin King, said they didn't want to live in a sterile, gallery-like white box.

"This is our home. We've never wanted to live in a museum," said Alan, 65, chief executive of Workplace Options, a provider of employee well-being perks.

So in 2023, when they bought a $1.4 million penthouse in downtown Raleigh, N.C., they opted for textured decor in neutral colors that wouldn't compete with their contemporary art collection, said their interior designer, Sally Williams of Colorful Concepts Interior Design in Raleigh. The renovation for the three-bedroom, roughly 2,500-square-foot condo cost double what they expected, about $620,000, and took nine months, said Alan.

"If art is the focal point, it's really easy with design to have things compete so that each piece doesn't get a chance to speak for itself. It just sort of gets jumbled up together," said Benjamin, a 61-year-old retired flower-shop owner.

One of the home's most striking features is the roughly $30,000 electric fireplace in the double-height great room. The bottom portion of the custom, floor-to-ceiling fireplace is made of black Venetian plaster with walnut accents. The upper portion is white slatted wood with recessed areas, a textured design that adds visual interest without relying on color. Williams said the neutral palette allows attention to remain on the portrait hanging on the fireplace, a roughly 5-by-6-foot black-and-white photograph of geometric patterns projected on a man's profile by New York-based artist Sarp Kerem Yavuz.

A roughly $30,000 oak accent wall unites the dining room and loft areas of the open-plan great room. Its fan pattern created visual interest but wasn't too busy to serve as a place to hang three more pieces of art, she said.

They also added warmth to the condo with wood details on handrails and drawers, displayed pottery on vertical walnut live-edge shelving, and commissioned

FROM TOP: BRYANT TYSON/BRYANT DEVON; ABIGAIL JACKSON, © SARP KEREM YAVUZ, "HÜSRAN," 2016

A photograph by artist Sarp Kerem Yavuz hangs over the roughly $30,000 electric fireplace.

BALANCE SHEET

Furnishings
$250,000

Bang & Olufsen sound system
$50,000

Murphy bed
$40,000

Fireplace
$30,000

Oak accent wall
$30,000

Headboard
$30,000

Light fixtures
$26,000

An oak accent wall, above, and headboard of oak, marble and brass, below, add warmth without competing with the art. Marble-like wallpaper highlights a Clarence Heyward painting, at right. The home has a loft, at left.

custom walnut and oak furnishings. In the foyer, a recently purchased oil painting of a woman in black by Washington, D.C., artist J. Rodney Dennis hangs over a custom-made $11,000 walnut foyer credenza, and in the loft, they hung a textile piece over a roughly $13,000 custom walnut television cabinet. The third bedroom functions as an office and has a $40,000 walnut Murphy bed for visits from their adult children, said Alan. The primary bedroom has a $30,000 oak headboard with marble and brass details.

"It's probably the most expensive Murphy bed that has ever been created, but you walk into that space and you see a beautiful office. There's no way you look at it and assume that this is actually a fully functioning bedroom with a queen-size bed," said Alan.

They spent about $250,000 on furnishings. They picked out three neutral and light-blue Tibetan-style rugs made in Nepal, about $21,000 total, for the living room, dining room and hallway. The living room's white, woven sofas cost about $18,000 total, and the loft has a $13,000 chenille sectional, said Alan.

"The space was very white and very blank. We needed things that would give it some warmth and give it some gravitas but not challenge the art," said Alan. "It was an exercise in really learning how the design complements the art and vice versa."

The stairway to the loft became a gallery-like space for six paintings and a $4,000 glass chandelier. They were nervous about so many paintings in the stairway, but Williams used wallpaper with a taupe and cream marble-like pattern, about $1,000 including installation, to break up the walls.

"It was important that it not just feel like a blur of color and images in that small area," said Williams, adding that the wallpaper helps draw attention to the prize painting by North Carolina-based artist Clarence Heyward.

The condo is designed to spotlight 60 of their 120 pieces, said Alan, and the rest are displayed at their mountain house in the town of Beech Mountain, about 200 miles west. Even before the work was complete, they had to re-engineer the design to feature 10 new pieces purchased during last year's renovation, and the Kings have since added four large pieces purchased at the Art Basel art show in Miami Beach, Fla.

The Kings are storing several paintings in the guest room until they can bring them to the mountain house. As their mountain house fills up, they'll distribute art to their children and stash pieces in storage units. "We are adding to our collection more rapidly than we had envisioned," said Alan.

ABIGAIL JACKSON (4); © CLARENCE HEYWARD, "PORTRAIT OF WILLIAM PAUL THOMAS," 2020 (STAIRWAY PAINTING)

HOUSE CALL | DEBRA MESSING

She Felt Antisemitism From a Young Age

The 'Alto Knights' co-star on her early TV escape, taking acting to the next level on 'Will & Grace' and starring alongside two Robert De Niros

I was fearful as a child. My parents grew up in Brooklyn, N.Y., surrounded by a large Jewish family and friends. When I was 3, in 1971, my father got a job in Rhode Island and we moved to East Greenwich, where there were very few Jews.

Everyone in elementary school knew I was a Jew, since I took off from school on Jewish holidays. My only memory of second grade was getting ready for gym class when a little boy said, "Get to the back of the line, kike." A swastika was painted on my grandfather's car on Halloween, and our driveway's globe lights were smashed routinely with bats. Next came our mailbox and garbage cans.

In East Greenwich, my parents had bought 3½ acres on a dirt road and built a split-level, brown-shingle house with three little steps from one story to the next.

Above, Debra Messing, around age 9, with her brother, Brett. At right, Messing pictured in March.

We lived next to a horse farm, where I'd hang out and watch horses being born. "Charlotte's Web" was my favorite book. Wilbur, the pig, was an outsider. I could relate.

School was stressful, socially, so I liked being home. TV was an escape, and I was glued to "I Love Lucy."

Broadway soundtracks played constantly. I danced and sang to them from age 3. When I was 7, my parents took me to see "Annie" on Broadway. During the show, I jumped up, turned to my mom and said, "I want to do that. Can I? I want to be up there."

"Up there" began in summer camp, when I was 8. I played a blind girl and took the role so seriously that I closed my eyes in rehearsal, to feel what it was like. I walked off the stage into the orchestra but wasn't hurt.

After that performance, I was in every play, from junior high until I graduated high school. Theater was my safe space. I could be anybody, say anything and not be judged.

My mother, Sandra, met my father, Brian, when she was 16 and he was 17. After they married, she worked as a secretary and helped put him through Brooklyn College. He started as a stock boy at JCPenney and soon worked in costume jewelry.

After being promoted to sales, he and my mom had to choose—Rhode Island or Long Island. Because of financial constraints, they chose East Greenwich.

My dad never missed a day of work. His work ethic was inspiring, and he expected the same of my older brother, Brett, and me. My mother urged me to pursue what made me happy.

She said, "You do something until it doesn't make you happy anymore. Then you move on and trust that something else will come along that will." She is the reason I'm an actor today.

I was lucky in high school. I wound up in a gaggle of popular girls who were cheerleaders. But I still felt on the outside looking in.

My drama teacher, Jim Metcalfe, changed my life. "You're going to be an actress." He helped me prep for my audition for Brandeis University's theater program, and I was accepted.

At Brandeis, the college's robust Jewish community was a revelation. For the first time I felt safe.

At NYU Tisch School of the Arts' graduate program, old acting habits were ripped away along with my preconceptions, and I was rebuilt and pushed. I loved it.

A guest-starring role on TV's "NYPD Blue" in 1994 was my first major break, but "Will & Grace" took me to a different level.

Today, I live in Manhattan. I moved back to New York about 14 years ago with my son, when I was cast in TV's "Smash." I love that we're near Central Park and I can see trees every day.

My mother passed away in 2014. She was very proud of me. When I finally earned enough as an actress that I had to pay taxes, my relieved parents threw a party.

—As told to Marc Myers

Debra Messing, 56, is known for her roles in TV's "Will & Grace" and "The Starter Wife." She executive produced the new documentary "October 8" and co-stars in the new crime-drama film "The Alto Knights."

DEBRA'S FLEXIBILITY

"The Alto Knights"? I play Bobbie Costello, wife of mob boss Frank Costello. The film is about the rivalry between bosses Frank Costello and Vito Genovese. Amazingly, Robert De Niro plays both roles.

De Niro lesson? Do less than you think you need to so there's room for flexibility. He learned his lines and improvised around them.

Favorite home spot? My TV room and library. It has a fluffy couch, my books, and blankets strewn all around.

Learning lines? TV and movie scripts I read over and over.

For the stage? I read the entire script into an app called LineLearner that actress Helen Hunt told me about. Then I listen to the play in its entirety on headphones, in a taxi or in bed.

FROM LEFT: MESSING FAMILY; GITA BASS

LUXURY PORTFOLIO INTERNATIONAL®

allen tate Realtors® | Beverly-Hanks REALTORS®

Well Connected.™
luxuryportfolio.com




Candler, NC | $4,850,000
Incredible 240 acre property with breathtaking mountain views and a 17-stall barn.
Allen Tate/Beverly-Hanks, Realtors
Scott Russell – +1 828 713 2060
Search CNAV on luxuryportfolio.com

Arden, NC | $4,350,000
Extraordinary modern luxury masterpiece with stunning mountain vistas in Walnut Cove.
Allen Tate/Beverly-Hanks, Realtors
Josh Smith – +1 828 606 0974
Search RFBN on luxuryportfolio.com

Asheville, NC | $3,750,000
Timeless elegance and modern ease define this magnificent downtown Asheville home.
Allen Tate/Beverly-Hanks, Realtors
Brent Russell – +1 828 528 1829
Search KKLQ on luxuryportfolio.com

Asheville, NC | $3,295,000
Elk View is a community of 25 environmentally conscious homes with mountain views.
Allen Tate/Beverly-Hanks, Realtors
Josh Smith – +1 828 606 0974
Search DCJM on luxuryportfolio.com




Zirconia, NC | $2,850,000
Stunning mountain home with open floor plan, panoramic views and high-end finishes.
Allen Tate/Beverly-Hanks, Realtors
Ali Thomas – +1 828 279 0019
Search GGRQ on luxuryportfolio.com

Highlands, NC | $2,750,000
This mountain masterpiece is the epitome of luxury and meticulous craftsmanship.
Allen Tate Realtors
Rob Blake – +1 770 846 3161
Search IAMI on luxuryportfolio.com

Sapphire, NC | $2,695,000
Lakefront, fully furnished turn-key in Burlingame CC - central to everything!
Allen Tate Realtors
Kelly Ramsay – +1 828 556 1252
Search JQDE on luxuryportfolio.com

Marshall, NC | $2,200,000
Secluded mountain estate with 201+ lush acres, two homes and a Civil War era cabin.
Allen Tate/Beverly-Hanks, Realtors
Robert Woodson – +1 828 231 6418
Search MFUO on luxuryportfolio.com




Arden, NC | $1,875,000
Nestled in Cove Park at Walnut Cove, this stunning home blends luxury and comfort.
Allen Tate/Beverly-Hanks, Realtors
Josh Smith – +1 828 606 0974
Search NSRQ on luxuryportfolio.com

Arden, NC | $1,825,000
A sanctuary for four-seasons living in 'The Meadow' in The Cliffs at Walnut Cove.
Allen Tate/Beverly-Hanks, Realtors
Kyle Olinger – +1 828 712 5953
Search OXFH on luxuryportfolio.com

Waynesville, NC | $1,799,000
Overlooking the 11th fairway, this estate offers stunning views and luxury living.
Allen Tate/Beverly-Hanks, Realtors
McElroy & Ellege Team – +1 828 400 9463
Search PIKY on luxuryportfolio.com

Fairview, NC | $1,750,000
Stunning custom home in The Willows, offering a home theater & six stone fireplaces.
Allen Tate/Beverly-Hanks, Realtors
Diane Demetris-Duermit – +1 828 337 1747
Search DUGT on luxuryportfolio.com




Waynesville, NC | $1,730,000
True log home on nearly 7 private acres in the heart of the Blue Ridge Mountains.
Allen Tate/Beverly-Hanks, Realtors
P. Williams/S. Corn – +1 803 528 5039
Search DUOZ on luxuryportfolio.com

Horse Shoe, NC | $1,699,000
This exquisite, custom-built residence offers unobstructed mountain views.
Allen Tate/Beverly-Hanks, Realtors
Margo Barbee – +1 828 329 9201
Search SKKI on luxuryportfolio.com

Waynesville, NC | $1,395,000
This stunning Junaluska Highlands home offers mountain, wooded and water views.
Allen Tate/Beverly-Hanks, Realtors
Ellen Sither – +1 828 734 8305
Search VBTN on luxuryportfolio.com

Asheville, NC | $1,395,000
Stunning post and beam with main level living on .9 ac, 1.5 mi to downtown Asheville.
Allen Tate/Beverly-Hanks, Realtors
Shelle Ball – +1 828 778 5015
Search DUBX on luxuryportfolio.com




Arden, NC | $1,395,000
A 14+ acre mountainside parcel awash with southeastern exposure and beautiful views.
Allen Tate/Beverly-Hanks, Realtors
Kyle Olinger – +1 828 712 5953
Search GKQF on luxuryportfolio.com

Asheville, NC | $1,300,000
This magical home has a three story addition plus a fabulous separate artist's loft.
Allen Tate/Beverly-Hanks, Realtors
J. Smith/T. Kaderabek – +1 828 215 3393
Search NEEY on luxuryportfolio.com

Alexander, NC | $1,200,000
Nestled on an expansive, private lot with breathtaking year-round mountain views.
Allen Tate/Beverly-Hanks, Realtors
Paul Brown – +1 828 785 8993
Search JDLP on luxuryportfolio.com

Asheville, NC | $1,015,000
Rare availability. The 20 unit complex is a small oasis tucked away and private.
Allen Tate/Beverly-Hanks, Realtors
Cheryl MacPhail – +1 828 337 2139
Search WQNH on luxuryportfolio.com

LUXURY HOMES FROM Leading REAL ESTATE COMPANIES OF THE WORLD

@luxuryportfolio

House of The Month: March

See which of our three homes was voted the winner

By Kerry Barger

LAST MONTH, we visited an Arizona compound with a subterranean basketball court and headed to a rammed-earth home in California wine country. We also traveled to Vermont, to an extreme a-frame house in Mad River Valley.

Ultimately, readers crowned the Napa home built from moist natural materials as their House of the Month for March.

What will the month of April bring? Be sure to check out WSJ.com/RealEstate as we reveal a new House of the Week every Friday. And thanks for voting!

This Napa home, which received the most votes in our poll, spans 4,382 square feet and has a pool, a horse barn, and a 2-acre carbernet vineyard. The owner sourced materials from three caves on the property to build the green, energy-efficient home.

This A-frame home, which came in third, uses towering tree trunks as a key structural element. The owner said the massive trunks measure about 30 feet tall and up to 4 feet in diameter. "They were rescue trees cut down for other projects."

Our second-place home was inspired by the owner's love of basketball. The court is 15 feet below ground and has a scoreboard, a viewing area, a locker room with five bathrooms and private parking. There is also a $100,000 sneaker closet.

CLOCKWISE FROM TOP: OPEN HOMES/SOTHEBY'S INTERNATIONAL REALTY; REFLECTING WALLS PHOTOGRAPHY; JACK REYNOLDS

ADVERTISEMENT

Distinctive Properties

To advertise: email sales.realestate@wsj.com or WSJ.com/classifieds

TEXAS

MORELAND PROPERTIES

Tour Austin like never before during our

CITYWIDE OPEN HOUSE

SAT, 4/5 & SUN, 4/6

Over 60 homes on tour | Scan for list

Forbes GLOBAL PROPERTIES

LUXURY PORTFOLIO INTERNATIONAL

Tarrytown | Price upon request
6 BR | 6.5 BA | Architectural masterpiece | Timeless design
LAURA GREISSING 847-302-9297

Lake Austin | $7,600,000
.67-Acre of waterfront in Westlake | 2-Slip boat dock
ERIC MORELAND & ANDREW WARE 512-480-0844

Westlake | $5,950,000
5 BR | 6 BA | Austin-Westlake sanctuary with unrivaled views
SEAN KUBICEK 512-826-1135

Barton Hills | $5,250,000
Modern work of art | New construction | Over 5,000 SF
DARIN WALKER 512-560-7633

Overlooking Lake Austin | $4,995,000
4 BR | 4.5 BA | Lake Austin & city views
DARIN WALKER 512-560-7633

Tarrytown | $4,899,500
5 BR | 4.5 BA | Modern Tarrytown luxury by Kalantari Group
STEWART SHANK 512-905-2777

Westlake | $4,495,000
5 BR | 5F+2H BA | Close-in Westlake modern
SEAN KUBICEK 512-826-1135

Ranches at Dripping Springs | $4,400,000
5 BR |4.5 BA | 1.61 Acres | Keith Wing custom new build
JAN MORELAND & BEN MORTON 512-694-0494

Westlake | $3,495,000
5 BR | 5.5 BA | Custom Seven Oaks estate | Eanes ISD
LEAH PETRI 512-239-9964

Westlake | $3,300,000
4 BR | 4.5 BA | Master bath recently remodeled
ANDREW WARE 512-484-3409

Travis Heights | $2,995,000
1890 Cottage | Timeless craftsmanship & contemporary luxury
DRU BROWN 512-658-5428

Downtown | $2,990,000
3 BR | 3F+2H BA | 3 Garage spaces
ALAINA MARTIN 512-777-8082

Westlake | $2,950,000
5 BR | 4F + 2H BA | Guest house | Sport court
ANDREW WARE 512-484-3409

Lakeway | $1,799,000
4 BR | 4.5 BA | Stunning home in Serene Hills
JEAN PHILLIPS 512-924-0175

Barton Creek Lakeside | $1,049,000
4 BR | 3 BA | Single-story, like new | Climate-controlled garage
JAMIE NOVAK 512-426-9957

Madrone Canyon | $750,000
1.34 Acres | Stunning homesite | Hill Country views
KELLY MARTIN & JESSICA YATES 512-632-9091

moreland.com | @morelandproperties
RESIDENTIAL | LAND & RANCH | DEVELOPMENT

AN ORIGINAL AUSTIN, TEXAS BROKERAGE
Serving ATX & surrounding areas since 1986

VIRGINIA

148 Acre Farm w/ 4 Ponds

Halifax Co, VA: Selling for the estate. Beautiful 148 acre farm offered in 4 tracts. Open pastures, 4 ponds, streams, 4BR home. Adjoins 40,000 acre preserve.
Details at **TRFAuctions.com | 434.847.7741 |** VAAF501


SOLD


SOLD